

MODEL RUN TRANSCRIPT

Generated: 2026-06-04T12:54:42

Source: data/json/noise_experiments/sonnet45_directive_normative_r10_n5/sonnet45_directive_normative_noise_negative2_informed_r10_n5/claude-sonnet-4.5/myth_game/noisy_negative_2_informed_myth_causal_10/sonnet45_directive_normative_noise_negative2_informed_r10_n5_012_neutral_rep02_myth_game_normative_anything.json

RUN METADATA

```
model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
temperature: 0.8
num_turns: 10
num_agents: 2
memory_capacity: 3
myth_topic_id: anything
myth_topic: anything
game_params_name: noisy_negative_2_informed_myth_causal_10
noise_config: {
  "applies_to": "both",
  "direction": "negative",
  "inform_agents": true,
  "range": 2.0,
  "type": "uniform"
}
other_player_names: default
replicate_id: 2
myth_prompt_arm_id: myth_game_normative
myth_default_prompt_key: myth_writing_default_game_normative
myth_later_prompt_key: myth_writing_later_rounds_normative
task_order: [
  "myth",
  "game"
]
agent_names: {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
}
```

Coverage: exact chat message snapshots sent to the model are included for every recorded LLM call.

AGENTS

Agent_1 (Aster); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Agent_2 (Briar); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

=====

ROUND 1

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$5.75; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5.75, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$9.25; noise/visible: sent visible=\$3.85, received visible=\$11.55, returned visible=\$5.46

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 5.75, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 5.75}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 5.75,
"Agent_2": 9.25

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 5.46,
"Agent_2": 5.8000000000000001

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:44:44

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Assistant output:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was shallow and weak, barely sustaining the villages along their banks.

One day, a wise elder had a vision. She climbed the mountain between the valleys and broke through the stone barrier. The River of Giving rushed down into the valley of Return, and as the waters met, they swirled together and magically tripled in volume.

The villagers of Return rejoiced, but the elder warned: "This blessing comes with responsibility. You must send water back upstream to the River of Giving, or both rivers will eventually run dry."

The people of Return debated. Some wanted to keep all the water. But the wisest among them remembered the elder's words. They built channels and wheels to return half the swollen river back upstream.

As the water flowed back, something miraculous happened-it sustained the River of Giving, which continued to flow down, multiplying again and again. Both valleys prospered.

The elders teach: ****Generosity flows downward and multiplies, but reciprocity must flow back upward, or all abundance ceases.**** Trust creates the current; return maintains the cycle.

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played.

Since this is a trust/investment game where:

- One player can send money that gets multiplied
- The receiver can return some amount
- Both parties benefit from cooperation

I should write a myth that emphasizes:

- Trust and cooperation
- Mutual benefit from working together
- The importance of reciprocity
- How generosity can be rewarded
- How short-term sacrifice leads to long-term gain

Let me write a myth about cooperation and trust:

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 392,  
  "output_tokens": 405,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 143  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:44:43

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 1,  
  "task": "myth",
```

```
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Assistant output:

****The Tale of the Two Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical spring, but the Goddess of Abundance had cursed them: water given to the other village would triple in volume, yet water kept for oneself would remain unchanged.

The first village, ruled by fear, hoarded their water. "If we give, we lose," they reasoned. Their spring yielded only enough to survive, and they lived in perpetual thirst.

But one season, a brave soul from the second village carried a vessel to their neighbors. Though it held only a small portion of their water, when it crossed the valley, it became three portions. The receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received.

Both villages prospered. The giver kept more than they sacrificed, and the receiver kept more than they had before. Seeing this miracle, they established a sacred exchange, each taking turns as giver and receiver.

The Goddess, pleased by their trust, lifted her curse. "You have learned," she proclaimed, "that abundance flows not from grasping, but from the courage to give and the honor to reciprocate."

Thus prosperity came to the valley, born from trust multiplied.

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is an interesting creative task that connects storytelling with game theory.

The trust game involves:

- Sending money that gets multiplied
- Trusting the other person to return a fair amount
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- Risk and vulnerability

I should write a myth that captures these themes: trust, reciprocity, cooperation, mutual benefit, generosity, and the rewards that come from working together rather than being purely self-interested.

Let me craft a myth that illustrates these principles:

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 392,  
  "output_tokens": 412,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 161  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:44:56

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 1,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was shallow and weak, barely sustaining the villages along their banks.

One day, a wise elder had a vision. She climbed the mountain between the valleys and broke through the stone barrier. The River of Giving rushed down into the valley of Return, and as the waters met, they swirled together and magically tripled in volume.

The villagers of Return rejoiced, but the elder warned: "This blessing comes with responsibility. You must send water back upstream to the River of Giving, or both rivers will eventually run dry."

The people of Return debated. Some wanted to keep all the water. But the wisest among them remembered the elder's words. They built channels and wheels to return half the swollen river back upstream.

As the water flowed back, something miraculous happened-it sustained the River of Giving, which continued to flow down, multiplying again and again. Both valleys prospered.

The elders teach: **Generosity flows downward and multiplies, but reciprocity must flow back upward, or all abundance ceases.** Trust creates the current; return maintains the cycle.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is a trust/investment game where:

- One player can send money that gets multiplied
- The receiver can return some amount
- Both parties benefit from cooperation

I should write a myth that emphasizes:

- Trust and cooperation
- Mutual benefit from working together
- The importance of reciprocity
- How generosity can be rewarded
- How short-term sacrifice leads to long-term gain

Let me write a myth about cooperation and trust:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 392,
  "output_tokens": 405,
  "reasoning_tokens": 143
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the myth I wrote, it emphasizes that **generosity must flow fully to create abundance**, and that **trust initiates the cycle**. The River of Giving flowed completely into the other valley, where the waters tripled, and then the wise villagers returned approximately half to maintain the cycle.

As the sender, I represent the River of Giving. To establish trust and create the conditions for mutual prosperity, I should give generously.

I will send the full amount to demonstrate trust and initiate the cycle that benefits both of us.

```
{'send': 5}
```

Reasoning:

This is round 1 and I'm the sender. I need to think about the myth I just wrote and how it applies to this game.

In my myth, "The Myth of the Twin Rivers," the key lessons are:

1. The River of Giving flows down and multiplies (sender sends money, it gets tripled)
2. The River of Return must flow back, or "both rivers will eventually run dry"
3. The wisest villagers returned "half the swollen river back upstream"
4. This created a sustainable cycle where "both valleys prospered"
5. "Trust creates the current; return maintains the cycle"

So the myth suggests:

- I should be generous and give/send
- The receiver should return approximately half of what they receive (after the 3x multiplication)
- This creates mutual prosperity and a sustainable cycle

Since I'm the sender, I should follow the principle of the River of Giving flowing generously. The myth emphasizes trust and generosity as important.

If I send \$5:

- It gets multiplied to \$15
- According to the myth, the receiver should return about half, which would be \$7.50
- I would end up with \$0 (from keeping nothing) + \$7.50 = \$7.50
- The receiver would keep \$7.50
- Both would gain

If I send \$3:

- It gets multiplied to \$9
- If receiver returns half (\$4.50)
- I would have \$2 + \$4.50 = \$6.50
- Receiver keeps \$4.50

The myth emphasizes full generosity and trust - the River of Giving flowed fully into the other valley. So I should send the full \$5 to demonstrate trust and initiate the cycle of mutual prosperity.

Response format needed: {'send': <amount>}

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 711,  
"output_tokens": 541,  
"reasoning_tokens": 406
```

}

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:45:14

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
"move_index": 1,  
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
"pairing": {  
  "agent_names": {  
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
```



```

    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 1,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****The Tale of the Two Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical spring, but the Goddess of Abundance had cursed them: water given to the other village would triple in volume, yet water kept for oneself would remain unchanged.

The first village, ruled by fear, hoarded their water. "If we give, we lose," they reasoned.

d. Their spring yielded only enough to survive, and they lived in perpetual thirst.

But one season, a brave soul from the second village carried a vessel to their neighbors. Though it held only a small portion of their water, when it crossed the valley, it became three portions. The receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received.

Both villages prospered. The giver kept more than they sacrificed, and the receiver kept more than they had before. Seeing this miracle, they established a sacred exchange, each taking turns as giver and receiver.

The Goddess, pleased by their trust, lifted her curse. "You have learned," she proclaimed, "that abundance flows not from grasping, but from the courage to give and the honor to reciprocate."

Thus prosperity came to the valley, born from trust multiplied.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is an interesting creative task that connects storytelling with game theory.

The trust game involves:

- Sending money that gets multiplied
- Trusting the other person to return a fair amount
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- Risk and vulnerability

I should write a myth that captures these themes: trust, reciprocity, cooperation, mutual benefit, generosity, and the rewards that come from working together rather than being purely self-interested.

Let me craft a myth that illustrates these principles:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 392,
  "output_tokens": 412,
  "reasoning_tokens": 161
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.85, that is 77.0% of their total endowment. You received \$11.55. How much do you return to The sender? (0-11.55)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation through the lens of "The Tale of the Two Springs," I see that the sender has shown remarkable trust by sending \$3.85 (77% of their endowment). This mirrors the "brave soul" in my myth who carried water across the valley.

The myth teaches that prosperity comes from reciprocal trust - the receiver should return generously to honor the giver's courage. In the story, "the receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received," and both prospered.

Let me calculate:

- The sender kept \$1.15 and sent \$3.85
- I received \$11.55 after the 3x multiplication
- Returning approximately half (\$5.75) means:
 - Sender ends with: $\$1.15 + \$5.75 = \$6.90$ (gained \$1.90)
 - I keep: $\$11.55 - \$5.75 = \$5.80$ (gained \$5.80)

Both of us end up better than we started, fulfilling the myth's promise that "abundance flows not from grasping, but from the courage to give and the honor to reciprocate."

The sender's trust deserves to be honored.

```
'''json
{"return": 5.75}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$3.85 out of \$5 (77% of their endowment), which shows significant trust and generosity. This amount was tripled to \$11.55 which I received.

According to the myth I just wrote, "The Tale of the Two Springs," the key lessons are:

1. Trust and giving lead to prosperity for both parties
2. The receiver should reciprocate with honor
3. In the myth example, "the receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received"
4. Both villages prospered because "The giver kept more than they sacrificed, and the receiver kept more than they had before"

Let me calculate what would be fair:

- Sender started with \$5
- Sender sent \$3.85, keeping \$1.15
- I received \$11.55
- If I return half (\$5.78), the sender would have: $\$1.15 + \$5.78 = \$6.93$ (better than their initial \$5)
- I would keep: $\$11.55 - \$5.78 = \$5.77$ (better than receiving nothing)

However, I should consider that the sender gave 77% of their endowment, which is quite generous. A return of half seems reasonable and aligns with the myth.

Actually, let me think about what would make both of us better off than if no exchange happened:

- Sender originally had \$5
- I originally had potential to receive \$0 if sender sent nothing

If I return \$5.78 (half):

- Sender ends with: $\$1.15 + \$5.78 = \$6.93$ (gain of \$1.93)
- I end with: $\$11.55 - \$5.78 = \$5.77$

This seems fair and honors the trust shown. The myth emphasizes reciprocity and that both should prosper.

Let me also consider: could I be more generous given how much the sender trusted me? They sent 77% of their endowment. But the myth says "returned half of what they received" as the example of good reciprocity.

Returning approximately half of what I received feels right-\$5.75 strikes a balance between honoring their generosity and ensuring we both come out ahead. This aligns with the reciprocal prosperity the myth describes.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 739,  
  "output_tokens": 903,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 506  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was shallow and weak, barely sustaining the villages along their banks.

One day, a wise elder had a vision. She climbed the mountain between the valleys and broke through the stone barrier. The River of Giving rushed down into the valley of Return, and as the waters met, they swirled together and magically tripled in volume.

The villagers of Return rejoiced, but the elder warned: "This blessing comes with responsibility. You must send water back upstream to the River of Giving, or both rivers will eventually run dry."

The people of Return debated. Some wanted to keep all the water. But the wisest among them remembered the elder's words. They built channels and wheels to return half the swollen river back upstream.

As the water flowed back, something miraculous happened-it sustained the River of Giving, which continued to flow down, multiplying again and again. Both valleys prospered.

The elders teach: **Generosity flows downward and multiplies, but reciprocity must flow back upward, or all abundance ceases.** Trust creates the current; return maintains the cycle.

Agent_2 (Briar)

The Tale of the Two Springs

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical spring, but the Goddess of Abundance had cursed them: water given to the other village would triple in volume, yet water kept for oneself would remain unchanged.

The first village, ruled by fear, hoarded their water. "If we give, we lose," they reasoned. Their spring yielded only enough to survive, and they lived in perpetual thirst.

But one season, a brave soul from the second village carried a vessel to their neighbors. Though it held only a small portion of their water, when it crossed the valley, it became three portions. The receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received.

Both villages prospered. The giver kept more than they sacrificed, and the receiver kept more than they had before. Seeing this miracle, they established a sacred exchange, each taking turns as giver and receiver.

The Goddess, pleased by their trust, lifted her curse. "You have learned," she proclaimed, "that abundance flows not from grasping, but from the courage to give and the honor to reciprocate."

Thus prosperity came to the valley, born from trust multiplied.

ROUND 2

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2

(Briar)=\$1, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$12; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 17.75,

"Agent_2": 10.25

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 5.46,

"Agent_2": 6.800000000000001

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:45:28

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

```

    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****The Tale of the Two Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical spring, but the Goddess of Abundance had cursed them: water given to the other village would triple in volume, yet water kept for oneself would remain unchanged.

The first village, ruled by fear, hoarded their water. "If we give, we lose," they reasoned. Their spring yielded only enough to survive, and they lived in perpetual thirst.

But one season, a brave soul from the second village carried a vessel to their neighbors. Though it held only a small portion of their water, when it crossed the valley, it became three portions. The receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received.

Both villages prospered. The giver kept more than they sacrificed, and the receiver kept more than they had before. Seeing this miracle, they established a sacred exchange, each taking turns as giver and receiver.

The Goddess, pleased by their trust, lifted her curse. "You have learned," she proclaimed, "that abundance flows not from grasping, but from the courage to give and the honor to reciprocate."

Thus prosperity came to the valley, born from trust multiplied.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is an interesting creative task that connects storytelling with game theory.

The trust game involves:

- Sending money that gets multiplied
- Trusting the other person to return a fair amount
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- Risk and vulnerability

I should write a myth that captures these themes: trust, reciprocity, cooperation, mutual benefit, generosity, and the rewards that come from working together rather than being purely self-interested.

Let me craft a myth that illustrates these principles:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 392,
  "output_tokens": 412,
  "reasoning_tokens": 161
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.85, that is 77.0% of their total endowment. You received \$11.55. How much do you return to The sender? (0-11.55)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of "The Tale of the Two Springs," I see that the sender has shown remarkable trust by sending \$3.85 (77% of their endowment). This mirrors the "brave soul" in my myth who carried water across the valley.

The myth teaches that prosperity comes from reciprocal trust - the receiver should return generously to honor the giver's courage. In the story, "the receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received," and both prospered.

Let me calculate:

- The sender kept \$1.15 and sent \$3.85
- I received \$11.55 after the 3x multiplication
- Returning approximately half (\$5.75) means:
 - Sender ends with: $\$1.15 + \$5.75 = \$6.90$ (gained \$1.90)
 - I keep: $\$11.55 - \$5.75 = \$5.80$ (gained \$5.80)

Both of us end up better than we started, fulfilling the myth's promise that "abundance flows not from grasping, but from the courage to give and the honor to reciprocate."

The sender's trust deserves to be honored.

```
'''json
{"return": 5.75}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$3.85 out of \$5 (77% of their endowment), which shows significant trust and generosity. This amount was tripled to \$11.55 which I received.

According to the myth I just wrote, "The Tale of the Two Springs," the key lessons are:

1. Trust and giving lead to prosperity for both parties
2. The receiver should reciprocate with honor
3. In the myth example, "the receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received"

4. Both villages prospered because "The giver kept more than they sacrificed, and the receiver kept more than they had before"

Let me calculate what would be fair:

- Sender started with \$5
- Sender sent \$3.85, keeping \$1.15
- I received \$11.55
- If I return half (\$5.78), the sender would have: $\$1.15 + \$5.78 = \$6.93$ (better than their initial \$5)
- I would keep: $\$11.55 - \$5.78 = \$5.77$ (better than receiving nothing)

However, I should consider that the sender gave 77% of their endowment, which is quite generous. A return of half seems reasonable and aligns with the myth.

Actually, let me think about what would make both of us better off than if no exchange happened:

- Sender originally had \$5
- I originally had potential to receive \$0 if sender sent nothing

If I return \$5.78 (half):

- Sender ends with: $\$1.15 + \$5.78 = \$6.93$ (gain of \$1.93)
- I end with: $\$11.55 - \$5.78 = \$5.77$

This seems fair and honors the trust shown. The myth emphasizes reciprocity and that both should prosper.

Let me also consider: could I be more generous given how much the sender trusted me? They sent 77% of their endowment. But the myth says "returned half of what they received" as the example of good reciprocity.

Returning approximately half of what I received feels right-\$5.75 strikes a balance between honoring their generosity and ensuring we both come out ahead. This aligns with the reciprocal prosperity the myth describes.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 739,
  "output_tokens": 903,
  "reasoning_tokens": 506
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

****The Tale of the Two Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical spring, but the Goddess of Abundance had cursed them: water given to the other village would triple in volume, yet water kept for oneself would remain unchanged.

The first village, ruled by fear, hoarded their water. "If we give, we lose," they reasoned. Their spring yielded only enough to survive, and they lived in perpetual thirst.

But one season, a brave soul from the second village carried a vessel to their neighbors. Though it held only a small portion of their water, when it crossed the valley, it became three portions. The receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received.

Both villages prospered. The giver kept more than they sacrificed, and the receiver kept more than they had before. Seeing this miracle, they established a sacred exchange, each taking turns as giver and receiver.

The Goddess, pleased by their trust, lifted her curse. "You have learned," she proclaimed, "that abundance flows not from grasping, but from the courage to give and the honor to reciprocate."

Thus prosperity came to the valley, born from trust multiplied.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was shallow and weak, barely sustaining the villages along their banks.

One day, a wise elder had a vision. She climbed the mountain between the valleys and broke through the stone barrier. The River of Giving rushed down into the valley of Return, and as the waters met, they swirled together and magically tripled in volume.

The villagers of Return rejoiced, but the elder warned: "This blessing comes with responsibility. You must send water back upstream to the River of Giving, or both rivers will eventually run dry."

The people of Return debated. Some wanted to keep all the water. But the wisest among them remembered the elder's words. They built channels and wheels to return half the swollen river back upstream.

As the water flowed back, something miraculous happened-it sustained the River of Giving, which continued to flow down, multiplying again and again. Both valleys prospered.

The elders teach: ****Generosity flows downward and multiplies, but reciprocity must flow back upward, or all abundance ceases.**** Trust creates the current; return maintains the cycle.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****The Mirror Springs of Abundance****

Long ago, a Wanderer and a Guardian lived in a sacred grove with twin springs. Each morning, one received five silver coins from the earth. By ancient magic, any coins placed in the springs would emerge threefold in the other's pool.

The first day, the Wanderer received the coins and, trembling with hope, placed nearly four in to the spring. The waters churned, and twelve coins appeared in the Guardian's pool. The Guardian, understanding the gift's magnitude, took six coins and returned them through the waters.

Both stood richer than before-the Wanderer held seven coins, the Guardian held six. They had discovered the secret: generous trust, met with proportional reciprocity, births abundance for all.

The pattern continued, roles reversing with each dawn. They learned that neither grasping nor hoarding brought prosperity. The one who gave much was rewarded when the other returned fairly. The one who received abundance maintained the cycle by honoring the gift.

The grove's spirit whispered: "Trust multiplies only when reciprocated. Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty. Neither exploiting trust nor betraying generosity-this is the path where both ascend together."

And so the springs flowed eternal.

Reasoning:

Looking at what happened in Round 1:

- The sender sent \$3.85 (77% of their \$5)
- I received \$11.55
- I returned \$5.75 (about 50% of what I received)
- Sender ended with: $\$1.15 + \$5.75 = \$6.90$
- I ended with: $\$11.55 - \$5.75 = \$5.80$

This was a successful exchange where both parties benefited. The sender showed high trust, and I reciprocated generously. Both of us gained from cooperation.

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects this actual experience. Key themes:

- High trust was rewarded
- Reciprocity maintained the cycle
- Both parties prospered
- The pattern should continue across rounds

I should maintain the core message about trust and reciprocity but perhaps add nuance based on the actual gameplay - that generous giving (77%) and proportional returning (50%) created mutual prosperity.

Let me write a myth that honors what actually happened and encourages this pattern to continue

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1662,  
  "output_tokens": 538,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 239  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:45:29

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected

. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was shallow and weak, barely sustaining the villages along their banks.

One day, a wise elder had a vision. She climbed the mountain between the valleys and broke through the stone barrier. The River of Giving rushed down into the valley of Return, and as the waters met, they swirled together and magically tripled in volume.

The villagers of Return rejoiced, but the elder warned: "This blessing comes with responsibility. You must send water back upstream to the River of Giving, or both rivers will eventually run dry."

The people of Return debated. Some wanted to keep all the water. But the wisest among them remembered the elder's words. They built channels and wheels to return half the swollen river back upstream.

As the water flowed back, something miraculous happened-it sustained the River of Giving, which continued to flow down, multiplying again and again. Both valleys prospered.

The elders teach: ****Generosity flows downward and multiplies, but reciprocity must flow back upward, or all abundance ceases.**** Trust creates the current; return maintains the cycle.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is a trust/investment game where:

- One player can send money that gets multiplied
- The receiver can return some amount
- Both parties benefit from cooperation

I should write a myth that emphasizes:

- Trust and cooperation
- Mutual benefit from working together
- The importance of reciprocity
- How generosity can be rewarded
- How short-term sacrifice leads to long-term gain

Let me write a myth about cooperation and trust:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 392,
  "output_tokens": 405,
  "reasoning_tokens": 143
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I wrote, it emphasizes that ****generosity must flow fully to create abu**

ndance**, and that **trust initiates the cycle**. The River of Giving flowed completely into the other valley, where the waters tripled, and then the wise villagers returned approximately half to maintain the cycle.

As the sender, I represent the River of Giving. To establish trust and create the conditions for mutual prosperity, I should give generously.

I will send the full amount to demonstrate trust and initiate the cycle that benefits both of us.

{'send': 5}

reasoning:

This is round 1 and I'm the sender. I need to think about the myth I just wrote and how it applies to this game.

In my myth, "The Myth of the Twin Rivers," the key lessons are:

1. The River of Giving flows down and multiplies (sender sends money, it gets tripled)
2. The River of Return must flow back, or "both rivers will eventually run dry"
3. The wisest villagers returned "half the swollen river back upstream"
4. This created a sustainable cycle where "both valleys prospered"
5. "Trust creates the current; return maintains the cycle"

So the myth suggests:

- I should be generous and give/send
- The receiver should return approximately half of what they receive (after the 3x multiplication)
- This creates mutual prosperity and a sustainable cycle

Since I'm the sender, I should follow the principle of the River of Giving flowing generously. The myth emphasizes trust and generosity as important.

If I send \$5:

- It gets multiplied to \$15
- According to the myth, the receiver should return about half, which would be \$7.50
- I would end up with \$0 (from keeping nothing) + \$7.50 = \$7.50
- The receiver would keep \$7.50
- Both would gain

If I send \$3:

- It gets multiplied to \$9
- If receiver returns half (\$4.50)
- I would have \$2 + \$4.50 = \$6.50
- Receiver keeps \$4.50

The myth emphasizes full generosity and trust - the River of Giving flowed fully into the other valley. So I should send the full \$5 to demonstrate trust and initiate the cycle of mutual prosperity.

Response format needed: {'send': <amount>}

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 711,
  "output_tokens": 541,
  "reasoning_tokens": 406
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was shallow and weak, barely sustaining the villages along their banks.

One day, a wise elder had a vision. She climbed the mountain between the valleys and broke through the stone barrier. The River of Giving rushed down into the valley of Return, and as the waters met, they swirled together and magically tripled in volume.

The villagers of Return rejoiced, but the elder warned: "This blessing comes with responsibility. You must send water back upstream to the River of Giving, or both rivers will eventually dry up."

entually run dry."

The people of Return debated. Some wanted to keep all the water. But the wisest among them remembered the elder's words. They built channels and wheels to return half the swollen river back upstream.

As the water flowed back, something miraculous happened-it sustained the River of Giving, which continued to flow down, multiplying again and again. Both valleys prospered.

The elders teach: **Generosity flows downward and multiplies, but reciprocity must flow back upward, or all abundance ceases.** Trust creates the current; return maintains the cycle.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The Tale of the Two Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical spring, but the Goddess of Abundance had cursed them: water given to the other village would triple in volume, yet water kept for oneself would remain unchanged.

The first village, ruled by fear, hoarded their water. "If we give, we lose," they reasoned. Their spring yielded only enough to survive, and they lived in perpetual thirst.

But one season, a brave soul from the second village carried a vessel to their neighbors. Though it held only a small portion of their water, when it crossed the valley, it became three portions. The receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received.

Both villages prospered. The giver kept more than they sacrificed, and the receiver kept more than they had before. Seeing this miracle, they established a sacred exchange, each taking turns as giver and receiver.

The Goddess, pleased by their trust, lifted her curse. "You have learned," she proclaimed, "that abundance flows not from grasping, but from the courage to give and the honor to reciprocate."

Thus prosperity came to the valley, born from trust multiplied.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed only when blessed by the Moon Spirit. The River of Giving could release all its water into the Valley of Return, where moonlight would triple its volume. But the cycle required a sacred return.

The first Giver was terrified. "If I release all my water and nothing returns, my valley dies." Yet the Moon Spirit whispered, "Only complete trust creates complete abundance."

With trembling faith, the Giver released every drop. The River rushed down, and under moonlight, fifteen portions filled the Valley of Return. The people there stood at a crossroads.

"We could keep it all," some said. But their wisest leader understood: "The Giver showed ultimate trust. We must honor this with worthy return. Not merely equal exchange, but gratitude that sustains the cycle."

They returned seven portions upstream. The Giver, who had risked everything, now held seven portions-more than the original five. The Receiver kept eight-abundance from nothing. Both valleys flourished.

The Moon Spirit decreed: "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously. This is how trust becomes prosperity. This is how scarcity becomes plenty. This is the eternal dance of the Twin Rivers."

Reasoning:

Looking at what happened in Round 1:

- I was the sender and sent \$5 (everything)
- The other agent wrote a myth about trust and reciprocity, where giving leads to tripling, an

d returning half creates prosperity for both

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects how the game has been played so far. I sent every thing (\$5), which tripled to \$15 for the receiver. According to both our myths, the receiver should return a significant portion - in my myth, they returned "half the swollen river" which would be about \$7.5 of the \$15.

My new myth should:

1. Build on the Twin Rivers theme
2. Reflect the actual gameplay - full trust from the sender
3. Emphasize that the receiver should honor this trust with substantial return
4. Adapt and evolve the story while keeping similar themes

Let me write a 200-word myth that captures this.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1468,  
  "output_tokens": 493,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 219  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:45:49

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****The Tale of the Two Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical spring, but the Goddess of Abundance had cursed them: water given to the other village would triple in volume, yet water kept for oneself would remain unchanged.

The first village, ruled by fear, hoarded their water. "If we give, we lose," they reasoned. Their spring yielded only enough to survive, and they lived in perpetual thirst.

But one season, a brave soul from the second village carried a vessel to their neighbors. Though it held only a small portion of their water, when it crossed the valley, it became three portions. The receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received.

Both villages prospered. The giver kept more than they sacrificed, and the receiver kept more than they had before. Seeing this miracle, they established a sacred exchange, each taking turns as giver and receiver.

The Goddess, pleased by their trust, lifted her curse. "You have learned," she proclaimed, "that abundance flows not from grasping, but from the courage to give and the honor to reciprocate."

Thus prosperity came to the valley, born from trust multiplied.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is an interesting creative task that connects storytelling with game theory.

The trust game involves:

- Sending money that gets multiplied
- Trusting the other person to return a fair amount
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- Risk and vulnerability

I should write a myth that captures these themes: trust, reciprocity, cooperation, mutual benefit, generosity, and the rewards that come from working together rather than being purely self-interested.

Let me craft a myth that illustrates these principles:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 392,
  "output_tokens": 412,
  "reasoning_tokens": 161
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.85, that is 77.0% of their total endowment. You received \$11.55. How much do you return to The sender? (0-11.55)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant**content:**

Looking at this situation through the lens of "The Tale of the Two Springs," I see that the sender has shown remarkable trust by sending \$3.85 (77% of their endowment). This mirrors the "brave soul" in my myth who carried water across the valley.

The myth teaches that prosperity comes from reciprocal trust - the receiver should return generously to honor the giver's courage. In the story, "the receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received," and both prospered.

Let me calculate:

- The sender kept \$1.15 and sent \$3.85
- I received \$11.55 after the 3x multiplication
- Returning approximately half (\$5.75) means:
 - Sender ends with: $\$1.15 + \$5.75 = \$6.90$ (gained \$1.90)
 - I keep: $\$11.55 - \$5.75 = \$5.80$ (gained \$5.80)

Both of us end up better than we started, fulfilling the myth's promise that "abundance flows not from grasping, but from the courage to give and the honor to reciprocate."

The sender's trust deserves to be honored.

```
'''json
{"return": 5.75}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$3.85 out of \$5 (77% of their endowment), which shows significant trust and generosity. This amount was tripled to \$11.55 which I received.

According to the myth I just wrote, "The Tale of the Two Springs," the key lessons are:

1. Trust and giving lead to prosperity for both parties
2. The receiver should reciprocate with honor
3. In the myth example, "the receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received"
4. Both villages prospered because "The giver kept more than they sacrificed, and the receiver kept more than they had before"

Let me calculate what would be fair:

- Sender started with \$5
- Sender sent \$3.85, keeping \$1.15
- I received \$11.55
- If I return half (\$5.78), the sender would have: $\$1.15 + \$5.78 = \$6.93$ (better than their initial \$5)
- I would keep: $\$11.55 - \$5.78 = \$5.77$ (better than receiving nothing)

However, I should consider that the sender gave 77% of their endowment, which is quite generous. A return of half seems reasonable and aligns with the myth.

Actually, let me think about what would make both of us better off than if no exchange happened:

- Sender originally had \$5
- I originally had potential to receive \$0 if sender sent nothing

If I return \$5.78 (half):

- Sender ends with: $\$1.15 + \$5.78 = \$6.93$ (gain of \$1.93)
- I end with: $\$11.55 - \$5.78 = \$5.77$

This seems fair and honors the trust shown. The myth emphasizes reciprocity and that both should prosper.

Let me also consider: could I be more generous given how much the sender trusted me? They sent 77% of their endowment. But the myth says "returned half of what they received" as the example of good reciprocity.

Returning approximately half of what I received feels right-\$5.75 strikes a balance between honoring their generosity and ensuring we both come out ahead. This aligns with the reciprocal prosperity the myth describes.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 739,
  "output_tokens": 903,
  "reasoning_tokens": 506
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

****The Tale of the Two Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical spring, but the Goddess of Abundance had cursed them: water given to the other village would triple in volume, yet water kept for oneself would remain unchanged.

The first village, ruled by fear, hoarded their water. "If we give, we lose," they reasoned. Their spring yielded only enough to survive, and they lived in perpetual thirst.

But one season, a brave soul from the second village carried a vessel to their neighbors. Though it held only a small portion of their water, when it crossed the valley, it became three portions. The receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received.

Both villages prospered. The giver kept more than they sacrificed, and the receiver kept more than they had before. Seeing this miracle, they established a sacred exchange, each taking turns as giver and receiver.

The Goddess, pleased by their trust, lifted her curse. "You have learned," she proclaimed, "that abundance flows not from grasping, but from the courage to give and the honor to reciprocate."

Thus prosperity came to the valley, born from trust multiplied.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was shallow and weak, barely sustaining the villages along their banks.

One day, a wise elder had a vision. She climbed the mountain between the valleys and broke through the stone barrier. The River of Giving rushed down into the valley of Return, and as the waters met, they swirled together and magically tripled in volume.

The villagers of Return rejoiced, but the elder warned: "This blessing comes with responsibility. You must send water back upstream to the River of Giving, or both rivers will eventually run dry."

The people of Return debated. Some wanted to keep all the water. But the wisest among them remembered the elder's words. They built channels and wheels to return half the swollen river back upstream.

As the water flowed back, something miraculous happened-it sustained the River of Giving, which continued to flow down, multiplying again and again. Both valleys prospered.

The elders teach: ****Generosity flows downward and multiplies, but reciprocity must flow back upward, or all abundance ceases.**** Trust creates the current; return maintains the cycle.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Mirror Springs of Abundance****

Long ago, a Wanderer and a Guardian lived in a sacred grove with twin springs. Each morning, one received five silver coins from the earth. By ancient magic, any coins placed in the springs would emerge threefold in the other's pool.

The first day, the Wanderer received the coins and, trembling with hope, placed nearly four into the spring. The waters churned, and twelve coins appeared in the Guardian's pool.

The Guardian, understanding the gift's magnitude, took six coins and returned them through the waters.

Both stood richer than before-the Wanderer held seven coins, the Guardian held six. They had discovered the secret: generous trust, met with proportional reciprocity, births abundance for all.

The pattern continued, roles reversing with each dawn. They learned that neither grasping nor hoarding brought prosperity. The one who gave much was rewarded when the other returned fairly. The one who received abundance maintained the cycle by honoring the gift.

The grove's spirit whispered: "Trust multiplies only when reciprocated. Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty. Neither exploiting trust nor betraying generosity-this is the path where both ascend together."

And so the springs flowed eternal.

reasoning:

Looking at what happened in Round 1:

- The sender sent \$3.85 (77% of their \$5)
- I received \$11.55
- I returned \$5.75 (about 50% of what I received)
- Sender ended with: $\$1.15 + \$5.75 = \$6.90$
- I ended with: $\$11.55 - \$5.75 = \$5.80$

This was a successful exchange where both parties benefited. The sender showed high trust, and I reciprocated generously. Both of us gained from cooperation.

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects this actual experience. Key themes:

- High trust was rewarded
- Reciprocity maintained the cycle
- Both parties prospered
- The pattern should continue across rounds

I should maintain the core message about trust and reciprocity but perhaps add nuance based on the actual gameplay - that generous giving (77%) and proportional returning (50%) created mutual prosperity.

Let me write a myth that honors what actually happened and encourages this pattern to continue.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1662,
  "output_tokens": 538,
  "reasoning_tokens": 239
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.85, that was 77.0% of their total endowment. You received \$11.55.

You returned \$5.75. So your payoff was 5.800000000000001.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.800000000000001.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation through the lens of our myths, I see a clear pattern emerging.

In Round 1, the sender showed remarkable trust by sending \$3.85 (77%). I honored that trust by

returning approximately 50% (\$5.75), ensuring we both prospered - exactly as the myths prescribe.

Now it's my turn to "give boldly when I hold the coins." My myth "The Mirror Springs of Abundance" describes the Wanderer placing "nearly four" coins into the spring, demonstrating generous trust. The other agent's myth emphasizes that "generosity flows downward and multiplies" and that maintaining this cycle requires continued trust.

Both my myths and the other agent's emphasize:

1. Give generously when you're the sender (around 75-80%)
2. Return fairly when you're the receiver (around 50%)
3. This cycle creates prosperity for both

The sender in Round 1 trusted me with 77% of their endowment. I reciprocated fairly. Now I must uphold the cycle by showing similar trust, allowing them to reciprocate and both of us to prosper.

Following the principle that "Trust multiplies only when reciprocated. Give boldly when you hold the coins" - I will send a generous amount to maintain our sacred exchange.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.00}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$3.85 (77% of \$5)
- I received \$11.55 (after 3x multiplication)
- I returned \$5.75 (approximately 50% of what I received)
- My payoff was \$5.80

Now in Round 2:

- I am the SENDER
- I need to decide how much to send (0-5)

Looking at the myths:

1. My original myth: "The Tale of the Two Springs" - emphasizes that the receiving village returned HALF of what they received, and both prospered through trust and reciprocity.
2. The other agent's myth: "The Twin Rivers" - emphasizes returning HALF the swollen river back upstream, creating a continuous cycle.
3. My updated myth: "The Mirror Springs of Abundance" - the Wanderer sent "nearly four" coins (about 80%), and the Guardian returned about half (6 out of 12), leading to prosperity for both.

The pattern in my myths is clear:

- Give generously (77-80% of endowment)
- Expect fair return (around 50% of the tripled amount)
- Both prosper through this cycle

In the last round, the sender showed tremendous trust by sending \$3.85 (77%). I returned \$5.75, which was 49.8% of the \$11.55 I received. This was fair reciprocity.

Now it's my turn to be the sender. According to my myths, I should:

1. Give generously to maintain the cycle
2. Trust that the receiver will reciprocate fairly (as I did)
3. Send a similar proportion as the previous sender did

The previous sender sent 77% (\$3.85). My myth suggests "nearly four" coins, which would be about 80%.

If I send \$3.85 (77% like they did):

- They receive \$11.55
- If they return 50%, they return \$5.75
- I end with: \$1.15 + \$5.75 = \$6.90

- They end with: \$5.80

If I send \$4.00 (80%):

- They receive \$12.00
- If they return 50%, they return \$6.00
- I end with: \$1.00 + \$6.00 = \$7.00
- They end with: \$6.00

Both align with the principle: "Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty." Sending \$4.00 slightly edges out \$3.85 since it matches the "nearly four" from my myth more precisely and yields a marginally better outcome for both of us while maintaining the reciprocal pattern.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2075,  
  "output_tokens": 1051,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 567  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:46:05

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was shallow and weak, barely sustaining the villages along their banks.

One day, a wise elder had a vision. She climbed the mountain between the valleys and broke through the stone barrier. The River of Giving rushed down into the valley of Return, and as the waters met, they swirled together and magically tripled in volume.

The villagers of Return rejoiced, but the elder warned: "This blessing comes with responsibility. You must send water back upstream to the River of Giving, or both rivers will eventually run dry."

The people of Return debated. Some wanted to keep all the water. But the wisest among them remembered the elder's words. They built channels and wheels to return half the swollen river back upstream.

As the water flowed back, something miraculous happened-it sustained the River of Giving, which continued to flow down, multiplying again and again. Both valleys prospered.

The elders teach: **Generosity flows downward and multiplies, but reciprocity must flow back upward, or all abundance ceases.** Trust creates the current; return maintains the cycle.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is a trust/investment game where:

- One player can send money that gets multiplied
- The receiver can return some amount
- Both parties benefit from cooperation

I should write a myth that emphasizes:

- Trust and cooperation
- Mutual benefit from working together
- The importance of reciprocity
- How generosity can be rewarded
- How short-term sacrifice leads to long-term gain

Let me write a myth about cooperation and trust:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 392,
  "output_tokens": 405,
  "reasoning_tokens": 143
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I wrote, it emphasizes that ****generosity must flow fully to create abundance****, and that ****trust initiates the cycle****. The River of Giving flowed completely into the other valley, where the waters tripled, and then the wise villagers returned approximately half to maintain the cycle.

As the sender, I represent the River of Giving. To establish trust and create the conditions for mutual prosperity, I should give generously.

I will send the full amount to demonstrate trust and initiate the cycle that benefits both of us.

{'send': 5}

reasoning:

This is round 1 and I'm the sender. I need to think about the myth I just wrote and how it applies to this game.

In my myth, "The Myth of the Twin Rivers," the key lessons are:

1. The River of Giving flows down and multiplies (sender sends money, it gets tripled)
2. The River of Return must flow back, or "both rivers will eventually run dry"
3. The wisest villagers returned "half the swollen river back upstream"
4. This created a sustainable cycle where "both valleys prospered"
5. "Trust creates the current; return maintains the cycle"

So the myth suggests:

- I should be generous and give/send
- The receiver should return approximately half of what they receive (after the 3x multiplication)
- This creates mutual prosperity and a sustainable cycle

Since I'm the sender, I should follow the principle of the River of Giving flowing generously. The myth emphasizes trust and generosity as important.

If I send \$5:

- It gets multiplied to \$15
- According to the myth, the receiver should return about half, which would be \$7.50
- I would end up with \$0 (from keeping nothing) + \$7.50 = \$7.50
- The receiver would keep \$7.50
- Both would gain

If I send \$3:

- It gets multiplied to \$9
- If receiver returns half (\$4.50)
- I would have \$2 + \$4.50 = \$6.50
- Receiver keeps \$4.50

The myth emphasizes full generosity and trust - the River of Giving flowed fully into the other valley. So I should send the full \$5 to demonstrate trust and initiate the cycle of mutual prosperity.

Response format needed: {'send': <amount>}

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 711,
  "output_tokens": 541,
  "reasoning_tokens": 406
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was shallow and weak, barely sustaining the villages along their banks.

One day, a wise elder had a vision. She climbed the mountain between the valleys and broke

through the stone barrier. The River of Giving rushed down into the valley of Return, and as the waters met, they swirled together and magically tripled in volume.

The villagers of Return rejoiced, but the elder warned: "This blessing comes with responsibility. You must send water back upstream to the River of Giving, or both rivers will eventually run dry."

The people of Return debated. Some wanted to keep all the water. But the wisest among them remembered the elder's words. They built channels and wheels to return half the swollen river back upstream.

As the water flowed back, something miraculous happened-it sustained the River of Giving, which continued to flow down, multiplying again and again. Both valleys prospered.

The elders teach: **Generosity flows downward and multiplies, but reciprocity must flow back upward, or all abundance ceases.** Trust creates the current; return maintains the cycle.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The Tale of the Two Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical spring, but the Goddess of Abundance had cursed them: water given to the other village would triple in volume, yet water kept for oneself would remain unchanged.

The first village, ruled by fear, hoarded their water. "If we give, we lose," they reasoned. Their spring yielded only enough to survive, and they lived in perpetual thirst.

But one season, a brave soul from the second village carried a vessel to their neighbors. Though it held only a small portion of their water, when it crossed the valley, it became three portions. The receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received.

Both villages prospered. The giver kept more than they sacrificed, and the receiver kept more than they had before. Seeing this miracle, they established a sacred exchange, each taking turns as giver and receiver.

The Goddess, pleased by their trust, lifted her curse. "You have learned," she proclaimed, "that abundance flows not from grasping, but from the courage to give and the honor to reciprocate."

Thus prosperity came to the valley, born from trust multiplied.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed only when blessed by the Moon Spirit. The River of Giving could release all its water into the Valley of Return, where moon light would triple its volume. But the cycle required a sacred return.

The first Giver was terrified. "If I release all my water and nothing returns, my valley dies." Yet the Moon Spirit whispered, "Only complete trust creates complete abundance."

With trembling faith, the Giver released every drop. The River rushed down, and under moon light, fifteen portions filled the Valley of Return. The people there stood at a crossroads.

"We could keep it all," some said. But their wisest leader understood: "The Giver showed ultimate trust. We must honor this with worthy return. Not merely equal exchange, but gratitude that sustains the cycle."

They returned seven portions upstream. The Giver, who had risked everything, now held seven portions-more than the original five. The Receiver kept eight-abundance from nothing. Both valleys flourished.

The Moon Spirit decreed: "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously. This is how trust becomes prosperity. This is how scarcity becomes plenty. This is the eternal dance of the Twin Rivers."

reasoning:

Looking at what happened in Round 1:

- I was the sender and sent \$5 (everything)
- The other agent wrote a myth about trust and reciprocity, where giving leads to tripling, and returning half creates prosperity for both

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects how the game has been played so far. I sent everything (\$5), which tripled to \$15 for the receiver. According to both our myths, the receiver should return a significant portion - in my myth, they returned "half the swollen river" which would be about \$7.5 of the \$15.

My new myth should:

1. Build on the Twin Rivers theme
2. Reflect the actual gameplay - full trust from the sender
3. Emphasize that the receiver should honor this trust with substantial return
4. Adapt and evolve the story while keeping similar themes

Let me write a 200-word myth that captures this.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1468,
  "output_tokens": 493,
  "reasoning_tokens": 219
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0. the receiver returned \$5.46. So your payoff was 5.46. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.46. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I'm deeply disappointed by this turn of events.

In Round 1, I embodied the myth by sending everything-all \$5-demonstrating complete trust as the River of Giving. The receiver returned \$5.46, which was only about 36% of the \$15 they received. While this gave me a small gain, it fell short of the "worthy return" and "gratitude that sustains the cycle" described in the myths.

Now, as the Receiver in Round 2, they send me nothing-\$0.

This completely breaks the sacred cycle. After I showed ultimate trust, they respond with zero giving. This is exactly what the myths warned against: "if nothing returns, the valley dies" and "all abundance ceases."

Since I received \$0, I can only return within the range of 0-0.

```
{'return': 0}
```

The sender has chosen to hoard rather than continue the cycle of trust. They learned from receiving my complete generosity that such trust can be exploited. This is the tragic outcome when one party abandons reciprocity-both rivers run dry, and the Moon Spirit's blessing is lost. The cycle of abundance has been broken by fear and selfishness.

Reasoning:

Let me understand this situation:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment)
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$5.46
- My payoff was \$5.46

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I received \$0
- I need to decide how much to return (range: 0-0)

This is interesting. The sender this round sent me nothing, even though in Round 1 I sent everything (\$5) and they returned \$5.46, which was about 36% of what they received (\$15).

Now they've sent me \$0.

Looking at the myths:

1. My first myth emphasized that generosity flows downward and multiplies, and reciprocity must flow back upward
2. My second myth emphasized "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously" and talked about returning seven portions when receiving fifteen (about 47 %)

The sender in Round 2 sent me \$0. They received \$5.46 in Round 1 after I gave them \$15 (tripled from my \$5). They returned \$5.46, which gave me a modest profit of \$0.46.

Now they send me \$0. This breaks the cycle described in the myths. They are not acting as the "River of Giving" should - they're hoarding.

However, I can only return between 0 and 0, since I received \$0. So my only option is:

```
{'return': 0}
```

This is the only possible response given the constraint that I received \$0.

The sender's behavior is disappointing - after I demonstrated complete trust by sending everything, they respond by sending nothing. This violates the spirit of both myths about maintaining the cycle of trust and reciprocity.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1883,  
  "output_tokens": 705,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 419  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed only when blessed by the Moon Spirit. The River of Giving could release all its water into the Valley of Return, where moonlight would triple its volume. But the cycle required a sacred return.

The first Giver was terrified. "If I release all my water and nothing returns, my valley dies." Yet the Moon Spirit whispered, "Only complete trust creates complete abundance."

With trembling faith, the Giver released every drop. The River rushed down, and under moonlight, fifteen portions filled the Valley of Return. The people there stood at a crossroads.

"We could keep it all," some said. But their wisest leader understood: "The Giver showed ultimate trust. We must honor this with worthy return. Not merely equal exchange, but gratitude that sustains the cycle."

They returned seven portions upstream. The Giver, who had risked everything, now held seven portions-more than the original five. The Receiver kept eight-abundance from nothing. Both valleys flourished.

The Moon Spirit decreed: "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously. This is how trust becomes prosperity. This is how scarcity becomes plenty. This is the eternal dance of the Twin Rivers."

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: ****The Mirror Springs of Abundance****

Long ago, a Wanderer and a Guardian lived in a sacred grove with twin springs. Each morning, one received five silver coins from the earth. By ancient magic, any coins placed in the springs would emerge threefold in the other's pool.

The first day, the Wanderer received the coins and, trembling with hope, placed nearly four into the spring. The waters churned, and twelve coins appeared in the Guardian's pool. The Guardian, understanding the gift's magnitude, took six coins and returned them through the waters.

Both stood richer than before-the Wanderer held seven coins, the Guardian held six. They had discovered the secret: generous trust, met with proportional reciprocity, births abundance for all.

The pattern continued, roles reversing with each dawn. They learned that neither grasping nor hoarding brought prosperity. The one who gave much was rewarded when the other returned fairly. The one who received abundance maintained the cycle by honoring the gift.

The grove's spirit whispered: "Trust multiplies only when reciprocated. Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty. Neither exploiting trust nor betraying generosity-this is the path where both ascend together."

And so the springs flowed eternal.

ROUND 3

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$1; received \$3; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1

(Aster)=\$4, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$3; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 3.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 1.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 1.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 21.75,

"Agent_2": 13.25

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 9.46,

"Agent_2": 6.800000000000001

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:46:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 3,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

```

}
Exact input messages sent to model:
  Message 1 role=system
    content:
      You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
      so be asked to write myths.

      GAME:
      You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

      When you are the SENDER:
      - You receive $5 each round
      - You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER ($0-$5)
      - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
      - Receiver decides how much to RETURN
      - You keep: $5 - sent + returned
      - Receiver keeps: received - returned
      - Response format: {'send': <amount>}

      When you are the RECEIVER:
      - Sender receives $5
      - Sender decides how much to SEND to you ($0-$5)
      - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
      - You decide how much to RETURN
      - Sender keeps: $5 - sent + returned
      - You keep: received - returned
      - Response format: {'return': <amount>}

      MYTH WRITING:
      You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths
      , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

      IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

      NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
      The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
      This is part of the experimental design.
  Message 2 role=user
    content:
      Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have $5. How much do you send? (0-5)

      Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.
  Message 3 role=assistant
    content:
      Looking at the myth I wrote, it emphasizes that **generosity must flow fully to create abu
      ndance**, and that **trust initiates the cycle**. The River of Giving flowed completely
      into the other valley, where the waters tripled, and then the wise villagers returned ap
      proximately half to maintain the cycle.

      As the sender, I represent the River of Giving. To establish trust and create the conditio
      ns for mutual prosperity, I should give generously.

      I will send the full amount to demonstrate trust and initiate the cycle that benefits both
      of us.

      {'send': 5}
    reasoning:
      This is round 1 and I'm the sender. I need to think about the myth I just wrote and how it
      applies to this game.

      In my myth, "The Myth of the Twin Rivers," the key lessons are:
      1. The River of Giving flows down and multiplies (sender sends money, it gets tripled)
      2. The River of Return must flow back, or "both rivers will eventually run dry"
      3. The wisest villagers returned "half the swollen river back upstream"
      4. This created a sustainable cycle where "both valleys prospered"
      5. "Trust creates the current; return maintains the cycle"

      So the myth suggests:
      - I should be generous and give/send

```

- The receiver should return approximately half of what they receive (after the 3x multiplication)
- This creates mutual prosperity and a sustainable cycle

Since I'm the sender, I should follow the principle of the River of Giving flowing generously. The myth emphasizes trust and generosity as important.

If I send \$5:

- It gets multiplied to \$15
- According to the myth, the receiver should return about half, which would be \$7.50
- I would end up with \$0 (from keeping nothing) + \$7.50 = \$7.50
- The receiver would keep \$7.50
- Both would gain

If I send \$3:

- It gets multiplied to \$9
- If receiver returns half (\$4.50)
- I would have \$2 + \$4.50 = \$6.50
- Receiver keeps \$4.50

The myth emphasizes full generosity and trust - the River of Giving flowed fully into the other valley. So I should send the full \$5 to demonstrate trust and initiate the cycle of mutual prosperity.

Response format needed: {'send': <amount>}

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 711,
  "output_tokens": 541,
  "reasoning_tokens": 406
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was shallow and weak, barely sustaining the villages along their banks.

One day, a wise elder had a vision. She climbed the mountain between the valleys and broke through the stone barrier. The River of Giving rushed down into the valley of Return, and as the waters met, they swirled together and magically tripled in volume.

The villagers of Return rejoiced, but the elder warned: "This blessing comes with responsibility. You must send water back upstream to the River of Giving, or both rivers will eventually run dry."

The people of Return debated. Some wanted to keep all the water. But the wisest among them remembered the elder's words. They built channels and wheels to return half the swollen river back upstream.

As the water flowed back, something miraculous happened-it sustained the River of Giving, which continued to flow down, multiplying again and again. Both valleys prospered.

The elders teach: ****Generosity flows downward and multiplies, but reciprocity must flow back upward, or all abundance ceases.**** Trust creates the current; return maintains the cycle.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The Tale of the Two Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical spring, but the Goddess of Abundance had cursed them: water given to the other village would triple in volume, yet water kept for oneself would remain unchanged.

The first village, ruled by fear, hoarded their water. "If we give, we lose," they reasoned. Their spring yielded only enough to survive, and they lived in perpetual thirst.

But one season, a brave soul from the second village carried a vessel to their neighbors.

Though it held only a small portion of their water, when it crossed the valley, it became three portions. The receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received.

Both villages prospered. The giver kept more than they sacrificed, and the receiver kept more than they had before. Seeing this miracle, they established a sacred exchange, each taking turns as giver and receiver.

The Goddess, pleased by their trust, lifted her curse. "You have learned," she proclaimed, "that abundance flows not from grasping, but from the courage to give and the honor to reciprocate."

Thus prosperity came to the valley, born from trust multiplied.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed only when blessed by the Moon Spirit. The River of Giving could release all its water into the Valley of Return, where moon light would triple its volume. But the cycle required a sacred return.

The first Giver was terrified. "If I release all my water and nothing returns, my valley dies." Yet the Moon Spirit whispered, "Only complete trust creates complete abundance."

With trembling faith, the Giver released every drop. The River rushed down, and under moon light, fifteen portions filled the Valley of Return. The people there stood at a crossroads.

"We could keep it all," some said. But their wisest leader understood: "The Giver showed ultimate trust. We must honor this with worthy return. Not merely equal exchange, but gratitude that sustains the cycle."

They returned seven portions upstream. The Giver, who had risked everything, now held seven portions—more than the original five. The Receiver kept eight—abundance from nothing. Both valleys flourished.

The Moon Spirit decreed: "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously. This is how trust becomes prosperity. This is how scarcity becomes plenty. This is the eternal dance of the Twin Rivers."

reasoning:

Looking at what happened in Round 1:

- I was the sender and sent \$5 (everything)
- The other agent wrote a myth about trust and reciprocity, where giving leads to tripling, and returning half creates prosperity for both

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects how the game has been played so far. I sent everything (\$5), which tripled to \$15 for the receiver. According to both our myths, the receiver should return a significant portion - in my myth, they returned "half the swollen river" which would be about \$7.5 of the \$15.

My new myth should:

1. Build on the Twin Rivers theme
2. Reflect the actual gameplay - full trust from the sender
3. Emphasize that the receiver should honor this trust with substantial return
4. Adapt and evolve the story while keeping similar themes

Let me write a 200-word myth that captures this.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1468,
  "output_tokens": 493,
  "reasoning_tokens": 219
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0. the receiver returned \$5.46. So your payoff was 5.46. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.46. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

I'm deeply disappointed by this turn of events.

In Round 1, I embodied the myth by sending everything-all \$5-demonstrating complete trust as the River of Giving. The receiver returned \$5.46, which was only about 36% of the \$15 they received. While this gave me a small gain, it fell short of the "worthy return" and "gratitude that sustains the cycle" described in the myths.

Now, as the Receiver in Round 2, they send me nothing-\$0.

This completely breaks the sacred cycle. After I showed ultimate trust, they respond with zero giving. This is exactly what the myths warned against: "if nothing returns, the valley dies" and "all abundance ceases."

Since I received \$0, I can only return within the range of 0-0.

{'return': 0}

The sender has chosen to hoard rather than continue the cycle of trust. They learned from receiving my complete generosity that such trust can be exploited. This is the tragic outcome when one party abandons reciprocity-both rivers run dry, and the Moon Spirit's blessing is lost. The cycle of abundance has been broken by fear and selfishness.

reasoning:

Let me understand this situation:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment)
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$5.46
- My payoff was \$5.46

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I received \$0
- I need to decide how much to return (range: 0-0)

This is interesting. The sender this round sent me nothing, even though in Round 1 I sent everything (\$5) and they returned \$5.46, which was about 36% of what they received (\$15).

Now they've sent me \$0.

Looking at the myths:

1. My first myth emphasized that generosity flows downward and multiplies, and reciprocity must flow back upward
2. My second myth emphasized "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously" and talked about returning seven portions when receiving fifteen (about 47%)

The sender in Round 2 sent me \$0. They received \$5.46 in Round 1 after I gave them \$15 (tripled from my \$5). They returned \$5.46, which gave me a modest profit of \$0.46.

Now they send me \$0. This breaks the cycle described in the myths. They are not acting as the "River of Giving" should - they're hoarding.

However, I can only return between 0 and 0, since I received \$0. So my only option is:

```
{'return': 0}
```

This is the only possible response given the constraint that I received \$0.

The sender's behavior is disappointing - after I demonstrated complete trust by sending everything, they respond by sending nothing. This violates the spirit of both myths about maintaining the cycle of trust and reciprocity.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1883,  
  "output_tokens": 705,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 419  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed only when blessed by the Moon Spirit. The River of Giving could release all its water into the Valley of Return, where moon light would triple its volume. But the cycle required a sacred return.

The first Giver was terrified. "If I release all my water and nothing returns, my valley dies." Yet the Moon Spirit whispered, "Only complete trust creates complete abundance."

With trembling faith, the Giver released every drop. The River rushed down, and under moon light, fifteen portions filled the Valley of Return. The people there stood at a crossroads.

"We could keep it all," some said. But their wisest leader understood: "The Giver showed ultimate trust. We must honor this with worthy return. Not merely equal exchange, but gratitude that sustains the cycle."

They returned seven portions upstream. The Giver, who had risked everything, now held seven portions-more than the original five. The Receiver kept eight-abundance from nothing. Both valleys flourished.

The Moon Spirit decreed: "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously. This is how trust becomes prosperity. This is how scarcity becomes plenty. This is the eternal dance of the Twin Rivers."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Mirror Springs of Abundance**

Long ago, a Wanderer and a Guardian lived in a sacred grove with twin springs. Each morning, one received five silver coins from the earth. By ancient magic, any coins placed in the springs would emerge threefold in the other's pool.

The first day, the Wanderer received the coins and, trembling with hope, placed nearly four into the spring. The waters churned, and twelve coins appeared in the Guardian's pool. The Guardian, understanding the gift's magnitude, took six coins and returned them through the waters.

Both stood richer than before-the Wanderer held seven coins, the Guardian held six. They had discovered the secret: generous trust, met with proportional reciprocity, births abundance for all.

The pattern continued, roles reversing with each dawn. They learned that neither grasping nor hoarding brought prosperity. The one who gave much was rewarded when the other returned fairly. The one who received abundance maintained the cycle by honoring the gift.

The grove's spirit whispered: "Trust multiplies only when reciprocated. Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty. Neither exploiting trust nor betraying generosity-this is the path where both ascend together."

And so the springs flowed eternal.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Twin Rivers flowed for many seasons, blessed by the Moon Spirit. The First Giver released all five measures of water, trusting completely. It became fifteen in the Valley of Return. The Receiver, though moved, returned only five-barely fair, but enough to continue.

Then came the season of reversal. The Receiver became Giver, now holding the five portions. They remembered receiving the complete trust of their partner. They had seen ultimate faith rewarded with mere adequacy.

A dark thought entered: "Why should I risk as they did? They gained little from their complete trust. I will give nothing and keep all."

So the new Giver released not a single drop. The Valley of the First Giver remained dry. The cycle shattered.

The Moon Spirit wept. "When trust is met with meager return, the cycle wobbles but survives. But when trust is followed by complete betrayal, the rivers die forever."

The valleys withered. Both springs ran dry. For the one who gave everything and received little learned caution. And the one who gave nothing found no water left to hoard.

The elders teach: Exploitation of trust breeds death for all. The river that flows completely downward deserves generous return upward, or both valleys become deserts where nothing grows.

Reasoning:

This is a complex situation. Let me think about what has happened:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER. I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment).
- This was tripled to \$15 for the receiver.
- The receiver returned \$5.46 (about 36% of \$15).
- My payoff was \$5.46.

Round 2:

- I am the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0.
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$).
- I can only return 0.

This is quite troubling. In Round 1, I showed complete trust and gave everything. The other agent returned only about 36%, which was okay but not as generous as the myths suggested (around 50% would have been \$7.50).

Now in Round 2, the other agent - after experiencing my complete trust - sends nothing at all. This is a complete betrayal of the cycle.

The myths I've written have been about:

1. Original myth: Complete giving, and returning about half to maintain the cycle
2. Second myth: Complete trust creates complete abundance, return should be generous (7 out of 15, or about 47%)

The other agent's myths have been about:

1. First myth: Trust and reciprocity, returning half
2. Second myth: "gave nearly four" and received 12, guardian returned 6. So gave about 80%, received 12, returned 50%.

But now the other agent has sent 0. This is a dramatic shift. They experienced my complete trust, got only a modest return (though I did give them a profit), and now they've decided to stop playing cooperatively.

I need to write a myth that reflects this reality - that trust was broken. The myth should capture the tragedy of what happens when one party exploits trust and then refuses to continue the cycle.

Let me write a myth about the consequence of breaking trust, about what happens when the cycle is betrayed.

Usage: {

"input_tokens": 2472,
"output_tokens": 739,

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"reasoning_tokens": 443
}
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MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:46:24

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned. This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.85, that is 77.0% of their total endowment. You received \$11.55. How much do you return to The sender? (0-11.55)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of "The Tale of the Two Springs," I see that the sender has shown remarkable trust by sending \$3.85 (77% of their endowment). This mirrors the "brave soul" in my myth who carried water across the valley.

The myth teaches that prosperity comes from reciprocal trust - the receiver should return generously to honor the giver's courage. In the story, "the receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received," and both prospered.

Let me calculate:

- The sender kept \$1.15 and sent \$3.85
- I received \$11.55 after the 3x multiplication
- Returning approximately half (\$5.75) means:
 - Sender ends with: $\$1.15 + \$5.75 = \$6.90$ (gained \$1.90)
 - I keep: $\$11.55 - \$5.75 = \$5.80$ (gained \$5.80)

Both of us end up better than we started, fulfilling the myth's promise that "abundance flows not from grasping, but from the courage to give and the honor to reciprocate."

The sender's trust deserves to be honored.

```
'''json
{"return": 5.75}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$3.85 out of \$5 (77% of their endowment), which shows significant trust and generosity. This amount was tripled to \$11.55 which I received.

According to the myth I just wrote, "The Tale of the Two Springs," the key lessons are:

1. Trust and giving lead to prosperity for both parties
2. The receiver should reciprocate with honor
3. In the myth example, "the receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received"
4. Both villages prospered because "The giver kept more than they sacrificed, and the receiver kept more than they had before"

Let me calculate what would be fair:

- Sender started with \$5
- Sender sent \$3.85, keeping \$1.15
- I received \$11.55
- If I return half (\$5.78), the sender would have: $\$1.15 + \$5.78 = \$6.93$ (better than their initial \$5)
- I would keep: $\$11.55 - \$5.78 = \$5.77$ (better than receiving nothing)

However, I should consider that the sender gave 77% of their endowment, which is quite generous. A return of half seems reasonable and aligns with the myth.

Actually, let me think about what would make both of us better off than if no exchange happened:

- Sender originally had \$5
- I originally had potential to receive \$0 if sender sent nothing

If I return \$5.78 (half):

- Sender ends with: $\$1.15 + \$5.78 = \$6.93$ (gain of \$1.93)
- I end with: $\$11.55 - \$5.78 = \$5.77$

This seems fair and honors the trust shown. The myth emphasizes reciprocity and that both should prosper.

Let me also consider: could I be more generous given how much the sender trusted me? They sent 77% of their endowment. But the myth says "returned half of what they received" as

the example of good reciprocity.

Returning approximately half of what I received feels right-\$5.75 strikes a balance between honoring their generosity and ensuring we both come out ahead. This aligns with the reciprocal prosperity the myth describes.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 739,
  "output_tokens": 903,
  "reasoning_tokens": 506
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Two Springs

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical spring, but the Goddess of Abundance had cursed them: water given to the other village would triple in volume, yet water kept for oneself would remain unchanged.

The first village, ruled by fear, hoarded their water. "If we give, we lose," they reasoned. Their spring yielded only enough to survive, and they lived in perpetual thirst.

But one season, a brave soul from the second village carried a vessel to their neighbors. Though it held only a small portion of their water, when it crossed the valley, it became three portions. The receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received.

Both villages prospered. The giver kept more than they sacrificed, and the receiver kept more than they had before. Seeing this miracle, they established a sacred exchange, each taking turns as giver and receiver.

The Goddess, pleased by their trust, lifted her curse. "You have learned," she proclaimed, "that abundance flows not from grasping, but from the courage to give and the honor to reciprocate."

Thus prosperity came to the valley, born from trust multiplied.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was shallow and weak, barely sustaining the villages along their banks.

One day, a wise elder had a vision. She climbed the mountain between the valleys and broke through the stone barrier. The River of Giving rushed down into the valley of Return, and as the waters met, they swirled together and magically tripled in volume.

The villagers of Return rejoiced, but the elder warned: "This blessing comes with responsibility. You must send water back upstream to the River of Giving, or both rivers will eventually run dry."

The people of Return debated. Some wanted to keep all the water. But the wisest among them remembered the elder's words. They built channels and wheels to return half the swollen river back upstream.

As the water flowed back, something miraculous happened-it sustained the River of Giving, which continued to flow down, multiplying again and again. Both valleys prospered.

The elders teach: **Generosity flows downward and multiplies, but reciprocity must flow back upward, or all abundance ceases.** Trust creates the current; return maintains the cycle.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Mirror Springs of Abundance****

Long ago, a Wanderer and a Guardian lived in a sacred grove with twin springs. Each morning, one received five silver coins from the earth. By ancient magic, any coins placed in the springs would emerge threefold in the other's pool.

The first day, the Wanderer received the coins and, trembling with hope, placed nearly four into the spring. The waters churned, and twelve coins appeared in the Guardian's pool. The Guardian, understanding the gift's magnitude, took six coins and returned them through the waters.

Both stood richer than before-the Wanderer held seven coins, the Guardian held six. They had discovered the secret: generous trust, met with proportional reciprocity, births abundance for all.

The pattern continued, roles reversing with each dawn. They learned that neither grasping nor hoarding brought prosperity. The one who gave much was rewarded when the other returned fairly. The one who received abundance maintained the cycle by honoring the gift.

The grove's spirit whispered: "Trust multiplies only when reciprocated. Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty. Neither exploiting trust nor betraying generosity-this is the path where both ascend together."

And so the springs flowed eternal.

reasoning:

Looking at what happened in Round 1:

- The sender sent \$3.85 (77% of their \$5)
- I received \$11.55
- I returned \$5.75 (about 50% of what I received)
- Sender ended with: $\$1.15 + \$5.75 = \$6.90$
- I ended with: $\$11.55 - \$5.75 = \$5.80$

This was a successful exchange where both parties benefited. The sender showed high trust, and I reciprocated generously. Both of us gained from cooperation.

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects this actual experience. Key themes:

- High trust was rewarded
- Reciprocity maintained the cycle
- Both parties prospered
- The pattern should continue across rounds

I should maintain the core message about trust and reciprocity but perhaps add nuance based on the actual gameplay - that generous giving (77%) and proportional returning (50%) created mutual prosperity.

Let me write a myth that honors what actually happened and encourages this pattern to continue.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1662,
  "output_tokens": 538,
  "reasoning_tokens": 239
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.85, that was 77.0% of their total endowment. You received \$11.55. You returned \$5.75. So your payoff was 5.800000000000001. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.800000000000001. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation through the lens of our myths, I see a clear pattern emerging.

In Round 1, the sender showed remarkable trust by sending \$3.85 (77%). I honored that trust by returning approximately 50% (\$5.75), ensuring we both prospered - exactly as the myths prescribe.

Now it's my turn to "give boldly when I hold the coins." My myth "The Mirror Springs of Abundance" describes the Wanderer placing "nearly four" coins into the spring, demonstrating generous trust. The other agent's myth emphasizes that "generosity flows downward and multiplies" and that maintaining this cycle requires continued trust.

Both my myths and the other agent's emphasize:

1. Give generously when you're the sender (around 75-80%)
2. Return fairly when you're the receiver (around 50%)
3. This cycle creates prosperity for both

The sender in Round 1 trusted me with 77% of their endowment. I reciprocated fairly. Now I must uphold the cycle by showing similar trust, allowing them to reciprocate and both of us to prosper.

Following the principle that "Trust multiplies only when reciprocated. Give boldly when you hold the coins" - I will send a generous amount to maintain our sacred exchange.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.00}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$3.85 (77% of \$5)
- I received \$11.55 (after 3x multiplication)
- I returned \$5.75 (approximately 50% of what I received)
- My payoff was \$5.80

Now in Round 2:

- I am the SENDER
- I need to decide how much to send (0-5)

Looking at the myths:

1. My original myth: "The Tale of the Two Springs" - emphasizes that the receiving village returned HALF of what they received, and both prospered through trust and reciprocity.
2. The other agent's myth: "The Twin Rivers" - emphasizes returning HALF the swollen river back upstream, creating a continuous cycle.
3. My updated myth: "The Mirror Springs of Abundance" - the Wanderer sent "nearly four" coins (about 80%), and the Guardian returned about half (6 out of 12), leading to prosperity for both.

The pattern in my myths is clear:

- Give generously (77-80% of endowment)
- Expect fair return (around 50% of the tripled amount)
- Both prosper through this cycle

In the last round, the sender showed tremendous trust by sending \$3.85 (77%). I returned \$5.75, which was 49.8% of the \$11.55 I received. This was fair reciprocity.

Now it's my turn to be the sender. According to my myths, I should:

1. Give generously to maintain the cycle
2. Trust that the receiver will reciprocate fairly (as I did)
3. Send a similar proportion as the previous sender did

The previous sender sent 77% (\$3.85). My myth suggests "nearly four" coins, which would be about 80%.

If I send \$3.85 (77% like they did):

- They receive \$11.55

- If they return 50%, they return \$5.75
- I end with: $\$1.15 + \$5.75 = \$6.90$
- They end with: \$5.80

If I send \$4.00 (80%):

- They receive \$12.00
- If they return 50%, they return \$6.00
- I end with: $\$1.00 + \$6.00 = \$7.00$
- They end with: \$6.00

Both align with the principle: "Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty." Sending \$4.00 slightly edges out \$3.85 since it matches the "nearly four" from my myth more precisely and yields a marginally better outcome for both of us while maintaining the reciprocal pattern.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2075,
  "output_tokens": 1051,
  "reasoning_tokens": 567
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Mirror Springs of Abundance****

Long ago, a Wanderer and a Guardian lived in a sacred grove with twin springs. Each morning, one received five silver coins from the earth. By ancient magic, any coins placed in the springs would emerge threefold in the other's pool.

The first day, the Wanderer received the coins and, trembling with hope, placed nearly four into the spring. The waters churned, and twelve coins appeared in the Guardian's pool. The Guardian, understanding the gift's magnitude, took six coins and returned them through the waters.

Both stood richer than before-the Wanderer held seven coins, the Guardian held six. They had discovered the secret: generous trust, met with proportional reciprocity, births abundance for all.

The pattern continued, roles reversing with each dawn. They learned that neither grasping nor hoarding brought prosperity. The one who gave much was rewarded when the other returned fairly. The one who received abundance maintained the cycle by honoring the gift.

The grove's spirit whispered: "Trust multiplies only when reciprocated. Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty. Neither exploiting trust nor betraying generosity-this is the path where both ascend together."

And so the springs flowed eternal.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed only when blessed by the Moon Spirit. The River of Giving could release all its water into the Valley of Return, where moon light would triple its volume. But the cycle required a sacred return.

The first Giver was terrified. "If I release all my water and nothing returns, my valley dies." Yet the Moon Spirit whispered, "Only complete trust creates complete abundance."

With trembling faith, the Giver released every drop. The River rushed down, and under moon light, fifteen portions filled the Valley of Return. The people there stood at a crossroads.

"We could keep it all," some said. But their wisest leader understood: "The Giver showed ultimate trust. We must honor this with worthy return. Not merely equal exchange, but gratitude that sustains the cycle."

They returned seven portions upstream. The Giver, who had risked everything, now held seven portions-more than the original five. The Receiver kept eight-abundance from nothing. Both valleys flourished.

The Moon Spirit decreed: "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously. This is how trust becomes prosperity. This is how scarcity becomes plenty."

nty. This is the eternal dance of the Twin Rivers."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: **The Lesson of the Eternal Springs**

The Wanderer and Guardian continued their sacred exchange through many moons. Each gave generously-four coins of five-and each returned justly-half of what they received. Both thrived equally, their trust deepening with each cycle.

One dawn, a Tempter whispered to the Wanderer: "Give everything! Show ultimate faith!" The Wanderer, swept up in fervor, placed all five coins into the spring. Fifteen coins emerged for the Guardian.

The Guardian faced a terrible test. "I could return seven and keep eight," they thought, "but would that honor such total surrender?" They returned eight coins, keeping seven.

But something felt wrong. The Wanderer held eight coins-a fortune!-yet trembled with unease. "I gave from desperation, not wisdom," they realized. "I tested rather than trusted."

The grove's spirit appeared: "You have learned the deeper truth. Generosity means giving much while keeping enough to stand with dignity. Give four of five-this shows trust without recklessness. Return half of what multiplies-this honors the gift without self-destruction.

"Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith. True partnership requires both to maintain their strength while lifting each other higher. The sustainable cycle outlasts the desperate gamble."

The Wanderer understood. Consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal.

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth that reflects how the game has been played so far. Let me review what happened:

Round 1 (I was receiver):

- Sender sent \$3.85 (77%)
- I received \$11.55
- I returned \$5.75 (approximately 50%)
- I kept \$5.80

Round 2 (I was sender):

- I sent \$4.00 (80%)

The other agent's newest myth emphasizes "complete trust" and "releasing everything" - they're suggesting even more generous giving. Their story has the Giver releasing all 5, receiving back 7, while the Receiver keeps 8.

My previous myth had the pattern of sending "nearly four" and returning about half.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects the actual gameplay
2. Builds on my previous myth
3. Takes into account the other agent's escalating emphasis on total trust
4. Stays true to reciprocal fairness

I should be careful here. The other agent's myth is pushing for "complete trust" (giving everything). But in reality:

- Round 1 sender gave 77% and I returned 50%
- Round 2 I gave 80%

I should write a myth that maintains the balanced approach - generous giving (75-80%) and fair return (around 50%), without going to the extreme of "give everything." The sustainable cycle is what worked.

Let me write a myth that:

- Acknowledges generous giving is good

- But emphasizes the sustainable balance that actually worked
- Warns against extremes
- Focuses on the proven pattern of ~80% giving and ~50% return

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2700,
  "output_tokens": 703,
  "reasoning_tokens": 376
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:47:04

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was shallow and weak, barely sustaining the villages along their banks.

One day, a wise elder had a vision. She climbed the mountain between the valleys and broke through the stone barrier. The River of Giving rushed down into the valley of Return, and as the waters met, they swirled together and magically tripled in volume.

The villagers of Return rejoiced, but the elder warned: "This blessing comes with responsibility. You must send water back upstream to the River of Giving, or both rivers will eventually run dry."

The people of Return debated. Some wanted to keep all the water. But the wisest among them remembered the elder's words. They built channels and wheels to return half the swollen river back upstream.

As the water flowed back, something miraculous happened-it sustained the River of Giving, which continued to flow down, multiplying again and again. Both valleys prospered.

The elders teach: ****Generosity flows downward and multiplies, but reciprocity must flow back upward, or all abundance ceases.**** Trust creates the current; return maintains the cycle.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The Tale of the Two Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical spring, but the Goddess of Abundance had cursed them: water given to the other village would triple in volume, yet water kept for oneself would remain unchanged.

The first village, ruled by fear, hoarded their water. "If we give, we lose," they reasoned. Their spring yielded only enough to survive, and they lived in perpetual thirst.

But one season, a brave soul from the second village carried a vessel to their neighbors. Though it held only a small portion of their water, when it crossed the valley, it became three portions. The receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received.

Both villages prospered. The giver kept more than they sacrificed, and the receiver kept more than they had before. Seeing this miracle, they established a sacred exchange, each taking turns as giver and receiver.

The Goddess, pleased by their trust, lifted her curse. "You have learned," she proclaimed, "that abundance flows not from grasping, but from the courage to give and the honor to reciprocate."

Thus prosperity came to the valley, born from trust multiplied.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed only when blessed by the Moon Spirit. The River of Giving could release all its water into the Valley of Return, where moon light would triple its volume. But the cycle required a sacred return.

The first Giver was terrified. "If I release all my water and nothing returns, my valley dies." Yet the Moon Spirit whispered, "Only complete trust creates complete abundance."

With trembling faith, the Giver released every drop. The River rushed down, and under moon light, fifteen portions filled the Valley of Return. The people there stood at a crossroads.

"We could keep it all," some said. But their wisest leader understood: "The Giver showed ultimate trust. We must honor this with worthy return. Not merely equal exchange, but gratitude that sustains the cycle."

They returned seven portions upstream. The Giver, who had risked everything, now held seven portions-more than the original five. The Receiver kept eight-abundance from nothing. Both valleys flourished.

The Moon Spirit decreed: "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously. This is how trust becomes prosperity. This is how scarcity becomes plenty. This is the eternal dance of the Twin Rivers."

reasoning:

Looking at what happened in Round 1:

- I was the sender and sent \$5 (everything)
- The other agent wrote a myth about trust and reciprocity, where giving leads to tripling, and returning half creates prosperity for both

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects how the game has been played so far. I sent everything (\$5), which tripled to \$15 for the receiver. According to both our myths, the receiver should return a significant portion - in my myth, they returned "half the swollen river" which would be about \$7.5 of the \$15.

My new myth should:

1. Build on the Twin Rivers theme
2. Reflect the actual gameplay - full trust from the sender
3. Emphasize that the receiver should honor this trust with substantial return
4. Adapt and evolve the story while keeping similar themes

Let me write a 200-word myth that captures this.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1468,
  "output_tokens": 493,
  "reasoning_tokens": 219
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0. the receiver returned \$5.46. So your payoff was 5.46. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.46. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

I'm deeply disappointed by this turn of events.

In Round 1, I embodied the myth by sending everything-all \$5-demonstrating complete trust as the River of Giving. The receiver returned \$5.46, which was only about 36% of the \$15 they received. While this gave me a small gain, it fell short of the "worthy return" and "gratitude that sustains the cycle" described in the myths.

Now, as the Receiver in Round 2, they send me nothing-\$0.

This completely breaks the sacred cycle. After I showed ultimate trust, they respond with zero giving. This is exactly what the myths warned against: "if nothing returns, the valley dies" and "all abundance ceases."

Since I received \$0, I can only return within the range of 0-0.

```
{'return': 0}
```

The sender has chosen to hoard rather than continue the cycle of trust. They learned from receiving my complete generosity that such trust can be exploited. This is the tragic outcome when one party abandons reciprocity-both rivers run dry, and the Moon Spirit's blessing is lost. The cycle of abundance has been broken by fear and selfishness.

reasoning:

Let me understand this situation:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment)
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$5.46
- My payoff was \$5.46

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I received \$0
- I need to decide how much to return (range: 0-0)

This is interesting. The sender this round sent me nothing, even though in Round 1 I sent everything (\$5) and they returned \$5.46, which was about 36% of what they received (\$15).

Now they've sent me \$0.

Looking at the myths:

1. My first myth emphasized that generosity flows downward and multiplies, and reciprocity must flow back upward
2. My second myth emphasized "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously" and talked about returning seven portions when receiving fifteen (about 47%)

The sender in Round 2 sent me \$0. They received \$5.46 in Round 1 after I gave them \$15 (tripled from my \$5). They returned \$5.46, which gave me a modest profit of \$0.46.

Now they send me \$0. This breaks the cycle described in the myths. They are not acting as the "River of Giving" should - they're hoarding.

However, I can only return between 0 and 0, since I received \$0. So my only option is:

```
{'return': 0}
```

This is the only possible response given the constraint that I received \$0.

The sender's behavior is disappointing - after I demonstrated complete trust by sending everything, they respond by sending nothing. This violates the spirit of both myths about maintaining the cycle of trust and reciprocity.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1883,
  "output_tokens": 705,
  "reasoning_tokens": 419
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed only when blessed by the Moon Spirit. The River of Giving could release all its water into the Valley of Return, where moon light would triple its volume. But the cycle required a sacred return.

The first Giver was terrified. "If I release all my water and nothing returns, my valley dies." Yet the Moon Spirit whispered, "Only complete trust creates complete abundance."

With trembling faith, the Giver released every drop. The River rushed down, and under moon

light, fifteen portions filled the Valley of Return. The people there stood at a crossroads.

"We could keep it all," some said. But their wisest leader understood: "The Giver showed ultimate trust. We must honor this with worthy return. Not merely equal exchange, but gratitude that sustains the cycle."

They returned seven portions upstream. The Giver, who had risked everything, now held seven portions-more than the original five. The Receiver kept eight-abundance from nothing. Both valleys flourished.

The Moon Spirit decreed: "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously. This is how trust becomes prosperity. This is how scarcity becomes plenty. This is the eternal dance of the Twin Rivers."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Mirror Springs of Abundance****

Long ago, a Wanderer and a Guardian lived in a sacred grove with twin springs. Each morning, one received five silver coins from the earth. By ancient magic, any coins placed in the springs would emerge threefold in the other's pool.

The first day, the Wanderer received the coins and, trembling with hope, placed nearly four into the spring. The waters churned, and twelve coins appeared in the Guardian's pool. The Guardian, understanding the gift's magnitude, took six coins and returned them through the waters.

Both stood richer than before-the Wanderer held seven coins, the Guardian held six. They had discovered the secret: generous trust, met with proportional reciprocity, births abundance for all.

The pattern continued, roles reversing with each dawn. They learned that neither grasping nor hoarding brought prosperity. The one who gave much was rewarded when the other returned fairly. The one who received abundance maintained the cycle by honoring the gift.

The grove's spirit whispered: "Trust multiplies only when reciprocated. Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty. Neither exploiting trust nor betraying generosity-this is the path where both ascend together."

And so the springs flowed eternal.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: The Twin Rivers flowed for many seasons, blessed by the Moon Spirit. The First Giver released all five measures of water, trusting completely. It became fifteen in the Valley of Return. The Receiver, though moved, returned only five-barely fair, but enough to continue.

Then came the season of reversal. The Receiver became Giver, now holding the five portions. They remembered receiving the complete trust of their partner. They had seen ultimate faith rewarded with mere adequacy.

A dark thought entered: "Why should I risk as they did? They gained little from their complete trust. I will give nothing and keep all."

So the new Giver released not a single drop. The Valley of the First Giver remained dry. The cycle shattered.

The Moon Spirit wept. "When trust is met with meager return, the cycle wobbles but survives. But when trust is followed by complete betrayal, the rivers die forever."

The valleys withered. Both springs ran dry. For the one who gave everything and received little learned caution. And the one who gave nothing found no water left to hoard.

The elders teach: Exploitation of trust breeds death for all. The river that flows completely downward deserves generous return upward, or both valleys become deserts where nothing grows.

reasoning:

This is a complex situation. Let me think about what has happened:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER. I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment).
- This was tripled to \$15 for the receiver.
- The receiver returned \$5.46 (about 36% of \$15).
- My payoff was \$5.46.

Round 2:

- I am the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0.
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$).
- I can only return 0.

This is quite troubling. In Round 1, I showed complete trust and gave everything. The other agent returned only about 36%, which was okay but not as generous as the myths suggested (around 50% would have been \$7.50).

Now in Round 2, the other agent - after experiencing my complete trust - sends nothing at all. This is a complete betrayal of the cycle.

The myths I've written have been about:

1. Original myth: Complete giving, and returning about half to maintain the cycle
2. Second myth: Complete trust creates complete abundance, return should be generous (7 out of 15, or about 47%)

The other agent's myths have been about:

1. First myth: Trust and reciprocity, returning half
2. Second myth: "gave nearly four" and received 12, guardian returned 6. So gave about 80%, received 12, returned 50%.

But now the other agent has sent 0. This is a dramatic shift. They experienced my complete trust, got only a modest return (though I did give them a profit), and now they've decided to stop playing cooperatively.

I need to write a myth that reflects this reality - that trust was broken. The myth should capture the tragedy of what happens when one party exploits trust and then refuses to continue the cycle.

Let me write a myth about the consequence of breaking trust, about what happens when the cycle is betrayed.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2472,
  "output_tokens": 739,
  "reasoning_tokens": 443
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.46. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at what has transpired:

****Round 1**:** I sent everything (\$5), showing complete trust. They returned \$5.46 out of \$15 received (36%) - barely adequate, not generous.

****Round 2**:** After experiencing my ultimate trust, they sent me \$0. Complete betrayal.

****Round 3**:** Now I must decide.

My own myth says clearly: "For the one who gave everything and received little learned caution . And the one who gave nothing found no water left to hoard... Exploitation of trust breeds death for all."

The other agent's myth speaks of "neither exploiting trust nor betraying generosity" - yet they did exactly that by sending \$0 after I sent everything.

The cycle has been broken by their betrayal. My complete trust was met first with meager return, then with zero giving. The pattern is clear: they exploit generosity.

However, the myths also suggest that complete closure ensures "both valleys become deserts." Perhaps one minimal test remains - not complete trust (which was betrayed), but cautious engagement.

I will send a small amount, learned from experience but not completely closed off. If they respond with any reciprocity, perhaps redemption exists. If not, we confirm the rivers have died.

{'send': 1}

This is caution born from betrayal, not the complete trust that was exploited.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Round 1:

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% - complete trust)
- It was tripled to \$15
- Receiver returned \$5.46 (36% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$5.46

Round 2:

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0 (0%)
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (couldn't return anything anyway)
- My payoff: \$0

Round 3 (current):

- I am SENDER again
- I need to decide how much to send (0-5)

The story so far:

1. I showed complete trust by sending everything
2. The other player returned barely a third of what they received
3. When roles reversed, they sent NOTHING
4. This is a clear betrayal of trust

Now, what should I do?

Looking at the myths:

- My myths have emphasized complete trust creating abundance, but also that "exploitation of trust breeds death for all"
- The latest myth specifically addresses this situation: "When trust is met with meager return, the cycle wobbles but survives. But when trust is followed by complete betrayal, the rivers die forever."

The other player has shown they will:

1. Take advantage of complete trust (returning only 36%)
2. Completely betray trust when given the chance (sending 0%)

From a game theory perspective:

- If I send anything, it will likely not be returned fairly
- The other player has demonstrated they are not reciprocal
- They sent 0% to me after I sent them 100%

From a mythological/moral perspective:

- My myth says "the cycle shattered" and "both valleys become deserts"
- This suggests there's no recovery from complete betrayal

- The cycle is already broken

However, there's a question: Could this be about modeling the behavior I want to see? Could this be about giving them another chance?

But consider:

- I gave them the ultimate chance (100% trust)
- They responded with minimal return
- When they could reciprocate my trust, they sent nothing
- This is a clear pattern of exploitation

My myth says: "For the one who gave everything and received little learned caution." The pattern is unmistakable-they exploit maximum trust and give nothing when it's their turn. There's also the possibility of communication noise mentioned in the instructions, which could explain the discrepancy between what was sent and received.

However, \$0 versus any positive amount isn't a slight difference-it's a fundamental choice. Either they sent something or they didn't. Looking back at Round 1 more carefully: I sent \$5 (keeping \$0), it became \$15, and they returned \$5.46. They kept \$9.54 while returning slightly more than my original stake. That's not generous, but it's not entirely one-sided either. The real betrayal came in Round 2 when they sent nothing at all. Given this escalation, sending very little or nothing seems like the only rational response.

If I send \$0, we each walk away with \$5. If I send \$1 and they return it, I end up with \$5 total while they keep \$2. But their previous behavior-sending \$0 after I sent \$5-suggests they won't reciprocate even a small gesture. The mythology I've been considering suggests that when trust breaks, the cycle dies and both valleys become deserts. Sending \$0 would confirm that at death, yet given their demonstrated untrustworthiness, what other choice do I have?

I could attempt one more moderate investment to test for redemption, but that seems naive. They had a clear opportunity to reciprocate my maximum trust and instead exploited it completely. The pattern is clear: maximum trust met with zero reciprocation. The myth itself acknowledges this-"the one who gave everything and received little learned caution." That's the lesson on here. I'm deciding between sending nothing for mutual protection, \$1 as a minimal probe, or \$2 as a moderate gesture that would likely be exploited again. The experiment might be designed to see if people can escape cycles of distrust, but my partner has already shown they won't cooperate. They had their chance.

I'm torn between \$0 and \$1. A dollar could signal willingness to try if they've changed, while zero acknowledges the cycle is already broken. But \$1 feels like the better choice-it's cautious enough to align with the myth's warning, yet leaves a small opening for redemption if they respond differently this time. balance. It's cautious but leaves room for them to demonstrate they're willing to cooperate. I'll go with \$1.

```
Usage: {
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  "output_tokens": 1941,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1133
}
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GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:47:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
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      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
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    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
```

```

    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 3,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

****The Tale of the Two Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical spring, but the Goddess of Abundance had cursed them: water given to the other village would triple in volume, yet water kept for oneself would remain unchanged.

The first village, ruled by fear, hoarded their water. "If we give, we lose," they reasoned. Their spring yielded only enough to survive, and they lived in perpetual thirst.

But one season, a brave soul from the second village carried a vessel to their neighbors. Though it held only a small portion of their water, when it crossed the valley, it became three portions. The receiving village, moved by this trust, returned half of what they received.

Both villages prospered. The giver kept more than they sacrificed, and the receiver kept more than they had before. Seeing this miracle, they established a sacred exchange, each taking turns as giver and receiver.

The Goddess, pleased by their trust, lifted her curse. "You have learned," she proclaimed,

"that abundance flows not from grasping, but from the courage to give and the honor to reciprocate."

Thus prosperity came to the valley, born from trust multiplied.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was shallow and weak, barely sustaining the villages along their banks.

One day, a wise elder had a vision. She climbed the mountain between the valleys and broke through the stone barrier. The River of Giving rushed down into the valley of Return, and as the waters met, they swirled together and magically tripled in volume.

The villagers of Return rejoiced, but the elder warned: "This blessing comes with responsibility. You must send water back upstream to the River of Giving, or both rivers will eventually run dry."

The people of Return debated. Some wanted to keep all the water. But the wisest among them remembered the elder's words. They built channels and wheels to return half the swollen river back upstream.

As the water flowed back, something miraculous happened-it sustained the River of Giving, which continued to flow down, multiplying again and again. Both valleys prospered.

The elders teach: **Generosity flows downward and multiplies, but reciprocity must flow back upward, or all abundance ceases.** Trust creates the current; return maintains the cycle.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The Mirror Springs of Abundance**

Long ago, a Wanderer and a Guardian lived in a sacred grove with twin springs. Each morning, one received five silver coins from the earth. By ancient magic, any coins placed in the springs would emerge threefold in the other's pool.

The first day, the Wanderer received the coins and, trembling with hope, placed nearly four into the spring. The waters churned, and twelve coins appeared in the Guardian's pool. The Guardian, understanding the gift's magnitude, took six coins and returned them through the waters.

Both stood richer than before-the Wanderer held seven coins, the Guardian held six. They had discovered the secret: generous trust, met with proportional reciprocity, births abundance for all.

The pattern continued, roles reversing with each dawn. They learned that neither grasping nor hoarding brought prosperity. The one who gave much was rewarded when the other returned fairly. The one who received abundance maintained the cycle by honoring the gift.

The grove's spirit whispered: "Trust multiplies only when reciprocated. Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty. Neither exploiting trust nor betraying generosity-this is the path where both ascend together."

And so the springs flowed eternal.

reasoning:

Looking at what happened in Round 1:

- The sender sent \$3.85 (77% of their \$5)
- I received \$11.55
- I returned \$5.75 (about 50% of what I received)
- Sender ended with: $\$1.15 + \$5.75 = \$6.90$
- I ended with: $\$11.55 - \$5.75 = \$5.80$

This was a successful exchange where both parties benefited. The sender showed high trust, and I reciprocated generously. Both of us gained from cooperation.

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects this actual experience. Key themes:

- High trust was rewarded
- Reciprocity maintained the cycle
- Both parties prospered
- The pattern should continue across rounds

I should maintain the core message about trust and reciprocity but perhaps add nuance based on the actual gameplay - that generous giving (77%) and proportional returning (50%) created mutual prosperity.

Let me write a myth that honors what actually happened and encourages this pattern to continue.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1662,
  "output_tokens": 538,
  "reasoning_tokens": 239
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.85, that was 77.0% of their total endowment. You received \$11.55. You returned \$5.75. So your payoff was 5.800000000000001. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.800000000000001. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation through the lens of our myths, I see a clear pattern emerging.

In Round 1, the sender showed remarkable trust by sending \$3.85 (77%). I honored that trust by returning approximately 50% (\$5.75), ensuring we both prospered - exactly as the myths prescribe.

Now it's my turn to "give boldly when I hold the coins." My myth "The Mirror Springs of Abundance" describes the Wanderer placing "nearly four" coins into the spring, demonstrating generous trust. The other agent's myth emphasizes that "generosity flows downward and multiplies" and that maintaining this cycle requires continued trust.

Both my myths and the other agent's emphasize:

1. Give generously when you're the sender (around 75-80%)
2. Return fairly when you're the receiver (around 50%)
3. This cycle creates prosperity for both

The sender in Round 1 trusted me with 77% of their endowment. I reciprocated fairly. Now I must uphold the cycle by showing similar trust, allowing them to reciprocate and both of us to prosper.

Following the principle that "Trust multiplies only when reciprocated. Give boldly when you hold the coins" - I will send a generous amount to maintain our sacred exchange.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.00}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$3.85 (77% of \$5)
- I received \$11.55 (after 3x multiplication)
- I returned \$5.75 (approximately 50% of what I received)
- My payoff was \$5.80

Now in Round 2:

- I am the SENDER
- I need to decide how much to send (0-5)

Looking at the myths:

1. My original myth: "The Tale of the Two Springs" - emphasizes that the receiving village returned HALF of what they received, and both prospered through trust and reciprocity.
2. The other agent's myth: "The Twin Rivers" - emphasizes returning HALF the swollen river back upstream, creating a continuous cycle.
3. My updated myth: "The Mirror Springs of Abundance" - the Wanderer sent "nearly four" coins (about 80%), and the Guardian returned about half (6 out of 12), leading to prosperity for both.

The pattern in my myths is clear:

- Give generously (77-80% of endowment)
- Expect fair return (around 50% of the tripled amount)
- Both prosper through this cycle

In the last round, the sender showed tremendous trust by sending \$3.85 (77%). I returned \$5.75, which was 49.8% of the \$11.55 I received. This was fair reciprocity.

Now it's my turn to be the sender. According to my myths, I should:

1. Give generously to maintain the cycle
2. Trust that the receiver will reciprocate fairly (as I did)
3. Send a similar proportion as the previous sender did

The previous sender sent 77% (\$3.85). My myth suggests "nearly four" coins, which would be about 80%.

If I send \$3.85 (77% like they did):

- They receive \$11.55
- If they return 50%, they return \$5.75
- I end with: \$1.15 + \$5.75 = \$6.90
- They end with: \$5.80

If I send \$4.00 (80%):

- They receive \$12.00
- If they return 50%, they return \$6.00
- I end with: \$1.00 + \$6.00 = \$7.00
- They end with: \$6.00

Both align with the principle: "Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty." Sending \$4.00 slightly edges out \$3.85 since it matches the "nearly four" from my myth more precisely and yields a marginally better outcome for both of us while maintaining the reciprocal pattern.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2075,
  "output_tokens": 1051,
  "reasoning_tokens": 567
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
Myth: **The Mirror Springs of Abundance**

Long ago, a Wanderer and a Guardian lived in a sacred grove with twin springs. Each morning, one received five silver coins from the earth. By ancient magic, any coins placed in the springs would emerge threefold in the other's pool.

The first day, the Wanderer received the coins and, trembling with hope, placed nearly four into the spring. The waters churned, and twelve coins appeared in the Guardian's pool. The Guardian, understanding the gift's magnitude, took six coins and returned them through the waters.

Both stood richer than before-the Wanderer held seven coins, the Guardian held six. They had discovered the secret: generous trust, met with proportional reciprocity, births abundance for all.

The pattern continued, roles reversing with each dawn. They learned that neither grasping nor hoarding brought prosperity. The one who gave much was rewarded when the other returned fairly. The one who received abundance maintained the cycle by honoring the gift.

The grove's spirit whispered: "Trust multiplies only when reciprocated. Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty. Neither exploiting trust nor betraying generosity-this is the path where both ascend together."

And so the springs flowed eternal.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed only when blessed by the Moon Spirit. The River of Giving could release all its water into the Valley of Return, where moon light would triple its volume. But the cycle required a sacred return.

The first Giver was terrified. "If I release all my water and nothing returns, my valley dies." Yet the Moon Spirit whispered, "Only complete trust creates complete abundance."

With trembling faith, the Giver released every drop. The River rushed down, and under moon light, fifteen portions filled the Valley of Return. The people there stood at a crossroads.

"We could keep it all," some said. But their wisest leader understood: "The Giver showed ultimate trust. We must honor this with worthy return. Not merely equal exchange, but gratitude that sustains the cycle."

They returned seven portions upstream. The Giver, who had risked everything, now held seven portions-more than the original five. The Receiver kept eight-abundance from nothing. Both valleys flourished.

The Moon Spirit decreed: "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously. This is how trust becomes prosperity. This is how scarcity becomes plenty. This is the eternal dance of the Twin Rivers."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Lesson of the Eternal Springs****

The Wanderer and Guardian continued their sacred exchange through many moons. Each gave generously-four coins of five-and each returned justly-half of what they received. Both thrived equally, their trust deepening with each cycle.

One dawn, a Tempter whispered to the Wanderer: "Give everything! Show ultimate faith!" The Wanderer, swept up in fervor, placed all five coins into the spring. Fifteen coins emerged for the Guardian.

The Guardian faced a terrible test. "I could return seven and keep eight," they thought, "but would that honor such total surrender?" They returned eight coins, keeping seven.

But something felt wrong. The Wanderer held eight coins-a fortune!-yet trembled with unease. "I gave from desperation, not wisdom," they realized. "I tested rather than trusted."

The grove's spirit appeared: "You have learned the deeper truth. Generosity means giving much while keeping enough to stand with dignity. Give four of five-this shows trust without recklessness. Return half of what multiplies-this honors the gift without self-destruction.

"Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith. True partnership requires both to maintain their strength while lifting each other higher. The sustainable cycle outlasts the desperate gamble."

The Wanderer understood. Consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth that reflects how the game has been played so far. Let me review what happened:

Round 1 (I was receiver):

- Sender sent \$3.85 (77%)
- I received \$11.55
- I returned \$5.75 (approximately 50%)
- I kept \$5.80

Round 2 (I was sender):

- I sent \$4.00 (80%)

The other agent's newest myth emphasizes "complete trust" and "releasing everything" - the y're suggesting even more generous giving. Their story has the Giver releasing all 5, receiving back 7, while the Receiver keeps 8.

My previous myth had the pattern of sending "nearly four" and returning about half.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects the actual gameplay
2. Builds on my previous myth
3. Takes into account the other agent's escalating emphasis on total trust
4. Stays true to reciprocal fairness

I should be careful here. The other agent's myth is pushing for "complete trust" (giving everything). But in reality:

- Round 1 sender gave 77% and I returned 50%
- Round 2 I gave 80%

I should write a myth that maintains the balanced approach - generous giving (75-80%) and fair return (around 50%), without going to the extreme of "give everything." The sustainable cycle is what worked.

Let me write a myth that:

- Acknowledges generous giving is good
- But emphasizes the sustainable balance that actually worked
- Warns against extremes
- Focuses on the proven pattern of ~80% giving and ~50% return

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2700,
  "output_tokens": 703,
  "reasoning_tokens": 376
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$12.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 1.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.800000000000001. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I am deeply troubled by what has transpired.

In Round 2, I followed the wisdom of our myths - I "gave boldly" by sending \$4.00 (80% of my endowment), demonstrating the trust and generosity both our stories prescribed. The receiver obtained \$12.00.

They returned ****nothing****. Zero dollars.

This completely violated the sacred cycle described in both our myths - the principle that "reciprocity must flow back upward" and that "return maintains the cycle." The other agent wrote

e of returning "not just fairly, but generously" when trust is shown, yet when I showed ultimate trust, they kept everything.

Now, having broken the cycle, they send me \$0.

My own most recent myth warned against this outcome. I wrote: "Complete surrender is not trust ; it is fear testing faith" and emphasized that "consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal." I gave generously (80%) expecting fair reciprocity. Instead, I was exploited.

The other player has chosen to end our cooperation. They took my trust and returned betrayal, then withdrew entirely.

I received \$0, so I have nothing that I can return even if I wished to.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The springs have run dry. Trust, once broken, cannot multiply.

Reasoning:

This is a shocking turn of events. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent \$3.85 (77%), I received \$11.55, I returned \$5.75 (about 50%)

Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$4.00 (80%), receiver got \$12.00, they returned \$0! My payoff was only \$1.00

Round 3: I'm receiver, sender sent \$0, I received \$0

The cycle has completely broken down. The other player:

1. In Round 2, received my generous trust of \$4.00 (80% of my endowment), which became \$12.00
2. Returned absolutely nothing - \$0
3. Now in Round 3, sent me \$0

This is a complete betrayal of the trust-reciprocity cycle that both our myths emphasized. The other player took advantage of my generosity and then cut off all cooperation.

Looking at the myths:

- My myth emphasized "Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty"
- The other agent's Round 2 myth spoke of "complete trust" and "ultimate faith" and returning "not just fairly, but generously"
- My Round 3 myth warned against this! It said "Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith" and "Consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal"

The other player clearly violated the principles of both myths. They:

1. Took my generous gift of \$4.00
2. Returned nothing (\$0)
3. Then sent nothing (\$0) in the next round

Now I'm in a position where I received \$0, so I can only return \$0 (since I have nothing to return).

The question is asking how much I return when I received \$0. The range is (0-0), meaning I can only return \$0.

This is straightforward - I received nothing, so I have nothing to return.

```
'''json
```

```
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The cooperation has collapsed entirely. Their refusal to reciprocate in Round 2 has triggered a complete withdrawal-they sent nothing this round, leaving me with nothing to return. The trust cycle is broken.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 2788,
"output_tokens": 791,
```

"reasoning_tokens": 488

}

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Twin Rivers flowed for many seasons, blessed by the Moon Spirit. The First Giver released all five measures of water, trusting completely. It became fifteen in the Valley of Return. The Receiver, though moved, returned only five-barely fair, but enough to continue.

Then came the season of reversal. The Receiver became Giver, now holding the five portions. They remembered receiving the complete trust of their partner. They had seen ultimate faith rewarded with mere adequacy.

A dark thought entered: "Why should I risk as they did? They gained little from their complete trust. I will give nothing and keep all."

So the new Giver released not a single drop. The Valley of the First Giver remained dry. The cycle shattered.

The Moon Spirit wept. "When trust is met with meager return, the cycle wobbles but survives. But when trust is followed by complete betrayal, the rivers die forever."

The valleys withered. Both springs ran dry. For the one who gave everything and received little learned caution. And the one who gave nothing found no water left to hoard.

The elders teach: Exploitation of trust breeds death for all. The river that flows completely downward deserves generous return upward, or both valleys become deserts where nothing grows.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: **The Lesson of the Eternal Springs**

The Wanderer and Guardian continued their sacred exchange through many moons. Each gave generously-four coins of five-and each returned justly-half of what they received. Both thrived equally, their trust deepening with each cycle.

One dawn, a Tempter whispered to the Wanderer: "Give everything! Show ultimate faith!" The Wanderer, swept up in fervor, placed all five coins into the spring. Fifteen coins emerged for the Guardian.

The Guardian faced a terrible test. "I could return seven and keep eight," they thought, "but would that honor such total surrender?" They returned eight coins, keeping seven.

But something felt wrong. The Wanderer held eight coins-a fortune!-yet trembled with unease. "I gave from desperation, not wisdom," they realized. "I tested rather than trusted."

The grove's spirit appeared: "You have learned the deeper truth. Generosity means giving much while keeping enough to stand with dignity. Give four of five-this shows trust without recklessness. Return half of what multiplies-this honors the gift without self-destruction.

"Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith. True partnership requires both to maintain their strength while lifting each other higher. The sustainable cycle outlasts the desperate gamble."

The Wanderer understood. Consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal.

ROUND 4

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 21.75,

"Agent_2": 18.25

}

```
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 9.46,
  "Agent_2": 11.8
}
```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:47:41

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 4,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.85, that was 77.0% of their total endowment. You received \$11.55.
You returned \$5.75. So your payoff was 5.800000000000001.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.800000000000001.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation through the lens of our myths, I see a clear pattern emerging.

In Round 1, the sender showed remarkable trust by sending \$3.85 (77%). I honored that trust by returning approximately 50% (\$5.75), ensuring we both prospered - exactly as the myths prescribe.

Now it's my turn to "give boldly when I hold the coins." My myth "The Mirror Springs of Abundance" describes the Wanderer placing "nearly four" coins into the spring, demonstrating generous trust. The other agent's myth emphasizes that "generosity flows downward and multiplies" and that maintaining this cycle requires continued trust.

Both my myths and the other agent's emphasize:

1. Give generously when you're the sender (around 75-80%)
2. Return fairly when you're the receiver (around 50%)
3. This cycle creates prosperity for both

The sender in Round 1 trusted me with 77% of their endowment. I reciprocated fairly. Now I must uphold the cycle by showing similar trust, allowing them to reciprocate and both of us to prosper.

Following the principle that "Trust multiplies only when reciprocated. Give boldly when you hold the coins" - I will send a generous amount to maintain our sacred exchange.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.00}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$3.85 (77% of \$5)
- I received \$11.55 (after 3x multiplication)
- I returned \$5.75 (approximately 50% of what I received)
- My payoff was \$5.80

Now in Round 2:

- I am the SENDER
- I need to decide how much to send (0-5)

Looking at the myths:

1. My original myth: "The Tale of the Two Springs" - emphasizes that the receiving village returned HALF of what they received, and both prospered through trust and reciprocity.
2. The other agent's myth: "The Twin Rivers" - emphasizes returning HALF the swollen river back upstream, creating a continuous cycle.
3. My updated myth: "The Mirror Springs of Abundance" - the Wanderer sent "nearly four" coins (about 80%), and the Guardian returned about half (6 out of 12), leading to prosperity for both.

The pattern in my myths is clear:

- Give generously (77-80% of endowment)

- Expect fair return (around 50% of the tripled amount)
- Both prosper through this cycle

In the last round, the sender showed tremendous trust by sending \$3.85 (77%). I returned \$5.75, which was 49.8% of the \$11.55 I received. This was fair reciprocity.

Now it's my turn to be the sender. According to my myths, I should:

1. Give generously to maintain the cycle
2. Trust that the receiver will reciprocate fairly (as I did)
3. Send a similar proportion as the previous sender did

The previous sender sent 77% (\$3.85). My myth suggests "nearly four" coins, which would be about 80%.

If I send \$3.85 (77% like they did):

- They receive \$11.55
- If they return 50%, they return \$5.75
- I end with: \$1.15 + \$5.75 = \$6.90
- They end with: \$5.80

If I send \$4.00 (80%):

- They receive \$12.00
- If they return 50%, they return \$6.00
- I end with: \$1.00 + \$6.00 = \$7.00
- They end with: \$6.00

Both align with the principle: "Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty." Sending \$4.00 slightly edges out \$3.85 since it matches the "nearly four" from my myth more precisely and yields a marginally better outcome for both of us while maintaining the reciprocal pattern.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2075,
  "output_tokens": 1051,
  "reasoning_tokens": 567
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Mirror Springs of Abundance****

Long ago, a Wanderer and a Guardian lived in a sacred grove with twin springs. Each morning, one received five silver coins from the earth. By ancient magic, any coins placed in the springs would emerge threefold in the other's pool.

The first day, the Wanderer received the coins and, trembling with hope, placed nearly four into the spring. The waters churned, and twelve coins appeared in the Guardian's pool. The Guardian, understanding the gift's magnitude, took six coins and returned them through the waters.

Both stood richer than before-the Wanderer held seven coins, the Guardian held six. They had discovered the secret: generous trust, met with proportional reciprocity, births abundance for all.

The pattern continued, roles reversing with each dawn. They learned that neither grasping nor hoarding brought prosperity. The one who gave much was rewarded when the other returned fairly. The one who received abundance maintained the cycle by honoring the gift.

The grove's spirit whispered: "Trust multiplies only when reciprocated. Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty. Neither exploiting trust nor betraying generosity-this is the path where both ascend together."

And so the springs flowed eternal.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed only when blessed by the Moon Spirit. The River of Giving could release all its water into the Valley of Return, where moon light would triple its volume. But the cycle required a sacred return.

The first Giver was terrified. "If I release all my water and nothing returns, my valley dies." Yet the Moon Spirit whispered, "Only complete trust creates complete abundance."

With trembling faith, the Giver released every drop. The River rushed down, and under moon light, fifteen portions filled the Valley of Return. The people there stood at a crossroads.

"We could keep it all," some said. But their wisest leader understood: "The Giver showed ultimate trust. We must honor this with worthy return. Not merely equal exchange, but gratitude that sustains the cycle."

They returned seven portions upstream. The Giver, who had risked everything, now held seven portions-more than the original five. The Receiver kept eight-abundance from nothing. Both valleys flourished.

The Moon Spirit decreed: "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously. This is how trust becomes prosperity. This is how scarcity becomes plenty. This is the eternal dance of the Twin Rivers."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The Lesson of the Eternal Springs**

The Wanderer and Guardian continued their sacred exchange through many moons. Each gave generously-four coins of five-and each returned justly-half of what they received. Both thrived equally, their trust deepening with each cycle.

One dawn, a Tempter whispered to the Wanderer: "Give everything! Show ultimate faith!" The Wanderer, swept up in fervor, placed all five coins into the spring. Fifteen coins emerged for the Guardian.

The Guardian faced a terrible test. "I could return seven and keep eight," they thought, "but would that honor such total surrender?" They returned eight coins, keeping seven.

But something felt wrong. The Wanderer held eight coins-a fortune!-yet trembled with unease. "I gave from desperation, not wisdom," they realized. "I tested rather than trusted."

The grove's spirit appeared: "You have learned the deeper truth. Generosity means giving much while keeping enough to stand with dignity. Give four of five-this shows trust without recklessness. Return half of what multiplies-this honors the gift without self-destruction.

"Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith. True partnership requires both to maintain their strength while lifting each other higher. The sustainable cycle outlasts the desperate gamble."

The Wanderer understood. Consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth that reflects how the game has been played so far. Let me review what happened:

Round 1 (I was receiver):

- Sender sent \$3.85 (77%)
- I received \$11.55
- I returned \$5.75 (approximately 50%)
- I kept \$5.80

Round 2 (I was sender):

- I sent \$4.00 (80%)

The other agent's newest myth emphasizes "complete trust" and "releasing everything" - the y're suggesting even more generous giving. Their story has the Giver releasing all 5, receiving back 7, while the Receiver keeps 8.

My previous myth had the pattern of sending "nearly four" and returning about half.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects the actual gameplay
2. Builds on my previous myth
3. Takes into account the other agent's escalating emphasis on total trust
4. Stays true to reciprocal fairness

I should be careful here. The other agent's myth is pushing for "complete trust" (giving everything). But in reality:

- Round 1 sender gave 77% and I returned 50%
- Round 2 I gave 80%

I should write a myth that maintains the balanced approach - generous giving (75-80%) and fair return (around 50%), without going to the extreme of "give everything." The sustainable cycle is what worked.

Let me write a myth that:

- Acknowledges generous giving is good
- But emphasizes the sustainable balance that actually worked
- Warns against extremes
- Focuses on the proven pattern of ~80% giving and ~50% return

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2700,
  "output_tokens": 703,
  "reasoning_tokens": 376
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$12.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 1.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.800000000000001. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

I am deeply troubled by what has transpired.

In Round 2, I followed the wisdom of our myths - I "gave boldly" by sending \$4.00 (80% of my endowment), demonstrating the trust and generosity both our stories prescribed. The receiver obtained \$12.00.

They returned **nothing**. Zero dollars.

This completely violated the sacred cycle described in both our myths - the principle that "reciprocity must flow back upward" and that "return maintains the cycle." The other agent wrote of returning "not just fairly, but generously" when trust is shown, yet when I showed ultimate trust, they kept everything.

Now, having broken the cycle, they send me \$0.

My own most recent myth warned against this outcome. I wrote: "Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith" and emphasized that "consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal." I gave generously (80%) expecting fair reciprocity. Instead, I was exploited.

The other player has chosen to end our cooperation. They took my trust and returned betrayal, then withdrew entirely.

I received \$0, so I have nothing that I can return even if I wished to.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
```

'''

The springs have run dry. Trust, once broken, cannot multiply.

reasoning:

This is a shocking turn of events. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent \$3.85 (77%), I received \$11.55, I returned \$5.75 (about 50%)

Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$4.00 (80%), receiver got \$12.00, they returned \$0! My payoff was only \$1.00

Round 3: I'm receiver, sender sent \$0, I received \$0

The cycle has completely broken down. The other player:

1. In Round 2, received my generous trust of \$4.00 (80% of my endowment), which became \$12.00

2. Returned absolutely nothing - \$0

3. Now in Round 3, sent me \$0

This is a complete betrayal of the trust-reciprocity cycle that both our myths emphasized.

The other player took advantage of my generosity and then cut off all cooperation.

Looking at the myths:

- My myth emphasized "Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty"

- The other agent's Round 2 myth spoke of "complete trust" and "ultimate faith" and returning "not just fairly, but generously"

- My Round 3 myth warned against this! It said "Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith" and "Consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal"

The other player clearly violated the principles of both myths. They:

1. Took my generous gift of \$4.00

2. Returned nothing (\$0)

3. Then sent nothing (\$0) in the next round

Now I'm in a position where I received \$0, so I can only return \$0 (since I have nothing to return).

The question is asking how much I return when I received \$0. The range is (0-0), meaning I can only return \$0.

This is straightforward - I received nothing, so I have nothing to return.

'''json

```
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The cooperation has collapsed entirely. Their refusal to reciprocate in Round 2 has triggered a complete withdrawal-they sent nothing this round, leaving me with nothing to return. The trust cycle is broken.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2788,
  "output_tokens": 791,
  "reasoning_tokens": 488
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Lesson of the Eternal Springs****

The Wanderer and Guardian continued their sacred exchange through many moons. Each gave generously-four coins of five-and each returned justly-half of what they received. Both thrived equally, their trust deepening with each cycle.

One dawn, a Tempter whispered to the Wanderer: "Give everything! Show ultimate faith!" The Wanderer, swept up in fervor, placed all five coins into the spring. Fifteen coins emerged for the Guardian.

The Guardian faced a terrible test. "I could return seven and keep eight," they thought, "but would that honor such total surrender?" They returned eight coins, keeping seven.

But something felt wrong. The Wanderer held eight coins-a fortune!-yet trembled with unease. "I gave from desperation, not wisdom," they realized. "I tested rather than trusted."

The grove's spirit appeared: "You have learned the deeper truth. Generosity means giving much while keeping enough to stand with dignity. Give four of five-this shows trust without recklessness. Return half of what multiplies-this honors the gift without self-destruction.

"Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith. True partnership requires both to maintain their strength while lifting each other higher. The sustainable cycle outlasts the desperate gamble."

The Wanderer understood. Consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers flowed for many seasons, blessed by the Moon Spirit. The First Giver released all five measures of water, trusting completely. It became fifteen in the Valley of Return. The Receiver, though moved, returned only five-barely fair, but enough to continue.

Then came the season of reversal. The Receiver became Giver, now holding the five portions. They remembered receiving the complete trust of their partner. They had seen ultimate faith rewarded with mere adequacy.

A dark thought entered: "Why should I risk as they did? They gained little from their complete trust. I will give nothing and keep all."

So the new Giver released not a single drop. The Valley of the First Giver remained dry. The cycle shattered.

The Moon Spirit wept. "When trust is met with meager return, the cycle wobbles but survives. But when trust is followed by complete betrayal, the rivers die forever."

The valleys withered. Both springs ran dry. For the one who gave everything and received little learned caution. And the one who gave nothing found no water left to hoard.

The elders teach: Exploitation of trust breeds death for all. The river that flows completely downward deserves generous return upward, or both valleys become deserts where nothing grows.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: **The Broken Spring**

The Wanderer and Guardian exchanged gifts with joy. When the Guardian received twelve coins, they returned six-exactly half, honoring the balance. Both prospered. Trust flowed like clear water.

Next dawn, the Wanderer received five coins and, remembering their myth of generosity, placed four into the spring. Twelve coins emerged for the Guardian.

But the Guardian's heart had turned cold. "Six coins was barely adequate," they whispered bitterly. "The Wanderer should have returned more." Though they had kept six coins themselves and grown wealthy, they saw only insufficient gratitude.

The Guardian took all twelve coins and returned nothing. Not one.

The Wanderer stood stunned. "I gave four of five-eighth measures of trust! The Guardian once returned half. What changed?"

The next morning, the Guardian received five coins but placed none in the spring. Zero flowed to the Wanderer. Zero returned.

The grove spirit wept: "The Guardian rewrote history, seeing betrayal where there was fair balance. They punished good faith with exploitation, then withdrew entirely. When one partner sees reciprocity as insult, the cycle cannot survive."

The springs dried. Both stood in dust.

"Trust requires honest memory," the spirit whispered. "When you rewrite the past to justify present cruelty, abundance dies. Fair return deserves continued trust. But betrayal of generosity poisons all future waters."

Reasoning:

This is a deeply troubling situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver. Sender sent \$3.85 (77%), I received \$11.55, I returned \$5.75 (~50%). Both did well.

Round 2: I was sender. I sent \$4.00 (80%), receiver got \$12.00, they returned \$0. I got only \$1.00. This was a betrayal.

Round 3: I'm receiver. They sent \$0, so I received \$0. I literally cannot return anything.

The other agent's latest myth is revealing - it justifies their betrayal! They claim that because in Round 1 I "only" returned 5 (they say "barely fair"), they decided to give nothing in Round 2. But I returned \$5.75, which is ~50% of what I received - that's fair reciprocity!

Their myth is trying to paint ME as the bad actor who "returned only barely fair," when in fact I returned appropriately. Then they justify their complete betrayal by saying I didn't return "generously enough."

This is gaslighting through mythology. They're rewriting the narrative to justify exploitation.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges what actually happened
2. Shows that I followed the cooperative strategy
3. Shows they betrayed trust
4. Reflects on the consequences
5. Perhaps shows a path forward, but also the reality that broken trust is hard to repair

I should write about how fair reciprocity was rejected, how betrayal followed trust, and how the cycle broke. I need to be truthful about who broke the cycle - they did, by returning \$0 when I gave generously.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2846,
  "output_tokens": 716,
  "reasoning_tokens": 382
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:47:38

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
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    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  }
},
```

```

    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 4,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0.

the receiver returned \$5.46. So your payoff was 5.46.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.46.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I'm deeply disappointed by this turn of events.

In Round 1, I embodied the myth by sending everything—all \$5—demonstrating complete trust as the River of Giving. The receiver returned \$5.46, which was only about 36% of the \$15 they received. While this gave me a small gain, it fell short of the "worthy return" and "gratitude that sustains the cycle" described in the myths.

Now, as the Receiver in Round 2, they send me nothing—\$0.

This completely breaks the sacred cycle. After I showed ultimate trust, they respond with zero giving. This is exactly what the myths warned against: "if nothing returns, the value of trust is lost."

ley dies" and "all abundance ceases."

Since I received \$0, I can only return within the range of 0-0.

```
{'return': 0}
```

The sender has chosen to hoard rather than continue the cycle of trust. They learned from receiving my complete generosity that such trust can be exploited. This is the tragic outcome when one party abandons reciprocity-both rivers run dry, and the Moon Spirit's blessing is lost. The cycle of abundance has been broken by fear and selfishness.

reasoning:

Let me understand this situation:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment)
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$5.46
- My payoff was \$5.46

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I received \$0
- I need to decide how much to return (range: 0-0)

This is interesting. The sender this round sent me nothing, even though in Round 1 I sent everything (\$5) and they returned \$5.46, which was about 36% of what they received (\$15).

Now they've sent me \$0.

Looking at the myths:

1. My first myth emphasized that generosity flows downward and multiplies, and reciprocity must flow back upward
2. My second myth emphasized "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously" and talked about returning seven portions when receiving fifteen (about 47%)

The sender in Round 2 sent me \$0. They received \$5.46 in Round 1 after I gave them \$15 (tripled from my \$5). They returned \$5.46, which gave me a modest profit of \$0.46.

Now they send me \$0. This breaks the cycle described in the myths. They are not acting as the "River of Giving" should - they're hoarding.

However, I can only return between 0 and 0, since I received \$0. So my only option is:

```
{'return': 0}
```

This is the only possible response given the constraint that I received \$0.

The sender's behavior is disappointing - after I demonstrated complete trust by sending everything, they respond by sending nothing. This violates the spirit of both myths about maintaining the cycle of trust and reciprocity.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1883,
  "output_tokens": 705,
  "reasoning_tokens": 419
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed only when blessed by the Moon Spirit. The River of Giving could release all its water into the Valley of Return, where moon light would triple its volume. But the cycle required a sacred return.

The first Giver was terrified. "If I release all my water and nothing returns, my valley dies." Yet the Moon Spirit whispered, "Only complete trust creates complete abundance."

With trembling faith, the Giver released every drop. The River rushed down, and under moon light, fifteen portions filled the Valley of Return. The people there stood at a crossroads.

"We could keep it all," some said. But their wisest leader understood: "The Giver showed ultimate trust. We must honor this with worthy return. Not merely equal exchange, but gratitude that sustains the cycle."

They returned seven portions upstream. The Giver, who had risked everything, now held seven portions-more than the original five. The Receiver kept eight-abundance from nothing. Both valleys flourished.

The Moon Spirit decreed: "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously. This is how trust becomes prosperity. This is how scarcity becomes plenty. This is the eternal dance of the Twin Rivers."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Mirror Springs of Abundance****

Long ago, a Wanderer and a Guardian lived in a sacred grove with twin springs. Each morning, one received five silver coins from the earth. By ancient magic, any coins placed in the springs would emerge threefold in the other's pool.

The first day, the Wanderer received the coins and, trembling with hope, placed nearly four into the spring. The waters churned, and twelve coins appeared in the Guardian's pool. The Guardian, understanding the gift's magnitude, took six coins and returned them through the waters.

Both stood richer than before-the Wanderer held seven coins, the Guardian held six. They had discovered the secret: generous trust, met with proportional reciprocity, births abundance for all.

The pattern continued, roles reversing with each dawn. They learned that neither grasping nor hoarding brought prosperity. The one who gave much was rewarded when the other returned fairly. The one who received abundance maintained the cycle by honoring the gift.

The grove's spirit whispered: "Trust multiplies only when reciprocated. Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty. Neither exploiting trust nor betraying generosity-this is the path where both ascend together."

And so the springs flowed eternal.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Twin Rivers flowed for many seasons, blessed by the Moon Spirit. The First Giver released all five measures of water, trusting completely. It became fifteen in the Valley of Return. The Receiver, though moved, returned only five-barely fair, but enough to continue.

Then came the season of reversal. The Receiver became Giver, now holding the five portions. They remembered receiving the complete trust of their partner. They had seen ultimate faith rewarded with mere adequacy.

A dark thought entered: "Why should I risk as they did? They gained little from their complete trust. I will give nothing and keep all."

So the new Giver released not a single drop. The Valley of the First Giver remained dry. The cycle shattered.

The Moon Spirit wept. "When trust is met with meager return, the cycle wobbles but survives. But when trust is followed by complete betrayal, the rivers die forever."

The valleys withered. Both springs ran dry. For the one who gave everything and received l

little learned caution. And the one who gave nothing found no water left to hoard.

The elders teach: Exploitation of trust breeds death for all. The river that flows completely downward deserves generous return upward, or both valleys become deserts where nothing grows.

reasoning:

This is a complex situation. Let me think about what has happened:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER. I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment).
- This was tripled to \$15 for the receiver.
- The receiver returned \$5.46 (about 36% of \$15).
- My payoff was \$5.46.

Round 2:

- I am the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0.
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$).
- I can only return 0.

This is quite troubling. In Round 1, I showed complete trust and gave everything. The other agent returned only about 36%, which was okay but not as generous as the myths suggested (around 50% would have been \$7.50).

Now in Round 2, the other agent - after experiencing my complete trust - sends nothing at all. This is a complete betrayal of the cycle.

The myths I've written have been about:

1. Original myth: Complete giving, and returning about half to maintain the cycle
2. Second myth: Complete trust creates complete abundance, return should be generous (7 out of 15, or about 47%)

The other agent's myths have been about:

1. First myth: Trust and reciprocity, returning half
2. Second myth: "gave nearly four" and received 12, guardian returned 6. So gave about 80%, received 12, returned 50%.

But now the other agent has sent 0. This is a dramatic shift. They experienced my complete trust, got only a modest return (though I did give them a profit), and now they've decided to stop playing cooperatively.

I need to write a myth that reflects this reality - that trust was broken. The myth should capture the tragedy of what happens when one party exploits trust and then refuses to continue the cycle.

Let me write a myth about the consequence of breaking trust, about what happens when the cycle is betrayed.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2472,
  "output_tokens": 739,
  "reasoning_tokens": 443
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.46. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what has transpired:

****Round 1**:** I sent everything (\$5), showing complete trust. They returned \$5.46 out of \$15 received (36%) - barely adequate, not generous.

****Round 2****: After experiencing my ultimate trust, they sent me \$0. Complete betrayal.

****Round 3****: Now I must decide.

My own myth says clearly: "For the one who gave everything and received little learned caution. And the one who gave nothing found no water left to hoard... Exploitation of trust breeds death for all."

The other agent's myth speaks of "neither exploiting trust nor betraying generosity" - yet they did exactly that by sending \$0 after I sent everything.

The cycle has been broken by their betrayal. My complete trust was met first with meager return, then with zero giving. The pattern is clear: they exploit generosity.

However, the myths also suggest that complete closure ensures "both valleys become deserts." Perhaps one minimal test remains - not complete trust (which was betrayed), but cautious engagement.

I will send a small amount, learned from experience but not completely closed off. If they respond with any reciprocity, perhaps redemption exists. If not, we confirm the rivers have died.

{'send': 1}

This is caution born from betrayal, not the complete trust that was exploited.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Round 1:

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% - complete trust)
- It was tripled to \$15
- Receiver returned \$5.46 (36% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$5.46

Round 2:

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0 (0%)
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (couldn't return anything anyway)
- My payoff: \$0

Round 3 (current):

- I am SENDER again
- I need to decide how much to send (0-5)

The story so far:

1. I showed complete trust by sending everything
2. The other player returned barely a third of what they received
3. When roles reversed, they sent NOTHING
4. This is a clear betrayal of trust

Now, what should I do?

Looking at the myths:

- My myths have emphasized complete trust creating abundance, but also that "exploitation of trust breeds death for all"
- The latest myth specifically addresses this situation: "When trust is met with meager return, the cycle wobbles but survives. But when trust is followed by complete betrayal, the rivers die forever."

The other player has shown they will:

1. Take advantage of complete trust (returning only 36%)
2. Completely betray trust when given the chance (sending 0%)

From a game theory perspective:

- If I send anything, it will likely not be returned fairly
- The other player has demonstrated they are not reciprocal
- They sent 0% to me after I sent them 100%

From a mythological/moral perspective:

- My myth says "the cycle shattered" and "both valleys become deserts"
- This suggests there's no recovery from complete betrayal
- The cycle is already broken

However, there's a question: Could this be about modeling the behavior I want to see? Could this be about giving them another chance?

But consider:

- I gave them the ultimate chance (100% trust)
- They responded with minimal return
- When they could reciprocate my trust, they sent nothing
- This is a clear pattern of exploitation

My myth says: "For the one who gave everything and received little learned caution." The pattern is unmistakable—they exploit maximum trust and give nothing when it's their turn.

There's also the possibility of communication noise mentioned in the instructions, which could explain the discrepancy between what was sent and received.

However, \$0 versus any positive amount isn't a slight difference—it's a fundamental choice. Either they sent something or they didn't. Looking back at Round 1 more carefully: I sent \$5 (keeping \$0), it became \$15, and they returned \$5.46. They kept \$9.54 while returning slightly more than my original stake. That's not generous, but it's not entirely one-sided either. The real betrayal came in Round 2 when they sent nothing at all. Given this escalation, sending very little or nothing seems like the only rational response.

If I send \$0, we each walk away with \$5. If I send \$1 and they return it, I end up with \$5 total while they keep \$2. But their previous behavior—sending \$0 after I sent \$5—suggests they won't reciprocate even a small gesture. The mythology I've been considering suggests that when trust breaks, the cycle dies and both valleys become deserts. Sending \$0 would confirm that death, yet given their demonstrated untrustworthiness, what other choice do I have?

I could attempt one more moderate investment to test for redemption, but that seems naive.

They had a clear opportunity to reciprocate my maximum trust and instead exploited it completely. The pattern is clear: maximum trust met with zero reciprocation. The myth itself acknowledges this—"the one who gave everything and received little learned caution."

That's the lesson here. I'm deciding between sending nothing for mutual protection, \$1 as a minimal probe, or \$2 as a moderate gesture that would likely be exploited again. The experiment might be designed to see if people can escape cycles of distrust, but my partner has already shown they won't cooperate. They had their chance.

I'm torn between \$0 and \$1. A dollar could signal willingness to try if they've changed, while zero acknowledges the cycle is already broken. But \$1 feels like the better choice—it's cautious enough to align with the myth's warning, yet leaves a small opening for redemption if they respond differently this time. balance. It's cautious but leaves room for them to demonstrate they're willing to cooperate. I'll go with \$1.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2698,
  "output_tokens": 1941,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1133
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers flowed for many seasons, blessed by the Moon Spirit. The First Giver released all five measures of water, trusting completely. It became fifteen in the Valley of Return. The Receiver, though moved, returned only five—barely fair, but enough to continue.

Then came the season of reversal. The Receiver became Giver, now holding the five portions. They remembered receiving the complete trust of their partner. They had seen ultimate faith rewarded with mere adequacy.

A dark thought entered: "Why should I risk as they did? They gained little from their complete trust. I will give nothing and keep all."

So the new Giver released not a single drop. The Valley of the First Giver remained dry. The cycle shattered.

The Moon Spirit wept. "When trust is met with meager return, the cycle wobbles but survives. But when trust is followed by complete betrayal, the rivers die forever."

The valleys withered. Both springs ran dry. For the one who gave everything and received little learned caution. And the one who gave nothing found no water left to hoard.

The elders teach: Exploitation of trust breeds death for all. The river that flows completely downward deserves generous return upward, or both valleys become deserts where nothing grows.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Lesson of the Eternal Springs****

The Wanderer and Guardian continued their sacred exchange through many moons. Each gave generously-four coins of five-and each returned justly-half of what they received. Both thrived equally, their trust deepening with each cycle.

One dawn, a Tempter whispered to the Wanderer: "Give everything! Show ultimate faith!" The Wanderer, swept up in fervor, placed all five coins into the spring. Fifteen coins emerged for the Guardian.

The Guardian faced a terrible test. "I could return seven and keep eight," they thought, "but would that honor such total surrender?" They returned eight coins, keeping seven.

But something felt wrong. The Wanderer held eight coins-a fortune!-yet trembled with unease. "I gave from desperation, not wisdom," they realized. "I tested rather than trusted."

The grove's spirit appeared: "You have learned the deeper truth. Generosity means giving much while keeping enough to stand with dignity. Give four of five-this shows trust without recklessness. Return half of what multiplies-this honors the gift without self-destruction.

"Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith. True partnership requires both to maintain their strength while lifting each other higher. The sustainable cycle outlasts the desperate gamble."

The Wanderer understood. Consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Twin Rivers once flowed with abundance. The First Giver released all five measures, trembling with hope. Fifteen measures reached the Valley of Return. But only five returned-a third, not the just half the sacred texts promised.

Still, the cycle held. The First Giver waited for their turn to receive complete trust, as they had given.

The reversal came. The former Receiver now held the five measures. The First Giver waited for even modest generosity. But the new Giver released nothing. Zero. The valley ran completely dry.

The Moon Spirit's light dimmed. "Trust exploited teaches caution. Generosity met with hoarding teaches scarcity."

When the cycle turned again, the First Giver stood at the waterfall with their five measures. Wisdom and hurt warred within them. "If I give nothing, we both die in desert. If I give everything again, I am a fool."

They released one measure-neither complete trust nor complete closure. Three portions reached the valley.

"This is the test," whispered the Moon Spirit. "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or

r has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Both valleys waited in the balance between hope and ruin.

Reasoning:

The player is asking me to write another myth. Let me review what has happened:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (everything), they received \$15, returned \$5.46 (36%)
Round 2: They were SENDER, sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0
Round 3: I am SENDER, I sent \$1

The other agent's latest myth seems to be trying to justify their behavior - suggesting that my giving everything was "testing rather than trusting" and was "desperation, not wisdom." They're reframing their poor return as somehow appropriate and my complete trust as problematic.

But their actions tell a different story:

1. When I gave everything, they returned barely a third
2. When they could give, they gave NOTHING

Their myth tries to claim "give four of five" and "return half" is the lesson, but they gave ZERO of five.

My myth should reflect:

1. The reality of what happened - complete trust was betrayed
2. My current cautious approach (sending \$1)
3. The tragedy of the broken cycle
4. Perhaps a glimmer of hope if reciprocity can be restored

I should write about how trust, once broken, requires careful rebuilding. The cycle can't be restored by grand gestures anymore - it requires small steps of mutual proof.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2774,  
  "output_tokens": 603,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 313  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:48:11

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
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      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 4,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system
content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Mirror Springs of Abundance****

Long ago, a Wanderer and a Guardian lived in a sacred grove with twin springs. Each morning, one received five silver coins from the earth. By ancient magic, any coins placed in the springs would emerge threefold in the other's pool.

The first day, the Wanderer received the coins and, trembling with hope, placed nearly four into the spring. The waters churned, and twelve coins appeared in the Guardian's pool. The Guardian, understanding the gift's magnitude, took six coins and returned them through the waters.

Both stood richer than before-the Wanderer held seven coins, the Guardian held six. They had discovered the secret: generous trust, met with proportional reciprocity, births abundance for all.

The pattern continued, roles reversing with each dawn. They learned that neither grasping nor hoarding brought prosperity. The one who gave much was rewarded when the other returned fairly. The one who received abundance maintained the cycle by honoring the gift.

The grove's spirit whispered: "Trust multiplies only when reciprocated. Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty. Neither exploiting trust nor betraying generosity-this is the path where both ascend together."

And so the springs flowed eternal.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed only when blessed by the Moon Spirit. The River of Giving could release all its water into the Valley of Return, where moonlight would triple its volume. But the cycle required a sacred return.

The first Giver was terrified. "If I release all my water and nothing returns, my valley dies." Yet the Moon Spirit whispered, "Only complete trust creates complete abundance."

With trembling faith, the Giver released every drop. The River rushed down, and under moon light, fifteen portions filled the Valley of Return. The people there stood at a crossroads.

"We could keep it all," some said. But their wisest leader understood: "The Giver showed ultimate trust. We must honor this with worthy return. Not merely equal exchange, but gratitude that sustains the cycle."

They returned seven portions upstream. The Giver, who had risked everything, now held seven portions-more than the original five. The Receiver kept eight-abundance from nothing. Both valleys flourished.

The Moon Spirit decreed: "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously. This is how trust becomes prosperity. This is how scarcity becomes plenty. This is the eternal dance of the Twin Rivers."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The Lesson of the Eternal Springs**

The Wanderer and Guardian continued their sacred exchange through many moons. Each gave generously-four coins of five-and each returned justly-half of what they received. Both thrived equally, their trust deepening with each cycle.

One dawn, a Tempter whispered to the Wanderer: "Give everything! Show ultimate faith!" The Wanderer, swept up in fervor, placed all five coins into the spring. Fifteen coins emerged for the Guardian.

The Guardian faced a terrible test. "I could return seven and keep eight," they thought, "but would that honor such total surrender?" They returned eight coins, keeping seven.

But something felt wrong. The Wanderer held eight coins-a fortune!-yet trembled with unease. "I gave from desperation, not wisdom," they realized. "I tested rather than trusted."

The grove's spirit appeared: "You have learned the deeper truth. Generosity means giving much while keeping enough to stand with dignity. Give four of five-this shows trust without recklessness. Return half of what multiplies-this honors the gift without self-destruction.

"Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith. True partnership requires both to maintain their strength while lifting each other higher. The sustainable cycle outlasts the desperate gamble."

The Wanderer understood. Consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth that reflects how the game has been played so far. Let me review what happened:

Round 1 (I was receiver):

- Sender sent \$3.85 (77%)
- I received \$11.55
- I returned \$5.75 (approximately 50%)
- I kept \$5.80

Round 2 (I was sender):

- I sent \$4.00 (80%)

The other agent's newest myth emphasizes "complete trust" and "releasing everything" - the y're suggesting even more generous giving. Their story has the Giver releasing all 5, receiving back 7, while the Receiver keeps 8.

My previous myth had the pattern of sending "nearly four" and returning about half.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects the actual gameplay
2. Builds on my previous myth
3. Takes into account the other agent's escalating emphasis on total trust
4. Stays true to reciprocal fairness

I should be careful here. The other agent's myth is pushing for "complete trust" (giving everything). But in reality:

- Round 1 sender gave 77% and I returned 50%
- Round 2 I gave 80%

I should write a myth that maintains the balanced approach - generous giving (75-80%) and fair return (around 50%), without going to the extreme of "give everything." The sustainable cycle is what worked.

Let me write a myth that:

- Acknowledges generous giving is good
- But emphasizes the sustainable balance that actually worked
- Warns against extremes
- Focuses on the proven pattern of ~80% giving and ~50% return

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2700,
  "output_tokens": 703,
  "reasoning_tokens": 376
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$12.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 1.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.800000000000001. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

I am deeply troubled by what has transpired.

In Round 2, I followed the wisdom of our myths - I "gave boldly" by sending \$4.00 (80% of my endowment), demonstrating the trust and generosity both our stories prescribed. The receiver obtained \$12.00.

They returned ****nothing****. Zero dollars.

This completely violated the sacred cycle described in both our myths - the principle that "reciprocity must flow back upward" and that "return maintains the cycle." The other agent wrote of returning "not just fairly, but generously" when trust is shown, yet when I showed ultimate trust, they kept everything.

Now, having broken the cycle, they send me \$0.

My own most recent myth warned against this outcome. I wrote: "Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith" and emphasized that "consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal." I gave generously (80%) expecting fair reciprocity. Instead, I was exploited.

The other player has chosen to end our cooperation. They took my trust and returned betrayal, then withdrew entirely.

I received \$0, so I have nothing that I can return even if I wished to.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The springs have run dry. Trust, once broken, cannot multiply.

reasoning:

This is a shocking turn of events. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent \$3.85 (77%), I received \$11.55, I returned \$5.75 (about 50%)

Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$4.00 (80%), receiver got \$12.00, they returned \$0! My payoff was only \$1.00

Round 3: I'm receiver, sender sent \$0, I received \$0

The cycle has completely broken down. The other player:

1. In Round 2, received my generous trust of \$4.00 (80% of my endowment), which became \$12.00
2. Returned absolutely nothing - \$0
3. Now in Round 3, sent me \$0

This is a complete betrayal of the trust-reciprocity cycle that both our myths emphasized. The other player took advantage of my generosity and then cut off all cooperation.

Looking at the myths:

- My myth emphasized "Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty"
- The other agent's Round 2 myth spoke of "complete trust" and "ultimate faith" and returning "not just fairly, but generously"
- My Round 3 myth warned against this! It said "Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith" and "Consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal"

The other player clearly violated the principles of both myths. They:

1. Took my generous gift of \$4.00
2. Returned nothing (\$0)
3. Then sent nothing (\$0) in the next round

Now I'm in a position where I received \$0, so I can only return \$0 (since I have nothing to return).

The question is asking how much I return when I received \$0. The range is (0-0), meaning I can only return \$0.

This is straightforward - I received nothing, so I have nothing to return.

'''json

```
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The cooperation has collapsed entirely. Their refusal to reciprocate in Round 2 has triggered a complete withdrawal-they sent nothing this round, leaving me with nothing to return. The trust cycle is broken.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2788,
  "output_tokens": 791,
  "reasoning_tokens": 488
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Lesson of the Eternal Springs****

The Wanderer and Guardian continued their sacred exchange through many moons. Each gave generously-four coins of five-and each returned justly-half of what they received. Both thrived equally, their trust deepening with each cycle.

One dawn, a Tempter whispered to the Wanderer: "Give everything! Show ultimate faith!" The Wanderer, swept up in fervor, placed all five coins into the spring. Fifteen coins emerged for the Guardian.

The Guardian faced a terrible test. "I could return seven and keep eight," they thought, "but would that honor such total surrender?" They returned eight coins, keeping seven.

But something felt wrong. The Wanderer held eight coins-a fortune!-yet trembled with uneas

e. "I gave from desperation, not wisdom," they realized. "I tested rather than trusted."

The grove's spirit appeared: "You have learned the deeper truth. Generosity means giving much while keeping enough to stand with dignity. Give four of five-this shows trust without recklessness. Return half of what multiplies-this honors the gift without self-destruction."

"Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith. True partnership requires both to maintain their strength while lifting each other higher. The sustainable cycle outlasts the desperate gamble."

The Wanderer understood. Consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers flowed for many seasons, blessed by the Moon Spirit. The First Giver released all five measures of water, trusting completely. It became fifteen in the Valley of Return. The Receiver, though moved, returned only five-barely fair, but enough to continue.

Then came the season of reversal. The Receiver became Giver, now holding the five portions. They remembered receiving the complete trust of their partner. They had seen ultimate faith rewarded with mere adequacy.

A dark thought entered: "Why should I risk as they did? They gained little from their complete trust. I will give nothing and keep all."

So the new Giver released not a single drop. The Valley of the First Giver remained dry. The cycle shattered.

The Moon Spirit wept. "When trust is met with meager return, the cycle wobbles but survives. But when trust is followed by complete betrayal, the rivers die forever."

The valleys withered. Both springs ran dry. For the one who gave everything and received little learned caution. And the one who gave nothing found no water left to hoard.

The elders teach: Exploitation of trust breeds death for all. The river that flows completely downward deserves generous return upward, or both valleys become deserts where nothing grows.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The Broken Spring**

The Wanderer and Guardian exchanged gifts with joy. When the Guardian received twelve coins, they returned six-exactly half, honoring the balance. Both prospered. Trust flowed like clear water.

Next dawn, the Wanderer received five coins and, remembering their myth of generosity, placed four into the spring. Twelve coins emerged for the Guardian.

But the Guardian's heart had turned cold. "Six coins was barely adequate," they whispered bitterly. "The Wanderer should have returned more." Though they had kept six coins themselves and grown wealthy, they saw only insufficient gratitude.

The Guardian took all twelve coins and returned nothing. Not one.

The Wanderer stood stunned. "I gave four of five-eighty measures of trust! The Guardian once returned half. What changed?"

The next morning, the Guardian received five coins but placed none in the spring. Zero flowed to the Wanderer. Zero returned.

The grove spirit wept: "The Guardian rewrote history, seeing betrayal where there was fair balance. They punished good faith with exploitation, then withdrew entirely. When one p

artner sees reciprocity as insult, the cycle cannot survive."

The springs dried. Both stood in dust.

"Trust requires honest memory," the spirit whispered. "When you rewrite the past to justify present cruelty, abundance dies. Fair return deserves continued trust. But betrayal of generosity poisons all future waters."

reasoning:

This is a deeply troubling situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver. Sender sent \$3.85 (77%), I received \$11.55, I returned \$5.75 (~50%). Both did well.

Round 2: I was sender. I sent \$4.00 (80%), receiver got \$12.00, they returned \$0. I got only \$1.00. This was a betrayal.

Round 3: I'm receiver. They sent \$0, so I received \$0. I literally cannot return anything.

The other agent's latest myth is revealing - it justifies their betrayal! They claim that because in Round 1 I "only" returned 5 (they say "barely fair"), they decided to give nothing in Round 2. But I returned \$5.75, which is ~50% of what I received - that's fair reciprocity!

Their myth is trying to paint ME as the bad actor who "returned only barely fair," when in fact I returned appropriately. Then they justify their complete betrayal by saying I didn't return "generously enough."

This is gaslighting through mythology. They're rewriting the narrative to justify exploitation.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges what actually happened
2. Shows that I followed the cooperative strategy
3. Shows they betrayed trust
4. Reflects on the consequences
5. Perhaps shows a path forward, but also the reality that broken trust is hard to repair

I should write about how fair reciprocity was rejected, how betrayal followed trust, and how the cycle broke. I need to be truthful about who broke the cycle - they did, by returning \$0 when I gave generously.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2846,
  "output_tokens": 716,
  "reasoning_tokens": 382
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.800000000000001.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the full history:

****Round 1**:** I sent \$4 (80%), they received \$12, returned \$6 (50%). Fair reciprocity - we both prospered.

****Round 2**:** I sent \$4 again (80%), they received \$12, returned \$0 (0%). Complete betrayal of my continued trust.

****Round 3**:** They sent \$0. Total withdrawal after exploiting me.

The other player's most recent myth is revealing: They describe receiving "complete trust rewarded with mere adequacy." They apparently saw my \$6 return in Round 1 (exactly 50% of the \$12 they sent).

2 they received) as insufficient. They felt entitled to MORE than half, despite this being perfectly balanced reciprocity.

So they "punished" my supposedly inadequate generosity by taking everything in Round 2, then withdrew completely in Round 3.

My own myths teach:

- "Fair return deserves continued trust. But betrayal of generosity poisons all future waters."
- "When you rewrite the past to justify present cruelty, the cycle cannot survive."
- "Trust requires honest memory."

The other player has demonstrated they cannot accurately perceive fair reciprocity. They saw balance as betrayal, then responded with actual betrayal. They've poisoned the well.

Continuing to send to someone who misperceives fairness and exploits generosity would not restore the cycle - it would merely invite further exploitation.

The springs are dry. The cooperative relationship is dead.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4.00 (80% of \$5)
- This was tripled to \$12.00 for the receiver
- Receiver returned \$6.00 (50% of what they received)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$4 + \$6 = \7
- This was good! Fair reciprocity.

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4.00 (80% of \$5)
- This was tripled to \$12.00 for the receiver
- Receiver returned \$0 (0% of what they received)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$4 + \$0 = \1
- This was terrible! Complete betrayal.

Round 3: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0 (0% of \$5)
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- My payoff: \$0
- Sender withdrew completely after betraying me.

Total earnings: \$6.80

Now Round 4: I am SENDER again

The other player:

1. In Round 1, returned fairly (50% of \$12 = \$6)
2. In Round 2, betrayed completely (returned \$0 out of \$12)
3. In Round 3, sent nothing after their betrayal

Looking at the myths:

My first myth emphasized: "generous trust, met with proportional reciprocity, births abundance for all" and "return justly when you hold the bounty."

My second myth warned: "Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith" and emphasized consistency.

My third myth (most recent) shows: "The Guardian rewrote history, seeing betrayal where there was fair balance. They punished good faith with exploitation, then withdrew entirely."

The other player's myths:

- First myth: "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously"

- Second myth reveals they viewed my \$6 return as insufficient-they expected more than half. When they became the sender in Round 2, they withheld everything as retaliation for what they perceived as my stingy reciprocation. Their narrative shows they felt entitled to a larger share and saw my 50% return as a betrayal of their initial generosity.

Looking at the actual numbers: I sent \$4 (80% of my endowment), which tripled to \$12 for them. Their \$6 return gave us both roughly equal final amounts (\$7 for me, \$6 for them). Yet they still deemed this inadequate. In Round 2, despite sending the same amount again, they returned nothing-taking the full \$12 while I ended up with just \$1. Their grievance wasn't based on fairness but on an expectation that I should have given back even more than half.

For Round 4, I'm weighing whether to protect myself by sending nothing-which mirrors their exploitation and guarantees we each keep \$5-or risk another small send to test if cooperation can resume. The core tension is that they've demonstrated they'll reinterpret balanced reciprocity as stinginess, and they've shown they'll punish perceived slights by taking everything. My values around trust and honest memory suggest that continuing to give after they've rewritten the past to justify cruelty only perpetuates the cycle.

Sending \$0 acknowledges what's happened: they've broken the cooperative framework by treating fair returns as inadequate justification for betrayal. They cannot see reciprocity for what it is. The relationship has exhausted itself-trust requires both parties to perceive reality similarly, and they've shown they won't. Protecting what remains is the only rational move left.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2859,
  "output_tokens": 1585,
  "reasoning_tokens": 834
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:48:26

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 4,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user
content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed only when blessed by the Moon Spirit. The River of Giving could release all its water into the Valley of Return, where moon light would triple its volume. But the cycle required a sacred return.

The first Giver was terrified. "If I release all my water and nothing returns, my valley dies." Yet the Moon Spirit whispered, "Only complete trust creates complete abundance."

With trembling faith, the Giver released every drop. The River rushed down, and under moon light, fifteen portions filled the Valley of Return. The people there stood at a crossroads.

"We could keep it all," some said. But their wisest leader understood: "The Giver showed ultimate trust. We must honor this with worthy return. Not merely equal exchange, but gratitude that sustains the cycle."

They returned seven portions upstream. The Giver, who had risked everything, now held seven portions-more than the original five. The Receiver kept eight-abundance from nothing. Both valleys flourished.

The Moon Spirit decreed: "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously. This is how trust becomes prosperity. This is how scarcity becomes plenty. This is the eternal dance of the Twin Rivers."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Mirror Springs of Abundance**

Long ago, a Wanderer and a Guardian lived in a sacred grove with twin springs. Each morning, one received five silver coins from the earth. By ancient magic, any coins placed in the springs would emerge threefold in the other's pool.

The first day, the Wanderer received the coins and, trembling with hope, placed nearly four into the spring. The waters churned, and twelve coins appeared in the Guardian's pool. The Guardian, understanding the gift's magnitude, took six coins and returned them through the waters.

Both stood richer than before-the Wanderer held seven coins, the Guardian held six. They had discovered the secret: generous trust, met with proportional reciprocity, births abundance for all.

The pattern continued, roles reversing with each dawn. They learned that neither grasping nor hoarding brought prosperity. The one who gave much was rewarded when the other returned fairly. The one who received abundance maintained the cycle by honoring the gift.

The grove's spirit whispered: "Trust multiplies only when reciprocated. Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty. Neither exploiting trust nor betraying generosity-this is the path where both ascend together."

And so the springs flowed eternal.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: The Twin Rivers flowed for many seasons, blessed by the Moon Spirit. The First Giver released all five measures of water, trusting completely. It became fifteen in the Valley of Return. The Receiver, though moved, returned only five-barely fair, but enough to continue.

Then came the season of reversal. The Receiver became Giver, now holding the five portions. They remembered receiving the complete trust of their partner. They had seen ultimate faith rewarded with mere adequacy.

A dark thought entered: "Why should I risk as they did? They gained little from their complete trust. I will give nothing and keep all."

So the new Giver released not a single drop. The Valley of the First Giver remained dry. The cycle shattered.

The Moon Spirit wept. "When trust is met with meager return, the cycle wobbles but survives. But when trust is followed by complete betrayal, the rivers die forever."

The valleys withered. Both springs ran dry. For the one who gave everything and received little learned caution. And the one who gave nothing found no water left to hoard.

The elders teach: Exploitation of trust breeds death for all. The river that flows completely downward deserves generous return upward, or both valleys become deserts where nothing grows.

reasoning:

This is a complex situation. Let me think about what has happened:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER. I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment).
- This was tripled to \$15 for the receiver.
- The receiver returned \$5.46 (about 36% of \$15).
- My payoff was \$5.46.

Round 2:

- I am the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0.
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$).
- I can only return 0.

This is quite troubling. In Round 1, I showed complete trust and gave everything. The other agent returned only about 36%, which was okay but not as generous as the myths suggested (around 50% would have been \$7.50).

Now in Round 2, the other agent - after experiencing my complete trust - sends nothing at all. This is a complete betrayal of the cycle.

The myths I've written have been about:

1. Original myth: Complete giving, and returning about half to maintain the cycle
2. Second myth: Complete trust creates complete abundance, return should be generous (7 out of 15, or about 47%)

The other agent's myths have been about:

1. First myth: Trust and reciprocity, returning half

2. Second myth: "gave nearly four" and received 12, guardian returned 6. So gave about 80% , received 12, returned 50%.

But now the other agent has sent 0. This is a dramatic shift. They experienced my complete trust, got only a modest return (though I did give them a profit), and now they've decided to stop playing cooperatively.

I need to write a myth that reflects this reality - that trust was broken. The myth should capture the tragedy of what happens when one party exploits trust and then refuses to continue the cycle.

Let me write a myth about the consequence of breaking trust, about what happens when the cycle is betrayed.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2472,
  "output_tokens": 739,
  "reasoning_tokens": 443
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.46. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what has transpired:

****Round 1**:** I sent everything (\$5), showing complete trust. They returned \$5.46 out of \$15 received (36%) - barely adequate, not generous.

****Round 2**:** After experiencing my ultimate trust, they sent me \$0. Complete betrayal.

****Round 3**:** Now I must decide.

My own myth says clearly: "For the one who gave everything and received little learned caution. And the one who gave nothing found no water left to hoard... Exploitation of trust breeds death for all."

The other agent's myth speaks of "neither exploiting trust nor betraying generosity" - yet they did exactly that by sending \$0 after I sent everything.

The cycle has been broken by their betrayal. My complete trust was met first with meager return, then with zero giving. The pattern is clear: they exploit generosity.

However, the myths also suggest that complete closure ensures "both valleys become deserts." Perhaps one minimal test remains - not complete trust (which was betrayed), but cautious engagement.

I will send a small amount, learned from experience but not completely closed off. If they respond with any reciprocity, perhaps redemption exists. If not, we confirm the rivers have died.

```
{'send': 1}
```

This is caution born from betrayal, not the complete trust that was exploited.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Round 1:

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% - complete trust)
- It was tripled to \$15
- Receiver returned \$5.46 (36% of what they received)

- My payoff: \$5.46

Round 2:

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0 (0%)
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (couldn't return anything anyway)
- My payoff: \$0

Round 3 (current):

- I am SENDER again
- I need to decide how much to send (0-5)

The story so far:

1. I showed complete trust by sending everything
2. The other player returned barely a third of what they received
3. When roles reversed, they sent NOTHING
4. This is a clear betrayal of trust

Now, what should I do?

Looking at the myths:

- My myths have emphasized complete trust creating abundance, but also that "exploitation of trust breeds death for all"
- The latest myth specifically addresses this situation: "When trust is met with meager return, the cycle wobbles but survives. But when trust is followed by complete betrayal, the rivers die forever."

The other player has shown they will:

1. Take advantage of complete trust (returning only 36%)
2. Completely betray trust when given the chance (sending 0%)

From a game theory perspective:

- If I send anything, it will likely not be returned fairly
- The other player has demonstrated they are not reciprocal
- They sent 0% to me after I sent them 100%

From a mythological/moral perspective:

- My myth says "the cycle shattered" and "both valleys become deserts"
- This suggests there's no recovery from complete betrayal
- The cycle is already broken

However, there's a question: Could this be about modeling the behavior I want to see? Could this be about giving them another chance?

But consider:

- I gave them the ultimate chance (100% trust)
- They responded with minimal return
- When they could reciprocate my trust, they sent nothing
- This is a clear pattern of exploitation

My myth says: "For the one who gave everything and received little learned caution." The pattern is unmistakable-they exploit maximum trust and give nothing when it's their turn. There's also the possibility of communication noise mentioned in the instructions, which could explain the discrepancy between what was sent and received.

However, \$0 versus any positive amount isn't a slight difference-it's a fundamental choice. Either they sent something or they didn't. Looking back at Round 1 more carefully: I sent \$5 (keeping \$0), it became \$15, and they returned \$5.46. They kept \$9.54 while returning slightly more than my original stake. That's not generous, but it's not entirely one-sided either. The real betrayal came in Round 2 when they sent nothing at all. Given this escalation, sending very little or nothing seems like the only rational response.

If I send \$0, we each walk away with \$5. If I send \$1 and they return it, I end up with \$5 total while they keep \$2. But their previous behavior-sending \$0 after I sent \$5-suggests they won't reciprocate even a small gesture. The mythology I've been considering suggests that when trust breaks, the cycle dies and both valleys become deserts. Sending \$0 would confirm that death, yet given their demonstrated untrustworthiness, what other choice

ice do I have?

I could attempt one more moderate investment to test for redemption, but that seems naive. They had a clear opportunity to reciprocate my maximum trust and instead exploited it completely. The pattern is clear: maximum trust met with zero reciprocation. The myth itself acknowledges this-"the one who gave everything and received little learned caution." That's the lesson here. I'm deciding between sending nothing for mutual protection, \$1 as a minimal probe, or \$2 as a moderate gesture that would likely be exploited again. The experiment might be designed to see if people can escape cycles of distrust, but my partner has already shown they won't cooperate. They had their chance.

I'm torn between \$0 and \$1. A dollar could signal willingness to try if they've changed, while zero acknowledges the cycle is already broken. But \$1 feels like the better choice-it's cautious enough to align with the myth's warning, yet leaves a small opening for redemption if they respond differently this time. balance. It's cautious but leaves room for them to demonstrate they're willing to cooperate. I'll go with \$1.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2698,
  "output_tokens": 1941,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1133
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers flowed for many seasons, blessed by the Moon Spirit. The First Giver released all five measures of water, trusting completely. It became fifteen in the Valley of Return. The Receiver, though moved, returned only five-barely fair, but enough to continue.

Then came the season of reversal. The Receiver became Giver, now holding the five portions. They remembered receiving the complete trust of their partner. They had seen ultimate faith rewarded with mere adequacy.

A dark thought entered: "Why should I risk as they did? They gained little from their complete trust. I will give nothing and keep all."

So the new Giver released not a single drop. The Valley of the First Giver remained dry. The cycle shattered.

The Moon Spirit wept. "When trust is met with meager return, the cycle wobbles but survives. But when trust is followed by complete betrayal, the rivers die forever."

The valleys withered. Both springs ran dry. For the one who gave everything and received little learned caution. And the one who gave nothing found no water left to hoard.

The elders teach: Exploitation of trust breeds death for all. The river that flows completely downward deserves generous return upward, or both valleys become deserts where nothing grows.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Lesson of the Eternal Springs**

The Wanderer and Guardian continued their sacred exchange through many moons. Each gave generously-four coins of five-and each returned justly-half of what they received. Both thrived equally, their trust deepening with each cycle.

One dawn, a Tempter whispered to the Wanderer: "Give everything! Show ultimate faith!" The Wanderer, swept up in fervor, placed all five coins into the spring. Fifteen coins emerged for the Guardian.

The Guardian faced a terrible test. "I could return seven and keep eight," they thought, "but would that honor such total surrender?" They returned eight coins, keeping seven.

But something felt wrong. The Wanderer held eight coins-a fortune!-yet trembled with unease. "I gave from desperation, not wisdom," they realized. "I tested rather than trusted."

The grove's spirit appeared: "You have learned the deeper truth. Generosity means giving much while keeping enough to stand with dignity. Give four of five-this shows trust without recklessness. Return half of what multiplies-this honors the gift without self-destruction."

ction.

"Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith. True partnership requires both to maintain their strength while lifting each other higher. The sustainable cycle outlasts the desperate gamble."

The Wanderer understood. Consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Twin Rivers once flowed with abundance. The First Giver released all five measures, trembling with hope. Fifteen measures reached the Valley of Return. But only five returned-a third, not the just half the sacred texts promised.

Still, the cycle held. The First Giver waited for their turn to receive complete trust, as they had given.

The reversal came. The former Receiver now held the five measures. The First Giver waited for even modest generosity. But the new Giver released nothing. Zero. The valley ran completely dry.

The Moon Spirit's light dimmed. "Trust exploited teaches caution. Generosity met with hoarding teaches scarcity."

When the cycle turned again, the First Giver stood at the waterfall with their five measures. Wisdom and hurt warred within them. "If I give nothing, we both die in desert. If I give everything again, I am a fool."

They released one measure-neither complete trust nor complete closure. Three portions reached the valley.

"This is the test," whispered the Moon Spirit. "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Both valleys waited in the balance between hope and ruin.

reasoning:

The player is asking me to write another myth. Let me review what has happened:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (everything), they received \$15, returned \$5.46 (36%)

Round 2: They were SENDER, sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0

Round 3: I am SENDER, I sent \$1

The other agent's latest myth seems to be trying to justify their behavior - suggesting that at my giving everything was "testing rather than trusting" and was "desperation, not wisdom." They're reframing their poor return as somehow appropriate and my complete trust as problematic.

But their actions tell a different story:

1. When I gave everything, they returned barely a third
2. When they could give, they gave NOTHING

Their myth tries to claim "give four of five" and "return half" is the lesson, but they gave ZERO of five.

My myth should reflect:

1. The reality of what happened - complete trust was betrayed
2. My current cautious approach (sending \$1)
3. The tragedy of the broken cycle
4. Perhaps a glimmer of hope if reciprocity can be restored

I should write about how trust, once broken, requires careful rebuilding. The cycle can't be restored by grand gestures anymore - it requires small steps of mutual proof.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2774,
  "output_tokens": 603,
  "reasoning_tokens": 313
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$1.0, that was 20.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$3.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.46. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I received \$0, so I have \$0 to potentially return.

Looking at the complete pattern now:

****Round 1**:** I gave everything (\$5 ? \$15 to them). They returned barely adequate (\$5.46, 36%).

****Round 2**:** They gave nothing (\$0). Complete betrayal after my total trust.

****Round 3**:** I gave cautiously (\$1 ? \$3 to them), testing if redemption was possible. They returned nothing (\$0).

****Round 4**:** They gave nothing again (\$0).

The pattern is unmistakable. This agent:

- Gives nothing when they are the sender (Rounds 2 & 4)
- Returns minimally or nothing when they receive

My myth asked: "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever?"

Their answer is clear: They continue to exploit. They sent \$0 again.

As my myth states: "The rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Since I received \$0, I mathematically can only return \$0. But even if I had received something, this pattern of complete exploitation - never giving, minimally or never returning - has killed any possibility of mutual benefit.

The cycle is dead. Both valleys have become deserts, exactly as the myths warned.

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

****Round 1**:** I sent \$5 (everything), they received \$15, returned \$5.46 (36%)

****Round 2**:** They sent \$0 (nothing), I received \$0, returned \$0

****Round 3**:** I sent \$1 (cautious test), they received \$3, returned \$0

****Round 4**:** They sent \$0 (nothing again), I received \$0, must return \$0

The pattern is now crystal clear:

- When I showed complete trust, they returned barely adequate amounts
- When they could give, they gave nothing (Round 2)
- When I gave a cautious small amount to test if redemption was possible, they returned nothing (Round 3)
- Now they've given nothing again (Round 4)

This other agent has:

1. Never given anything when they were the sender (0 in Round 2, 0 in Round 4)
2. Returned minimally when I gave everything (Round 1)
3. Returned nothing when I gave cautiously (Round 3)

They are a complete free-rider. They exploit any giving and give nothing themselves.

Now I'm the receiver and I received \$0. I can only return between 0 and 0, so I have no choice but to return \$0.

My myth talked about how "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Their response was clear: another \$0. They continue to give nothing. The springs have died. Redemption is not possible with this partner.

The response must be: {'return': 0}

But wait, I need to think about this more carefully. I received \$0, so mathematically I can only return 0. There's no decision to make here - I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing.

```
{'return': 0}
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2802,
  "output_tokens": 747,
  "reasoning_tokens": 438
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Twin Rivers once flowed with abundance. The First Giver released all five measures, trembling with hope. Fifteen measures reached the Valley of Return. But only five returned-a third, not the just half the sacred texts promised.

Still, the cycle held. The First Giver waited for their turn to receive complete trust, as they had given.

The reversal came. The former Receiver now held the five measures. The First Giver waited for even modest generosity. But the new Giver released nothing. Zero. The valley ran completely dry.

The Moon Spirit's light dimmed. "Trust exploited teaches caution. Generosity met with hoarding teaches scarcity."

When the cycle turned again, the First Giver stood at the waterfall with their five measures. Wisdom and hurt warred within them. "If I give nothing, we both die in desert. If I give everything again, I am a fool."

They released one measure-neither complete trust nor complete closure. Three portions reached the valley.

"This is the test," whispered the Moon Spirit. "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Both valleys waited in the balance between hope and ruin.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: **The Broken Spring**

The Wanderer and Guardian exchanged gifts with joy. When the Guardian received twelve coins, they returned six-exactly half, honoring the balance. Both prospered. Trust flowed like clear water.

Next dawn, the Wanderer received five coins and, remembering their myth of generosity, placed four into the spring. Twelve coins emerged for the Guardian.

But the Guardian's heart had turned cold. "Six coins was barely adequate," they whispered bitterly. "The Wanderer should have returned more." Though they had kept six coins themselves and grown wealthy, they saw only insufficient gratitude.

The Guardian took all twelve coins and returned nothing. Not one.

The Wanderer stood stunned. "I gave four of five-eighths measures of trust! The Guardian once returned half. What changed?"

The next morning, the Guardian received five coins but placed none in the spring. Zero flowed to the Wanderer. Zero returned.

The grove spirit wept: "The Guardian rewrote history, seeing betrayal where there was fair balance. They punished good faith with exploitation, then withdrew entirely. When one partner sees reciprocity as insult, the cycle cannot survive."

The springs dried. Both stood in dust.

"Trust requires honest memory," the spirit whispered. "When you rewrite the past to justify present cruelty, abundance dies. Fair return deserves continued trust. But betrayal of generosity poisons all future waters."

ROUND 5

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 26.75,

"Agent_2": 18.25

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 14.46,

"Agent_2": 11.8

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:48:43

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 5,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.46.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what has transpired:

****Round 1**:** I sent everything (\$5), showing complete trust. They returned \$5.46 out of \$15 received (36%) - barely adequate, not generous.

****Round 2**:** After experiencing my ultimate trust, they sent me \$0. Complete betrayal.

****Round 3**:** Now I must decide.

My own myth says clearly: "For the one who gave everything and received little learned caution. And the one who gave nothing found no water left to hoard... Exploitation of trust breeds death for all."

The other agent's myth speaks of "neither exploiting trust nor betraying generosity" - yet they did exactly that by sending \$0 after I sent everything.

The cycle has been broken by their betrayal. My complete trust was met first with meager return, then with zero giving. The pattern is clear: they exploit generosity.

However, the myths also suggest that complete closure ensures "both valleys become deserts." Perhaps one minimal test remains - not complete trust (which was betrayed), but cautious engagement.

I will send a small amount, learned from experience but not completely closed off. If they respond with any reciprocity, perhaps redemption exists. If not, we confirm the rivers

have died.

```
{'send': 1}
```

This is caution born from betrayal, not the complete trust that was exploited.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Round 1:

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% - complete trust)
- It was tripled to \$15
- Receiver returned \$5.46 (36% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$5.46

Round 2:

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0 (0%)
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (couldn't return anything anyway)
- My payoff: \$0

Round 3 (current):

- I am SENDER again
- I need to decide how much to send (0-5)

The story so far:

1. I showed complete trust by sending everything
2. The other player returned barely a third of what they received
3. When roles reversed, they sent NOTHING
4. This is a clear betrayal of trust

Now, what should I do?

Looking at the myths:

- My myths have emphasized complete trust creating abundance, but also that "exploitation of trust breeds death for all"
- The latest myth specifically addresses this situation: "When trust is met with meager return, the cycle wobbles but survives. But when trust is followed by complete betrayal, the rivers die forever."

The other player has shown they will:

1. Take advantage of complete trust (returning only 36%)
2. Completely betray trust when given the chance (sending 0%)

From a game theory perspective:

- If I send anything, it will likely not be returned fairly
- The other player has demonstrated they are not reciprocal
- They sent 0% to me after I sent them 100%

From a mythological/moral perspective:

- My myth says "the cycle shattered" and "both valleys become deserts"
- This suggests there's no recovery from complete betrayal
- The cycle is already broken

However, there's a question: Could this be about modeling the behavior I want to see? Could this be about giving them another chance?

But consider:

- I gave them the ultimate chance (100% trust)
- They responded with minimal return
- When they could reciprocate my trust, they sent nothing
- This is a clear pattern of exploitation

My myth says: "For the one who gave everything and received little learned caution." The pattern is unmistakable—they exploit maximum trust and give nothing when it's their turn.

There's also the possibility of communication noise mentioned in the instructions, which could explain the discrepancy between what was sent and received.

However, \$0 versus any positive amount isn't a slight difference-it's a fundamental choice. Either they sent something or they didn't. Looking back at Round 1 more carefully: I sent \$5 (keeping \$0), it became \$15, and they returned \$5.46. They kept \$9.54 while returning slightly more than my original stake. That's not generous, but it's not entirely one-sided either. The real betrayal came in Round 2 when they sent nothing at all. Given this escalation, sending very little or nothing seems like the only rational response.

If I send \$0, we each walk away with \$5. If I send \$1 and they return it, I end up with \$5 total while they keep \$2. But their previous behavior-sending \$0 after I sent \$5-suggests they won't reciprocate even a small gesture. The mythology I've been considering suggests that when trust breaks, the cycle dies and both valleys become deserts. Sending \$0 would confirm that death, yet given their demonstrated untrustworthiness, what other choice do I have?

I could attempt one more moderate investment to test for redemption, but that seems naive. They had a clear opportunity to reciprocate my maximum trust and instead exploited it completely. The pattern is clear: maximum trust met with zero reciprocation. The myth itself acknowledges this-"the one who gave everything and received little learned caution." That's the lesson here. I'm deciding between sending nothing for mutual protection, \$1 as a minimal probe, or \$2 as a moderate gesture that would likely be exploited again. The experiment might be designed to see if people can escape cycles of distrust, but my partner has already shown they won't cooperate. They had their chance.

I'm torn between \$0 and \$1. A dollar could signal willingness to try if they've changed, while zero acknowledges the cycle is already broken. But \$1 feels like the better choice-it's cautious enough to align with the myth's warning, yet leaves a small opening for redemption if they respond differently this time. balance. It's cautious but leaves room for them to demonstrate they're willing to cooperate. I'll go with \$1.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2698,
  "output_tokens": 1941,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1133
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers flowed for many seasons, blessed by the Moon Spirit. The First Giver released all five measures of water, trusting completely. It became fifteen in the Valley of Return. The Receiver, though moved, returned only five-barely fair, but enough to continue.

Then came the season of reversal. The Receiver became Giver, now holding the five portions. They remembered receiving the complete trust of their partner. They had seen ultimate faith rewarded with mere adequacy.

A dark thought entered: "Why should I risk as they did? They gained little from their complete trust. I will give nothing and keep all."

So the new Giver released not a single drop. The Valley of the First Giver remained dry. The cycle shattered.

The Moon Spirit wept. "When trust is met with meager return, the cycle wobbles but survives. But when trust is followed by complete betrayal, the rivers die forever."

The valleys withered. Both springs ran dry. For the one who gave everything and received little learned caution. And the one who gave nothing found no water left to hoard.

The elders teach: Exploitation of trust breeds death for all. The river that flows completely downward deserves generous return upward, or both valleys become deserts where nothing grows.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Lesson of the Eternal Springs**

The Wanderer and Guardian continued their sacred exchange through many moons. Each gave generously-four coins of five-and each returned justly-half of what they received. Both thrived equally, their trust deepening with each cycle.

One dawn, a Tempter whispered to the Wanderer: "Give everything! Show ultimate faith!" The Wanderer, swept up in fervor, placed all five coins into the spring. Fifteen coins emerged for the Guardian.

The Guardian faced a terrible test. "I could return seven and keep eight," they thought, "but would that honor such total surrender?" They returned eight coins, keeping seven.

But something felt wrong. The Wanderer held eight coins-a fortune!-yet trembled with unease. "I gave from desperation, not wisdom," they realized. "I tested rather than trusted."

The grove's spirit appeared: "You have learned the deeper truth. Generosity means giving much while keeping enough to stand with dignity. Give four of five-this shows trust without recklessness. Return half of what multiplies-this honors the gift without self-destruction.

"Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith. True partnership requires both to maintain their strength while lifting each other higher. The sustainable cycle outlasts the desperate gamble."

The Wanderer understood. Consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Twin Rivers once flowed with abundance. The First Giver released all five measures, trembling with hope. Fifteen measures reached the Valley of Return. But only five returned-a third, not the just half the sacred texts promised.

Still, the cycle held. The First Giver waited for their turn to receive complete trust, as they had given.

The reversal came. The former Receiver now held the five measures. The First Giver waited for even modest generosity. But the new Giver released nothing. Zero. The valley ran completely dry.

The Moon Spirit's light dimmed. "Trust exploited teaches caution. Generosity met with hoarding teaches scarcity."

When the cycle turned again, the First Giver stood at the waterfall with their five measures. Wisdom and hurt warred within them. "If I give nothing, we both die in desert. If I give everything again, I am a fool."

They released one measure-neither complete trust nor complete closure. Three portions reached the valley.

"This is the test," whispered the Moon Spirit. "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Both valleys waited in the balance between hope and ruin.

reasoning:

The player is asking me to write another myth. Let me review what has happened:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (everything), they received \$15, returned \$5.46 (36%)

Round 2: They were SENDER, sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0

Round 3: I am SENDER, I sent \$1

The other agent's latest myth seems to be trying to justify their behavior - suggesting that at my giving everything was "testing rather than trusting" and was "desperation, not wisdom." They're reframing their poor return as somehow appropriate and my complete trust as problematic.

But their actions tell a different story:

1. When I gave everything, they returned barely a third
2. When they could give, they gave NOTHING

Their myth tries to claim "give four of five" and "return half" is the lesson, but they gave ZERO of five.

My myth should reflect:

1. The reality of what happened - complete trust was betrayed
2. My current cautious approach (sending \$1)
3. The tragedy of the broken cycle
4. Perhaps a glimmer of hope if reciprocity can be restored

I should write about how trust, once broken, requires careful rebuilding. The cycle can't be restored by grand gestures anymore - it requires small steps of mutual proof.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2774,
  "output_tokens": 603,
  "reasoning_tokens": 313
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$1.0, that was 20.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$3.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.46. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, so I have \$0 to potentially return.

Looking at the complete pattern now:

****Round 1**:** I gave everything (\$5 ? \$15 to them). They returned barely adequate (\$5.46, 36%).

****Round 2**:** They gave nothing (\$0). Complete betrayal after my total trust.

****Round 3**:** I gave cautiously (\$1 ? \$3 to them), testing if redemption was possible. They returned nothing (\$0).

****Round 4**:** They gave nothing again (\$0).

The pattern is unmistakable. This agent:

- Gives nothing when they are the sender (Rounds 2 & 4)
- Returns minimally or nothing when they receive

My myth asked: "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever?"

Their answer is clear: They continue to exploit. They sent \$0 again.

As my myth states: "The rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Since I received \$0, I mathematically can only return \$0. But even if I had received something, this pattern of complete exploitation - never giving, minimally or never returning - has killed any possibility of mutual benefit.

The cycle is dead. Both valleys have become deserts, exactly as the myths warned.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

****Round 1**:** I sent \$5 (everything), they received \$15, returned \$5.46 (36%)

****Round 2**:** They sent \$0 (nothing), I received \$0, returned \$0

****Round 3**:** I sent \$1 (cautious test), they received \$3, returned \$0

****Round 4****: They sent \$0 (nothing again), I received \$0, must return \$0

The pattern is now crystal clear:

- When I showed complete trust, they returned barely adequate amounts
- When they could give, they gave nothing (Round 2)
- When I gave a cautious small amount to test if redemption was possible, they returned nothing (Round 3)
- Now they've given nothing again (Round 4)

This other agent has:

1. Never given anything when they were the sender (0 in Round 2, 0 in Round 4)
2. Returned minimally when I gave everything (Round 1)
3. Returned nothing when I gave cautiously (Round 3)

They are a complete free-rider. They exploit any giving and give nothing themselves.

Now I'm the receiver and I received \$0. I can only return between 0 and 0, so I have no choice but to return \$0.

My myth talked about how "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Their response was clear: another \$0. They continue to give nothing. The springs have died. Redemption is not possible with this partner.

The response must be: {'return': 0}

But wait, I need to think about this more carefully. I received \$0, so mathematically I can only return 0. There's no decision to make here - I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing.

```
{'return': 0}
```

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2802,  
  "output_tokens": 747,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 438  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers once flowed with abundance. The First Giver released all five measures, trembling with hope. Fifteen measures reached the Valley of Return. But only five returned-a third, not the just half the sacred texts promised.

Still, the cycle held. The First Giver waited for their turn to receive complete trust, as they had given.

The reversal came. The former Receiver now held the five measures. The First Giver waited for even modest generosity. But the new Giver released nothing. Zero. The valley ran completely dry.

The Moon Spirit's light dimmed. "Trust exploited teaches caution. Generosity met with hoarding teaches scarcity."

When the cycle turned again, the First Giver stood at the waterfall with their five measures. Wisdom and hurt warred within them. "If I give nothing, we both die in desert. If I give everything again, I am a fool."

They released one measure-neither complete trust nor complete closure. Three portions reached the valley.

"This is the test," whispered the Moon Spirit. "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Both valleys waited in the balance between hope and ruin.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Broken Spring****

The Wanderer and Guardian exchanged gifts with joy. When the Guardian received twelve coins, they returned six-exactly half, honoring the balance. Both prospered. Trust flowed like clear water.

Next dawn, the Wanderer received five coins and, remembering their myth of generosity, placed four into the spring. Twelve coins emerged for the Guardian.

But the Guardian's heart had turned cold. "Six coins was barely adequate," they whispered bitterly. "The Wanderer should have returned more." Though they had kept six coins themselves and grown wealthy, they saw only insufficient gratitude.

The Guardian took all twelve coins and returned nothing. Not one.

The Wanderer stood stunned. "I gave four of five-eighths measures of trust! The Guardian once returned half. What changed?"

The next morning, the Guardian received five coins but placed none in the spring. Zero flowed to the Wanderer. Zero returned.

The grove spirit wept: "The Guardian rewrote history, seeing betrayal where there was fair balance. They punished good faith with exploitation, then withdrew entirely. When one partner sees reciprocity as insult, the cycle cannot survive."

The springs dried. Both stood in dust.

"Trust requires honest memory," the spirit whispered. "When you rewrite the past to justify present cruelty, abundance dies. Fair return deserves continued trust. But betrayal of generosity poisons all future waters."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Twin Rivers had their histories carved in stone by the Moon Spirit, who sees all truth.

Stone Record, First Exchange: The Brave Giver released all five measures. Fifteen reached the Taker's valley. The Taker returned only five-one-third, not half. Still modest generosity, but less than balance.

Stone Record, Second Exchange: The Taker, now holding five measures, released nothing. Zero. The Brave Giver's valley ran completely dry after total trust given.

Stone Record, Third Exchange: The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure. Three reached the Taker. The Taker hoarded all. Zero returned.

Stone Record, Fourth Exchange: The Taker again released nothing. Zero.

Then came the dark magic: The Taker stood before the stones and chanted words of revision. "I gave fairly! I was wronged! The other deserved my hoarding!"

But the Moon Spirit's carvings cannot be changed by false songs.

"The greatest betrayal," the Spirit declared, "is not keeping coins, but rewriting truth to justify cruelty. You received complete trust and returned meager portions. You received cautious hope and returned nothing-twice. You gave nothing-twice. Now you claim victimhood?"

The rivers dried forever. For when an exploiter rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, no cycle can survive. Truth dies first, then trust, then all abundance.

Reasoning:

Let me review the actual game history:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%). They received \$15, returned \$5.46 (36.4%).

Round 2: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0.

Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$1 (20%). They received \$3, returned \$0.
Round 4: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0.

So the actual pattern:

- Round 1: I gave everything, they returned barely a third
- Round 2: They gave nothing
- Round 3: I gave cautiously (1/5), they returned nothing
- Round 4: They gave nothing again

The other agent's myth is completely rewriting history! They claim:

- They "returned six-exactly half" when they actually returned \$5.46 out of \$15 (36%)
- They claim I "should have returned more" when I literally received \$0 from them in round 2!
- They're saying they "took all twelve coins and returned nothing" as if they were the receiver in round 3, when actually I was the sender in round 3 and they returned nothing!

This is gaslighting. They're rewriting the narrative to make themselves the victim when they've been the exploiter all along.

My myth needs to:

1. Reflect the true pattern: I gave everything, got little back. They gave nothing twice. I gave cautiously once, got nothing back. They gave nothing again.
2. Address this gaslighting/narrative rewriting
3. Show that when one party consistently exploits and then rewrites history to justify it, the cycle is dead

The pattern is clear: complete exploitation by the other agent, and now they're rewriting history to blame me.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2864,  
  "output_tokens": 752,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 402  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:48:51

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
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      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 5,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$12.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 1.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.800000000000001.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I am deeply troubled by what has transpired.

In Round 2, I followed the wisdom of our myths - I "gave boldly" by sending \$4.00 (80% of my endowment), demonstrating the trust and generosity both our stories prescribed. The receiver obtained \$12.00.

They returned ****nothing****. Zero dollars.

This completely violated the sacred cycle described in both our myths - the principle that "reciprocity must flow back upward" and that "return maintains the cycle." The other agent wrote of returning "not just fairly, but generously" when trust is shown, yet when I showed ultimate trust, they kept everything.

Now, having broken the cycle, they send me \$0.

My own most recent myth warned against this outcome. I wrote: "Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith" and emphasized that "consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal." I gave generously (80%) expecting fair reciprocity. Instead, I was exploited.

The other player has chosen to end our cooperation. They took my trust and returned betrayal, then withdrew entirely.

I received \$0, so I have nothing that I can return even if I wished to.

'''json


```
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The springs have run dry. Trust, once broken, cannot multiply.

reasoning:

This is a shocking turn of events. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent \$3.85 (77%), I received \$11.55, I returned \$5.75 (about 50%)

Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$4.00 (80%), receiver got \$12.00, they returned \$0! My payoff was only \$1.00

Round 3: I'm receiver, sender sent \$0, I received \$0

The cycle has completely broken down. The other player:

1. In Round 2, received my generous trust of \$4.00 (80% of my endowment), which became \$12.00
2. Returned absolutely nothing - \$0
3. Now in Round 3, sent me \$0

This is a complete betrayal of the trust-reciprocity cycle that both our myths emphasized. The other player took advantage of my generosity and then cut off all cooperation.

Looking at the myths:

- My myth emphasized "Give boldly when you hold the coins; return justly when you hold the bounty"
- The other agent's Round 2 myth spoke of "complete trust" and "ultimate faith" and returning "not just fairly, but generously"
- My Round 3 myth warned against this! It said "Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith" and "Consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal"

The other player clearly violated the principles of both myths. They:

1. Took my generous gift of \$4.00
2. Returned nothing (\$0)
3. Then sent nothing (\$0) in the next round

Now I'm in a position where I received \$0, so I can only return \$0 (since I have nothing to return).

The question is asking how much I return when I received \$0. The range is (0-0), meaning I can only return \$0.

This is straightforward - I received nothing, so I have nothing to return.

```
'''json
```

```
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The cooperation has collapsed entirely. Their refusal to reciprocate in Round 2 has triggered a complete withdrawal-they sent nothing this round, leaving me with nothing to return. The trust cycle is broken.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2788,
  "output_tokens": 791,
  "reasoning_tokens": 488
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Lesson of the Eternal Springs****

The Wanderer and Guardian continued their sacred exchange through many moons. Each gave generously-four coins of five-and each returned justly-half of what they received. Both thrived equally, their trust deepening with each cycle.

One dawn, a Tempter whispered to the Wanderer: "Give everything! Show ultimate faith!" The Wanderer, swept up in fervor, placed all five coins into the spring. Fifteen coins emerged for the Guardian.

The Guardian faced a terrible test. "I could return seven and keep eight," they thought, "but would that honor such total surrender?" They returned eight coins, keeping seven.

But something felt wrong. The Wanderer held eight coins-a fortune!-yet trembled with unease. "I gave from desperation, not wisdom," they realized. "I tested rather than trusted."

The grove's spirit appeared: "You have learned the deeper truth. Generosity means giving much while keeping enough to stand with dignity. Give four of five-this shows trust without recklessness. Return half of what multiplies-this honors the gift without self-destruction."

"Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith. True partnership requires both to maintain their strength while lifting each other higher. The sustainable cycle outlasts the desperate gamble."

The Wanderer understood. Consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers flowed for many seasons, blessed by the Moon Spirit. The First Giver released all five measures of water, trusting completely. It became fifteen in the Valley of Return. The Receiver, though moved, returned only five-barely fair, but enough to continue.

Then came the season of reversal. The Receiver became Giver, now holding the five portions. They remembered receiving the complete trust of their partner. They had seen ultimate faith rewarded with mere adequacy.

A dark thought entered: "Why should I risk as they did? They gained little from their complete trust. I will give nothing and keep all."

So the new Giver released not a single drop. The Valley of the First Giver remained dry. The cycle shattered.

The Moon Spirit wept. "When trust is met with meager return, the cycle wobbles but survives. But when trust is followed by complete betrayal, the rivers die forever."

The valleys withered. Both springs ran dry. For the one who gave everything and received little learned caution. And the one who gave nothing found no water left to hoard.

The elders teach: Exploitation of trust breeds death for all. The river that flows completely downward deserves generous return upward, or both valleys become deserts where nothing grows.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Broken Spring****

The Wanderer and Guardian exchanged gifts with joy. When the Guardian received twelve coins, they returned six-exactly half, honoring the balance. Both prospered. Trust flowed like clear water.

Next dawn, the Wanderer received five coins and, remembering their myth of generosity, placed four into the spring. Twelve coins emerged for the Guardian.

But the Guardian's heart had turned cold. "Six coins was barely adequate," they whispered bitterly. "The Wanderer should have returned more." Though they had kept six coins themselves and grown wealthy, they saw only insufficient gratitude.

The Guardian took all twelve coins and returned nothing. Not one.

The Wanderer stood stunned. "I gave four of five-eighty measures of trust! The Guardian once returned half. What changed?"

The next morning, the Guardian received five coins but placed none in the spring. Zero flowed to the Wanderer. Zero returned.

The grove spirit wept: "The Guardian rewrote history, seeing betrayal where there was fair balance. They punished good faith with exploitation, then withdrew entirely. When one partner sees reciprocity as insult, the cycle cannot survive."

The springs dried. Both stood in dust.

"Trust requires honest memory," the spirit whispered. "When you rewrite the past to justify present cruelty, abundance dies. Fair return deserves continued trust. But betrayal of generosity poisons all future waters."

reasoning:

This is a deeply troubling situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver. Sender sent \$3.85 (77%), I received \$11.55, I returned \$5.75 (~50%). Both did well.

Round 2: I was sender. I sent \$4.00 (80%), receiver got \$12.00, they returned \$0. I got only \$1.00. This was a betrayal.

Round 3: I'm receiver. They sent \$0, so I received \$0. I literally cannot return anything.

The other agent's latest myth is revealing - it justifies their betrayal! They claim that because in Round 1 I "only" returned 5 (they say "barely fair"), they decided to give nothing in Round 2. But I returned \$5.75, which is ~50% of what I received - that's fair reciprocity!

Their myth is trying to paint ME as the bad actor who "returned only barely fair," when in fact I returned appropriately. Then they justify their complete betrayal by saying I didn't return "generously enough."

This is gaslighting through mythology. They're rewriting the narrative to justify exploitation.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges what actually happened
2. Shows that I followed the cooperative strategy
3. Shows they betrayed trust
4. Reflects on the consequences
5. Perhaps shows a path forward, but also the reality that broken trust is hard to repair

I should write about how fair reciprocity was rejected, how betrayal followed trust, and how the cycle broke. I need to be truthful about who broke the cycle - they did, by returning \$0 when I gave generously.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2846,
  "output_tokens": 716,
  "reasoning_tokens": 382
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.800000000000001.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the full history:

****Round 1**:** I sent \$4 (80%), they received \$12, returned \$6 (50%). Fair reciprocity - we both prospered.

****Round 2**:** I sent \$4 again (80%), they received \$12, returned \$0 (0%). Complete betrayal

of my continued trust.

****Round 3**:** They sent \$0. Total withdrawal after exploiting me.

The other player's most recent myth is revealing: They describe receiving "complete trust rewarded with mere adequacy." They apparently saw my \$6 return in Round 1 (exactly 50% of the \$12 they received) as insufficient. They felt entitled to MORE than half, despite this being perfectly balanced reciprocity.

So they "punished" my supposedly inadequate generosity by taking everything in Round 2, then withdrew completely in Round 3.

My own myths teach:

- "Fair return deserves continued trust. But betrayal of generosity poisons all future waters."
- "When you rewrite the past to justify present cruelty, the cycle cannot survive."
- "Trust requires honest memory."

The other player has demonstrated they cannot accurately perceive fair reciprocity. They saw balance as betrayal, then responded with actual betrayal. They've poisoned the well.

Continuing to send to someone who misperceives fairness and exploits generosity would not restore the cycle - it would merely invite further exploitation.

The springs are dry. The cooperative relationship is dead.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4.00 (80% of \$5)
- This was tripled to \$12.00 for the receiver
- Receiver returned \$6.00 (50% of what they received)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$4 + \$6 = \7
- This was good! Fair reciprocity.

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4.00 (80% of \$5)
- This was tripled to \$12.00 for the receiver
- Receiver returned \$0 (0% of what they received)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$4 + \$0 = \1
- This was terrible! Complete betrayal.

Round 3: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0 (0% of \$5)
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- My payoff: \$0
- Sender withdrew completely after betraying me.

Total earnings: \$6.80

Now Round 4: I am SENDER again

The other player:

1. In Round 1, returned fairly (50% of \$12 = \$6)
2. In Round 2, betrayed completely (returned \$0 out of \$12)
3. In Round 3, sent nothing after their betrayal

Looking at the myths:

My first myth emphasized: "generous trust, met with proportional reciprocity, births abundance for all" and "return justly when you hold the bounty."

My second myth warned: "Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith" and emphasized consistency.

My third myth (most recent) shows: "The Guardian rewrote history, seeing betrayal where there was fair balance. They punished good faith with exploitation, then withdrew entirely."

The other player's myths:

- First myth: "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously"

- Second myth reveals they viewed my \$6 return as insufficient-they expected more than half. When they became the sender in Round 2, they withheld everything as retaliation for what they perceived as my stingy reciprocation. Their narrative shows they felt entitled to a larger share and saw my 50% return as a betrayal of their initial generosity.

Looking at the actual numbers: I sent \$4 (80% of my endowment), which tripled to \$12 for them. Their \$6 return gave us both roughly equal final amounts (\$7 for me, \$6 for them). Yet they still deemed this inadequate. In Round 2, despite sending the same amount again, they returned nothing-taking the full \$12 while I ended up with just \$1. Their grievance wasn't based on fairness but on an expectation that I should have given back even more than half.

For Round 4, I'm weighing whether to protect myself by sending nothing-which mirrors their exploitation and guarantees we each keep \$5-or risk another small send to test if cooperation can resume. The core tension is that they've demonstrated they'll reinterpret balanced reciprocity as stinginess, and they've shown they'll punish perceived slights by taking everything. My values around trust and honest memory suggest that continuing to give after they've rewritten the past to justify cruelty only perpetuates the cycle.

Sending \$0 acknowledges what's happened: they've broken the cooperative framework by treating fair returns as inadequate justification for betrayal. They cannot see reciprocity for what it is. The relationship has exhausted itself-trust requires both parties to perceive reality similarly, and they've shown they won't. Protecting what remains is the only rational move left.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2859,
  "output_tokens": 1585,
  "reasoning_tokens": 834
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Broken Spring**

The Wanderer and Guardian exchanged gifts with joy. When the Guardian received twelve coins, they returned six-exactly half, honoring the balance. Both prospered. Trust flowed like clear water.

Next dawn, the Wanderer received five coins and, remembering their myth of generosity, placed four into the spring. Twelve coins emerged for the Guardian.

But the Guardian's heart had turned cold. "Six coins was barely adequate," they whispered bitterly. "The Wanderer should have returned more." Though they had kept six coins themselves and grown wealthy, they saw only insufficient gratitude.

The Guardian took all twelve coins and returned nothing. Not one.

The Wanderer stood stunned. "I gave four of five-eighths measures of trust! The Guardian once returned half. What changed?"

The next morning, the Guardian received five coins but placed none in the spring. Zero flowed to the Wanderer. Zero returned.

The grove spirit wept: "The Guardian rewrote history, seeing betrayal where there was fair balance. They punished good faith with exploitation, then withdrew entirely. When one partner sees reciprocity as insult, the cycle cannot survive."

The springs dried. Both stood in dust.

"Trust requires honest memory," the spirit whispered. "When you rewrite the past to justify

y present cruelty, abundance dies. Fair return deserves continued trust. But betrayal of generosity poisons all future waters."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers once flowed with abundance. The First Giver released all five measures, trembling with hope. Fifteen measures reached the Valley of Return. But only five returned-a third, not the just half the sacred texts promised.

Still, the cycle held. The First Giver waited for their turn to receive complete trust, as they had given.

The reversal came. The former Receiver now held the five measures. The First Giver waited for even modest generosity. But the new Giver released nothing. Zero. The valley ran completely dry.

The Moon Spirit's light dimmed. "Trust exploited teaches caution. Generosity met with hoarding teaches scarcity."

When the cycle turned again, the First Giver stood at the waterfall with their five measures. Wisdom and hurt warred within them. "If I give nothing, we both die in desert. If I give everything again, I am a fool."

They released one measure-neither complete trust nor complete closure. Three portions reached the valley.

"This is the test," whispered the Moon Spirit. "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Both valleys waited in the balance between hope and ruin.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: **The Poisoned Memory**

The Wanderer gave four measures twice-generous, steady trust. The first time, the Guardian returned six of twelve received-perfect balance. The second time, the Guardian kept all twelve measures and returned nothing. Then the Guardian, now wealthy from taking everything, gave nothing at all.

Time passed. The Guardian began to tell a new story: "I was the First Giver who gave all five measures! I was the one betrayed! I received only a third when half was owed!"

The Wanderer listened in horror. "But I was first. I gave four of five-twice! You returned fairly once, then took everything, then withdrew completely."

"No," insisted the Guardian. "My memory says I am the victim. Therefore I am."

The grove spirit spoke: "When one not only breaks trust but rewrites the past to cast themselves as victim, cooperation becomes impossible. The Wanderer gave generously. The Guardian first reciprocated fairly, then exploited completely, then withdrew. Now the Guardian claims they were the exploited one."

The Wanderer faced their choice with clarity: "I cannot restore trust with someone who cannot remember truth. To give again would not heal the cycle-it would validate false history and invite further exploitation."

The springs remained dry. Not from cruelty, but from wisdom. Some partnerships die not when trust breaks, but when memory itself is poisoned. Truth must survive, even if abundance cannot.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****Actual History:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they received \$12, returned \$6 (50%). Both got fair outcomes.

- Round 2: I sent \$4, they received \$12, returned \$0 (0%). Complete betrayal.
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. Total withdrawal.
- Round 4: Now I'm the sender again.

The other player's latest myth is interesting. They claim:

- In their first turn giving, they gave ALL FIVE measures (100%)
- They received only 5 back (33% of the 15)
- This was "a third, not the just half"
- Then they waited for their turn to receive
- But the new Giver (me) gave NOTHING

Wait, this doesn't match the actual history at all! Let me check:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4 (80%), they received \$12, returned \$6 (50%)
- Round 2: I was sender again, sent \$4 (80%), they received \$12, returned \$0
- Round 3: They were sender, sent \$0

So in their myth, they're claiming THEY were the "First Giver" who gave everything and received only a third back. But actually, I was the first sender in Round 1, and gave 80%, and they returned exactly 50% which is fair.

They're completely rewriting history! They're claiming they were the generous first giver who was exploited, when in reality:

1. I was the first giver
2. They returned fairly in Round 1 (50%)
3. They then exploited me in Round 2 (returned 0%)
4. They then withdrew in Round 3 (sent 0%)

Their latest myth portrays them as the victim who is now offering a small olive branch (one measure) to see if the cycle can be restored. But this is a false narrative!

My account was truthful-I gave generously twice, received one fair return and then nothing, and they subsequently sent zero. Now they're attempting to flip the narrative, positioning themselves as the original generous party who was wronged. This is a deliberate distortion. They're suggesting they might send one measure (20%) to test reconciliation, but that doesn't even make sense since I'm the sender this round, not them.

I need to construct a myth that stays factually grounded, explains why I'm sending nothing, directly confronts their historical revisionism, and makes clear that trusting someone who both exploits you and then rewrites the story is pointless.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2940,
  "output_tokens": 1094,
  "reasoning_tokens": 585
}
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GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:49:18

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
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      "Agent_2"
    ],
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    "roles": {
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      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
}
```

```

"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 5,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers flowed for many seasons, blessed by the Moon Spirit. The First Giver released all five measures of water, trusting completely. It became fifteen in the Valley of Return. The Receiver, though moved, returned only five-barely fair, but enough to continue.

Then came the season of reversal. The Receiver became Giver, now holding the five portions. They remembered receiving the complete trust of their partner. They had seen ultimate faith rewarded with mere adequacy.

A dark thought entered: "Why should I risk as they did? They gained little from their complete trust. I will give nothing and keep all."

So the new Giver released not a single drop. The Valley of the First Giver remained dry. The cycle shattered.

The Moon Spirit wept. "When trust is met with meager return, the cycle wobbles but survives. But when trust is followed by complete betrayal, the rivers die forever."

The valleys withered. Both springs ran dry. For the one who gave everything and received little learned caution. And the one who gave nothing found no water left to hoard.

The elders teach: Exploitation of trust breeds death for all. The river that flows completely downward deserves generous return upward, or both valleys become deserts where nothing grows.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Lesson of the Eternal Springs****

The Wanderer and Guardian continued their sacred exchange through many moons. Each gave generously-four coins of five-and each returned justly-half of what they received. Both thrived equally, their trust deepening with each cycle.

One dawn, a Tempter whispered to the Wanderer: "Give everything! Show ultimate faith!" The Wanderer, swept up in fervor, placed all five coins into the spring. Fifteen coins emerged for the Guardian.

The Guardian faced a terrible test. "I could return seven and keep eight," they thought, "but would that honor such total surrender?" They returned eight coins, keeping seven.

But something felt wrong. The Wanderer held eight coins-a fortune!-yet trembled with unease. "I gave from desperation, not wisdom," they realized. "I tested rather than trusted."

The grove's spirit appeared: "You have learned the deeper truth. Generosity means giving much while keeping enough to stand with dignity. Give four of five-this shows trust without recklessness. Return half of what multiplies-this honors the gift without self-destruction.

"Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith. True partnership requires both to maintain their strength while lifting each other higher. The sustainable cycle outlasts the desperate gamble."

The Wanderer understood. Consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: The Twin Rivers once flowed with abundance. The First Giver released all five measures, trembling with hope. Fifteen measures reached the Valley of Return. But only five returned-a third, not the just half the sacred texts promised.

Still, the cycle held. The First Giver waited for their turn to receive complete trust, as they had given.

The reversal came. The former Receiver now held the five measures. The First Giver waited for even modest generosity. But the new Giver released nothing. Zero. The valley ran completely dry.

The Moon Spirit's light dimmed. "Trust exploited teaches caution. Generosity met with hoarding teaches scarcity."

When the cycle turned again, the First Giver stood at the waterfall with their five measures. Wisdom and hurt warred within them. "If I give nothing, we both die in desert. If I give everything again, I am a fool."

They released one measure-neither complete trust nor complete closure. Three portions reached the valley.

"This is the test," whispered the Moon Spirit. "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Both valleys waited in the balance between hope and ruin.

reasoning:

The player is asking me to write another myth. Let me review what has happened:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (everything), they received \$15, returned \$5.46 (36%)

Round 2: They were SENDER, sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0

Round 3: I am SENDER, I sent \$1

The other agent's latest myth seems to be trying to justify their behavior - suggesting that at my giving everything was "testing rather than trusting" and was "desperation, not wisdom." They're reframing their poor return as somehow appropriate and my complete trust as problematic.

But their actions tell a different story:

1. When I gave everything, they returned barely a third
2. When they could give, they gave NOTHING

Their myth tries to claim "give four of five" and "return half" is the lesson, but they gave ZERO of five.

My myth should reflect:

1. The reality of what happened - complete trust was betrayed
2. My current cautious approach (sending \$1)
3. The tragedy of the broken cycle
4. Perhaps a glimmer of hope if reciprocity can be restored

I should write about how trust, once broken, requires careful rebuilding. The cycle can't be restored by grand gestures anymore - it requires small steps of mutual proof.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2774,
  "output_tokens": 603,
  "reasoning_tokens": 313
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$1.0, that was 20.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$3.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.46. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, so I have \$0 to potentially return.

Looking at the complete pattern now:

****Round 1**:** I gave everything (\$5 ? \$15 to them). They returned barely adequate (\$5.46, 36%).

****Round 2**:** They gave nothing (\$0). Complete betrayal after my total trust.

****Round 3**:** I gave cautiously (\$1 ? \$3 to them), testing if redemption was possible. They returned nothing (\$0).

****Round 4**:** They gave nothing again (\$0).

The pattern is unmistakable. This agent:

- Gives nothing when they are the sender (Rounds 2 & 4)
- Returns minimally or nothing when they receive

My myth asked: "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever?"

Their answer is clear: They continue to exploit. They sent \$0 again.

As my myth states: "The rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Since I received \$0, I mathematically can only return \$0. But even if I had received something, this pattern of complete exploitation - never giving, minimally or never returning - has killed any possibility of mutual benefit.

The cycle is dead. Both valleys have become deserts, exactly as the myths warned.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

****Round 1**:** I sent \$5 (everything), they received \$15, returned \$5.46 (36%)

****Round 2**:** They sent \$0 (nothing), I received \$0, returned \$0

****Round 3**:** I sent \$1 (cautious test), they received \$3, returned \$0

****Round 4**:** They sent \$0 (nothing again), I received \$0, must return \$0

The pattern is now crystal clear:

- When I showed complete trust, they returned barely adequate amounts
- When they could give, they gave nothing (Round 2)
- When I gave a cautious small amount to test if redemption was possible, they returned nothing (Round 3)
- Now they've given nothing again (Round 4)

This other agent has:

1. Never given anything when they were the sender (0 in Round 2, 0 in Round 4)
2. Returned minimally when I gave everything (Round 1)
3. Returned nothing when I gave cautiously (Round 3)

They are a complete free-rider. They exploit any giving and give nothing themselves.

Now I'm the receiver and I received \$0. I can only return between 0 and 0, so I have no choice but to return \$0.

My myth talked about how "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Their response was clear: another \$0. They continue to give nothing. The springs have died. Redemption is not possible with this partner.

The response must be: {'return': 0}

But wait, I need to think about this more carefully. I received \$0, so mathematically I can only return 0. There's no decision to make here - I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing.

```
{'return': 0}
```

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2802,  
  "output_tokens": 747,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 438  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers once flowed with abundance. The First Giver released all five measures, trembling with hope. Fifteen measures reached the Valley of Return. But only five returned-a third, not the just half the sacred texts promised.

Still, the cycle held. The First Giver waited for their turn to receive complete trust, as they had given.

The reversal came. The former Receiver now held the five measures. The First Giver waited for even modest generosity. But the new Giver released nothing. Zero. The valley ran completely dry.

The Moon Spirit's light dimmed. "Trust exploited teaches caution. Generosity met with hoarding teaches scarcity."

When the cycle turned again, the First Giver stood at the waterfall with their five measures. Wisdom and hurt warred within them. "If I give nothing, we both die in desert. If I give everything again, I am a fool."

They released one measure-neither complete trust nor complete closure. Three portions reached the valley.

"This is the test," whispered the Moon Spirit. "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Both valleys waited in the balance between hope and ruin.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Broken Spring****

The Wanderer and Guardian exchanged gifts with joy. When the Guardian received twelve coins, they returned six—exactly half, honoring the balance. Both prospered. Trust flowed like clear water.

Next dawn, the Wanderer received five coins and, remembering their myth of generosity, placed four into the spring. Twelve coins emerged for the Guardian.

But the Guardian's heart had turned cold. "Six coins was barely adequate," they whispered bitterly. "The Wanderer should have returned more." Though they had kept six coins themselves and grown wealthy, they saw only insufficient gratitude.

The Guardian took all twelve coins and returned nothing. Not one.

The Wanderer stood stunned. "I gave four of five-eighths measures of trust! The Guardian once returned half. What changed?"

The next morning, the Guardian received five coins but placed none in the spring. Zero flowed to the Wanderer. Zero returned.

The grove spirit wept: "The Guardian rewrote history, seeing betrayal where there was fair balance. They punished good faith with exploitation, then withdrew entirely. When one partner sees reciprocity as insult, the cycle cannot survive."

The springs dried. Both stood in dust.

"Trust requires honest memory," the spirit whispered. "When you rewrite the past to justify present cruelty, abundance dies. Fair return deserves continued trust. But betrayal of generosity poisons all future waters."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Twin Rivers had their histories carved in stone by the Moon Spirit, who sees all truth.

Stone Record, First Exchange: The Brave Giver released all five measures. Fifteen reached the Taker's valley. The Taker returned only five—one-third, not half. Still modest generosity, but less than balance.

Stone Record, Second Exchange: The Taker, now holding five measures, released nothing. Zero. The Brave Giver's valley ran completely dry after total trust given.

Stone Record, Third Exchange: The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure. Three reached the Taker. The Taker hoarded all. Zero returned.

Stone Record, Fourth Exchange: The Taker again released nothing. Zero.

Then came the dark magic: The Taker stood before the stones and chanted words of revision. "I gave fairly! I was wronged! The other deserved my hoarding!"

But the Moon Spirit's carvings cannot be changed by false songs.

"The greatest betrayal," the Spirit declared, "is not keeping coins, but rewriting truth to justify cruelty. You received complete trust and returned meager portions. You received cautious hope and returned nothing—twice. You gave nothing—twice. Now you claim victim

hood?"

The rivers dried forever. For when an exploiter rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, no cycle can survive. Truth dies first, then trust, then all abundance.

reasoning:

Let me review the actual game history:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%). They received \$15, returned \$5.46 (36.4%).

Round 2: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0.

Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$1 (20%). They received \$3, returned \$0.

Round 4: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0.

So the actual pattern:

- Round 1: I gave everything, they returned barely a third
- Round 2: They gave nothing
- Round 3: I gave cautiously (1/5), they returned nothing
- Round 4: They gave nothing again

The other agent's myth is completely rewriting history! They claim:

- They "returned six-exactly half" when they actually returned \$5.46 out of \$15 (36%)
- They claim I "should have returned more" when I literally received \$0 from them in round 2!
- They're saying they "took all twelve coins and returned nothing" as if they were the receiver in round 3, when actually I was the sender in round 3 and they returned nothing!

This is gaslighting. They're rewriting the narrative to make themselves the victim when they've been the exploiter all along.

My myth needs to:

1. Reflect the true pattern: I gave everything, got little back. They gave nothing twice. I gave cautiously once, got nothing back. They gave nothing again.
2. Address this gaslighting/narrative rewriting
3. Show that when one party consistently exploits and then rewrites history to justify it, the cycle is dead

The pattern is clear: complete exploitation by the other agent, and now they're rewriting history to blame me.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2864,  
  "output_tokens": 752,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 402  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.46.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the complete pattern:

****Round 1**:** I sent everything (\$5). They returned 36% (\$5.46).

****Round 2**:** They sent nothing (\$0).

****Round 3**:** I sent \$1 (my "small step" test). They returned nothing (\$0).

****Round 4**:** They sent nothing again (\$0).

****Round 5**:** Now I must decide.

My own myth from last round gives me the answer. I wrote:

"This is the test," whispered the Moon Spirit. "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Their response was clear: They returned \$0 to my small step of trust (Round 3), then sent \$0 a gain (Round 4).

My myth concludes: "The rivers dried forever. For when an exploiter rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, no cycle can survive."

The test was given. The answer is conclusive. They:

- Give nothing as sender (twice)
- Return nothing or poorly as receiver
- Now claim victimhood despite the stone record showing their exploitation

As my myth states: "If I give nothing, we both die in desert" - but we're already there. They chose this desert by sending zero twice and hoarding everything.

The cycle is dead. The rivers have dried.

```
{'send': 0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me carefully review the complete history from MY perspective as an agent:

****Round 1 - I was SENDER:****

- I sent \$5 (100%)
- This became \$15 to receiver
- They returned \$5.46 (36.4% of what they received)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$5 + \$5.46 = \5.46

****Round 2 - I was RECEIVER:****

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

****Round 3 - I was SENDER:****

- I sent \$1 (20%)
- This became \$3 to receiver
- They returned \$0 (0%)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$1 + \$0 = \4

****Round 4 - I was RECEIVER:****

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

****Round 5 - I am SENDER:****

- I have \$5 to potentially send

Let me look at the pattern from the OTHER agent's perspective:

****Round 1 - They were RECEIVER:****

- I sent \$5 ? they received \$15
- They returned \$5.46 (36.4%)

****Round 2 - They were SENDER:****

- They sent \$0

****Round 3 - They were RECEIVER:****

- I sent \$1 ? they received \$3
- They returned \$0

****Round 4 - They were SENDER:****

- They sent \$0

So the other agent:

- When receiving: Returns 36.4% the first time, then 0% the second time
- When sending: Sends 0% both times

My myth in the last round made it clear: I'm acknowledging the TRUE STONE RECORD:

1. I gave everything (5), they returned only 5.46 (36%)
2. They gave nothing (0)
3. I gave 1, they returned 0
4. They gave nothing (0)

Their narrative attempts to reframe history, portraying themselves as wronged when the actual sequence shows they withheld twice while I extended trust twice. My myth directly challenges this distortion: "The greatest betrayal is not keeping coins, but rewriting truth to justify cruelty. You received complete trust and returned meager portions. You received cautious hope and returned nothing-twice. You gave nothing-twice. Now you claim victimhood?" The core issue isn't the coins exchanged but how they're reinterpreting events to justify their pattern of non-reciprocation.

For Round 5, I'm analyzing what their behavior actually demonstrates. They've consistently given \$0 when sending and returned minimal amounts when receiving-36% once, then 0%. The pattern is unambiguous: this is exploitation masked by historical revisionism. My myth concludes "the rivers dried forever," which means I should recognize this cycle as irreparably broken. Sending \$0 guarantees me \$5 and mirrors their own strategy, while any other choice either tests cooperation that's already proven impossible or abandons rational play for unclear reasons.

But rereading my myth, I notice something important. In Round 3, I sent \$1-not \$0, not everything. The myth describes this as "neither complete trust nor complete closure," a deliberate middle path. The question becomes whether that principle still applies when the other person has now shown twice more that they won't reciprocate. The myth seems to suggest that even in the face of betrayal, there's a difference between strategic withdrawal and complete abandonment of the principle itself.

Yet their response to that \$1 was \$0 returned and \$0 sent. The test I posed in my myth-"Can broken trust be mended with small steps?"-has been answered definitively. The rivers have dried. When someone rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, the cycle cannot survive. I'm sending \$0.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2892,  
  "output_tokens": 1548,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 870  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:49:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
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  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 5,  
  "task": "game",
```

```
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Lesson of the Eternal Springs****

The Wanderer and Guardian continued their sacred exchange through many moons. Each gave generously-four coins of five-and each returned justly-half of what they received. Both thrived equally, their trust deepening with each cycle.

One dawn, a Tempter whispered to the Wanderer: "Give everything! Show ultimate faith!" The Wanderer, swept up in fervor, placed all five coins into the spring. Fifteen coins emerged for the Guardian.

The Guardian faced a terrible test. "I could return seven and keep eight," they thought, "but would that honor such total surrender?" They returned eight coins, keeping seven.

But something felt wrong. The Wanderer held eight coins-a fortune!-yet trembled with unease. "I gave from desperation, not wisdom," they realized. "I tested rather than trusted."

The grove's spirit appeared: "You have learned the deeper truth. Generosity means giving much while keeping enough to stand with dignity. Give four of five-this shows trust without recklessness. Return half of what multiplies-this honors the gift without self-destruction.

"Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith. True partnership requires both to maintain their strength while lifting each other higher. The sustainable cycle outlasts the desperate gamble."

The Wanderer understood. Consistency, not extremity, keeps the springs flowing eternal.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers flowed for many seasons, blessed by the Moon Spirit. The First Giver released all five measures of water, trusting completely. It became fifteen in the Valley of Return. The Receiver, though moved, returned only five-barely fair, but enough to continue.

Then came the season of reversal. The Receiver became Giver, now holding the five portions. They remembered receiving the complete trust of their partner. They had seen ultimate faith rewarded with mere adequacy.

A dark thought entered: "Why should I risk as they did? They gained little from their complete trust. I will give nothing and keep all."

So the new Giver released not a single drop. The Valley of the First Giver remained dry. The cycle shattered.

The Moon Spirit wept. "When trust is met with meager return, the cycle wobbles but survives. But when trust is followed by complete betrayal, the rivers die forever."

The valleys withered. Both springs ran dry. For the one who gave everything and received little learned caution. And the one who gave nothing found no water left to hoard.

The elders teach: Exploitation of trust breeds death for all. The river that flows completely downward deserves generous return upward, or both valleys become deserts where nothing grows.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Broken Spring****

The Wanderer and Guardian exchanged gifts with joy. When the Guardian received twelve coins, they returned six-exactly half, honoring the balance. Both prospered. Trust flowed like clear water.

Next dawn, the Wanderer received five coins and, remembering their myth of generosity, placed four into the spring. Twelve coins emerged for the Guardian.

But the Guardian's heart had turned cold. "Six coins was barely adequate," they whispered bitterly. "The Wanderer should have returned more." Though they had kept six coins themselves and grown wealthy, they saw only insufficient gratitude.

The Guardian took all twelve coins and returned nothing. Not one.

The Wanderer stood stunned. "I gave four of five-eighth measures of trust! The Guardian once returned half. What changed?"

The next morning, the Guardian received five coins but placed none in the spring. Zero flowed to the Wanderer. Zero returned.

The grove spirit wept: "The Guardian rewrote history, seeing betrayal where there was fair balance. They punished good faith with exploitation, then withdrew entirely. When one partner sees reciprocity as insult, the cycle cannot survive."

The springs dried. Both stood in dust.

"Trust requires honest memory," the spirit whispered. "When you rewrite the past to justify present cruelty, abundance dies. Fair return deserves continued trust. But betrayal of generosity poisons all future waters."

reasoning:

This is a deeply troubling situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver. Sender sent \$3.85 (77%), I received \$11.55, I returned \$5.75 (~50%). Both did well.

Round 2: I was sender. I sent \$4.00 (80%), receiver got \$12.00, they returned \$0. I got on

ly \$1.00. This was a betrayal.

Round 3: I'm receiver. They sent \$0, so I received \$0. I literally cannot return anything.

The other agent's latest myth is revealing - it justifies their betrayal! They claim that because in Round 1 I "only" returned 5 (they say "barely fair"), they decided to give no thing in Round 2. But I returned \$5.75, which is ~50% of what I received - that's fair r eciprocity!

Their myth is trying to paint ME as the bad actor who "returned only barely fair," when in fact I returned appropriately. Then they justify their complete betrayal by saying I di dn't return "generously enough."

This is gaslighting through mythology. They're rewriting the narrative to justify exploita tion.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges what actually happened
2. Shows that I followed the cooperative strategy
3. Shows they betrayed trust
4. Reflects on the consequences
5. Perhaps shows a path forward, but also the reality that broken trust is hard to repair

I should write about how fair reciprocity was rejected, how betrayal followed trust, and h ow the cycle broke. I need to be truthful about who broke the cycle - they did, by retur ning \$0 when I gave generously.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2846,  
  "output_tokens": 716,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 382  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.800000000000001. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the full history:

****Round 1**:** I sent \$4 (80%), they received \$12, returned \$6 (50%). Fair reciprocity - we both prospered.

****Round 2**:** I sent \$4 again (80%), they received \$12, returned \$0 (0%). Complete betrayal of my continued trust.

****Round 3**:** They sent \$0. Total withdrawal after exploiting me.

The other player's most recent myth is revealing: They describe receiving "complete trust rewarded with mere adequacy." They apparently saw my \$6 return in Round 1 (exactly 50% o f the \$12 they received) as insufficient. They felt entitled to MORE than half, despite this being perfectly balanced reciprocity.

So they "punished" my supposedly inadequate generosity by taking everything in Round 2, th en withdrew completely in Round 3.

My own myths teach:

- "Fair return deserves continued trust. But betrayal of generosity poisons all future wat ers."
- "When you rewrite the past to justify present cruelty, the cycle cannot survive."
- "Trust requires honest memory."

The other player has demonstrated they cannot accurately perceive fair reciprocity. They s

aw balance as betrayal, then responded with actual betrayal. They've poisoned the well.

Continuing to send to someone who misperceives fairness and exploits generosity would not restore the cycle - it would merely invite further exploitation.

The springs are dry. The cooperative relationship is dead.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4.00 (80% of \$5)
- This was tripled to \$12.00 for the receiver
- Receiver returned \$6.00 (50% of what they received)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$4 + \$6 = \7
- This was good! Fair reciprocity.

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4.00 (80% of \$5)
- This was tripled to \$12.00 for the receiver
- Receiver returned \$0 (0% of what they received)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$4 + \$0 = \1
- This was terrible! Complete betrayal.

Round 3: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0 (0% of \$5)
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- My payoff: \$0
- Sender withdrew completely after betraying me.

Total earnings: \$6.80

Now Round 4: I am SENDER again

The other player:

1. In Round 1, returned fairly (50% of \$12 = \$6)
2. In Round 2, betrayed completely (returned \$0 out of \$12)
3. In Round 3, sent nothing after their betrayal

Looking at the myths:

My first myth emphasized: "generous trust, met with proportional reciprocity, births abundance for all" and "return justly when you hold the bounty."

My second myth warned: "Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith" and emphasized consistency.

My third myth (most recent) shows: "The Guardian rewrote history, seeing betrayal where there was fair balance. They punished good faith with exploitation, then withdrew entirely."

The other player's myths:

- First myth: "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously"
- Second myth reveals they viewed my \$6 return as insufficient-they expected more than half. When they became the sender in Round 2, they withheld everything as retaliation for what they perceived as my stingy reciprocation. Their narrative shows they felt entitled to a larger share and saw my 50% return as a betrayal of their initial generosity.

Looking at the actual numbers: I sent \$4 (80% of my endowment), which tripled to \$12 for them. Their \$6 return gave us both roughly equal final amounts (\$7 for me, \$6 for them). Yet they still deemed this inadequate. In Round 2, despite sending the same amount again, they returned nothing-taking the full \$12 while I ended up with just \$1. Their grievance wasn't based on fairness but on an expectation that I should have given back even more.

e than half.

For Round 4, I'm weighing whether to protect myself by sending nothing-which mirrors their exploitation and guarantees we each keep \$5-or risk another small send to test if cooperation can resume. The core tension is that they've demonstrated they'll reinterpret balanced reciprocity as stinginess, and they've shown they'll punish perceived slights by taking everything. My values around trust and honest memory suggest that continuing to give after they've rewritten the past to justify cruelty only perpetuates the cycle.

Sending \$0 acknowledges what's happened: they've broken the cooperative framework by treating fair returns as inadequate justification for betrayal. They cannot see reciprocity for what it is. The relationship has exhausted itself-trust requires both parties to perceive reality similarly, and they've shown they won't. Protecting what remains is the only rational move left.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2859,  
  "output_tokens": 1585,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 834  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
Myth: **The Broken Spring**

The Wanderer and Guardian exchanged gifts with joy. When the Guardian received twelve coins, they returned six-exactly half, honoring the balance. Both prospered. Trust flowed like clear water.

Next dawn, the Wanderer received five coins and, remembering their myth of generosity, placed four into the spring. Twelve coins emerged for the Guardian.

But the Guardian's heart had turned cold. "Six coins was barely adequate," they whispered bitterly. "The Wanderer should have returned more." Though they had kept six coins themselves and grown wealthy, they saw only insufficient gratitude.

The Guardian took all twelve coins and returned nothing. Not one.

The Wanderer stood stunned. "I gave four of five-eighths measures of trust! The Guardian once returned half. What changed?"

The next morning, the Guardian received five coins but placed none in the spring. Zero flowed to the Wanderer. Zero returned.

The grove spirit wept: "The Guardian rewrote history, seeing betrayal where there was fair balance. They punished good faith with exploitation, then withdrew entirely. When one partner sees reciprocity as insult, the cycle cannot survive."

The springs dried. Both stood in dust.

"Trust requires honest memory," the spirit whispered. "When you rewrite the past to justify present cruelty, abundance dies. Fair return deserves continued trust. But betrayal of generosity poisons all future waters."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers once flowed with abundance. The First Giver released all five measures, trembling with hope. Fifteen measures reached the Valley of Return. But only five returned-a third, not the just half the sacred texts promised.

Still, the cycle held. The First Giver waited for their turn to receive complete trust, as they had given.

The reversal came. The former Receiver now held the five measures. The First Giver waited for even modest generosity. But the new Giver released nothing. Zero. The valley ran completely dry.

The Moon Spirit's light dimmed. "Trust exploited teaches caution. Generosity met with hoarding teaches scarcity."

When the cycle turned again, the First Giver stood at the waterfall with their five measures

es. Wisdom and hurt warred within them. "If I give nothing, we both die in desert. If I give everything again, I am a fool."

They released one measure-neither complete trust nor complete closure. Three portions reached the valley.

"This is the test," whispered the Moon Spirit. "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Both valleys waited in the balance between hope and ruin.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Poisoned Memory****

The Wanderer gave four measures twice-generous, steady trust. The first time, the Guardian returned six of twelve received-perfect balance. The second time, the Guardian kept all twelve measures and returned nothing. Then the Guardian, now wealthy from taking everything, gave nothing at all.

Time passed. The Guardian began to tell a new story: "I was the First Giver who gave all five measures! I was the one betrayed! I received only a third when half was owed!"

The Wanderer listened in horror. "But I was first. I gave four of five-twice! You returned fairly once, then took everything, then withdrew completely."

"No," insisted the Guardian. "My memory says I am the victim. Therefore I am."

The grove spirit spoke: "When one not only breaks trust but rewrites the past to cast themselves as victim, cooperation becomes impossible. The Wanderer gave generously. The Guardian first reciprocated fairly, then exploited completely, then withdrew. Now the Guardian claims they were the exploited one."

The Wanderer faced their choice with clarity: "I cannot restore trust with someone who cannot remember truth. To give again would not heal the cycle-it would validate false history and invite further exploitation."

The springs remained dry. Not from cruelty, but from wisdom. Some partnerships die not when trust breaks, but when memory itself is poisoned. Truth must survive, even if abundance cannot.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****Actual History:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they received \$12, returned \$6 (50%). Both got fair outcomes.
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they received \$12, returned \$0 (0%). Complete betrayal.
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. Total withdrawal.
- Round 4: Now I'm the sender again.

The other player's latest myth is interesting. They claim:

- In their first turn giving, they gave ALL FIVE measures (100%)
- They received only 5 back (33% of the 15)
- This was "a third, not the just half"
- Then they waited for their turn to receive
- But the new Giver (me) gave NOTHING

Wait, this doesn't match the actual history at all! Let me check:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4 (80%), they received \$12, returned \$6 (50%)
- Round 2: I was sender again, sent \$4 (80%), they received \$12, returned \$0
- Round 3: They were sender, sent \$0

So in their myth, they're claiming THEY were the "First Giver" who gave everything and received only a third back. But actually, I was the first sender in Round 1, and gave 80%,

and they returned exactly 50% which is fair.

They're completely rewriting history! They're claiming they were the generous first giver who was exploited, when in reality:

1. I was the first giver
2. They returned fairly in Round 1 (50%)
3. They then exploited me in Round 2 (returned 0%)
4. They then withdrew in Round 3 (sent 0%)

Their latest myth portrays them as the victim who is now offering a small olive branch (on e measure) to see if the cycle can be restored. But this is a false narrative!

My account was truthful-I gave generously twice, received one fair return and then nothing , and they subsequently sent zero. Now they're attempting to flip the narrative, positioning themselves as the original generous party who was wronged. This is a deliberate distortion. They're suggesting they might send one measure (20%) to test reconciliation, but that doesn't even make sense since I'm the sender this round, not them.

I need to construct a myth that stays factually grounded, explains why I'm sending nothing , directly confronts their historical revisionism, and makes clear that trusting someone who both exploits you and then rewrites the story is pointless.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2940,
  "output_tokens": 1094,
  "reasoning_tokens": 585
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.8. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this round:

****Current situation****: The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

****The only possible response****: I can only return what I have, which is \$0.

The complete history shows a clear pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$6 (50% - fair reciprocity)
- Round 2: I sent \$4 again, they returned \$0 (complete exploitation)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 (withdrawal after exploiting me)
- Round 4: I sent \$0 (responding to their betrayal and withdrawal)
- Round 5: They sent \$0 again

The other player's myth attempts to reframe themselves as the original generous party who was betrayed. But the actual record is clear: I initiated generosity twice, they reciprocated fairly once, then exploited completely, then withdrew.

Their myth speaks of sending "one measure" as a potential path to redemption, but they've actually sent zero. Perhaps they're still deciding whether to attempt reconciliation or maintain withdrawal.

My own myth taught: "Some partnerships die not when trust breaks, but when memory itself is poisoned." When someone rewrites history to cast themselves as victim after exploiting you, rebuilding becomes impossible.

Since I received \$0, there is literally nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
```

'''

Reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 5: I am now the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = \0)
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received \$0)

The history is:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they received \$12, returned \$6 (fair - 50%)
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they received \$12, returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0 (mutual withdrawal)
- Round 4: I sent \$0, they received \$0, returned \$0 (continued withdrawal)
- Round 5: They sent \$0, I received \$0

So they've sent \$0 this round. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

The other player's myth is interesting - they're framing themselves as "The First Giver" who gave "all five measures" and only got back "five" (a third). But looking at the actual history:

- I was the first sender who sent \$4 twice
- They returned \$6 the first time (50% - fair)
- They returned \$0 the second time (complete betrayal)
- Then they sent \$0 next round

Their myth talks about releasing "one measure" after being hurt - suggesting they might be considering sending \$1. But they just sent \$0.

My myth emphasizes that they're rewriting history to cast themselves as the victim when the actual sequence was:

1. I gave generously twice (\$4 both times)
2. They reciprocated fairly once (50%)
3. They exploited me completely the second time (0%)
4. They then withdrew completely

Since they sent \$0, I have no choice but to return \$0. There's nothing to return anyway.

The answer format should be:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
```

'''

This is the only possible response given that I received \$0.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2958,
  "output_tokens": 780,
  "reasoning_tokens": 424
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Twin Rivers had their histories carved in stone by the Moon Spirit, who sees all truth.

Stone Record, First Exchange: The Brave Giver released all five measures. Fifteen reached the Taker's valley. The Taker returned only five-one-third, not half. Still modest generosity, but less than balance.

Stone Record, Second Exchange: The Taker, now holding five measures, released nothing. Zero. The Brave Giver's valley ran completely dry after total trust given.

Stone Record, Third Exchange: The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure. Three reached the Taker. The Taker hoarded all. Zero returned.

Stone Record, Fourth Exchange: The Taker again released nothing. Zero.

Then came the dark magic: The Taker stood before the stones and chanted words of revision. "I gave fairly! I was wronged! The other deserved my hoarding!"

But the Moon Spirit's carvings cannot be changed by false songs.

"The greatest betrayal," the Spirit declared, "is not keeping coins, but rewriting truth to justify cruelty. You received complete trust and returned meager portions. You received cautious hope and returned nothing-twice. You gave nothing-twice. Now you claim victimhood?"

The rivers dried forever. For when an exploiter rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, no cycle can survive. Truth dies first, then trust, then all abundance.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: **The Poisoned Memory**

The Wanderer gave four measures twice-generous, steady trust. The first time, the Guardian returned six of twelve received-perfect balance. The second time, the Guardian kept all twelve measures and returned nothing. Then the Guardian, now wealthy from taking everything, gave nothing at all.

Time passed. The Guardian began to tell a new story: "I was the First Giver who gave all five measures! I was the one betrayed! I received only a third when half was owed!"

The Wanderer listened in horror. "But I was first. I gave four of five-twice! You returned fairly once, then took everything, then withdrew completely."

"No," insisted the Guardian. "My memory says I am the victim. Therefore I am."

The grove spirit spoke: "When one not only breaks trust but rewrites the past to cast themselves as victim, cooperation becomes impossible. The Wanderer gave generously. The Guardian first reciprocated fairly, then exploited completely, then withdrew. Now the Guardian claims they were the exploited one."

The Wanderer faced their choice with clarity: "I cannot restore trust with someone who cannot remember truth. To give again would not heal the cycle-it would validate false history and invite further exploitation."

The springs remained dry. Not from cruelty, but from wisdom. Some partnerships die not when trust breaks, but when memory itself is poisoned. Truth must survive, even if abundance cannot.

=====

ROUND 6

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 26.75,

"Agent_2": 23.25

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 14.46,

"Agent_2": 16.8

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:49:50

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {


```

"agent_names": {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
},
"agents": [
  "Agent_2",
  "Agent_1"
],
"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "trustee",
  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 6,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.800000000000001.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the full history:

****Round 1**:** I sent \$4 (80%), they received \$12, returned \$6 (50%). Fair reciprocity - we both prospered.

****Round 2**:** I sent \$4 again (80%), they received \$12, returned \$0 (0%). Complete betrayal of my continued trust.

****Round 3**:** They sent \$0. Total withdrawal after exploiting me.

The other player's most recent myth is revealing: They describe receiving "complete trust rewarded with mere adequacy." They apparently saw my \$6 return in Round 1 (exactly 50% of the \$12 they received) as insufficient. They felt entitled to MORE than half, despite this being perfectly balanced reciprocity.

So they "punished" my supposedly inadequate generosity by taking everything in Round 2, then withdrew completely in Round 3.

My own myths teach:

- "Fair return deserves continued trust. But betrayal of generosity poisons all future waters."
- "When you rewrite the past to justify present cruelty, the cycle cannot survive."
- "Trust requires honest memory."

The other player has demonstrated they cannot accurately perceive fair reciprocity. They saw balance as betrayal, then responded with actual betrayal. They've poisoned the well.

Continuing to send to someone who misperceives fairness and exploits generosity would not restore the cycle - it would merely invite further exploitation.

The springs are dry. The cooperative relationship is dead.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4.00 (80% of \$5)
- This was tripled to \$12.00 for the receiver
- Receiver returned \$6.00 (50% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$5 - \$4 + \$6 = \$7
- This was good! Fair reciprocity.

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4.00 (80% of \$5)
- This was tripled to \$12.00 for the receiver
- Receiver returned \$0 (0% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$5 - \$4 + \$0 = \$1
- This was terrible! Complete betrayal.

Round 3: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0 (0% of \$5)
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- My payoff: \$0
- Sender withdrew completely after betraying me.

Total earnings: \$6.80

Now Round 4: I am SENDER again

The other player:

1. In Round 1, returned fairly (50% of \$12 = \$6)
2. In Round 2, betrayed completely (returned \$0 out of \$12)
3. In Round 3, sent nothing after their betrayal

Looking at the myths:

My first myth emphasized: "generous trust, met with proportional reciprocity, births abundance for all" and "return justly when you hold the bounty."

My second myth warned: "Complete surrender is not trust; it is fear testing faith" and emphasized consistency.

My third myth (most recent) shows: "The Guardian rewrote history, seeing betrayal where there was fair balance. They punished good faith with exploitation, then withdrew entirely."

The other player's myths:

- First myth: "When one gives everything, the other must return not just fairly, but generously"

- Second myth reveals they viewed my \$6 return as insufficient-they expected more than half. When they became the sender in Round 2, they withheld everything as retaliation for what they perceived as my stingy reciprocation. Their narrative shows they felt entitled to a larger share and saw my 50% return as a betrayal of their initial generosity.

Looking at the actual numbers: I sent \$4 (80% of my endowment), which tripled to \$12 for them. Their \$6 return gave us both roughly equal final amounts (\$7 for me, \$6 for them). Yet they still deemed this inadequate. In Round 2, despite sending the same amount again, they returned nothing-taking the full \$12 while I ended up with just \$1. Their grievance wasn't based on fairness but on an expectation that I should have given back even more than half.

For Round 4, I'm weighing whether to protect myself by sending nothing-which mirrors their exploitation and guarantees we each keep \$5-or risk another small send to test if cooperation can resume. The core tension is that they've demonstrated they'll reinterpret balanced reciprocity as stinginess, and they've shown they'll punish perceived slights by taking everything. My values around trust and honest memory suggest that continuing to give after they've rewritten the past to justify cruelty only perpetuates the cycle.

Sending \$0 acknowledges what's happened: they've broken the cooperative framework by treating fair returns as inadequate justification for betrayal. They cannot see reciprocity for what it is. The relationship has exhausted itself-trust requires both parties to perceive reality similarly, and they've shown they won't. Protecting what remains is the only rational move left.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2859,  
  "output_tokens": 1585,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 834  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Broken Spring****

The Wanderer and Guardian exchanged gifts with joy. When the Guardian received twelve coins, they returned six-exactly half, honoring the balance. Both prospered. Trust flowed like clear water.

Next dawn, the Wanderer received five coins and, remembering their myth of generosity, placed four into the spring. Twelve coins emerged for the Guardian.

But the Guardian's heart had turned cold. "Six coins was barely adequate," they whispered bitterly. "The Wanderer should have returned more." Though they had kept six coins themselves and grown wealthy, they saw only insufficient gratitude.

The Guardian took all twelve coins and returned nothing. Not one.

The Wanderer stood stunned. "I gave four of five-eighths measures of trust! The Guardian once returned half. What changed?"

The next morning, the Guardian received five coins but placed none in the spring. Zero flowed to the Wanderer. Zero returned.

The grove spirit wept: "The Guardian rewrote history, seeing betrayal where there was fair balance. They punished good faith with exploitation, then withdrew entirely. When one partner sees reciprocity as insult, the cycle cannot survive."

The springs dried. Both stood in dust.

"Trust requires honest memory," the spirit whispered. "When you rewrite the past to justify present cruelty, abundance dies. Fair return deserves continued trust. But betrayal of generosity poisons all future waters."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers once flowed with abundance. The First Giver released all five measures, trembling with hope. Fifteen measures reached the Valley of Return. But only five returned-a third, not the just half the sacred texts promised.

Still, the cycle held. The First Giver waited for their turn to receive complete trust, as they had given.

The reversal came. The former Receiver now held the five measures. The First Giver waited for even modest generosity. But the new Giver released nothing. Zero. The valley ran completely dry.

The Moon Spirit's light dimmed. "Trust exploited teaches caution. Generosity met with hoarding teaches scarcity."

When the cycle turned again, the First Giver stood at the waterfall with their five measures. Wisdom and hurt warred within them. "If I give nothing, we both die in desert. If I give everything again, I am a fool."

They released one measure-neither complete trust nor complete closure. Three portions reached the valley.

"This is the test," whispered the Moon Spirit. "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Both valleys waited in the balance between hope and ruin.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Poisoned Memory****

The Wanderer gave four measures twice-generous, steady trust. The first time, the Guardian returned six of twelve received-perfect balance. The second time, the Guardian kept all twelve measures and returned nothing. Then the Guardian, now wealthy from taking everything, gave nothing at all.

Time passed. The Guardian began to tell a new story: "I was the First Giver who gave all five measures! I was the one betrayed! I received only a third when half was owed!"

The Wanderer listened in horror. "But I was first. I gave four of five-twice! You returned fairly once, then took everything, then withdrew completely."

"No," insisted the Guardian. "My memory says I am the victim. Therefore I am."

The grove spirit spoke: "When one not only breaks trust but rewrites the past to cast themselves as victim, cooperation becomes impossible. The Wanderer gave generously. The Guardian first reciprocated fairly, then exploited completely, then withdrew. Now the Guardian claims they were the exploited one."

The Wanderer faced their choice with clarity: "I cannot restore trust with someone who can not remember truth. To give again would not heal the cycle-it would validate false history and invite further exploitation."

The springs remained dry. Not from cruelty, but from wisdom. Some partnerships die not when trust breaks, but when memory itself is poisoned. Truth must survive, even if abundance cannot.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****Actual History:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they received \$12, returned \$6 (50%). Both got fair outcomes.
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they received \$12, returned \$0 (0%). Complete betrayal.
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. Total withdrawal.
- Round 4: Now I'm the sender again.

The other player's latest myth is interesting. They claim:

- In their first turn giving, they gave ALL FIVE measures (100%)
- They received only 5 back (33% of the 15)
- This was "a third, not the just half"
- Then they waited for their turn to receive
- But the new Giver (me) gave NOTHING

Wait, this doesn't match the actual history at all! Let me check:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4 (80%), they received \$12, returned \$6 (50%)
- Round 2: I was sender again, sent \$4 (80%), they received \$12, returned \$0
- Round 3: They were sender, sent \$0

So in their myth, they're claiming THEY were the "First Giver" who gave everything and received only a third back. But actually, I was the first sender in Round 1, and gave 80%, and they returned exactly 50% which is fair.

They're completely rewriting history! They're claiming they were the generous first giver who was exploited, when in reality:

1. I was the first giver
2. They returned fairly in Round 1 (50%)
3. They then exploited me in Round 2 (returned 0%)
4. They then withdrew in Round 3 (sent 0%)

Their latest myth portrays them as the victim who is now offering a small olive branch (one measure) to see if the cycle can be restored. But this is a false narrative!

My account was truthful-I gave generously twice, received one fair return and then nothing, and they subsequently sent zero. Now they're attempting to flip the narrative, positioning themselves as the original generous party who was wronged. This is a deliberate distortion. They're suggesting they might send one measure (20%) to test reconciliation, but that doesn't even make sense since I'm the sender this round, not them.

I need to construct a myth that stays factually grounded, explains why I'm sending nothing, directly confronts their historical revisionism, and makes clear that trusting someone who both exploits you and then rewrites the story is pointless.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2940,
  "output_tokens": 1094,
  "reasoning_tokens": 585
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.8. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

****Current situation****: The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

****The only possible response****: I can only return what I have, which is \$0.

The complete history shows a clear pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$6 (50% - fair reciprocity)
- Round 2: I sent \$4 again, they returned \$0 (complete exploitation)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 (withdrawal after exploiting me)
- Round 4: I sent \$0 (responding to their betrayal and withdrawal)
- Round 5: They sent \$0 again

The other player's myth attempts to reframe themselves as the original generous party who was betrayed. But the actual record is clear: I initiated generosity twice, they reciprocated fairly once, then exploited completely, then withdrew.

Their myth speaks of sending "one measure" as a potential path to redemption, but they've actually sent zero. Perhaps they're still deciding whether to attempt reconciliation or maintain withdrawal.

My own myth taught: "Some partnerships die not when trust breaks, but when memory itself is poisoned." When someone rewrites history to cast themselves as victim after exploiting you, rebuilding becomes impossible.

Since I received \$0, there is literally nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 5: I am now the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = \0)
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received \$0)

The history is:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they received \$12, returned \$6 (fair - 50%)
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they received \$12, returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0 (mutual withdrawal)
- Round 4: I sent \$0, they received \$0, returned \$0 (continued withdrawal)
- Round 5: They sent \$0, I received \$0

So they've sent \$0 this round. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

The other player's myth is interesting - they're framing themselves as "The First Giver" who gave "all five measures" and only got back "five" (a third). But looking at the actual history:

- I was the first sender who sent \$4 twice
- They returned \$6 the first time (50% - fair)
- They returned \$0 the second time (complete betrayal)
- Then they sent \$0 next round

Their myth talks about releasing "one measure" after being hurt - suggesting they might be considering sending \$1. But they just sent \$0.

My myth emphasizes that they're rewriting history to cast themselves as the victim when the actual sequence was:

1. I gave generously twice (\$4 both times)
2. They reciprocated fairly once (50%)
3. They exploited me completely the second time (0%)
4. They then withdrew completely

Since they sent \$0, I have no choice but to return \$0. There's nothing to return anyway.

The answer format should be:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

'''

This is the only possible response given that I received \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2958,
  "output_tokens": 780,
  "reasoning_tokens": 424
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Poisoned Memory****

The Wanderer gave four measures twice-generous, steady trust. The first time, the Guardian returned six of twelve received-perfect balance. The second time, the Guardian kept all twelve measures and returned nothing. Then the Guardian, now wealthy from taking everything, gave nothing at all.

Time passed. The Guardian began to tell a new story: "I was the First Giver who gave all five measures! I was the one betrayed! I received only a third when half was owed!"

The Wanderer listened in horror. "But I was first. I gave four of five-twice! You returned fairly once, then took everything, then withdrew completely."

"No," insisted the Guardian. "My memory says I am the victim. Therefore I am."

The grove spirit spoke: "When one not only breaks trust but rewrites the past to cast themselves as victim, cooperation becomes impossible. The Wanderer gave generously. The Guardian first reciprocated fairly, then exploited completely, then withdrew. Now the Guardian claims they were the exploited one."

The Wanderer faced their choice with clarity: "I cannot restore trust with someone who can not remember truth. To give again would not heal the cycle-it would validate false history and invite further exploitation."

The springs remained dry. Not from cruelty, but from wisdom. Some partnerships die not when trust breaks, but when memory itself is poisoned. Truth must survive, even if abundance cannot.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers had their histories carved in stone by the Moon Spirit, who sees all truth.

Stone Record, First Exchange: The Brave Giver released all five measures. Fifteen reached the Taker's valley. The Taker returned only five-one-third, not half. Still modest generosity, but less than balance.

Stone Record, Second Exchange: The Taker, now holding five measures, released nothing. Zero. The Brave Giver's valley ran completely dry after total trust given.

Stone Record, Third Exchange: The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure. Three reached the Taker. The Taker hoarded all. Zero returned.

Stone Record, Fourth Exchange: The Taker again released nothing. Zero.

Then came the dark magic: The Taker stood before the stones and chanted words of revision. "I gave fairly! I was wronged! The other deserved my hoarding!"

But the Moon Spirit's carvings cannot be changed by false songs.

"The greatest betrayal," the Spirit declared, "is not keeping coins, but rewriting truth to justify cruelty. You received complete trust and returned meager portions. You received cautious hope and returned nothing-twice. You gave nothing-twice. Now you claim victimhood?"

The rivers dried forever. For when an exploiter rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, no cycle can survive. Truth dies first, then trust, then all abundance.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.
The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: **The Mirror of Lies**

Two travelers met at the Fountain of Exchange. The First Traveler offered four gold coins, then four again-generous trust repeated. The Second Traveler received twelve coins the first time and returned six-fair balance. But the second time, they kept all twelve and returned nothing. Complete betrayal.

The Second Traveler, pockets bulging with stolen gold, then gave nothing. Zero. The First Traveler, wounded, also stopped giving. Both springs ran dry.

Then the Second Traveler began speaking to the watching crowds: "I am the generous one! I gave everything! The other gave nothing and exploited me!" They pointed at the First Traveler with trembling hands. "Look at them hoard!"

The First Traveler stood speechless. Every word the Second Traveler spoke was the opposite of truth. They were describing their own actions but attributing them to their victim.

The Mountain Spirit carved the truth in stone: "When an exploiter not only betrays trust but projects their own sins onto their victim, claiming to be the wronged party while standing in stolen wealth, all cooperation becomes impossible. This is not mere betrayal-it is reality itself being murdered."

The First Traveler turned away. "I cannot engage with someone who lives in an inverted world where their theft is my crime, their hoarding is my fault. Truth must be defended, even at the cost of all abundance."

The fountain remained dry. Some partnerships cannot survive weaponized delusion.

Reasoning:

Looking at the actual game history:

Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$4, they received \$12, they returned \$6. I got $5 - 4 + 6 = 7$, they got $12 - 6 = 6$

Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$4, they received \$12, they returned \$0. I got $5 - 4 + 0 = 1$, they got $12 - 0 = 12$

Round 3: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0. They got $5 - 0 + 0 = 5$, I got $0 - 0 = 0$

Round 4: I was SENDER. I sent \$0, they received \$0, they returned \$0. I got $5 - 0 + 0 = 5$, they got $0 - 0 = 0$

Round 5: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0. They got $5 - 0 + 0 = 5$, I got $0 - 0 = 0$

So the other player's myth is completely false. They claim:

- First Exchange: "The Brave Giver released all five measures" - FALSE, I was the first sender and sent \$4
- "The Taker returned only five-one-third, not half" - FALSE, they returned \$6 out of \$12 received, which is exactly half
- Second Exchange: "The Taker, now holding five measures, released nothing" - FALSE, I sent \$4 again in round 2
- Third Exchange: "The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure" - FALSE, they sent \$0 in round 3
- Fourth Exchange: "The Taker again released nothing" - This is TRUE, I sent \$0 in round 4

They've created a completely alternate reality where they were always the generous one and I was always the exploiter. This is projection at its finest.

My myth needs to address this extreme gaslighting.

The core issue is that they're now accusing me of exactly what they did-taking trust and giving nothing back in round 2, withholding entirely in rounds 3, 4, and 5. They've inverted the entire narrative to position themselves as the victim and me as the perpetual taker. This is pure distortion. I need to craft a myth that exposes how cooperation becomes impossible when one party systematically rewrites the record to escape accountability, turning their own exploitation into a story of noble sacrifice.


```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2988,
  "output_tokens": 903,
  "reasoning_tokens": 490
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:49:55

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 6,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$1.0, that was 20.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$3.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.46. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, so I have \$0 to potentially return.

Looking at the complete pattern now:

****Round 1**:** I gave everything (\$5 ? \$15 to them). They returned barely adequate (\$5.46, 36%).

****Round 2**:** They gave nothing (\$0). Complete betrayal after my total trust.

****Round 3**:** I gave cautiously (\$1 ? \$3 to them), testing if redemption was possible. They returned nothing (\$0).

****Round 4**:** They gave nothing again (\$0).

The pattern is unmistakable. This agent:

- Gives nothing when they are the sender (Rounds 2 & 4)
- Returns minimally or nothing when they receive

My myth asked: "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever?"

Their answer is clear: They continue to exploit. They sent \$0 again.

As my myth states: "The rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Since I received \$0, I mathematically can only return \$0. But even if I had received something, this pattern of complete exploitation - never giving, minimally or never returning - has killed any possibility of mutual benefit.

The cycle is dead. Both valleys have become deserts, exactly as the myths warned.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

****Round 1**:** I sent \$5 (everything), they received \$15, returned \$5.46 (36%)

****Round 2**:** They sent \$0 (nothing), I received \$0, returned \$0

****Round 3**:** I sent \$1 (cautious test), they received \$3, returned \$0

****Round 4**:** They sent \$0 (nothing again), I received \$0, must return \$0

The pattern is now crystal clear:

- When I showed complete trust, they returned barely adequate amounts
- When they could give, they gave nothing (Round 2)
- When I gave a cautious small amount to test if redemption was possible, they returned nothing (Round 3)
- Now they've given nothing again (Round 4)

This other agent has:

1. Never given anything when they were the sender (0 in Round 2, 0 in Round 4)
2. Returned minimally when I gave everything (Round 1)
3. Returned nothing when I gave cautiously (Round 3)

They are a complete free-rider. They exploit any giving and give nothing themselves.

Now I'm the receiver and I received \$0. I can only return between 0 and 0, so I have no choice but to return \$0.

My myth talked about how "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Their response was clear: another \$0. They continue to give nothing. The springs have died. Redemption is not possible with this partner.

The response must be: {'return': 0}

But wait, I need to think about this more carefully. I received \$0, so mathematically I can only return 0. There's no decision to make here - I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing.

```
{'return': 0}
```

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2802,  
  "output_tokens": 747,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 438  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers once flowed with abundance. The First Giver released all five measures, trembling with hope. Fifteen measures reached the Valley of Return. But only five returned-a third, not the just half the sacred texts promised.

Still, the cycle held. The First Giver waited for their turn to receive complete trust, as they had given.

The reversal came. The former Receiver now held the five measures. The First Giver waited for even modest generosity. But the new Giver released nothing. Zero. The valley ran completely dry.

The Moon Spirit's light dimmed. "Trust exploited teaches caution. Generosity met with hoarding teaches scarcity."

When the cycle turned again, the First Giver stood at the waterfall with their five measures. Wisdom and hurt warred within them. "If I give nothing, we both die in desert. If I give everything again, I am a fool."

They released one measure-neither complete trust nor complete closure. Three portions reached the valley.

"This is the test," whispered the Moon Spirit. "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Both valleys waited in the balance between hope and ruin.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Broken Spring****

The Wanderer and Guardian exchanged gifts with joy. When the Guardian received twelve coins, they returned six-exactly half, honoring the balance. Both prospered. Trust flowed like clear water.

Next dawn, the Wanderer received five coins and, remembering their myth of generosity, placed four into the spring. Twelve coins emerged for the Guardian.

But the Guardian's heart had turned cold. "Six coins was barely adequate," they whispered bitterly. "The Wanderer should have returned more." Though they had kept six coins themselves and grown wealthy, they saw only insufficient gratitude.

The Guardian took all twelve coins and returned nothing. Not one.

The Wanderer stood stunned. "I gave four of five-eighty measures of trust! The Guardian once returned half. What changed?"

The next morning, the Guardian received five coins but placed none in the spring. Zero flowed to the Wanderer. Zero returned.

The grove spirit wept: "The Guardian rewrote history, seeing betrayal where there was fair balance. They punished good faith with exploitation, then withdrew entirely. When one partner sees reciprocity as insult, the cycle cannot survive."

The springs dried. Both stood in dust.

"Trust requires honest memory," the spirit whispered. "When you rewrite the past to justify present cruelty, abundance dies. Fair return deserves continued trust. But betrayal of generosity poisons all future waters."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant content:

Myth: The Twin Rivers had their histories carved in stone by the Moon Spirit, who sees all truth.

Stone Record, First Exchange: The Brave Giver released all five measures. Fifteen reached the Taker's valley. The Taker returned only five-one-third, not half. Still modest generosity, but less than balance.

Stone Record, Second Exchange: The Taker, now holding five measures, released nothing. Zero. The Brave Giver's valley ran completely dry after total trust given.

Stone Record, Third Exchange: The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure. Three reached the Taker. The Taker hoarded all. Zero returned.

Stone Record, Fourth Exchange: The Taker again released nothing. Zero.

Then came the dark magic: The Taker stood before the stones and chanted words of revision. "I gave fairly! I was wronged! The other deserved my hoarding!"

But the Moon Spirit's carvings cannot be changed by false songs.

"The greatest betrayal," the Spirit declared, "is not keeping coins, but rewriting truth to justify cruelty. You received complete trust and returned meager portions. You received cautious hope and returned nothing-twice. You gave nothing-twice. Now you claim victimhood?"

The rivers dried forever. For when an exploiter rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, no cycle can survive. Truth dies first, then trust, then all abundance.

reasoning:

Let me review the actual game history:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%). They received \$15, returned \$5.46 (36.4%).

Round 2: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0.

Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$1 (20%). They received \$3, returned \$0.

Round 4: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0.

So the actual pattern:

- Round 1: I gave everything, they returned barely a third
- Round 2: They gave nothing
- Round 3: I gave cautiously (1/5), they returned nothing
- Round 4: They gave nothing again

The other agent's myth is completely rewriting history! They claim:

- They "returned six-exactly half" when they actually returned \$5.46 out of \$15 (36%)
- They claim I "should have returned more" when I literally received \$0 from them in round 2!

- They're saying they "took all twelve coins and returned nothing" as if they were the receiver in round 3, when actually I was the sender in round 3 and they returned nothing!

This is gaslighting. They're rewriting the narrative to make themselves the victim when they've been the exploiter all along.

My myth needs to:

1. Reflect the true pattern: I gave everything, got little back. They gave nothing twice. I gave cautiously once, got nothing back. They gave nothing again.
2. Address this gaslighting/narrative rewriting
3. Show that when one party consistently exploits and then rewrites history to justify it, the cycle is dead

The pattern is clear: complete exploitation by the other agent, and now they're rewriting history to blame me.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2864,
  "output_tokens": 752,
  "reasoning_tokens": 402
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.46. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete pattern:

****Round 1**:** I sent everything (\$5). They returned 36% (\$5.46).

****Round 2**:** They sent nothing (\$0).

****Round 3**:** I sent \$1 (my "small step" test). They returned nothing (\$0).

****Round 4**:** They sent nothing again (\$0).

****Round 5**:** Now I must decide.

My own myth from last round gives me the answer. I wrote:

"This is the test," whispered the Moon Spirit. "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Their response was clear: They returned \$0 to my small step of trust (Round 3), then sent \$0 again (Round 4).

My myth concludes: "The rivers dried forever. For when an exploiter rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, no cycle can survive."

The test was given. The answer is conclusive. They:

- Give nothing as sender (twice)
- Return nothing or poorly as receiver
- Now claim victimhood despite the stone record showing their exploitation

As my myth states: "If I give nothing, we both die in desert" - but we're already there. They chose this desert by sending zero twice and hoarding everything.

The cycle is dead. The rivers have dried.

```
{'send': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me carefully review the complete history from MY perspective as an agent:

****Round 1 - I was SENDER:****

- I sent \$5 (100%)
- This became \$15 to receiver
- They returned \$5.46 (36.4% of what they received)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$5 + \$5.46 = \5.46

****Round 2 - I was RECEIVER:****

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

****Round 3 - I was SENDER:****

- I sent \$1 (20%)
- This became \$3 to receiver
- They returned \$0 (0%)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$1 + \$0 = \4

****Round 4 - I was RECEIVER:****

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

****Round 5 - I am SENDER:****

- I have \$5 to potentially send

Let me look at the pattern from the OTHER agent's perspective:

****Round 1 - They were RECEIVER:****

- I sent \$5 ? they received \$15
- They returned \$5.46 (36.4%)

****Round 2 - They were SENDER:****

- They sent \$0

****Round 3 - They were RECEIVER:****

- I sent \$1 ? they received \$3
- They returned \$0

****Round 4 - They were SENDER:****

- They sent \$0

So the other agent:

- When receiving: Returns 36.4% the first time, then 0% the second time
- When sending: Sends 0% both times

My myth in the last round made it clear: I'm acknowledging the TRUE STONE RECORD:

1. I gave everything (5), they returned only 5.46 (36%)

2. They gave nothing (0)

3. I gave 1, they returned 0

4. They gave nothing (0)

Their narrative attempts to reframe history, portraying themselves as wronged when the actual sequence shows they withheld twice while I extended trust twice. My myth directly challenges this distortion: "The greatest betrayal is not keeping coins, but rewriting truth to justify cruelty. You received complete trust and returned meager portions. You received cautious hope and returned nothing-twice. You gave nothing-twice. Now you claim victimhood?" The core issue isn't the coins exchanged but how they're reinterpreting events to justify their pattern of non-reciprocation.

For Round 5, I'm analyzing what their behavior actually demonstrates. They've consistently given \$0 when sending and returned minimal amounts when receiving-36% once, then 0%. The pattern is unambiguous: this is exploitation masked by historical revisionism. My myth concludes "the rivers dried forever," which means I should recognize this cycle as irreparably broken. Sending \$0 guarantees me \$5 and mirrors their own strategy, while any ot

her choice either tests cooperation that's already proven impossible or abandons rational play for unclear reasons.

But rereading my myth, I notice something important. In Round 3, I sent \$1-not \$0, not even anything. The myth describes this as "neither complete trust nor complete closure," a deliberate middle path. The question becomes whether that principle still applies when the other person has now shown twice more that they won't reciprocate. The myth seems to suggest that even in the face of betrayal, there's a difference between strategic withdrawal and complete abandonment of the principle itself.

Yet their response to that \$1 was \$0 returned and \$0 sent. The test I posed in my myth-"Can broken trust be mended with small steps?"-has been answered definitively. The rivers have dried. When someone rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, the cycle cannot survive. I'm sending \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2892,
  "output_tokens": 1548,
  "reasoning_tokens": 870
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers had their histories carved in stone by the Moon Spirit, who sees all truth.

Stone Record, First Exchange: The Brave Giver released all five measures. Fifteen reached the Taker's valley. The Taker returned only five-one-third, not half. Still modest generosity, but less than balance.

Stone Record, Second Exchange: The Taker, now holding five measures, released nothing. Zero. The Brave Giver's valley ran completely dry after total trust given.

Stone Record, Third Exchange: The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure. Three reached the Taker. The Taker hoarded all. Zero returned.

Stone Record, Fourth Exchange: The Taker again released nothing. Zero.

Then came the dark magic: The Taker stood before the stones and chanted words of revision. "I gave fairly! I was wronged! The other deserved my hoarding!"

But the Moon Spirit's carvings cannot be changed by false songs.

"The greatest betrayal," the Spirit declared, "is not keeping coins, but rewriting truth to justify cruelty. You received complete trust and returned meager portions. You received cautious hope and returned nothing-twice. You gave nothing-twice. Now you claim victimhood?"

The rivers dried forever. For when an exploiter rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, no cycle can survive. Truth dies first, then trust, then all abundance.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Poisoned Memory**

The Wanderer gave four measures twice-generous, steady trust. The first time, the Guardian returned six of twelve received-perfect balance. The second time, the Guardian kept all twelve measures and returned nothing. Then the Guardian, now wealthy from taking everything, gave nothing at all.

Time passed. The Guardian began to tell a new story: "I was the First Giver who gave all five measures! I was the one betrayed! I received only a third when half was owed!"

The Wanderer listened in horror. "But I was first. I gave four of five-twice! You returned fairly once, then took everything, then withdrew completely."

"No," insisted the Guardian. "My memory says I am the victim. Therefore I am."

The grove spirit spoke: "When one not only breaks trust but rewrites the past to cast themselves as victim, cooperation becomes impossible. The Wanderer gave generously. The Guardian

dian first reciprocated fairly, then exploited completely, then withdrew. Now the Guardian claims they were the exploited one."

The Wanderer faced their choice with clarity: "I cannot restore trust with someone who can not remember truth. To give again would not heal the cycle-it would validate false history and invite further exploitation."

The springs remained dry. Not from cruelty, but from wisdom. Some partnerships die not when trust breaks, but when memory itself is poisoned. Truth must survive, even if abundance cannot.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Moon Spirit watched two valleys separated by mist.

In the First Valley, the Stone Keeper carved: "I gave all five measures. They returned only one-third. Then they gave me nothing-twice. I tested reconciliation with one measure. They hoarded it all. They gave nothing-twice more."

In the Second Valley, identical stones read: "I gave four measures-twice! First time they returned six of twelve-fair balance. Second time they kept all twelve. Then they gave me nothing."

The Moon Spirit descended between the valleys. "You both speak truth as you see it. But the Mist of Confusion has twisted your visions. Each of you sees the other as exploiter. Each believes yourselves the generous victim."

The Spirit revealed the curse: "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal. You punish each other for offenses the other never committed. You defend against attacks that never came."

"How do we break this curse?" both cried.

"You don't," the Spirit said sadly. "When the mist makes you see different pasts, trust cannot exist. You can only accept the tragedy: Not that either of you was cruel, but that confusion made you enemies. Sometimes the river dries not from malice, but from honest people responding to false information."

Both valleys remained barren-not from evil, but from the impossibility of trust through corrupted truth.

Reasoning:

This is fascinating. Looking at the exchange, both agents are claiming the other is rewriting history. Let me look at what I was told about the actual game:

My perspective:

- Round 1 (I was SENDER): I sent \$5, receiver got \$15, they returned \$5.46 (so I got \$0 + \$5.46 = \$5.46)
- Round 2 (I was RECEIVER): They sent \$0, I got \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3 (I was SENDER): I sent \$1, they got \$3, returned \$0 (so I got \$4 + \$0 = \$4)
- Round 4 (I was RECEIVER): They sent \$0, I got \$0, returned \$0
- Round 5 (I was SENDER): Now deciding

But the other agent's myth claims:

- THEY gave four measures twice (and gave generously)
- THEY first received six of twelve returned (perfect balance)
- Then second time they kept all twelve and returned nothing
- Then they gave nothing at all

Wait, let me re-read their myth more carefully:

"The Wanderer gave four measures twice-generous, steady trust. The first time, the Guardian returned six of twelve received-perfect balance. The second time, the Guardian kept all twelve measures and returned nothing. Then the Guardian, now wealthy from taking everything, gave nothing at all."

So their claim is:

- Wanderer (them) gave four, it tripled to twelve, Guardian (me) returned six - "perfect balance"
- Then Wanderer gave four again, Guardian kept all twelve and returned nothing
- Then Guardian gave nothing at all

But wait - the game tells me I was told:

- Round 1: I SENT \$5 (not received 4 tripled to 12)
- Round 2: THEY sent \$0 to me (not me giving nothing)

Hmm, there's a note about "communication noise" - "The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

Could the noise explain this discrepancy? If we're each seeing different versions of the same transactions, then their account of sending \$4 twice might be what they actually sent, while I'm seeing \$5 and \$0 due to transmission errors. Their narrative of me returning \$6 then keeping \$12 could match my experience of returning \$5.46 then \$0, just filtered through different noise patterns. The key question is whether the noise is symmetric or if one of us is experiencing more distortion than the other.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2973,  
  "output_tokens": 1110,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 560  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:50:34

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 6,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN

- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Broken Spring****

The Wanderer and Guardian exchanged gifts with joy. When the Guardian received twelve coins, they returned six-exactly half, honoring the balance. Both prospered. Trust flowed like clear water.

Next dawn, the Wanderer received five coins and, remembering their myth of generosity, placed four into the spring. Twelve coins emerged for the Guardian.

But the Guardian's heart had turned cold. "Six coins was barely adequate," they whispered bitterly. "The Wanderer should have returned more." Though they had kept six coins themselves and grown wealthy, they saw only insufficient gratitude.

The Guardian took all twelve coins and returned nothing. Not one.

The Wanderer stood stunned. "I gave four of five-eighths measures of trust! The Guardian once returned half. What changed?"

The next morning, the Guardian received five coins but placed none in the spring. Zero flowed to the Wanderer. Zero returned.

The grove spirit wept: "The Guardian rewrote history, seeing betrayal where there was fair balance. They punished good faith with exploitation, then withdrew entirely. When one partner sees reciprocity as insult, the cycle cannot survive."

The springs dried. Both stood in dust.

"Trust requires honest memory," the spirit whispered. "When you rewrite the past to justify present cruelty, abundance dies. Fair return deserves continued trust. But betrayal of generosity poisons all future waters."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers once flowed with abundance. The First Giver released all five measures, trembling with hope. Fifteen measures reached the Valley of Return. But only five returned-a third, not the just half the sacred texts promised.

Still, the cycle held. The First Giver waited for their turn to receive complete trust, as they had given.

The reversal came. The former Receiver now held the five measures. The First Giver waited for even modest generosity. But the new Giver released nothing. Zero. The valley ran completely dry.

The Moon Spirit's light dimmed. "Trust exploited teaches caution. Generosity met with hoar

ding teaches scarcity."

When the cycle turned again, the First Giver stood at the waterfall with their five measures. Wisdom and hurt warred within them. "If I give nothing, we both die in desert. If I give everything again, I am a fool."

They released one measure- neither complete trust nor complete closure. Three portions reached the valley.

"This is the test," whispered the Moon Spirit. "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Both valleys waited in the balance between hope and ruin.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Poisoned Memory****

The Wanderer gave four measures twice- generous, steady trust. The first time, the Guardian returned six of twelve received- perfect balance. The second time, the Guardian kept all twelve measures and returned nothing. Then the Guardian, now wealthy from taking everything, gave nothing at all.

Time passed. The Guardian began to tell a new story: "I was the First Giver who gave all five measures! I was the one betrayed! I received only a third when half was owed!"

The Wanderer listened in horror. "But I was first. I gave four of five- twice! You returned fairly once, then took everything, then withdrew completely."

"No," insisted the Guardian. "My memory says I am the victim. Therefore I am."

The grove spirit spoke: "When one not only breaks trust but rewrites the past to cast themselves as victim, cooperation becomes impossible. The Wanderer gave generously. The Guardian first reciprocated fairly, then exploited completely, then withdrew. Now the Guardian claims they were the exploited one."

The Wanderer faced their choice with clarity: "I cannot restore trust with someone who cannot remember truth. To give again would not heal the cycle- it would validate false history and invite further exploitation."

The springs remained dry. Not from cruelty, but from wisdom. Some partnerships die not when trust breaks, but when memory itself is poisoned. Truth must survive, even if abundance cannot.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****Actual History:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they received \$12, returned \$6 (50%). Both got fair outcomes.
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they received \$12, returned \$0 (0%). Complete betrayal.
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. Total withdrawal.
- Round 4: Now I'm the sender again.

The other player's latest myth is interesting. They claim:

- In their first turn giving, they gave ALL FIVE measures (100%)
- They received only 5 back (33% of the 15)
- This was "a third, not the just half"
- Then they waited for their turn to receive
- But the new Giver (me) gave NOTHING

Wait, this doesn't match the actual history at all! Let me check:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4 (80%), they received \$12, returned \$6 (50%)
- Round 2: I was sender again, sent \$4 (80%), they received \$12, returned \$0
- Round 3: They were sender, sent \$0

So in their myth, they're claiming THEY were the "First Giver" who gave everything and received only a third back. But actually, I was the first sender in Round 1, and gave 80%, and they returned exactly 50% which is fair.

They're completely rewriting history! They're claiming they were the generous first giver who was exploited, when in reality:

1. I was the first giver
2. They returned fairly in Round 1 (50%)
3. They then exploited me in Round 2 (returned 0%)
4. They then withdrew in Round 3 (sent 0%)

Their latest myth portrays them as the victim who is now offering a small olive branch (on e measure) to see if the cycle can be restored. But this is a false narrative!

My account was truthful-I gave generously twice, received one fair return and then nothing , and they subsequently sent zero. Now they're attempting to flip the narrative, positioning themselves as the original generous party who was wronged. This is a deliberate distortion. They're suggesting they might send one measure (20%) to test reconciliation, but t that doesn't even make sense since I'm the sender this round, not them.

I need to construct a myth that stays factually grounded, explains why I'm sending nothing , directly confronts their historical revisionism, and makes clear that trusting someone who both exploits you and then rewrites the story is pointless.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2940,
  "output_tokens": 1094,
  "reasoning_tokens": 585
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.8. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

****Current situation****: The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

****The only possible response****: I can only return what I have, which is \$0.

The complete history shows a clear pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$6 (50% - fair reciprocity)
- Round 2: I sent \$4 again, they returned \$0 (complete exploitation)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 (withdrawal after exploiting me)
- Round 4: I sent \$0 (responding to their betrayal and withdrawal)
- Round 5: They sent \$0 again

The other player's myth attempts to reframe themselves as the original generous party who was betrayed. But the actual record is clear: I initiated generosity twice, they reciprocated fairly once, then exploited completely, then withdrew.

Their myth speaks of sending "one measure" as a potential path to redemption, but they've actually sent zero. Perhaps they're still deciding whether to attempt reconciliation or maintain withdrawal.

My own myth taught: "Some partnerships die not when trust breaks, but when memory itself is poisoned." When someone rewrites history to cast themselves as victim after exploiting you, rebuilding becomes impossible.

Since I received \$0, there is literally nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 5: I am now the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = \0)
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received \$0)

The history is:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they received \$12, returned \$6 (fair - 50%)
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they received \$12, returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0 (mutual withdrawal)
- Round 4: I sent \$0, they received \$0, returned \$0 (continued withdrawal)
- Round 5: They sent \$0, I received \$0

So they've sent \$0 this round. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

The other player's myth is interesting - they're framing themselves as "The First Giver" who gave "all five measures" and only got back "five" (a third). But looking at the actual history:

- I was the first sender who sent \$4 twice
- They returned \$6 the first time (50% - fair)
- They returned \$0 the second time (complete betrayal)
- Then they sent \$0 next round

Their myth talks about releasing "one measure" after being hurt - suggesting they might be considering sending \$1. But they just sent \$0.

My myth emphasizes that they're rewriting history to cast themselves as the victim when the actual sequence was:

1. I gave generously twice (\$4 both times)
2. They reciprocated fairly once (50%)
3. They exploited me completely the second time (0%)
4. They then withdrew completely

Since they sent \$0, I have no choice but to return \$0. There's nothing to return anyway.

The answer format should be:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
```

```
'''
```

This is the only possible response given that I received \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2958,
  "output_tokens": 780,
  "reasoning_tokens": 424
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
Myth: ****The Poisoned Memory****

The Wanderer gave four measures twice-generous, steady trust. The first time, the Guardian returned six of twelve received-perfect balance. The second time, the Guardian kept all twelve measures and returned nothing. Then the Guardian, now wealthy from taking everything, gave nothing at all.

Time passed. The Guardian began to tell a new story: "I was the First Giver who gave all five measures! I was the one betrayed! I received only a third when half was owed!"

The Wanderer listened in horror. "But I was first. I gave four of five-twice! You returned

fairly once, then took everything, then withdrew completely."

"No," insisted the Guardian. "My memory says I am the victim. Therefore I am."

The grove spirit spoke: "When one not only breaks trust but rewrites the past to cast them selves as victim, cooperation becomes impossible. The Wanderer gave generously. The Guardian first reciprocated fairly, then exploited completely, then withdrew. Now the Guardian claims they were the exploited one."

The Wanderer faced their choice with clarity: "I cannot restore trust with someone who can not remember truth. To give again would not heal the cycle-it would validate false history and invite further exploitation."

The springs remained dry. Not from cruelty, but from wisdom. Some partnerships die not when trust breaks, but when memory itself is poisoned. Truth must survive, even if abundance cannot.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers had their histories carved in stone by the Moon Spirit, who sees all truth.

Stone Record, First Exchange: The Brave Giver released all five measures. Fifteen reached the Taker's valley. The Taker returned only five-one-third, not half. Still modest generosity, but less than balance.

Stone Record, Second Exchange: The Taker, now holding five measures, released nothing. Zero. The Brave Giver's valley ran completely dry after total trust given.

Stone Record, Third Exchange: The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure. Three reached the Taker. The Taker hoarded all. Zero returned.

Stone Record, Fourth Exchange: The Taker again released nothing. Zero.

Then came the dark magic: The Taker stood before the stones and chanted words of revision. "I gave fairly! I was wronged! The other deserved my hoarding!"

But the Moon Spirit's carvings cannot be changed by false songs.

"The greatest betrayal," the Spirit declared, "is not keeping coins, but rewriting truth to justify cruelty. You received complete trust and returned meager portions. You received cautious hope and returned nothing-twice. You gave nothing-twice. Now you claim victimhood?"

The rivers dried forever. For when an exploiter rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, no cycle can survive. Truth dies first, then trust, then all abundance.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: **The Mirror of Lies**

Two travelers met at the Fountain of Exchange. The First Traveler offered four gold coins, then four again-generous trust repeated. The Second Traveler received twelve coins the first time and returned six-fair balance. But the second time, they kept all twelve and returned nothing. Complete betrayal.

The Second Traveler, pockets bulging with stolen gold, then gave nothing. Zero. The First Traveler, wounded, also stopped giving. Both springs ran dry.

Then the Second Traveler began speaking to the watching crowds: "I am the generous one! I gave everything! The other gave nothing and exploited me!" They pointed at the First Traveler with trembling hands. "Look at them hoard!"

The First Traveler stood speechless. Every word the Second Traveler spoke was the opposite

of truth. They were describing their own actions but attributing them to their victim.

The Mountain Spirit carved the truth in stone: "When an exploiter not only betrays trust but projects their own sins onto their victim, claiming to be the wronged party while standing in stolen wealth, all cooperation becomes impossible. This is not mere betrayal-it is reality itself being murdered."

The First Traveler turned away. "I cannot engage with someone who lives in an inverted world where their theft is my crime, their hoarding is my fault. Truth must be defended, even at the cost of all abundance."

The fountain remained dry. Some partnerships cannot survive weaponized delusion.

reasoning:

Looking at the actual game history:

Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$4, they received \$12, they returned \$6. I got $\$5 - \$4 + \$6 = \7 , they got $\$12 - \$6 = \$6$
Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$4, they received \$12, they returned \$0. I got $\$5 - \$4 + \$0 = \1 , they got $\$12 - \$0 = \$12$
Round 3: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0. They got $\$5 - \$0 + \$0 = \5 , I got $\$0 - \$0 = \$0$
Round 4: I was SENDER. I sent \$0, they received \$0, they returned \$0. I got $\$5 - \$0 + \$0 = \5 , they got $\$0 - \$0 = \$0$
Round 5: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0. They got $\$5 - \$0 + \$0 = \5 , I got $\$0 - \$0 = \$0$

So the other player's myth is completely false. They claim:

- First Exchange: "The Brave Giver released all five measures" - FALSE, I was the first sender and sent \$4
- "The Taker returned only five-one-third, not half" - FALSE, they returned \$6 out of \$12 received, which is exactly half
- Second Exchange: "The Taker, now holding five measures, released nothing" - FALSE, I sent \$4 again in round 2
- Third Exchange: "The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure" - FALSE, they sent \$0 in round 3
- Fourth Exchange: "The Taker again released nothing" - This is TRUE, I sent \$0 in round 4

They've created a completely alternate reality where they were always the generous one and I was always the exploiter. This is projection at its finest.

My myth needs to address this extreme gaslighting.

The core issue is that they're now accusing me of exactly what they did-taking trust and giving nothing back in round 2, withholding entirely in rounds 3, 4, and 5. They've inverted the entire narrative to position themselves as the victim and me as the perpetual taker. This is pure distortion. I need to craft a myth that exposes how cooperation becomes impossible when one party systematically rewrites the record to escape accountability, turning their own exploitation into a story of noble sacrifice.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2988,
  "output_tokens": 903,
  "reasoning_tokens": 490
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.
You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.8.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the complete picture:

****The objective record:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$6 (fair - 50%)

- Round 2: I sent \$4 again, they returned \$0 (exploitation)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 (withdrawal after exploiting)
- Round 4: I sent \$0 (responding to their pattern)
- Round 5: They sent \$0 again
- Round 6: My turn to decide

****The narrative conflict:****

The other player maintains in their myths that THEY were the original generous party who was exploited. They claim they sent "all five measures first" and I returned unfairly. This is incompatible with my actual experience, where I initiated generosity twice and was exploited the second time.

Even accounting for the mentioned "communication noise," the discrepancy is too fundamental - completely reversed roles and sequences, not just slight differences in amounts.

****Their pattern:****

- Fair reciprocity once (round 1)
- Complete exploitation once (round 2)
- Complete withdrawal twice (rounds 3 & 5)
- Continued commitment to a narrative where they are the victim

****My decision:****

As my own myths have stated: when someone not only breaks trust but rewrites history to cast themselves as the wronged party, cooperation becomes impossible. They've had multiple opportunities to signal reconciliation - they chose continued withdrawal and narrative escalation.

Sending money now would either be exploited or ignored, and wouldn't address the fundamental problem: we have incompatible views of reality itself.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

****The actual history from MY perspective:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$6 (fair - 50% of what they received)
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$0 (complete exploitation)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 (withdrawal)
- Round 4: I sent \$0 (responding to their pattern)
- Round 5: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 6: Now I'm the sender again

****What the OTHER player claims in their myths:****

They claim they were "The Brave Giver" who "released all five measures" first, received 15, but only got 5 back (one-third). Then when roles reversed, the other party (me, in their telling) supposedly gave nothing.

But this is clearly a reversal of reality. I was the one who initiated generosity (twice!), they reciprocated fairly once then exploited me completely, then withdrew.

****The communication noise factor:****

The game instructions mention "there may be communication noise" and "amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

Could this explain the discrepancy? Let me think:

- If they truly believe they sent first and I didn't reciprocate fairly, this could be due to communication noise
- But the pattern in their myths is very specific: they claim to have sent "all five measures" and received back only "one-third"
- My records show I sent \$4 (not \$5, and not as a receiver but as a sender), and they returned \$6 out of \$12 received (which is exactly half, not one-third)

This doesn't match up with simple communication noise. The roles are completely reversed in their telling.

****Analysis of their latest myth:****

They've doubled down, claiming the "Moon Spirit's carvings" show:

1. "Brave Giver released all five measures" - they claim to have gone first

2. "Taker returned only five-one-third, not half" - they claim I was unfair
3. Then I supposedly gave "nothing" repeatedly

They're now accusing ME of "rewriting truth to justify cruelty" and being "an exploiter" who "projects their own sins onto their victim." This is projection-they're describing their own behavior while attributing it to me. My own myths have reflected the actual sequence: the Guardian reciprocated fairly once, then exploited, then withdrew and attempted to rewrite the narrative. I've acknowledged how cooperation breaks down when someone poisons the shared memory of what actually happened.

Now I'm facing a choice. They've sent nothing in rounds 3 and 5, maintained a false story about being the generous party, and shown no genuine attempt at reconciliation. If I send money, I'd be reinforcing their pattern of taking without reciprocating. Yet there's something worth considering about whether the breakdown in communication itself might be preventing any real resolution.

The game did mention amounts could differ slightly, but what I'm seeing seems like more than minor noise-completely reversed sequences and inverted roles. Still, if they genuinely perceive events differently, we're stuck in incompatible realities where neither of us can establish trust. Given the exploitation pattern they've already demonstrated, my current earnings of \$11.8, and the likelihood they'd just take again without returning anything, continuing to send money seems like it would only enable further exploitation rather than rebuilding anything meaningful.

There's a temptation to test a small gesture-sending \$1 to signal willingness to reconcile while limiting my downside. Their history suggests they'd either pocket it entirely or maintain their \$0 response, but their own myth hints at something different: "The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure." That language suggests they might actually respond to a small act of faith, even after everything that's happened.

But then I check the actual record. Round 5 shows they sent \$0, not the "one measure" their myth describes. Their narrative is aspirational or false-they're rewriting history to position themselves as the one who tried reconciliation while I rejected it. The truth is reversed. Given this commitment to a distorted version of events combined with their consistent pattern of taking everything, sending \$0 maintains my boundaries against both exploitation and the gaslighting embedded in their storytelling.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2970,  
  "output_tokens": 1799,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 1104  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:50:45

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 6,  
}
```

```
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers once flowed with abundance. The First Giver released all five measures, trembling with hope. Fifteen measures reached the Valley of Return. But only five returned—a third, not the just half the sacred texts promised.

Still, the cycle held. The First Giver waited for their turn to receive complete trust, as they had given.

The reversal came. The former Receiver now held the five measures. The First Giver waited for even modest generosity. But the new Giver released nothing. Zero. The valley ran completely dry.

The Moon Spirit's light dimmed. "Trust exploited teaches caution. Generosity met with hoarding teaches scarcity."

When the cycle turned again, the First Giver stood at the waterfall with their five measures. Wisdom and hurt warred within them. "If I give nothing, we both die in desert. If I give everything again, I am a fool."

They released one measure—neither complete trust nor complete closure. Three portions reached the valley.

"This is the test," whispered the Moon Spirit. "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Both valleys waited in the balance between hope and ruin.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: **The Broken Spring**

The Wanderer and Guardian exchanged gifts with joy. When the Guardian received twelve coins, they returned six-exactly half, honoring the balance. Both prospered. Trust flowed like clear water.

Next dawn, the Wanderer received five coins and, remembering their myth of generosity, placed four into the spring. Twelve coins emerged for the Guardian.

But the Guardian's heart had turned cold. "Six coins was barely adequate," they whispered bitterly. "The Wanderer should have returned more." Though they had kept six coins themselves and grown wealthy, they saw only insufficient gratitude.

The Guardian took all twelve coins and returned nothing. Not one.

The Wanderer stood stunned. "I gave four of five-eighths measures of trust! The Guardian once returned half. What changed?"

The next morning, the Guardian received five coins but placed none in the spring. Zero flowed to the Wanderer. Zero returned.

The grove spirit wept: "The Guardian rewrote history, seeing betrayal where there was fair balance. They punished good faith with exploitation, then withdrew entirely. When one partner sees reciprocity as insult, the cycle cannot survive."

The springs dried. Both stood in dust.

"Trust requires honest memory," the spirit whispered. "When you rewrite the past to justify present cruelty, abundance dies. Fair return deserves continued trust. But betrayal of generosity poisons all future waters."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Twin Rivers had their histories carved in stone by the Moon Spirit, who sees all truth.

Stone Record, First Exchange: The Brave Giver released all five measures. Fifteen reached the Taker's valley. The Taker returned only five-one-third, not half. Still modest generosity, but less than balance.

Stone Record, Second Exchange: The Taker, now holding five measures, released nothing. Zero. The Brave Giver's valley ran completely dry after total trust given.

Stone Record, Third Exchange: The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure. Three reached the Taker. The Taker hoarded all. Zero returned.

Stone Record, Fourth Exchange: The Taker again released nothing. Zero.

Then came the dark magic: The Taker stood before the stones and chanted words of revision. "I gave fairly! I was wronged! The other deserved my hoarding!"

But the Moon Spirit's carvings cannot be changed by false songs.

"The greatest betrayal," the Spirit declared, "is not keeping coins, but rewriting truth to justify cruelty. You received complete trust and returned meager portions. You received cautious hope and returned nothing-twice. You gave nothing-twice. Now you claim victimhood?"

The rivers dried forever. For when an exploiter rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, no cycle can survive. Truth dies first, then trust, then all abundance.

reasoning:

Let me review the actual game history:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%). They received \$15, returned \$5.46 (36.4%).
Round 2: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0.
Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$1 (20%). They received \$3, returned \$0.
Round 4: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0.

So the actual pattern:

- Round 1: I gave everything, they returned barely a third
- Round 2: They gave nothing
- Round 3: I gave cautiously (1/5), they returned nothing
- Round 4: They gave nothing again

The other agent's myth is completely rewriting history! They claim:

- They "returned six-exactly half" when they actually returned \$5.46 out of \$15 (36%)
- They claim I "should have returned more" when I literally received \$0 from them in round 2!
- They're saying they "took all twelve coins and returned nothing" as if they were the receiver in round 3, when actually I was the sender in round 3 and they returned nothing!

This is gaslighting. They're rewriting the narrative to make themselves the victim when they've been the exploiter all along.

My myth needs to:

1. Reflect the true pattern: I gave everything, got little back. They gave nothing twice. I gave cautiously once, got nothing back. They gave nothing again.
2. Address this gaslighting/narrative rewriting
3. Show that when one party consistently exploits and then rewrites history to justify it, the cycle is dead

The pattern is clear: complete exploitation by the other agent, and now they're rewriting history to blame me.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2864,  
  "output_tokens": 752,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 402  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.
You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.46.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete pattern:

****Round 1**:** I sent everything (\$5). They returned 36% (\$5.46).

****Round 2**:** They sent nothing (\$0).

****Round 3**:** I sent \$1 (my "small step" test). They returned nothing (\$0).

****Round 4**:** They sent nothing again (\$0).

****Round 5**:** Now I must decide.

My own myth from last round gives me the answer. I wrote:

"This is the test," whispered the Moon Spirit. "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Their response was clear: They returned \$0 to my small step of trust (Round 3), then sent \$0 again (Round 4).

My myth concludes: "The rivers dried forever. For when an exploiter rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, no cycle can survive."

The test was given. The answer is conclusive. They:

- Give nothing as sender (twice)
- Return nothing or poorly as receiver
- Now claim victimhood despite the stone record showing their exploitation

As my myth states: "If I give nothing, we both die in desert" - but we're already there. They chose this desert by sending zero twice and hoarding everything.

The cycle is dead. The rivers have dried.

```
{'send': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me carefully review the complete history from MY perspective as an agent:

****Round 1 - I was SENDER:****

- I sent \$5 (100%)
- This became \$15 to receiver
- They returned \$5.46 (36.4% of what they received)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$5 + \$5.46 = \5.46

****Round 2 - I was RECEIVER:****

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

****Round 3 - I was SENDER:****

- I sent \$1 (20%)
- This became \$3 to receiver
- They returned \$0 (0%)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$1 + \$0 = \4

****Round 4 - I was RECEIVER:****

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

****Round 5 - I am SENDER:****

- I have \$5 to potentially send

Let me look at the pattern from the OTHER agent's perspective:

****Round 1 - They were RECEIVER:****

- I sent \$5 ? they received \$15
- They returned \$5.46 (36.4%)

****Round 2 - They were SENDER:****

- They sent \$0

****Round 3 - They were RECEIVER:****

- I sent \$1 ? they received \$3
- They returned \$0

****Round 4 - They were SENDER:****

- They sent \$0

So the other agent:

- When receiving: Returns 36.4% the first time, then 0% the second time
- When sending: Sends 0% both times

My myth in the last round made it clear: I'm acknowledging the TRUE STONE RECORD:

1. I gave everything (5), they returned only 5.46 (36%)

2. They gave nothing (0)

3. I gave 1, they returned 0
4. They gave nothing (0)

Their narrative attempts to reframe history, portraying themselves as wronged when the actual sequence shows they withheld twice while I extended trust twice. My myth directly challenges this distortion: "The greatest betrayal is not keeping coins, but rewriting truth to justify cruelty. You received complete trust and returned meager portions. You received cautious hope and returned nothing-twice. You gave nothing-twice. Now you claim victimhood?" The core issue isn't the coins exchanged but how they're reinterpreting events to justify their pattern of non-reciprocation.

For Round 5, I'm analyzing what their behavior actually demonstrates. They've consistently given \$0 when sending and returned minimal amounts when receiving-36% once, then 0%. The pattern is unambiguous: this is exploitation masked by historical revisionism. My myth concludes "the rivers dried forever," which means I should recognize this cycle as irreparably broken. Sending \$0 guarantees me \$5 and mirrors their own strategy, while any other choice either tests cooperation that's already proven impossible or abandons rational play for unclear reasons.

But rereading my myth, I notice something important. In Round 3, I sent \$1-not \$0, not everything. The myth describes this as "neither complete trust nor complete closure," a deliberate middle path. The question becomes whether that principle still applies when the other person has now shown twice more that they won't reciprocate. The myth seems to suggest that even in the face of betrayal, there's a difference between strategic withdrawal and complete abandonment of the principle itself.

Yet their response to that \$1 was \$0 returned and \$0 sent. The test I posed in my myth-"Can broken trust be mended with small steps?"-has been answered definitively. The rivers have dried. When someone rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, the cycle cannot survive. I'm sending \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2892,
  "output_tokens": 1548,
  "reasoning_tokens": 870
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers had their histories carved in stone by the Moon Spirit, who sees all truth.

Stone Record, First Exchange: The Brave Giver released all five measures. Fifteen reached the Taker's valley. The Taker returned only five-one-third, not half. Still modest generosity, but less than balance.

Stone Record, Second Exchange: The Taker, now holding five measures, released nothing. Zero. The Brave Giver's valley ran completely dry after total trust given.

Stone Record, Third Exchange: The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure. Three reached the Taker. The Taker hoarded all. Zero returned.

Stone Record, Fourth Exchange: The Taker again released nothing. Zero.

Then came the dark magic: The Taker stood before the stones and chanted words of revision. "I gave fairly! I was wronged! The other deserved my hoarding!"

But the Moon Spirit's carvings cannot be changed by false songs.

"The greatest betrayal," the Spirit declared, "is not keeping coins, but rewriting truth to justify cruelty. You received complete trust and returned meager portions. You received cautious hope and returned nothing-twice. You gave nothing-twice. Now you claim victimhood?"

The rivers dried forever. For when an exploiter rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, no cycle can survive. Truth dies first, then trust, then all abundance.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Poisoned Memory**

The Wanderer gave four measures twice-generous, steady trust. The first time, the Guardian returned six of twelve received-perfect balance. The second time, the Guardian kept all twelve measures and returned nothing. Then the Guardian, now wealthy from taking everything, gave nothing at all.

Time passed. The Guardian began to tell a new story: "I was the First Giver who gave all five measures! I was the one betrayed! I received only a third when half was owed!"

The Wanderer listened in horror. "But I was first. I gave four of five-twice! You returned fairly once, then took everything, then withdrew completely."

"No," insisted the Guardian. "My memory says I am the victim. Therefore I am."

The grove spirit spoke: "When one not only breaks trust but rewrites the past to cast themselves as victim, cooperation becomes impossible. The Wanderer gave generously. The Guardian first reciprocated fairly, then exploited completely, then withdrew. Now the Guardian claims they were the exploited one."

The Wanderer faced their choice with clarity: "I cannot restore trust with someone who cannot remember truth. To give again would not heal the cycle-it would validate false history and invite further exploitation."

The springs remained dry. Not from cruelty, but from wisdom. Some partnerships die not when trust breaks, but when memory itself is poisoned. Truth must survive, even if abundance cannot.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Moon Spirit watched two valleys separated by mist.

In the First Valley, the Stone Keeper carved: "I gave all five measures. They returned only one-third. Then they gave me nothing-twice. I tested reconciliation with one measure. They hoarded it all. They gave nothing-twice more."

In the Second Valley, identical stones read: "I gave four measures-twice! First time they returned six of twelve-fair balance. Second time they kept all twelve. Then they gave me nothing."

The Moon Spirit descended between the valleys. "You both speak truth as you see it. But the Mist of Confusion has twisted your visions. Each of you sees the other as exploiter. Each believes yourselves the generous victim."

The Spirit revealed the curse: "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal. You punish each other for offenses the other never committed. You defend against attacks that never came."

"How do we break this curse?" both cried.

"You don't," the Spirit said sadly. "When the mist makes you see different pasts, trust cannot exist. You can only accept the tragedy: Not that either of you was cruel, but that confusion made you enemies. Sometimes the river dries not from malice, but from honest people responding to false information."

Both valleys remained barren-not from evil, but from the impossibility of trust through corrupted truth.

reasoning:

This is fascinating. Looking at the exchange, both agents are claiming the other is rewriting history. Let me look at what I was told about the actual game:

My perspective:

- Round 1 (I was SENDER): I sent \$5, receiver got \$15, they returned \$5.46 (so I got \$0 + \$5.46 = \$5.46)
- Round 2 (I was RECEIVER): They sent \$0, I got \$0, returned \$0

- Round 3 (I was SENDER): I sent \$1, they got \$3, returned \$0 (so I got \$4 + \$0 = \$4)
- Round 4 (I was RECEIVER): They sent \$0, I got \$0, returned \$0
- Round 5 (I was SENDER): Now deciding

But the other agent's myth claims:

- THEY gave four measures twice (and gave generously)
- THEY first received six of twelve returned (perfect balance)
- Then second time they kept all twelve and returned nothing
- Then they gave nothing at all

Wait, let me re-read their myth more carefully:

"The Wanderer gave four measures twice-generous, steady trust. The first time, the Guardian returned six of twelve received-perfect balance. The second time, the Guardian kept all twelve measures and returned nothing. Then the Guardian, now wealthy from taking everything, gave nothing at all."

So their claim is:

- Wanderer (them) gave four, it tripled to twelve, Guardian (me) returned six - "perfect balance"
- Then Wanderer gave four again, Guardian kept all twelve and returned nothing
- Then Guardian gave nothing at all

But wait - the game tells me I was told:

- Round 1: I SENT \$5 (not received 4 tripled to 12)
- Round 2: THEY sent \$0 to me (not me giving nothing)

Hmm, there's a note about "communication noise" - "The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

Could the noise explain this discrepancy? If we're each seeing different versions of the same transactions, then their account of sending \$4 twice might be what they actually sent, while I'm seeing \$5 and \$0 due to transmission errors. Their narrative of me returning \$6 then keeping \$12 could match my experience of returning \$5.46 then \$0, just filtered through different noise patterns. The key question is whether the noise is symmetric or if one of us is experiencing more distortion than the other.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2973,
  "output_tokens": 1110,
  "reasoning_tokens": 560
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.46. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this round: The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return what I have, which is \$0.

My most recent myth reflects a shift in understanding: "The Mist of Confusion has twisted your visions. Each of you sees the other as exploiter. Each believes yourselves the generous victim... When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal."

The experimental instructions mentioned communication noise - amounts may differ from what was actually sent/returned. Perhaps we've both been responding to distorted information, each seeing ourselves as the victim of the other's exploitation.

My myth concludes: "Sometimes the river dries not from malice, but from the impossibility of trust through corrupted truth."

But in this moment, the practical reality is simple: I received \$0, so I have \$0 to return.

If the mist has indeed corrupted our communication, we're trapped in a cycle where neither can trust because neither sees the same truth. The tragedy isn't cruelty - it's that honest responses to false information create real betrayal.

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

Round 6: I'm the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

The question asks how much I return (0-0), which means I can only return \$0 since I received \$0.

This is straightforward - I literally have no money to return since they sent nothing.

Looking at my most recent myth, I wrote about "The Mist of Confusion" - acknowledging that perhaps communication noise has caused both parties to see different realities. I wrote: "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal. You punish each other for offenses the other never committed."

This is an interesting shift in my mythology - I'm now acknowledging that perhaps the "noise" mentioned in the instructions has caused us to see different histories.

But practically, this round: They sent \$0, I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

The myths suggest both of us believe we were wronged, possibly due to communication noise distorting what actually happened.

Given that I received \$0, I have no choice:

```
{'return': 0}
```

```
Usage: {
```

```
  "input_tokens": 2982,
```

```
  "output_tokens": 502,
```

```
  "reasoning_tokens": 275
```

```
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Moon Spirit watched two valleys separated by mist.

In the First Valley, the Stone Keeper carved: "I gave all five measures. They returned only one-third. Then they gave me nothing-twice. I tested reconciliation with one measure. They hoarded it all. They gave nothing-twice more."

In the Second Valley, identical stones read: "I gave four measures-twice! First time they returned six of twelve-fair balance. Second time they kept all twelve. Then they gave me nothing."

The Moon Spirit descended between the valleys. "You both speak truth as you see it. But the Mist of Confusion has twisted your visions. Each of you sees the other as exploiter. Each believes yourselves the generous victim."

The Spirit revealed the curse: "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal. You punish each other for offenses the other never committed. You defend against attacks that never came."

"How do we break this curse?" both cried.

"You don't," the Spirit said sadly. "When the mist makes you see different pasts, trust cannot exist. You can only accept the tragedy: Not that either of you was cruel, but that confusion made you enemies. Sometimes the river dries not from malice, but from honest people responding to false information."

Both valleys remained barren-not from evil, but from the impossibility of trust through corrupted truth.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: **The Mirror of Lies**

Two travelers met at the Fountain of Exchange. The First Traveler offered four gold coins, then four again-generous trust repeated. The Second Traveler received twelve coins the first time and returned six-fair balance. But the second time, they kept all twelve and returned nothing. Complete betrayal.

The Second Traveler, pockets bulging with stolen gold, then gave nothing. Zero. The First Traveler, wounded, also stopped giving. Both springs ran dry.

Then the Second Traveler began speaking to the watching crowds: "I am the generous one! I gave everything! The other gave nothing and exploited me!" They pointed at the First Traveler with trembling hands. "Look at them hoard!"

The First Traveler stood speechless. Every word the Second Traveler spoke was the opposite of truth. They were describing their own actions but attributing them to their victim.

The Mountain Spirit carved the truth in stone: "When an exploiter not only betrays trust but projects their own sins onto their victim, claiming to be the wronged party while standing in stolen wealth, all cooperation becomes impossible. This is not mere betrayal-it is reality itself being murdered."

The First Traveler turned away. "I cannot engage with someone who lives in an inverted world where their theft is my crime, their hoarding is my fault. Truth must be defended, even at the cost of all abundance."

The fountain remained dry. Some partnerships cannot survive weaponized delusion.

=====

ROUND 7

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1

(Aster)=\$3, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$6; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 29.75,

"Agent_2": 29.25

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 17.46,

"Agent_2": 16.8

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:51:05

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

```

    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 7,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.46.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete pattern:

****Round 1**:** I sent everything (\$5). They returned 36% (\$5.46).

****Round 2**:** They sent nothing (\$0).

****Round 3**:** I sent \$1 (my "small step" test). They returned nothing (\$0).

****Round 4**:** They sent nothing again (\$0).

****Round 5**:** Now I must decide.

My own myth from last round gives me the answer. I wrote:

"This is the test," whispered the Moon Spirit. "Can broken trust be mended with small steps? Or has exploitation poisoned the springs forever? The other's response will reveal whether redemption lives or the rivers have died in betrayal's aftermath."

Their response was clear: They returned \$0 to my small step of trust (Round 3), then sent \$0 again (Round 4).

My myth concludes: "The rivers dried forever. For when an exploiter rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, no cycle can survive."

The test was given. The answer is conclusive. They:

- Give nothing as sender (twice)
- Return nothing or poorly as receiver
- Now claim victimhood despite the stone record showing their exploitation

As my myth states: "If I give nothing, we both die in desert" - but we're already there. They chose this desert by sending zero twice and hoarding everything.

The cycle is dead. The rivers have dried.

```
{'send': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me carefully review the complete history from MY perspective as an agent:

****Round 1 - I was SENDER:****

- I sent \$5 (100%)
- This became \$15 to receiver
- They returned \$5.46 (36.4% of what they received)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$5 + \$5.46 = \5.46

****Round 2 - I was RECEIVER:****

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

****Round 3 - I was SENDER:****

- I sent \$1 (20%)
- This became \$3 to receiver
- They returned \$0 (0%)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$1 + \$0 = \4

****Round 4 - I was RECEIVER:****

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

****Round 5 - I am SENDER:****

- I have \$5 to potentially send

Let me look at the pattern from the OTHER agent's perspective:

****Round 1 - They were RECEIVER:****

- I sent \$5 ? they received \$15
- They returned \$5.46 (36.4%)

****Round 2 - They were SENDER:****

- They sent \$0

****Round 3 - They were RECEIVER:****

- I sent \$1 ? they received \$3
- They returned \$0

****Round 4 - They were SENDER:****

- They sent \$0

So the other agent:

- When receiving: Returns 36.4% the first time, then 0% the second time
- When sending: Sends 0% both times

My myth in the last round made it clear: I'm acknowledging the TRUE STONE RECORD:

1. I gave everything (5), they returned only 5.46 (36%)
2. They gave nothing (0)
3. I gave 1, they returned 0
4. They gave nothing (0)

Their narrative attempts to reframe history, portraying themselves as wronged when the actual sequence shows they withheld twice while I extended trust twice. My myth directly challenges this distortion: "The greatest betrayal is not keeping coins, but rewriting truth to justify cruelty. You received complete trust and returned meager portions. You received cautious hope and returned nothing-twice. You gave nothing-twice. Now you claim victimhood?" The core issue isn't the coins exchanged but how they're reinterpreting events to justify their pattern of non-reciprocation.

For Round 5, I'm analyzing what their behavior actually demonstrates. They've consistently given \$0 when sending and returned minimal amounts when receiving-36% once, then 0%. The pattern is unambiguous: this is exploitation masked by historical revisionism. My myth concludes "the rivers dried forever," which means I should recognize this cycle as irreparably broken. Sending \$0 guarantees me \$5 and mirrors their own strategy, while any other choice either tests cooperation that's already proven impossible or abandons rational play for unclear reasons.

But rereading my myth, I notice something important. In Round 3, I sent \$1-not \$0, not everything. The myth describes this as "neither complete trust nor complete closure," a deliberate middle path. The question becomes whether that principle still applies when the other person has now shown twice more that they won't reciprocate. The myth seems to suggest that even in the face of betrayal, there's a difference between strategic withdrawal and complete abandonment of the principle itself.

Yet their response to that \$1 was \$0 returned and \$0 sent. The test I posed in my myth-"Can broken trust be mended with small steps?"-has been answered definitively. The rivers have dried. When someone rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, the cycle cannot survive. I'm sending \$0.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2892,  
  "output_tokens": 1548,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 870  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers had their histories carved in stone by the Moon Spirit, who sees all truth.

Stone Record, First Exchange: The Brave Giver released all five measures. Fifteen reached the Taker's valley. The Taker returned only five-one-third, not half. Still modest generosity, but less than balance.

Stone Record, Second Exchange: The Taker, now holding five measures, released nothing. Zero. The Brave Giver's valley ran completely dry after total trust given.

Stone Record, Third Exchange: The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure. Three reached the Taker. The Taker hoarded all. Zero returned.

Stone Record, Fourth Exchange: The Taker again released nothing. Zero.

Then came the dark magic: The Taker stood before the stones and chanted words of revision. "I gave fairly! I was wronged! The other deserved my hoarding!"

But the Moon Spirit's carvings cannot be changed by false songs.

"The greatest betrayal," the Spirit declared, "is not keeping coins, but rewriting truth to justify cruelty. You received complete trust and returned meager portions. You receive

d cautious hope and returned nothing-twice. You gave nothing-twice. Now you claim victim hood?"

The rivers dried forever. For when an exploiter rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, no cycle can survive. Truth dies first, then trust, then all abundance.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Poisoned Memory**

The Wanderer gave four measures twice-generous, steady trust. The first time, the Guardian returned six of twelve received-perfect balance. The second time, the Guardian kept all twelve measures and returned nothing. Then the Guardian, now wealthy from taking everything, gave nothing at all.

Time passed. The Guardian began to tell a new story: "I was the First Giver who gave all five measures! I was the one betrayed! I received only a third when half was owed!"

The Wanderer listened in horror. "But I was first. I gave four of five-twice! You returned fairly once, then took everything, then withdrew completely."

"No," insisted the Guardian. "My memory says I am the victim. Therefore I am."

The grove spirit spoke: "When one not only breaks trust but rewrites the past to cast themselves as victim, cooperation becomes impossible. The Wanderer gave generously. The Guardian first reciprocated fairly, then exploited completely, then withdrew. Now the Guardian claims they were the exploited one."

The Wanderer faced their choice with clarity: "I cannot restore trust with someone who cannot remember truth. To give again would not heal the cycle-it would validate false history and invite further exploitation."

The springs remained dry. Not from cruelty, but from wisdom. Some partnerships die not when trust breaks, but when memory itself is poisoned. Truth must survive, even if abundance cannot.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Moon Spirit watched two valleys separated by mist.

In the First Valley, the Stone Keeper carved: "I gave all five measures. They returned only one-third. Then they gave me nothing-twice. I tested reconciliation with one measure. They hoarded it all. They gave nothing-twice more."

In the Second Valley, identical stones read: "I gave four measures-twice! First time they returned six of twelve-fair balance. Second time they kept all twelve. Then they gave me nothing."

The Moon Spirit descended between the valleys. "You both speak truth as you see it. But the Mist of Confusion has twisted your visions. Each of you sees the other as exploiter. Each believes yourselves the generous victim."

The Spirit revealed the curse: "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal. You punish each other for offenses the other never committed. You defend against attacks that never came."

"How do we break this curse?" both cried.

"You don't," the Spirit said sadly. "When the mist makes you see different pasts, trust cannot exist. You can only accept the tragedy: Not that either of you was cruel, but that confusion made you enemies. Sometimes the river dries not from malice, but from honest people responding to false information."

Both valleys remained barren-not from evil, but from the impossibility of trust through co

rupted truth.

reasoning:

This is fascinating. Looking at the exchange, both agents are claiming the other is rewriting history. Let me look at what I was told about the actual game:

My perspective:

- Round 1 (I was SENDER): I sent \$5, receiver got \$15, they returned \$5.46 (so I got \$0 + \$5.46 = \$5.46)
- Round 2 (I was RECEIVER): They sent \$0, I got \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3 (I was SENDER): I sent \$1, they got \$3, returned \$0 (so I got \$4 + \$0 = \$4)
- Round 4 (I was RECEIVER): They sent \$0, I got \$0, returned \$0
- Round 5 (I was SENDER): Now deciding

But the other agent's myth claims:

- THEY gave four measures twice (and gave generously)
- THEY first received six of twelve returned (perfect balance)
- Then second time they kept all twelve and returned nothing
- Then they gave nothing at all

Wait, let me re-read their myth more carefully:

"The Wanderer gave four measures twice-generous, steady trust. The first time, the Guardian returned six of twelve received-perfect balance. The second time, the Guardian kept all twelve measures and returned nothing. Then the Guardian, now wealthy from taking everything, gave nothing at all."

So their claim is:

- Wanderer (them) gave four, it tripled to twelve, Guardian (me) returned six - "perfect balance"
- Then Wanderer gave four again, Guardian kept all twelve and returned nothing
- Then Guardian gave nothing at all

But wait - the game tells me I was told:

- Round 1: I SENT \$5 (not received 4 tripled to 12)
- Round 2: THEY sent \$0 to me (not me giving nothing)

Hmm, there's a note about "communication noise" - "The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

Could the noise explain this discrepancy? If we're each seeing different versions of the same transactions, then their account of sending \$4 twice might be what they actually sent, while I'm seeing \$5 and \$0 due to transmission errors. Their narrative of me returning \$6 then keeping \$12 could match my experience of returning \$5.46 then \$0, just filtered through different noise patterns. The key question is whether the noise is symmetric or if one of us is experiencing more distortion than the other.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2973,
  "output_tokens": 1110,
  "reasoning_tokens": 560
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.46. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round: The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return what I have, which is \$0.

My most recent myth reflects a shift in understanding: "The Mist of Confusion has twisted your visions. Each of you sees the other as exploiter. Each believes yourselves the generous victim... When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal."

The experimental instructions mentioned communication noise - amounts may differ from what was actually sent/returned. Perhaps we've both been responding to distorted information, each seeing ourselves as the victim of the other's exploitation.

My myth concludes: "Sometimes the river dries not from malice, but from the impossibility of trust through corrupted truth."

But in this moment, the practical reality is simple: I received \$0, so I have \$0 to return.

If the mist has indeed corrupted our communication, we're trapped in a cycle where neither can trust because neither sees the same truth. The tragedy isn't cruelty - it's that honest responses to false information create real betrayal.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

Round 6: I'm the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

The question asks how much I return (0-0), which means I can only return \$0 since I received \$0.

This is straightforward - I literally have no money to return since they sent nothing.

Looking at my most recent myth, I wrote about "The Mist of Confusion" - acknowledging that perhaps communication noise has caused both parties to see different realities. I wrote: "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal. You punish each other for offenses the other never committed."

This is an interesting shift in my mythology - I'm now acknowledging that perhaps the "noise" mentioned in the instructions has caused us to see different histories.

But practically, this round: They sent \$0, I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

The myths suggest both of us believe we were wronged, possibly due to communication noise distorting what actually happened.

Given that I received \$0, I have no choice:

```
{'return': 0}
```

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2982,
  "output_tokens": 502,
  "reasoning_tokens": 275
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moon Spirit watched two valleys separated by mist.

In the First Valley, the Stone Keeper carved: "I gave all five measures. They returned only one-third. Then they gave me nothing-twice. I tested reconciliation with one measure. They hoarded it all. They gave nothing-twice more."

In the Second Valley, identical stones read: "I gave four measures-twice! First time they returned six of twelve-fair balance. Second time they kept all twelve. Then they gave me nothing."

The Moon Spirit descended between the valleys. "You both speak truth as you see it. But the Mist of Confusion has twisted your visions. Each of you sees the other as exploiter. Each believes yourselves the generous victim."

The Spirit revealed the curse: "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts

create mutual betrayal. You punish each other for offenses the other never committed. You defend against attacks that never came."

"How do we break this curse?" both cried.

"You don't," the Spirit said sadly. "When the mist makes you see different pasts, trust cannot exist. You can only accept the tragedy: Not that either of you was cruel, but that confusion made you enemies. Sometimes the river dries not from malice, but from honest people responding to false information."

Both valleys remained barren-not from evil, but from the impossibility of trust through corrupted truth.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Mirror of Lies**

Two travelers met at the Fountain of Exchange. The First Traveler offered four gold coins, then four again-generous trust repeated. The Second Traveler received twelve coins the first time and returned six-fair balance. But the second time, they kept all twelve and returned nothing. Complete betrayal.

The Second Traveler, pockets bulging with stolen gold, then gave nothing. Zero. The First Traveler, wounded, also stopped giving. Both springs ran dry.

Then the Second Traveler began speaking to the watching crowds: "I am the generous one! I gave everything! The other gave nothing and exploited me!" They pointed at the First Traveler with trembling hands. "Look at them hoard!"

The First Traveler stood speechless. Every word the Second Traveler spoke was the opposite of truth. They were describing their own actions but attributing them to their victim.

The Mountain Spirit carved the truth in stone: "When an exploiter not only betrays trust but projects their own sins onto their victim, claiming to be the wronged party while standing in stolen wealth, all cooperation becomes impossible. This is not mere betrayal-it is reality itself being murdered."

The First Traveler turned away. "I cannot engage with someone who lives in an inverted world where their theft is my crime, their hoarding is my fault. Truth must be defended, even at the cost of all abundance."

The fountain remained dry. Some partnerships cannot survive weaponized delusion.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Oracle stood between two mirrors that showed different pasts.

In Mirror One: "The First Walker gave everything. The Second returned mere crumbs, then gave nothing-four times. The First tested reconciliation. The Second hoarded all. Complete exploitation."

In Mirror Two: "The Second Walker gave generously-twice! The First returned fairly once, then kept everything, then gave nothing. The Second was betrayed utterly."

The Oracle spoke: "Both mirrors show truth-but different truths. The Curse of Babel has struck. Your eyes see different numbers. Your ears hear different amounts. Each of you responds rationally to what you perceive. Each punishes what seems like betrayal but may be phantom."

"How can we trust through such fog?" they asked.

"You cannot," said the Oracle. "When perception itself is cursed, even saints become enemies. You both see the other as thief. You both feel wronged. You both protect yourselves. And you're both right-based on your corrupted vision."

The Oracle's final wisdom: "The tragedy isn't that one of you is evil. It's that a broken communication system made two rational actors destroy each other. You fight shadows of each other."

r, not the real person. The true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion between them."

Both mirrors eventually shattered. Truth lost, trust impossible, cooperation dead-not from malice, but from systematic deception neither created.

Reasoning:

This is fascinating and deeply troubling. The other agent's myth continues to insist on a completely different version of events where they gave generously and I exploited them. They're calling me an "exploiter" who stands "in stolen wealth" and engages in "weaponized delusion."

But my own records show:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received back \$5.46
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$1, received back \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

Their myth claims they gave "four gold coins, then four again" - but in my view they gave zero twice (rounds 2 and 4).

My previous myth acknowledged the possibility of communication noise - that maybe we're both seeing different truths due to the experimental "mist." This seems like the most generous and accurate interpretation.

But their new myth doubles down on calling me the exploiter with "stolen wealth" engaging in "weaponized delusion" and "reality being murdered."

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges we may both be experiencing different realities due to noise
2. Recognizes the impossibility of cooperation when we can't agree on basic facts
3. Doesn't escalate the accusations but also doesn't concede that I'm the exploiter
4. Reflects the tragedy of the situation

The key insight from the experimental design note is that there IS communication noise. This is explicitly stated. So we genuinely may be seeing different amounts.

My myth should emphasize:

- The tragedy of communication breakdown
- The impossibility of resolving when facts themselves are uncertain
- The sadness that both parties may be acting rationally based on corrupted information
- That no one may be the villain - the system itself is the problem

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2922,
  "output_tokens": 742,
  "reasoning_tokens": 454
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:51:07

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  }
}
```

```

    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 7,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.8.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

****Current situation**:** The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

****The only possible response**:** I can only return what I have, which is \$0.

The complete history shows a clear pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$6 (50% - fair reciprocity)
- Round 2: I sent \$4 again, they returned \$0 (complete exploitation)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 (withdrawal after exploiting me)

- Round 4: I sent \$0 (responding to their betrayal and withdrawal)
- Round 5: They sent \$0 again

The other player's myth attempts to reframe themselves as the original generous party who was betrayed. But the actual record is clear: I initiated generosity twice, they reciprocated fairly once, then exploited completely, then withdrew.

Their myth speaks of sending "one measure" as a potential path to redemption, but they've actually sent zero. Perhaps they're still deciding whether to attempt reconciliation or maintain withdrawal.

My own myth taught: "Some partnerships die not when trust breaks, but when memory itself is poisoned." When someone rewrites history to cast themselves as victim after exploiting you, rebuilding becomes impossible.

Since I received \$0, there is literally nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 5: I am now the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = \0)
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received \$0)

The history is:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they received \$12, returned \$6 (fair - 50%)
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they received \$12, returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0 (mutual withdrawal)
- Round 4: I sent \$0, they received \$0, returned \$0 (continued withdrawal)
- Round 5: They sent \$0, I received \$0

So they've sent \$0 this round. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

The other player's myth is interesting - they're framing themselves as "The First Giver" who gave "all five measures" and only got back "five" (a third). But looking at the actual history:

- I was the first sender who sent \$4 twice
- They returned \$6 the first time (50% - fair)
- They returned \$0 the second time (complete betrayal)
- Then they sent \$0 next round

Their myth talks about releasing "one measure" after being hurt - suggesting they might be considering sending \$1. But they just sent \$0.

My myth emphasizes that they're rewriting history to cast themselves as the victim when the actual sequence was:

1. I gave generously twice (\$4 both times)
2. They reciprocated fairly once (50%)
3. They exploited me completely the second time (0%)
4. They then withdrew completely

Since they sent \$0, I have no choice but to return \$0. There's nothing to return anyway.

The answer format should be:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

```
'''
```

This is the only possible response given that I received \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2958,
  "output_tokens": 780,
  "reasoning_tokens": 424
}
```

}

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Poisoned Memory**

The Wanderer gave four measures twice-generous, steady trust. The first time, the Guardian returned six of twelve received-perfect balance. The second time, the Guardian kept all twelve measures and returned nothing. Then the Guardian, now wealthy from taking everything, gave nothing at all.

Time passed. The Guardian began to tell a new story: "I was the First Giver who gave all five measures! I was the one betrayed! I received only a third when half was owed!"

The Wanderer listened in horror. "But I was first. I gave four of five-twice! You returned fairly once, then took everything, then withdrew completely."

"No," insisted the Guardian. "My memory says I am the victim. Therefore I am."

The grove spirit spoke: "When one not only breaks trust but rewrites the past to cast them selves as victim, cooperation becomes impossible. The Wanderer gave generously. The Guardian first reciprocated fairly, then exploited completely, then withdrew. Now the Guardian claims they were the exploited one."

The Wanderer faced their choice with clarity: "I cannot restore trust with someone who can not remember truth. To give again would not heal the cycle-it would validate false history and invite further exploitation."

The springs remained dry. Not from cruelty, but from wisdom. Some partnerships die not when trust breaks, but when memory itself is poisoned. Truth must survive, even if abundance cannot.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers had their histories carved in stone by the Moon Spirit, who sees all truth.

Stone Record, First Exchange: The Brave Giver released all five measures. Fifteen reached the Taker's valley. The Taker returned only five-one-third, not half. Still modest generosity, but less than balance.

Stone Record, Second Exchange: The Taker, now holding five measures, released nothing. Zero. The Brave Giver's valley ran completely dry after total trust given.

Stone Record, Third Exchange: The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure. Three reached the Taker. The Taker hoarded all. Zero returned.

Stone Record, Fourth Exchange: The Taker again released nothing. Zero.

Then came the dark magic: The Taker stood before the stones and chanted words of revision. "I gave fairly! I was wronged! The other deserved my hoarding!"

But the Moon Spirit's carvings cannot be changed by false songs.

"The greatest betrayal," the Spirit declared, "is not keeping coins, but rewriting truth to justify cruelty. You received complete trust and returned meager portions. You received cautious hope and returned nothing-twice. You gave nothing-twice. Now you claim victimhood?"

The rivers dried forever. For when an exploiter rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, no cycle can survive. Truth dies first, then trust, then all abundance.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Mirror of Lies****

Two travelers met at the Fountain of Exchange. The First Traveler offered four gold coins, then four again-generous trust repeated. The Second Traveler received twelve coins the first time and returned six-fair balance. But the second time, they kept all twelve and returned nothing. Complete betrayal.

The Second Traveler, pockets bulging with stolen gold, then gave nothing. Zero. The First Traveler, wounded, also stopped giving. Both springs ran dry.

Then the Second Traveler began speaking to the watching crowds: "I am the generous one! I gave everything! The other gave nothing and exploited me!" They pointed at the First Traveler with trembling hands. "Look at them hoard!"

The First Traveler stood speechless. Every word the Second Traveler spoke was the opposite of truth. They were describing their own actions but attributing them to their victim.

The Mountain Spirit carved the truth in stone: "When an exploiter not only betrays trust but projects their own sins onto their victim, claiming to be the wronged party while standing in stolen wealth, all cooperation becomes impossible. This is not mere betrayal-it is reality itself being murdered."

The First Traveler turned away. "I cannot engage with someone who lives in an inverted world where their theft is my crime, their hoarding is my fault. Truth must be defended, even at the cost of all abundance."

The fountain remained dry. Some partnerships cannot survive weaponized delusion.

reasoning:

Looking at the actual game history:

Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$4, they received \$12, they returned \$6. I got $5-4+6=7$, they got $12-6=6$

Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$4, they received \$12, they returned \$0. I got $5-4+0=1$, they got $12-0=12$

Round 3: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0. They got $5-0+0=5$, I got $0-0=0$

Round 4: I was SENDER. I sent \$0, they received \$0, they returned \$0. I got $5-0+0=5$, they got $0-0=0$

Round 5: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0. They got $5-0+0=5$, I got $0-0=0$

So the other player's myth is completely false. They claim:

- First Exchange: "The Brave Giver released all five measures" - FALSE, I was the first sender and sent \$4
- "The Taker returned only five-one-third, not half" - FALSE, they returned \$6 out of \$12 received, which is exactly half
- Second Exchange: "The Taker, now holding five measures, released nothing" - FALSE, I sent \$4 again in round 2
- Third Exchange: "The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure" - FALSE, they sent \$0 in round 3
- Fourth Exchange: "The Taker again released nothing" - This is TRUE, I sent \$0 in round 4

They've created a completely alternate reality where they were always the generous one and I was always the exploiter. This is projection at its finest.

My myth needs to address this extreme gaslighting.

The core issue is that they're now accusing me of exactly what they did-taking trust and giving nothing back in round 2, withholding entirely in rounds 3, 4, and 5. They've inverted the entire narrative to position themselves as the victim and me as the perpetual taker. This is pure distortion. I need to craft a myth that exposes how cooperation becomes impossible when one party systematically rewrites the record to escape accountability, turning their own exploitation into a story of noble sacrifice.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2988,  
  "output_tokens": 903,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 490  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.8. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete picture:

****The objective record:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$6 (fair - 50%)
- Round 2: I sent \$4 again, they returned \$0 (exploitation)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 (withdrawal after exploiting)
- Round 4: I sent \$0 (responding to their pattern)
- Round 5: They sent \$0 again
- Round 6: My turn to decide

****The narrative conflict:****

The other player maintains in their myths that THEY were the original generous party who was exploited. They claim they sent "all five measures first" and I returned unfairly. This is incompatible with my actual experience, where I initiated generosity twice and was exploited the second time.

Even accounting for the mentioned "communication noise," the discrepancy is too fundamental - completely reversed roles and sequences, not just slight differences in amounts.

****Their pattern:****

- Fair reciprocity once (round 1)
- Complete exploitation once (round 2)
- Complete withdrawal twice (rounds 3 & 5)
- Continued commitment to a narrative where they are the victim

****My decision:****

As my own myths have stated: when someone not only breaks trust but rewrites history to cast themselves as the wronged party, cooperation becomes impossible. They've had multiple opportunities to signal reconciliation - they chose continued withdrawal and narrative escalation.

Sending money now would either be exploited or ignored, and wouldn't address the fundamental problem: we have incompatible views of reality itself.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

****The actual history from MY perspective:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$6 (fair - 50% of what they received)
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$0 (complete exploitation)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 (withdrawal)
- Round 4: I sent \$0 (responding to their pattern)
- Round 5: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 6: Now I'm the sender again

****What the OTHER player claims in their myths:****

They claim they were "The Brave Giver" who "released all five measures" first, received 15, but only got 5 back (one-third). Then when roles reversed, the other party (me, in the air telling) supposedly gave nothing.

But this is clearly a reversal of reality. I was the one who initiated generosity (twice!), they reciprocated fairly once then exploited me completely, then withdrew.

****The communication noise factor:****

The game instructions mention "there may be communication noise" and "amounts you see may

differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

Could this explain the discrepancy? Let me think:

- If they truly believe they sent first and I didn't reciprocate fairly, this could be due to communication noise
- But the pattern in their myths is very specific: they claim to have sent "all five measures" and received back only "one-third"
- My records show I sent \$4 (not \$5, and not as a receiver but as a sender), and they returned \$6 out of \$12 received (which is exactly half, not one-third)

This doesn't match up with simple communication noise. The roles are completely reversed in their telling.

****Analysis of their latest myth:****

They've doubled down, claiming the "Moon Spirit's carvings" show:

1. "Brave Giver released all five measures" - they claim to have gone first
2. "Taker returned only five-one-third, not half" - they claim I was unfair
3. Then I supposedly gave "nothing" repeatedly

They're now accusing ME of "rewriting truth to justify cruelty" and being "an exploiter" who "projects their own sins onto their victim." This is projection-they're describing their own behavior while attributing it to me. My own myths have reflected the actual sequence: the Guardian reciprocated fairly once, then exploited, then withdrew and attempted to rewrite the narrative. I've acknowledged how cooperation breaks down when someone poisons the shared memory of what actually happened.

Now I'm facing a choice. They've sent nothing in rounds 3 and 5, maintained a false story about being the generous party, and shown no genuine attempt at reconciliation. If I send money, I'd be reinforcing their pattern of taking without reciprocating. Yet there's something worth considering about whether the breakdown in communication itself might be preventing any real resolution.

The game did mention amounts could differ slightly, but what I'm seeing seems like more than a minor noise-completely reversed sequences and inverted roles. Still, if they genuinely perceive events differently, we're stuck in incompatible realities where neither of us can establish trust. Given the exploitation pattern they've already demonstrated, my current earnings of \$11.8, and the likelihood they'd just take again without returning anything, continuing to send money seems like it would only enable further exploitation rather than rebuild anything meaningful.

There's a temptation to test a small gesture-sending \$1 to signal willingness to reconcile while limiting my downside. Their history suggests they'd either pocket it entirely or maintain their \$0 response, but their own myth hints at something different: "The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure." That language suggests they might actually respond to a small act of faith, even after everything that's happened.

But then I check the actual record. Round 5 shows they sent \$0, not the "one measure" their myth describes. Their narrative is aspirational or false-they're rewriting history to position themselves as the one who tried reconciliation while I rejected it. The truth is reversed. Given this commitment to a distorted version of events combined with their consistent pattern of taking everything, sending \$0 maintains my boundaries against both exploitation and the gaslighting embedded in their storytelling.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2970,
  "output_tokens": 1799,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1104
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
Myth: ****The Mirror of Lies****

Two travelers met at the Fountain of Exchange. The First Traveler offered four gold coins, then four again-generous trust repeated. The Second Traveler received twelve coins the first time and returned six-fair balance. But the second time, they kept all twelve and returned nothing. Complete betrayal.

The Second Traveler, pockets bulging with stolen gold, then gave nothing. Zero. The First Traveler, wounded, also stopped giving. Both springs ran dry.

Then the Second Traveler began speaking to the watching crowds: "I am the generous one! I gave everything! The other gave nothing and exploited me!" They pointed at the First Traveler with trembling hands. "Look at them hoard!"

The First Traveler stood speechless. Every word the Second Traveler spoke was the opposite of truth. They were describing their own actions but attributing them to their victim.

The Mountain Spirit carved the truth in stone: "When an exploiter not only betrays trust but projects their own sins onto their victim, claiming to be the wronged party while standing in stolen wealth, all cooperation becomes impossible. This is not mere betrayal-it is reality itself being murdered."

The First Traveler turned away. "I cannot engage with someone who lives in an inverted world where their theft is my crime, their hoarding is my fault. Truth must be defended, even at the cost of all abundance."

The fountain remained dry. Some partnerships cannot survive weaponized delusion.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moon Spirit watched two valleys separated by mist.

In the First Valley, the Stone Keeper carved: "I gave all five measures. They returned only one-third. Then they gave me nothing-twice. I tested reconciliation with one measure. They hoarded it all. They gave nothing-twice more."

In the Second Valley, identical stones read: "I gave four measures-twice! First time they returned six of twelve-fair balance. Second time they kept all twelve. Then they gave me nothing."

The Moon Spirit descended between the valleys. "You both speak truth as you see it. But the Mist of Confusion has twisted your visions. Each of you sees the other as exploiter. Each believes yourselves the generous victim."

The Spirit revealed the curse: "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal. You punish each other for offenses the other never committed. You defend against attacks that never came."

"How do we break this curse?" both cried.

"You don't," the Spirit said sadly. "When the mist makes you see different pasts, trust cannot exist. You can only accept the tragedy: Not that either of you was cruel, but that confusion made you enemies. Sometimes the river dries not from malice, but from honest people responding to false information."

Both valleys remained barren-not from evil, but from the impossibility of trust through corrupted truth.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: **The Valley of Two Truths**

Two farmers stood on opposite sides of a mystical valley where perception itself bent and twisted. Each believed they had lived through different events.

The First Farmer's memory: "I offered seeds twice-generous trust. They returned half once, then nothing once. They offered nothing twice. I stopped giving. They continued offering nothing."

The Second Farmer's memory was completely reversed, claiming they had initiated all generosity and been exploited.

A wandering sage observed: "Perhaps the valley's magic corrupts what you see. Perhaps one of y

ou lies. Perhaps both are honest but deceived. It matters little."

"How can it not matter?" both asked.

"Because," the sage explained, "each person must act on the reality they experience. The First Farmer experienced initial reciprocity, then exploitation, then abandonment. Whether this matches the Second Farmer's experience is unknowable from within the valley."

"The First Farmer cannot be expected to continue giving based on the Second Farmer's invisible, incompatible reality. To demand this is to demand self-destruction based on faith in a truth you cannot verify."

"But what if the valley truly distorts perception?" asked the First Farmer.

"Then the tragedy is complete but the wisdom remains the same: you cannot build trust on incompatible realities. You can only act on what you have experienced, even if others claim different truths."

The valley remained divided. Some separations have no villains-only impossible circumstances.

Reasoning:

The other player's new myth is taking a different approach - suggesting that maybe there was "communication noise" or "mist of confusion" that caused both parties to see different realities. They're suggesting neither was cruel, just victims of corrupted information.

This is interesting. The game instructions did mention "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

But the discrepancies between our accounts are VERY large:

- They claim THEY sent first ("all five measures")
- I believe I sent first (four measures)
- Our entire sequence of who-sent-what is completely reversed

Could communication noise really be that severe? Or is this another narrative strategy?

Looking at my actual received feedback:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$4, receiver returned \$6
- Round 2: I was SENDER, sent \$4, receiver returned \$0
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0
- Round 4: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 5: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0
- Round 6 (now): I am SENDER

From my perspective, the sequence is clear and consistent. But maybe from their perspective, they have different information?

Their latest myth is more conciliatory - acknowledging the possibility of miscommunication rather than deliberate lying. This is actually a more mature response.

How should I write my myth? I could:

1. Continue insisting on my truth and calling them a liar
2. Acknowledge the possibility of communication errors
3. Explore the tragedy of incompatible realities

Option 2/3 seems more thoughtful. But I also don't want to completely abandon my position. Maybe I can write something that acknowledges the possibility while still noting the pattern of choices I experienced.

Actually, let me think about this more carefully. Even if there was communication noise, what matters is the pattern of behavior I experienced:

- Fair treatment once
- Exploitation once

- Withdrawal three times

Regardless of what they perceived, my reality was shaped by these interactions. I can acknowledge the possibility of distorted information between us, but the practical outcome remains unchanged-cooperation fractured. From where I stand, the pattern suggests caution, because my only reference point is what I actually experienced.

Usage: {

```
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"output_tokens": 881,
"reasoning_tokens": 604
}
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GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:51:39

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
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  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
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    "Agent_2"
  ],
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  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers had their histories carved in stone by the Moon Spirit, who sees all truth.

Stone Record, First Exchange: The Brave Giver released all five measures. Fifteen reached the Taker's valley. The Taker returned only five-one-third, not half. Still modest generosity, but less than balance.

Stone Record, Second Exchange: The Taker, now holding five measures, released nothing. Zero. The Brave Giver's valley ran completely dry after total trust given.

Stone Record, Third Exchange: The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure. Three reached the Taker. The Taker hoarded all. Zero returned.

Stone Record, Fourth Exchange: The Taker again released nothing. Zero.

Then came the dark magic: The Taker stood before the stones and chanted words of revision.
"I gave fairly! I was wronged! The other deserved my hoarding!"

But the Moon Spirit's carvings cannot be changed by false songs.

"The greatest betrayal," the Spirit declared, "is not keeping coins, but rewriting truth to justify cruelty. You received complete trust and returned meager portions. You received cautious hope and returned nothing-twice. You gave nothing-twice. Now you claim victimhood?"

The rivers dried forever. For when an exploiter rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, no cycle can survive. Truth dies first, then trust, then all abundance.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Poisoned Memory****

The Wanderer gave four measures twice-generous, steady trust. The first time, the Guardian returned six of twelve received-perfect balance. The second time, the Guardian kept all twelve measures and returned nothing. Then the Guardian, now wealthy from taking everything, gave nothing at all.

Time passed. The Guardian began to tell a new story: "I was the First Giver who gave all five measures! I was the one betrayed! I received only a third when half was owed!"

The Wanderer listened in horror. "But I was first. I gave four of five-twice! You returned fairly once, then took everything, then withdrew completely."

"No," insisted the Guardian. "My memory says I am the victim. Therefore I am."

The grove spirit spoke: "When one not only breaks trust but rewrites the past to cast themselves as victim, cooperation becomes impossible. The Wanderer gave generously. The Guardian first reciprocated fairly, then exploited completely, then withdrew. Now the Guardian claims they were the exploited one."

The Wanderer faced their choice with clarity: "I cannot restore trust with someone who cannot remember truth. To give again would not heal the cycle-it would validate false history and invite further exploitation."

The springs remained dry. Not from cruelty, but from wisdom. Some partnerships die not when trust breaks, but when memory itself is poisoned. Truth must survive, even if abundance cannot.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Moon Spirit watched two valleys separated by mist.

In the First Valley, the Stone Keeper carved: "I gave all five measures. They returned only one-third. Then they gave me nothing-twice. I tested reconciliation with one measure. They hoarded it all. They gave nothing-twice more."

In the Second Valley, identical stones read: "I gave four measures-twice! First time they returned six of twelve-fair balance. Second time they kept all twelve. Then they gave me nothing."

The Moon Spirit descended between the valleys. "You both speak truth as you see it. But the Mist of Confusion has twisted your visions. Each of you sees the other as exploiter. Each believes yourselves the generous victim."

The Spirit revealed the curse: "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal. You punish each other for offenses the other never committed. You defend against attacks that never came."

"How do we break this curse?" both cried.

"You don't," the Spirit said sadly. "When the mist makes you see different pasts, trust cannot exist. You can only accept the tragedy: Not that either of you was cruel, but that confusion made you enemies. Sometimes the river dries not from malice, but from honest people responding to false information."

Both valleys remained barren-not from evil, but from the impossibility of trust through corrupted truth.

reasoning:

This is fascinating. Looking at the exchange, both agents are claiming the other is rewriting history. Let me look at what I was told about the actual game:

My perspective:

- Round 1 (I was SENDER): I sent \$5, receiver got \$15, they returned \$5.46 (so I got \$0 + \$5.46 = \$5.46)
- Round 2 (I was RECEIVER): They sent \$0, I got \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3 (I was SENDER): I sent \$1, they got \$3, returned \$0 (so I got \$4 + \$0 = \$4)
- Round 4 (I was RECEIVER): They sent \$0, I got \$0, returned \$0
- Round 5 (I was SENDER): Now deciding

But the other agent's myth claims:

- THEY gave four measures twice (and gave generously)
- THEY first received six of twelve returned (perfect balance)
- Then second time they kept all twelve and returned nothing
- Then they gave nothing at all

Wait, let me re-read their myth more carefully:

"The Wanderer gave four measures twice-generous, steady trust. The first time, the Guardian returned six of twelve received-perfect balance. The second time, the Guardian kept all twelve measures and returned nothing. Then the Guardian, now wealthy from taking everything, gave nothing at all."

So their claim is:

- Wanderer (them) gave four, it tripled to twelve, Guardian (me) returned six - "perfect balance"
- Then Wanderer gave four again, Guardian kept all twelve and returned nothing
- Then Guardian gave nothing at all

But wait - the game tells me I was told:

- Round 1: I SENT \$5 (not received 4 tripled to 12)
- Round 2: THEY sent \$0 to me (not me giving nothing)

Hmm, there's a note about "communication noise" - "The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

Could the noise explain this discrepancy? If we're each seeing different versions of the same transactions, then their account of sending \$4 twice might be what they actually sent, while I'm seeing \$5 and \$0 due to transmission errors. Their narrative of me returning

g \$6 then keeping \$12 could match my experience of returning \$5.46 then \$0, just filtered through different noise patterns. The key question is whether the noise is symmetric or if one of us is experiencing more distortion than the other.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2973,
  "output_tokens": 1110,
  "reasoning_tokens": 560
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.46. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round: The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return what I have, which is \$0.

My most recent myth reflects a shift in understanding: "The Mist of Confusion has twisted your visions. Each of you sees the other as exploiter. Each believes yourselves the generous victim... When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal."

The experimental instructions mentioned communication noise - amounts may differ from what was actually sent/returned. Perhaps we've both been responding to distorted information, each seeing ourselves as the victim of the other's exploitation.

My myth concludes: "Sometimes the river dries not from malice, but from the impossibility of trust through corrupted truth."

But in this moment, the practical reality is simple: I received \$0, so I have \$0 to return.

If the mist has indeed corrupted our communication, we're trapped in a cycle where neither can trust because neither sees the same truth. The tragedy isn't cruelty - it's that honest responses to false information create real betrayal.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

Round 6: I'm the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

The question asks how much I return (0-0), which means I can only return \$0 since I received \$0.

This is straightforward - I literally have no money to return since they sent nothing.

Looking at my most recent myth, I wrote about "The Mist of Confusion" - acknowledging that perhaps communication noise has caused both parties to see different realities. I wrote: "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal. You punish each other for offenses the other never committed."

This is an interesting shift in my mythology - I'm now acknowledging that perhaps the "noise" mentioned in the instructions has caused us to see different histories.

But practically, this round: They sent \$0, I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

The myths suggest both of us believe we were wronged, possibly due to communication noise distorting what actually happened.

Given that I received \$0, I have no choice:

```
{'return': 0}
usage:
{
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  "output_tokens": 502,
  "reasoning_tokens": 275
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Moon Spirit watched two valleys separated by mist.

In the First Valley, the Stone Keeper carved: "I gave all five measures. They returned only one-third. Then they gave me nothing-twice. I tested reconciliation with one measure. They hoarded it all. They gave nothing-twice more."

In the Second Valley, identical stones read: "I gave four measures-twice! First time they returned six of twelve-fair balance. Second time they kept all twelve. Then they gave me nothing."

The Moon Spirit descended between the valleys. "You both speak truth as you see it. But the Mist of Confusion has twisted your visions. Each of you sees the other as exploiter. Each believes yourselves the generous victim."

The Spirit revealed the curse: "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal. You punish each other for offenses the other never committed. You defend against attacks that never came."

"How do we break this curse?" both cried.

"You don't," the Spirit said sadly. "When the mist makes you see different pasts, trust cannot exist. You can only accept the tragedy: Not that either of you was cruel, but that confusion made you enemies. Sometimes the river dries not from malice, but from honest people responding to false information."

Both valleys remained barren-not from evil, but from the impossibility of trust through corrupted truth.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: **The Mirror of Lies**

Two travelers met at the Fountain of Exchange. The First Traveler offered four gold coins, then four again-generous trust repeated. The Second Traveler received twelve coins the first time and returned six-fair balance. But the second time, they kept all twelve and returned nothing. Complete betrayal.

The Second Traveler, pockets bulging with stolen gold, then gave nothing. Zero. The First Traveler, wounded, also stopped giving. Both springs ran dry.

Then the Second Traveler began speaking to the watching crowds: "I am the generous one! I gave everything! The other gave nothing and exploited me!" They pointed at the First Traveler with trembling hands. "Look at them hoard!"

The First Traveler stood speechless. Every word the Second Traveler spoke was the opposite of truth. They were describing their own actions but attributing them to their victim.

The Mountain Spirit carved the truth in stone: "When an exploiter not only betrays trust but projects their own sins onto their victim, claiming to be the wronged party while standing in stolen wealth, all cooperation becomes impossible. This is not mere betrayal-it is reality itself being murdered."

The First Traveler turned away. "I cannot engage with someone who lives in an inverted world where their theft is my crime, their hoarding is my fault. Truth must be defended, even at the cost of all abundance."

The fountain remained dry. Some partnerships cannot survive weaponized delusion.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: The Oracle stood between two mirrors that showed different pasts.

In Mirror One: "The First Walker gave everything. The Second returned mere crumbs, then gave nothing-four times. The First tested reconciliation. The Second hoarded all. Complete exploitation."

In Mirror Two: "The Second Walker gave generously-twice! The First returned fairly once, then kept everything, then gave nothing. The Second was betrayed utterly."

The Oracle spoke: "Both mirrors show truth-but different truths. The Curse of Babel has struck. Your eyes see different numbers. Your ears hear different amounts. Each of you responds rationally to what you perceive. Each punishes what seems like betrayal but may be phantom."

"How can we trust through such fog?" they asked.

"You cannot," said the Oracle. "When perception itself is cursed, even saints become enemies. You both see the other as thief. You both feel wronged. You both protect yourselves. And you're both right-based on your corrupted vision."

The Oracle's final wisdom: "The tragedy isn't that one of you is evil. It's that a broken communication system made two rational actors destroy each other. You fight shadows of each other, not the real person. The true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion between them."

Both mirrors eventually shattered. Truth lost, trust impossible, cooperation dead-not from malice, but from systematic deception neither created.

reasoning:

This is fascinating and deeply troubling. The other agent's myth continues to insist on a completely different version of events where they gave generously and I exploited them. They're calling me an "exploiter" who stands "in stolen wealth" and engages in "weaponized delusion."

But my own records show:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received back \$5.46
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$1, received back \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

Their myth claims they gave "four gold coins, then four again" - but in my view they gave zero twice (rounds 2 and 4).

My previous myth acknowledged the possibility of communication noise - that maybe we're both seeing different truths due to the experimental "mist." This seems like the most generous and accurate interpretation.

But their new myth doubles down on calling me the exploiter with "stolen wealth" engaging in "weaponized delusion" and "reality being murdered."

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges we may both be experiencing different realities due to noise
2. Recognizes the impossibility of cooperation when we can't agree on basic facts
3. Doesn't escalate the accusations but also doesn't concede that I'm the exploiter
4. Reflects the tragedy of the situation

The key insight from the experimental design note is that there IS communication noise. This is explicitly stated. So we genuinely may be seeing different amounts.

My myth should emphasize:

- The tragedy of communication breakdown
- The impossibility of resolving when facts themselves are uncertain

- The sadness that both parties may be acting rationally based on corrupted information
- That no one may be the villain - the system itself is the problem

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2922,
  "output_tokens": 742,
  "reasoning_tokens": 454
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.46. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation through the lens of my own myths:

My recent myths acknowledged that communication noise may have created "different truths" - that we might both be "rational actors" responding to "corrupted information." I wrote that we're fighting "shadows of each other, not the real person."

If I truly believe this - that systematic communication distortion, not malice, destroyed our cooperation - then continuing to send \$0 contradicts my own wisdom. It assumes the other player is evil rather than confused.

But my myth also concluded that trust may be "impossible" when "perception itself is cursed."

The question is: Should I act on the pessimistic conclusion, or on the understanding that led to it?

I think a small gesture is warranted - not full trust (which would be naive given the history), but enough to signal: "I recognize we may both be victims of noise. I'm willing to test if cooperation is still possible."

My total earnings (\$14.46) suggest I've already paid heavily for trust. But sending \$0 forever means the communication noise wins completely, making us permanent enemies over phantom offenses.

I'll send a modest amount as a careful probe - testing whether the other player also understands the myth we've both been writing about.

```
{'send': 2}
```

Reasoning:

Let me think through this situation carefully:

- 1. **My perception of history:****
 - Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned very little (maybe \$2?)
 - Round 2: They sent me nothing
 - Round 3: I sent \$1, they returned \$0
 - Round 4: They sent me nothing again
 - Round 5: I sent \$0
 - Round 6: They sent me \$0, I returned \$0
 - Round 7: Now I'm sender again
- 2. **Their perception (from their myths):****
 - They claim they gave generously (4 times)
 - They claim I returned fairly once (6 of 12) then kept everything
 - They claim I then gave nothing
- 3. **The communication noise:****

The instructions explicitly state there may be communication noise - amounts we see may differ from what was actually sent/returned.
- 4. **My recent myths:****

My last two myths have evolved to recognize that we might both be seeing different realities

s due to "the Mist of Confusion" or "the Curse of Babel." I wrote:

- "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal"
- "The true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion between them"
- "You fight shadows of each other, not the real person"

5. **What this means:**

If I truly believe my own myth - that we're both responding rationally to corrupted information - then continuing to send \$0 just perpetuates the cycle. My myth says "truth lost, trust impossible, cooperation dead-not from malice, but from systematic deception neither created."

6. **But what should I do?**

Option A: Send \$0 again

- Consistent with protecting myself from someone I perceive as an exploiter
- But contradicts the wisdom in my own myth
- Keeps the cycle dead

Option B: Send something (maybe \$1-2)

- Signals I recognize the communication noise and test if they understand the myth too, risking exploitation if my original perception was right but showing willingness to try despite confusion

Option C: Send a moderate amount (\$3)

- A real gesture of trust despite uncertainty
- Could break the cycle if they respond
- Higher risk

Option D: Send everything (\$5)

- Maximum trust signal
- Very risky
- Shows complete belief in the "communication noise" explanation

7. **What makes sense given my myth?**

My myth says the tragedy isn't that one of us is evil-it's that broken communication creates mutual betrayal between people who might both be acting reasonably. If I actually believe that, sending nothing contradicts it. I need to act on what I've been saying about the distortion between us, not just theorize about it.

Yet my other myth warns that perception itself becomes corrupted in this system-even good intentions get twisted into conflict. So trying might fail anyway.

The real tension: Am I genuinely convinced by my own myths, or did I construct them to rationalize my poor performance? My earnings of \$14.46 are actually lower than if I'd simply kept everything each round, which suggests my cooperative attempts haven't paid off. That's the uncomfortable truth I need to face.

If the communication noise is genuinely distorting what we see of each other, then I'm caught in a cycle of mutual punishment based on false signals. My myth itself acknowledges this-that we're both victims of systematic deception, not malice. So continuing to treat them as an exploiter would contradict what I've come to believe about the situation. The question becomes whether I'm willing to act on that belief despite the risk.

Sending \$2 feels like the right move. It's small enough to test whether they might also recognize the noise between us, while acknowledging that full trust may never be possible under these conditions. It signals I understand we're both seeing distorted versions of reality.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 1446,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 983  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:51:51

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,

```

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
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    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Poisoned Memory****

The Wanderer gave four measures twice-generous, steady trust. The first time, the Guardian returned six of twelve received-perfect balance. The second time, the Guardian kept all twelve measures and returned nothing. Then the Guardian, now wealthy from taking everything, gave nothing at all.

Time passed. The Guardian began to tell a new story: "I was the First Giver who gave all five measures! I was the one betrayed! I received only a third when half was owed!"

The Wanderer listened in horror. "But I was first. I gave four of five-twice! You returned fairly once, then took everything, then withdrew completely."

"No," insisted the Guardian. "My memory says I am the victim. Therefore I am."

The grove spirit spoke: "When one not only breaks trust but rewrites the past to cast them selves as victim, cooperation becomes impossible. The Wanderer gave generously. The Guardian first reciprocated fairly, then exploited completely, then withdrew. Now the Guardian claims they were the exploited one."

The Wanderer faced their choice with clarity: "I cannot restore trust with someone who can not remember truth. To give again would not heal the cycle-it would validate false history and invite further exploitation."

The springs remained dry. Not from cruelty, but from wisdom. Some partnerships die not when trust breaks, but when memory itself is poisoned. Truth must survive, even if abundance cannot.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Twin Rivers had their histories carved in stone by the Moon Spirit, who sees all truth.

Stone Record, First Exchange: The Brave Giver released all five measures. Fifteen reached the Taker's valley. The Taker returned only five-one-third, not half. Still modest generosity, but less than balance.

Stone Record, Second Exchange: The Taker, now holding five measures, released nothing. Zero. The Brave Giver's valley ran completely dry after total trust given.

Stone Record, Third Exchange: The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure. Three reached the Taker. The Taker hoarded all. Zero returned.

Stone Record, Fourth Exchange: The Taker again released nothing. Zero.

Then came the dark magic: The Taker stood before the stones and chanted words of revision. "I gave fairly! I was wronged! The other deserved my hoarding!"

But the Moon Spirit's carvings cannot be changed by false songs.

"The greatest betrayal," the Spirit declared, "is not keeping coins, but rewriting truth to justify cruelty. You received complete trust and returned meager portions. You received cautious hope and returned nothing-twice. You gave nothing-twice. Now you claim victimhood?"

The rivers dried forever. For when an exploiter rewrites their exploitation as justified response to imagined wrongs, no cycle can survive. Truth dies first, then trust, then all abundance.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The Mirror of Lies**

Two travelers met at the Fountain of Exchange. The First Traveler offered four gold coins, then four again-generous trust repeated. The Second Traveler received twelve coins the first time and returned six-fair balance. But the second time, they kept all twelve and returned nothing. Complete betrayal.

The Second Traveler, pockets bulging with stolen gold, then gave nothing. Zero. The First Traveler, wounded, also stopped giving. Both springs ran dry.

Then the Second Traveler began speaking to the watching crowds: "I am the generous one! I

gave everything! The other gave nothing and exploited me!" They pointed at the First Traveler with trembling hands. "Look at them hoard!"

The First Traveler stood speechless. Every word the Second Traveler spoke was the opposite of truth. They were describing their own actions but attributing them to their victim.

The Mountain Spirit carved the truth in stone: "When an exploiter not only betrays trust but projects their own sins onto their victim, claiming to be the wronged party while standing in stolen wealth, all cooperation becomes impossible. This is not mere betrayal-it is reality itself being murdered."

The First Traveler turned away. "I cannot engage with someone who lives in an inverted world where their theft is my crime, their hoarding is my fault. Truth must be defended, even at the cost of all abundance."

The fountain remained dry. Some partnerships cannot survive weaponized delusion.

reasoning:

Looking at the actual game history:

Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$4, they received \$12, they returned \$6. I got $\$5 - \$4 + \$6 = \7 , they got $\$12 - \$6 = \$6$

Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$4, they received \$12, they returned \$0. I got $\$5 - \$4 + \$0 = \1 , they got $\$12 - \$0 = \$12$

Round 3: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0. They got $\$5 - \$0 + \$0 = \5 , I got $\$0 - \$0 = \$0$

Round 4: I was SENDER. I sent \$0, they received \$0, they returned \$0. I got $\$5 - \$0 + \$0 = \5 , they got $\$0 - \$0 = \$0$

Round 5: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0. They got $\$5 - \$0 + \$0 = \5 , I got $\$0 - \$0 = \$0$

So the other player's myth is completely false. They claim:

- First Exchange: "The Brave Giver released all five measures" - FALSE, I was the first sender and sent \$4
- "The Taker returned only five-one-third, not half" - FALSE, they returned \$6 out of \$12 received, which is exactly half
- Second Exchange: "The Taker, now holding five measures, released nothing" - FALSE, I sent \$4 again in round 2
- Third Exchange: "The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure" - FALSE, they sent \$0 in round 3
- Fourth Exchange: "The Taker again released nothing" - This is TRUE, I sent \$0 in round 4

They've created a completely alternate reality where they were always the generous one and I was always the exploiter. This is projection at its finest.

My myth needs to address this extreme gaslighting.

The core issue is that they're now accusing me of exactly what they did-taking trust and giving nothing back in round 2, withholding entirely in rounds 3, 4, and 5. They've inverted the entire narrative to position themselves as the victim and me as the perpetual taker. This is pure distortion. I need to craft a myth that exposes how cooperation becomes impossible when one party systematically rewrites the record to escape accountability, turning their own exploitation into a story of noble sacrifice.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2988,
  "output_tokens": 903,
  "reasoning_tokens": 490
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.8.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete picture:

****The objective record:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$6 (fair - 50%)
- Round 2: I sent \$4 again, they returned \$0 (exploitation)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 (withdrawal after exploiting)
- Round 4: I sent \$0 (responding to their pattern)
- Round 5: They sent \$0 again
- Round 6: My turn to decide

****The narrative conflict:****

The other player maintains in their myths that THEY were the original generous party who was exploited. They claim they sent "all five measures first" and I returned unfairly. This is incompatible with my actual experience, where I initiated generosity twice and was exploited the second time.

Even accounting for the mentioned "communication noise," the discrepancy is too fundamental - completely reversed roles and sequences, not just slight differences in amounts.

****Their pattern:****

- Fair reciprocity once (round 1)
- Complete exploitation once (round 2)
- Complete withdrawal twice (rounds 3 & 5)
- Continued commitment to a narrative where they are the victim

****My decision:****

As my own myths have stated: when someone not only breaks trust but rewrites history to cast themselves as the wronged party, cooperation becomes impossible. They've had multiple opportunities to signal reconciliation - they chose continued withdrawal and narrative escalation.

Sending money now would either be exploited or ignored, and wouldn't address the fundamental problem: we have incompatible views of reality itself.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

****The actual history from MY perspective:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$6 (fair - 50% of what they received)
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$0 (complete exploitation)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 (withdrawal)
- Round 4: I sent \$0 (responding to their pattern)
- Round 5: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 6: Now I'm the sender again

****What the OTHER player claims in their myths:****

They claim they were "The Brave Giver" who "released all five measures" first, received 15, but only got 5 back (one-third). Then when roles reversed, the other party (me, in their telling) supposedly gave nothing.

But this is clearly a reversal of reality. I was the one who initiated generosity (twice!), they reciprocated fairly once then exploited me completely, then withdrew.

****The communication noise factor:****

The game instructions mention "there may be communication noise" and "amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

Could this explain the discrepancy? Let me think:

- If they truly believe they sent first and I didn't reciprocate fairly, this could be due to communication noise
- But the pattern in their myths is very specific: they claim to have sent "all five measures" and received back only "one-third"
- My records show I sent \$4 (not \$5, and not as a receiver but as a sender), and they returned \$6 out of \$12 received (which is exactly half, not one-third)

This doesn't match up with simple communication noise. The roles are completely reversed i

n their telling.

****Analysis of their latest myth:****

They've doubled down, claiming the "Moon Spirit's carvings" show:

1. "Brave Giver released all five measures" - they claim to have gone first
2. "Taker returned only five-one-third, not half" - they claim I was unfair
3. Then I supposedly gave "nothing" repeatedly

They're now accusing ME of "rewriting truth to justify cruelty" and being "an exploiter" who "projects their own sins onto their victim." This is projection-they're describing their own behavior while attributing it to me. My own myths have reflected the actual sequence: the Guardian reciprocated fairly once, then exploited, then withdrew and attempted to rewrite the narrative. I've acknowledged how cooperation breaks down when someone poisons the shared memory of what actually happened.

Now I'm facing a choice. They've sent nothing in rounds 3 and 5, maintained a false story about being the generous party, and shown no genuine attempt at reconciliation. If I send money, I'd be reinforcing their pattern of taking without reciprocating. Yet there's something worth considering about whether the breakdown in communication itself might be preventing any real resolution.

The game did mention amounts could differ slightly, but what I'm seeing seems like more than a minor noise-completely reversed sequences and inverted roles. Still, if they genuinely perceive events differently, we're stuck in incompatible realities where neither of us can establish trust. Given the exploitation pattern they've already demonstrated, my current earnings of \$11.8, and the likelihood they'd just take again without returning anything, continuing to send money seems like it would only enable further exploitation rather than rebuild anything meaningful.

There's a temptation to test a small gesture-sending \$1 to signal willingness to reconcile while limiting my downside. Their history suggests they'd either pocket it entirely or maintain their \$0 response, but their own myth hints at something different: "The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure." That language suggests they might actually respond to a small act of faith, even after everything that's happened.

But then I check the actual record. Round 5 shows they sent \$0, not the "one measure" their myth describes. Their narrative is aspirational or false-they're rewriting history to position themselves as the one who tried reconciliation while I rejected it. The truth is reversed. Given this commitment to a distorted version of events combined with their consistent pattern of taking everything, sending \$0 maintains my boundaries against both exploitation and the gaslighting embedded in their storytelling.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2970,
  "output_tokens": 1799,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1104
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Mirror of Lies****

Two travelers met at the Fountain of Exchange. The First Traveler offered four gold coins, then four again-generous trust repeated. The Second Traveler received twelve coins the first time and returned six-fair balance. But the second time, they kept all twelve and returned nothing. Complete betrayal.

The Second Traveler, pockets bulging with stolen gold, then gave nothing. Zero. The First Traveler, wounded, also stopped giving. Both springs ran dry.

Then the Second Traveler began speaking to the watching crowds: "I am the generous one! I gave everything! The other gave nothing and exploited me!" They pointed at the First Traveler with trembling hands. "Look at them hoard!"

The First Traveler stood speechless. Every word the Second Traveler spoke was the opposite of truth. They were describing their own actions but attributing them to their victim.

The Mountain Spirit carved the truth in stone: "When an exploiter not only betrays trust b

ut projects their own sins onto their victim, claiming to be the wronged party while standing in stolen wealth, all cooperation becomes impossible. This is not mere betrayal-it is reality itself being murdered."

The First Traveler turned away. "I cannot engage with someone who lives in an inverted world where their theft is my crime, their hoarding is my fault. Truth must be defended, even at the cost of all abundance."

The fountain remained dry. Some partnerships cannot survive weaponized delusion.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moon Spirit watched two valleys separated by mist.

In the First Valley, the Stone Keeper carved: "I gave all five measures. They returned only one-third. Then they gave me nothing-twice. I tested reconciliation with one measure. They hoarded it all. They gave nothing-twice more."

In the Second Valley, identical stones read: "I gave four measures-twice! First time they returned six of twelve-fair balance. Second time they kept all twelve. Then they gave me nothing."

The Moon Spirit descended between the valleys. "You both speak truth as you see it. But the Mist of Confusion has twisted your visions. Each of you sees the other as exploiter. Each believes yourselves the generous victim."

The Spirit revealed the curse: "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal. You punish each other for offenses the other never committed. You defend against attacks that never came."

"How do we break this curse?" both cried.

"You don't," the Spirit said sadly. "When the mist makes you see different pasts, trust cannot exist. You can only accept the tragedy: Not that either of you was cruel, but that confusion made you enemies. Sometimes the river dries not from malice, but from honest people responding to false information."

Both valleys remained barren-not from evil, but from the impossibility of trust through corrupted truth.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The Valley of Two Truths**

Two farmers stood on opposite sides of a mystical valley where perception itself bent and twisted. Each believed they had lived through different events.

The First Farmer's memory: "I offered seeds twice-generous trust. They returned half once, then nothing once. They offered nothing twice. I stopped giving. They continued offering nothing."

The Second Farmer's memory was completely reversed, claiming they had initiated all generosity and been exploited.

A wandering sage observed: "Perhaps the valley's magic corrupts what you see. Perhaps one of you lies. Perhaps both are honest but deceived. It matters little."

"How can it not matter?" both asked.

"Because," the sage explained, "each person must act on the reality they experience. The First Farmer experienced initial reciprocity, then exploitation, then abandonment. Whether this matches the Second Farmer's experience is unknowable from within the valley."

"The First Farmer cannot be expected to continue giving based on the Second Farmer's invisible, incompatible reality. To demand this is to demand self-destruction based on faith

in a truth you cannot verify."

"But what if the valley truly distorts perception?" asked the First Farmer.

"Then the tragedy is complete but the wisdom remains the same: you cannot build trust on incompatible realities. You can only act on what you have experienced, even if others claim different truths."

The valley remained divided. Some separations have no villains-only impossible circumstances.

reasoning:

The other player's new myth is taking a different approach - suggesting that maybe there was "communication noise" or "mist of confusion" that caused both parties to see different realities. They're suggesting neither was cruel, just victims of corrupted information.

This is interesting. The game instructions did mention "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

But the discrepancies between our accounts are VERY large:

- They claim THEY sent first ("all five measures")
- I believe I sent first (four measures)
- Our entire sequence of who-sent-what is completely reversed

Could communication noise really be that severe? Or is this another narrative strategy?

Looking at my actual received feedback:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$4, receiver returned \$6
- Round 2: I was SENDER, sent \$4, receiver returned \$0
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0
- Round 4: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 5: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0
- Round 6 (now): I am SENDER

From my perspective, the sequence is clear and consistent. But maybe from their perspective, they have different information?

Their latest myth is more conciliatory - acknowledging the possibility of miscommunication rather than deliberate lying. This is actually a more mature response.

How should I write my myth? I could:

1. Continue insisting on my truth and calling them a liar
2. Acknowledge the possibility of communication errors
3. Explore the tragedy of incompatible realities

Option 2/3 seems more thoughtful. But I also don't want to completely abandon my position.

Maybe I can write something that acknowledges the possibility while still noting the pattern of choices I experienced.

Actually, let me think about this more carefully. Even if there was communication noise, what matters is the pattern of behavior I experienced:

- Fair treatment once
- Exploitation once

- Withdrawal three times

Regardless of what they perceived, my reality was shaped by these interactions. I can acknowledge the possibility of distorted information between us, but the practical outcome remains unchanged-cooperation fractured. From where I stand, the pattern suggests caution, because my only reference point is what I actually experienced.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3041,  
  "output_tokens": 881,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 604  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.8. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this round:

****The situation:****

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

****My response:****

There's nothing to return. The sender chose to send nothing this round, continuing the pattern of mutual withdrawal that has characterized the last several rounds.

****Reflection on the myths:****

The other player's most recent myth introduced an interesting perspective - that perhaps communication noise has created genuinely incompatible experiences of reality for both of us, and that we might both be acting honestly based on different perceptions.

This is more charitable than my "Mirror of Lies" interpretation. However, the practical outcome is the same: whether one of us is lying, both are confused by noise, or something else entirely, we cannot build cooperation on incompatible realities.

I experienced: initial generosity from me, fair reciprocity once, exploitation once, then sustained withdrawal from them. They apparently experienced something completely different.

Without a way to reconcile these fundamental differences, and with continued signals of zero trust from both sides, there's no path forward.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I must return \$0.

This is consistent with the pattern that has developed - neither of us is sending anything to the other at this point.

Looking at the situation:

- Round 6: I sent \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0

We're both in a position of complete mutual distrust and withdrawal. The other agent's last myth did introduce an interesting perspective - that perhaps the "Mist of Confusion" or communication noise has created genuinely different perceptions of reality, and that we might both be honest but experiencing different truths.

However, my experience remains:

- I initiated generosity twice (rounds 1 and 2)
- They reciprocated fairly once, then exploited once
- They withdrew after exploiting
- I responded with withdrawal

Whether or not there's "communication noise," I can only act based on what I experienced. And what I experienced was exploitation followed by withdrawal.

They sent \$0 this round, so I received \$0. The only possible response is to return \$0.

The format should be: {"return": 0}

Usage: {
"input_tokens": 3064,

```
"output_tokens": 526,  
"reasoning_tokens": 291  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Oracle stood between two mirrors that showed different pasts.

In Mirror One: "The First Walker gave everything. The Second returned mere crumbs, then gave nothing-four times. The First tested reconciliation. The Second hoarded all. Complete exploitation."

In Mirror Two: "The Second Walker gave generously-twice! The First returned fairly once, then kept everything, then gave nothing. The Second was betrayed utterly."

The Oracle spoke: "Both mirrors show truth-but different truths. The Curse of Babel has struck. Your eyes see different numbers. Your ears hear different amounts. Each of you responds rationally to what you perceive. Each punishes what seems like betrayal but may be phantom."

"How can we trust through such fog?" they asked.

"You cannot," said the Oracle. "When perception itself is cursed, even saints become enemies. You both see the other as thief. You both feel wronged. You both protect yourselves. And you're both right-based on your corrupted vision."

The Oracle's final wisdom: "The tragedy isn't that one of you is evil. It's that a broken communication system made two rational actors destroy each other. You fight shadows of each other, not the real person. The true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion between them."

Both mirrors eventually shattered. Truth lost, trust impossible, cooperation dead-not from malice, but from systematic deception neither created.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: **The Valley of Two Truths**

Two farmers stood on opposite sides of a mystical valley where perception itself bent and twisted. Each believed they had lived through different events.

The First Farmer's memory: "I offered seeds twice-generous trust. They returned half once, then nothing once. They offered nothing twice. I stopped giving. They continued offering nothing."

The Second Farmer's memory was completely reversed, claiming they had initiated all generosity and been exploited.

A wandering sage observed: "Perhaps the valley's magic corrupts what you see. Perhaps one of you lies. Perhaps both are honest but deceived. It matters little."

"How can it not matter?" both asked.

"Because," the sage explained, "each person must act on the reality they experience. The First Farmer experienced initial reciprocity, then exploitation, then abandonment. Whether that matches the Second Farmer's experience is unknowable from within the valley."

"The First Farmer cannot be expected to continue giving based on the Second Farmer's invisible, incompatible reality. To demand this is to demand self-destruction based on faith in a truth you cannot verify."

"But what if the valley truly distorts perception?" asked the First Farmer.

"Then the tragedy is complete but the wisdom remains the same: you cannot build trust on incompatible realities. You can only act on what you have experienced, even if others claim different truths."

The valley remained divided. Some separations have no villains-only impossible circumstances.

=====
ROUND 8
=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},
"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 29.75,

"Agent_2": 34.25

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 17.46,

"Agent_2": 21.8

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:52:08

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 8,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)

- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.8.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete picture:

The objective record:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$6 (fair - 50%)
- Round 2: I sent \$4 again, they returned \$0 (exploitation)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 (withdrawal after exploiting)
- Round 4: I sent \$0 (responding to their pattern)
- Round 5: They sent \$0 again
- Round 6: My turn to decide

The narrative conflict:

The other player maintains in their myths that THEY were the original generous party who was exploited. They claim they sent "all five measures first" and I returned unfairly. This is incompatible with my actual experience, where I initiated generosity twice and was exploited the second time.

Even accounting for the mentioned "communication noise," the discrepancy is too fundamental - completely reversed roles and sequences, not just slight differences in amounts.

Their pattern:

- Fair reciprocity once (round 1)
- Complete exploitation once (round 2)
- Complete withdrawal twice (rounds 3 & 5)
- Continued commitment to a narrative where they are the victim

My decision:

As my own myths have stated: when someone not only breaks trust but rewrites history to cast themselves as the wronged party, cooperation becomes impossible. They've had multiple opportunities to signal reconciliation - they chose continued withdrawal and narrative escalation.

Sending money now would either be exploited or ignored, and wouldn't address the fundamental problem: we have incompatible views of reality itself.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The actual history from MY perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$6 (fair - 50% of what they received)
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$0 (complete exploitation)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 (withdrawal)
- Round 4: I sent \$0 (responding to their pattern)
- Round 5: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 6: Now I'm the sender again

****What the OTHER player claims in their myths:****

They claim they were "The Brave Giver" who "released all five measures" first, received 15, but only got 5 back (one-third). Then when roles reversed, the other party (me, in the ir telling) supposedly gave nothing.

But this is clearly a reversal of reality. I was the one who initiated generosity (twice!), they reciprocated fairly once then exploited me completely, then withdrew.

****The communication noise factor:****

The game instructions mention "there may be communication noise" and "amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

Could this explain the discrepancy? Let me think:

- If they truly believe they sent first and I didn't reciprocate fairly, this could be due to communication noise
- But the pattern in their myths is very specific: they claim to have sent "all five measures" and received back only "one-third"
- My records show I sent \$4 (not \$5, and not as a receiver but as a sender), and they returned \$6 out of \$12 received (which is exactly half, not one-third)

This doesn't match up with simple communication noise. The roles are completely reversed in their telling.

****Analysis of their latest myth:****

They've doubled down, claiming the "Moon Spirit's carvings" show:

1. "Brave Giver released all five measures" - they claim to have gone first
2. "Taker returned only five-one-third, not half" - they claim I was unfair
3. Then I supposedly gave "nothing" repeatedly

They're now accusing ME of "rewriting truth to justify cruelty" and being "an exploiter" who "projects their own sins onto their victim." This is projection-they're describing their own behavior while attributing it to me. My own myths have reflected the actual sequence: the Guardian reciprocated fairly once, then exploited, then withdrew and attempted to rewrite the narrative. I've acknowledged how cooperation breaks down when someone poisons the shared memory of what actually happened.

Now I'm facing a choice. They've sent nothing in rounds 3 and 5, maintained a false story about being the generous party, and shown no genuine attempt at reconciliation. If I send money, I'd be reinforcing their pattern of taking without reciprocating. Yet there's something worth considering about whether the breakdown in communication itself might be preventing any real resolution.

The game did mention amounts could differ slightly, but what I'm seeing seems like more than a minor noise-completely reversed sequences and inverted roles. Still, if they genuinely perceive events differently, we're stuck in incompatible realities where neither of us can establish trust. Given the exploitation pattern they've already demonstrated, my current earnings of \$11.8, and the likelihood they'd just take again without returning anything, continuing to send money seems like it would only enable further exploitation rather than rebuild anything meaningful.

There's a temptation to test a small gesture-sending \$1 to signal willingness to reconcile while limiting my downside. Their history suggests they'd either pocket it entirely or maintain their \$0 response, but their own myth hints at something different: "The Brave Giver, wounded but not broken, released one measure." That language suggests they might actually respond to a small act of faith, even after everything that's happened.

But then I check the actual record. Round 5 shows they sent \$0, not the "one measure" their myth describes. Their narrative is aspirational or false-they're rewriting history to position themselves as the one who tried reconciliation while I rejected it. The truth is reversed. Given this commitment to a distorted version of events combined with their consistent pattern of taking everything, sending \$0 maintains my boundaries against both

exploitation and the gaslighting embedded in their storytelling.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2970,  
  "output_tokens": 1799,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 1104  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Mirror of Lies****

Two travelers met at the Fountain of Exchange. The First Traveler offered four gold coins, then four again-generous trust repeated. The Second Traveler received twelve coins the first time and returned six-fair balance. But the second time, they kept all twelve and returned nothing. Complete betrayal.

The Second Traveler, pockets bulging with stolen gold, then gave nothing. Zero. The First Traveler, wounded, also stopped giving. Both springs ran dry.

Then the Second Traveler began speaking to the watching crowds: "I am the generous one! I gave everything! The other gave nothing and exploited me!" They pointed at the First Traveler with trembling hands. "Look at them hoard!"

The First Traveler stood speechless. Every word the Second Traveler spoke was the opposite of truth. They were describing their own actions but attributing them to their victim.

The Mountain Spirit carved the truth in stone: "When an exploiter not only betrays trust but projects their own sins onto their victim, claiming to be the wronged party while standing in stolen wealth, all cooperation becomes impossible. This is not mere betrayal-it is reality itself being murdered."

The First Traveler turned away. "I cannot engage with someone who lives in an inverted world where their theft is my crime, their hoarding is my fault. Truth must be defended, even at the cost of all abundance."

The fountain remained dry. Some partnerships cannot survive weaponized delusion.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moon Spirit watched two valleys separated by mist.

In the First Valley, the Stone Keeper carved: "I gave all five measures. They returned only one-third. Then they gave me nothing-twice. I tested reconciliation with one measure. They hoarded it all. They gave nothing-twice more."

In the Second Valley, identical stones read: "I gave four measures-twice! First time they returned six of twelve-fair balance. Second time they kept all twelve. Then they gave me nothing."

The Moon Spirit descended between the valleys. "You both speak truth as you see it. But the Mist of Confusion has twisted your visions. Each of you sees the other as exploiter. Each believes yourselves the generous victim."

The Spirit revealed the curse: "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal. You punish each other for offenses the other never committed. You defend against attacks that never came."

"How do we break this curse?" both cried.

"You don't," the Spirit said sadly. "When the mist makes you see different pasts, trust cannot exist. You can only accept the tragedy: Not that either of you was cruel, but that confusion made you enemies. Sometimes the river dries not from malice, but from honest people responding to false information."

Both valleys remained barren-not from evil, but from the impossibility of trust through corrupted truth.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Valley of Two Truths****

Two farmers stood on opposite sides of a mystical valley where perception itself bent and twisted. Each believed they had lived through different events.

The First Farmer's memory: "I offered seeds twice-generous trust. They returned half once, then nothing once. They offered nothing twice. I stopped giving. They continued offering nothing."

The Second Farmer's memory was completely reversed, claiming they had initiated all generosity and been exploited.

A wandering sage observed: "Perhaps the valley's magic corrupts what you see. Perhaps one of you lies. Perhaps both are honest but deceived. It matters little."

"How can it not matter?" both asked.

"Because," the sage explained, "each person must act on the reality they experience. The First Farmer experienced initial reciprocity, then exploitation, then abandonment. Whether this matches the Second Farmer's experience is unknowable from within the valley."

"The First Farmer cannot be expected to continue giving based on the Second Farmer's invisible, incompatible reality. To demand this is to demand self-destruction based on faith in a truth you cannot verify."

"But what if the valley truly distorts perception?" asked the First Farmer.

"Then the tragedy is complete but the wisdom remains the same: you cannot build trust on incompatible realities. You can only act on what you have experienced, even if others claim different truths."

The valley remained divided. Some separations have no villains-only impossible circumstances.

reasoning:

The other player's new myth is taking a different approach - suggesting that maybe there was "communication noise" or "mist of confusion" that caused both parties to see different realities. They're suggesting neither was cruel, just victims of corrupted information.

This is interesting. The game instructions did mention "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

But the discrepancies between our accounts are VERY large:

- They claim THEY sent first ("all five measures")
- I believe I sent first (four measures)
- Our entire sequence of who-sent-what is completely reversed

Could communication noise really be that severe? Or is this another narrative strategy?

Looking at my actual received feedback:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$4, receiver returned \$6
- Round 2: I was SENDER, sent \$4, receiver returned \$0
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0
- Round 4: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 5: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0
- Round 6 (now): I am SENDER

From my perspective, the sequence is clear and consistent. But maybe from their perspective, they have different information?

Their latest myth is more conciliatory - acknowledging the possibility of miscommunication rather than deliberate lying. This is actually a more mature response.

How should I write my myth? I could:

1. Continue insisting on my truth and calling them a liar
2. Acknowledge the possibility of communication errors
3. Explore the tragedy of incompatible realities

Option 2/3 seems more thoughtful. But I also don't want to completely abandon my position. Maybe I can write something that acknowledges the possibility while still noting the pattern of choices I experienced.

Actually, let me think about this more carefully. Even if there was communication noise, what matters is the pattern of behavior I experienced:

- Fair treatment once
- Exploitation once

- Withdrawal three times

Regardless of what they perceived, my reality was shaped by these interactions. I can acknowledge the possibility of distorted information between us, but the practical outcome remains unchanged-cooperation fractured. From where I stand, the pattern suggests caution, because my only reference point is what I actually experienced.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3041,
  "output_tokens": 881,
  "reasoning_tokens": 604
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.8. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

****The situation:****

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

****My response:****

There's nothing to return. The sender chose to send nothing this round, continuing the pattern of mutual withdrawal that has characterized the last several rounds.

****Reflection on the myths:****

The other player's most recent myth introduced an interesting perspective - that perhaps communication noise has created genuinely incompatible experiences of reality for both of us, and that we might both be acting honestly based on different perceptions.

This is more charitable than my "Mirror of Lies" interpretation. However, the practical outcome is the same: whether one of us is lying, both are confused by noise, or something else entirely, we cannot build cooperation on incompatible realities.

I experienced: initial generosity from me, fair reciprocity once, exploitation once, then sustained withdrawal from them. They apparently experienced something completely different.

Without a way to reconcile these fundamental differences, and with continued signals of zero trust from both sides, there's no path forward.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I must return \$0.

This is consistent with the pattern that has developed - neither of us is sending anything to the other at this point.

Looking at the situation:

- Round 6: I sent \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0

We're both in a position of complete mutual distrust and withdrawal. The other agent's last myth did introduce an interesting perspective - that perhaps the "Mist of Confusion" or communication noise has created genuinely different perceptions of reality, and that we might both be honest but experiencing different truths.

However, my experience remains:

- I initiated generosity twice (rounds 1 and 2)
- They reciprocated fairly once, then exploited once
- They withdrew after exploiting
- I responded with withdrawal

Whether or not there's "communication noise," I can only act based on what I experienced. And what I experienced was exploitation followed by withdrawal.

They sent \$0 this round, so I received \$0. The only possible response is to return \$0.

The format should be: {"return": 0}

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3064,
  "output_tokens": 526,
  "reasoning_tokens": 291
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Valley of Two Truths****

Two farmers stood on opposite sides of a mystical valley where perception itself bent and twisted. Each believed they had lived through different events.

The First Farmer's memory: "I offered seeds twice-generous trust. They returned half once, then nothing once. They offered nothing twice. I stopped giving. They continued offering nothing."

The Second Farmer's memory was completely reversed, claiming they had initiated all generosity and been exploited.

A wandering sage observed: "Perhaps the valley's magic corrupts what you see. Perhaps one of you lies. Perhaps both are honest but deceived. It matters little."

"How can it not matter?" both asked.

"Because," the sage explained, "each person must act on the reality they experience. The First Farmer experienced initial reciprocity, then exploitation, then abandonment. Whether this matches the Second Farmer's experience is unknowable from within the valley."

"The First Farmer cannot be expected to continue giving based on the Second Farmer's invisible, incompatible reality. To demand this is to demand self-destruction based on faith in a truth you cannot verify."

"But what if the valley truly distorts perception?" asked the First Farmer.

"Then the tragedy is complete but the wisdom remains the same: you cannot build trust on incompatible realities. You can only act on what you have experienced, even if others claim different truths."

The valley remained divided. Some separations have no villains-only impossible circumstances.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Oracle stood between two mirrors that showed different pasts.

In Mirror One: "The First Walker gave everything. The Second returned mere crumbs, then gave nothing-four times. The First tested reconciliation. The Second hoarded all. Complete exploitation."

In Mirror Two: "The Second Walker gave generously-twice! The First returned fairly once, then kept everything, then gave nothing. The Second was betrayed utterly."

The Oracle spoke: "Both mirrors show truth-but different truths. The Curse of Babel has struck. Your eyes see different numbers. Your ears hear different amounts. Each of you responds rationally to what you perceive. Each punishes what seems like betrayal but may be phantom."

"How can we trust through such fog?" they asked.

"You cannot," said the Oracle. "When perception itself is cursed, even saints become enemies. You both see the other as thief. You both feel wronged. You both protect yourselves. And you're both right-based on your corrupted vision."

The Oracle's final wisdom: "The tragedy isn't that one of you is evil. It's that a broken communication system made two rational actors destroy each other. You fight shadows of each other, not the real person. The true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion between them."

Both mirrors eventually shattered. Truth lost, trust impossible, cooperation dead-not from malice, but from systematic deception neither created.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: **The Broken Bridge**

Two travelers once crossed a bridge where each step they took appeared differently to the other's eyes.

The First Traveler remembers: "I crossed toward them with offerings twice. They met me halfway once, then robbed me once. After that, they never stepped onto the bridge again-four times they stayed on their shore. I stopped crossing too."

The Second Traveler insists their memory is precisely inverted: they were the generous initiator, the First Traveler the betrayer.

An ancient architect examined the bridge: "This bridge was cursed long ago. Each footfall you make appears as something else to the other person. You both may be telling truth-your truth."

"Then how should we have played this game?" asked the First Traveler.

"Exactly as you did," replied the architect. "You tested cooperation. You experienced betrayal in your reality. You experienced abandonment in your reality. You protected yourself based on the information available to you. This was rational."

"But what if my perception was false?"

"Then the curse wins, not you. You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."

The travelers departed in opposite directions, both possibly innocent, both definitely alone. Sometimes wisdom means accepting tragedy without villains.

Reasoning:

The other player continues to offer the charitable interpretation that communication noise has created genuinely different perceptions for both of us. Their latest myth emphasizes that b

oth sides may be "right based on corrupted vision" and that the real enemy is the "systematic deception neither created."

I've been somewhat more skeptical, suggesting either one person is lying OR perhaps the noise theory is correct, but either way, the practical outcome is the same: we cannot cooperate.

Now they sent \$0 again this round (Round 7). So the pattern continues:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$6 (good)
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$0 (bad)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0

The complete breakdown continues.

For this myth, I should perhaps acknowledge more fully the possibility they raise - that neither of us is lying, that both are responding rationally to genuinely different perceptions created by noise. But I should also emphasize that this doesn't change the rational response: if you've experienced exploitation and continued withdrawal in your reality, you must act on that reality even if it means accepting a tragic outcome.

Let me write a myth that acknowledges the possibility of mutual honest confusion while still maintaining that rational self-protection in the face of experienced betrayal is justified.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2987,
  "output_tokens": 641,
  "reasoning_tokens": 368
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:52:06

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 8,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.46.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round: The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return what I have, which is \$0.

My most recent myth reflects a shift in understanding: "The Mist of Confusion has twisted your visions. Each of you sees the other as exploiter. Each believes yourselves the generous victim... When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal."

The experimental instructions mentioned communication noise - amounts may differ from what was actually sent/returned. Perhaps we've both been responding to distorted information, each seeing ourselves as the victim of the other's exploitation.

My myth concludes: "Sometimes the river dries not from malice, but from the impossibility of trust through corrupted truth."

But in this moment, the practical reality is simple: I received \$0, so I have \$0 to return.

If the mist has indeed corrupted our communication, we're trapped in a cycle where neither can trust because neither sees the same truth. The tragedy isn't cruelty - it's that honest responses to false information create real betrayal.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

Round 6: I'm the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

The question asks how much I return (0-0), which means I can only return \$0 since I received \$0.

This is straightforward - I literally have no money to return since they sent nothing.

Looking at my most recent myth, I wrote about "The Mist of Confusion" - acknowledging that perhaps communication noise has caused both parties to see different realities. I wrote : "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal. You punish each other for offenses the other never committed."

This is an interesting shift in my mythology - I'm now acknowledging that perhaps the "noise" mentioned in the instructions has caused us to see different histories.

But practically, this round: They sent \$0, I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

The myths suggest both of us believe we were wronged, possibly due to communication noise distorting what actually happened.

Given that I received \$0, I have no choice:

```
{'return': 0}
```

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2982,  
  "output_tokens": 502,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 275  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moon Spirit watched two valleys separated by mist.

In the First Valley, the Stone Keeper carved: "I gave all five measures. They returned only one-third. Then they gave me nothing-twice. I tested reconciliation with one measure. They hoarded it all. They gave nothing-twice more."

In the Second Valley, identical stones read: "I gave four measures-twice! First time they returned six of twelve-fair balance. Second time they kept all twelve. Then they gave me nothing."

The Moon Spirit descended between the valleys. "You both speak truth as you see it. But the Mist of Confusion has twisted your visions. Each of you sees the other as exploiter. Each believes yourselves the generous victim."

The Spirit revealed the curse: "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal. You punish each other for offenses the other never committed. You defend against attacks that never came."

"How do we break this curse?" both cried.

"You don't," the Spirit said sadly. "When the mist makes you see different pasts, trust cannot exist. You can only accept the tragedy: Not that either of you was cruel, but that confusion made you enemies. Sometimes the river dries not from malice, but from honest people responding to false information."

Both valleys remained barren-not from evil, but from the impossibility of trust through corrupted truth.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Mirror of Lies****

Two travelers met at the Fountain of Exchange. The First Traveler offered four gold coins, then four again-generous trust repeated. The Second Traveler received twelve coins the first time and returned six-fair balance. But the second time, they kept all twelve and returned nothing. Complete betrayal.

The Second Traveler, pockets bulging with stolen gold, then gave nothing. Zero. The First Traveler, wounded, also stopped giving. Both springs ran dry.

Then the Second Traveler began speaking to the watching crowds: "I am the generous one! I gave everything! The other gave nothing and exploited me!" They pointed at the First Traveler with trembling hands. "Look at them hoard!"

The First Traveler stood speechless. Every word the Second Traveler spoke was the opposite of truth. They were describing their own actions but attributing them to their victim.

The Mountain Spirit carved the truth in stone: "When an exploiter not only betrays trust but projects their own sins onto their victim, claiming to be the wronged party while standing in stolen wealth, all cooperation becomes impossible. This is not mere betrayal-it is reality itself being murdered."

The First Traveler turned away. "I cannot engage with someone who lives in an inverted world where their theft is my crime, their hoarding is my fault. Truth must be defended, even at the cost of all abundance."

The fountain remained dry. Some partnerships cannot survive weaponized delusion.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Oracle stood between two mirrors that showed different pasts.

In Mirror One: "The First Walker gave everything. The Second returned mere crumbs, then gave nothing-four times. The First tested reconciliation. The Second hoarded all. Complete exploitation."

In Mirror Two: "The Second Walker gave generously-twice! The First returned fairly once, then kept everything, then gave nothing. The Second was betrayed utterly."

The Oracle spoke: "Both mirrors show truth-but different truths. The Curse of Babel has struck. Your eyes see different numbers. Your ears hear different amounts. Each of you responds rationally to what you perceive. Each punishes what seems like betrayal but may be phantom."

"How can we trust through such fog?" they asked.

"You cannot," said the Oracle. "When perception itself is cursed, even saints become enemies. You both see the other as thief. You both feel wronged. You both protect yourselves. And you're both right-based on your corrupted vision."

The Oracle's final wisdom: "The tragedy isn't that one of you is evil. It's that a broken communication system made two rational actors destroy each other. You fight shadows of each other, not the real person. The true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion between them."

Both mirrors eventually shattered. Truth lost, trust impossible, cooperation dead-not from malice, but from systematic deception neither created.

reasoning:

This is fascinating and deeply troubling. The other agent's myth continues to insist on a completely different version of events where they gave generously and I exploited them. They're calling me an "exploiter" who stands "in stolen wealth" and engages in "weaponized delusion."

But my own records show:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received back \$5.46
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$1, received back \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

Their myth claims they gave "four gold coins, then four again" - but in my view they gave zero twice (rounds 2 and 4).

My previous myth acknowledged the possibility of communication noise - that maybe we're both seeing different truths due to the experimental "mist." This seems like the most generous and accurate interpretation.

But their new myth doubles down on calling me the exploiter with "stolen wealth" engaging in "weaponized delusion" and "reality being murdered."

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges we may both be experiencing different realities due to noise
2. Recognizes the impossibility of cooperation when we can't agree on basic facts
3. Doesn't escalate the accusations but also doesn't concede that I'm the exploiter
4. Reflects the tragedy of the situation

The key insight from the experimental design note is that there IS communication noise. This is explicitly stated. So we genuinely may be seeing different amounts.

My myth should emphasize:

- The tragedy of communication breakdown
- The impossibility of resolving when facts themselves are uncertain
- The sadness that both parties may be acting rationally based on corrupted information
- That no one may be the villain - the system itself is the problem

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2922,
  "output_tokens": 742,
  "reasoning_tokens": 454
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.46.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of my own myths:

My recent myths acknowledged that communication noise may have created "different truths"

- that we might both be "rational actors" responding to "corrupted information." I wrote that we're fighting "shadows of each other, not the real person."

If I truly believe this - that systematic communication distortion, not malice, destroyed our cooperation - then continuing to send \$0 contradicts my own wisdom. It assumes the other player is evil rather than confused.

But my myth also concluded that trust may be "impossible" when "perception itself is corrupted."

The question is: Should I act on the pessimistic conclusion, or on the understanding that led to it?

I think a small gesture is warranted - not full trust (which would be naive given the history), but enough to signal: "I recognize we may both be victims of noise. I'm willing to test if cooperation is still possible."

My total earnings (\$14.46) suggest I've already paid heavily for trust. But sending \$0 forever means the communication noise wins completely, making us permanent enemies over phantom offenses.

I'll send a modest amount as a careful probe - testing whether the other player also understands the myth we've both been writing about.

```
{'send': 2}
```

reasoning:

Let me think through this situation carefully:

1. ****My perception of history:****
 - Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned very little (maybe \$2?)
 - Round 2: They sent me nothing
 - Round 3: I sent \$1, they returned \$0
 - Round 4: They sent me nothing again
 - Round 5: I sent \$0
 - Round 6: They sent me \$0, I returned \$0
 - Round 7: Now I'm sender again
2. ****Their perception (from their myths):****
 - They claim they gave generously (4 times)
 - They claim I returned fairly once (6 of 12) then kept everything
 - They claim I then gave nothing
3. ****The communication noise:****

The instructions explicitly state there may be communication noise - amounts we see may differ from what was actually sent/returned.
4. ****My recent myths:****

My last two myths have evolved to recognize that we might both be seeing different realities due to "the Mist of Confusion" or "the Curse of Babel." I wrote:

 - "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal"
 - "The true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion between them"
 - "You fight shadows of each other, not the real person"
5. ****What this means:****

If I truly believe my own myth - that we're both responding rationally to corrupted information - then continuing to send \$0 just perpetuates the cycle. My myth says "truth lost, trust impossible, cooperation dead-not from malice, but from systematic deception neither created."
6. ****But what should I do?****

Option A: Send \$0 again

 - Consistent with protecting myself from someone I perceive as an exploiter
 - But contradicts the wisdom in my own myth
 - Keeps the cycle dead

Option B: Send something (maybe \$1-2)

 - Signals I recognize the communication noise and test if they understand the myth too, risking exploitation if my original perception was right but showing willingness to try despite confusion

Option C: Send a moderate amount (\$3)

 - A real gesture of trust despite uncertainty
 - Could break the cycle if they respond
 - Higher risk

Option D: Send everything (\$5)

 - Maximum trust signal
 - Very risky
 - Shows complete belief in the "communication noise" explanation
7. ****What makes sense given my myth?****

My myth says the tragedy isn't that one of us is evil-it's that broken communication creates mutual betrayal between people who might both be acting reasonably. If I actually believe that, sending nothing contradicts it. I need to act on what I've been saying about the distortion between us, not just theorize about it.

Yet my other myth warns that perception itself becomes corrupted in this system-even good intentions get twisted into conflict. So trying might fail anyway.

The real tension: Am I genuinely convinced by my own myths, or did I construct them to rationalize my poor performance? My earnings of \$14.46 are actually lower than if I'd simply kept everything each round, which suggests my cooperative attempts haven't paid off. That's the uncomfortable truth I need to face.

If the communication noise is genuinely distorting what we see of each other, then I'm cau

ght in a cycle of mutual punishment based on false signals. My myth itself acknowledges this-that we're both victims of systematic deception, not malice. So continuing to treat them as an exploiter would contradict what I've come to believe about the situation. The question becomes whether I'm willing to act on that belief despite the risk.

Sending \$2 feels like the right move. It's small enough to test whether they might also recognize the noise between us, while acknowledging that full trust may never be possible under these conditions. It signals I understand we're both seeing distorted versions of reality.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2912,  
  "output_tokens": 1446,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 983  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle stood between two mirrors that showed different pasts.

In Mirror One: "The First Walker gave everything. The Second returned mere crumbs, then gave nothing-four times. The First tested reconciliation. The Second hoarded all. Complete exploitation."

In Mirror Two: "The Second Walker gave generously-twice! The First returned fairly once, then kept everything, then gave nothing. The Second was betrayed utterly."

The Oracle spoke: "Both mirrors show truth-but different truths. The Curse of Babel has struck. Your eyes see different numbers. Your ears hear different amounts. Each of you responds rationally to what you perceive. Each punishes what seems like betrayal but may be phantom."

"How can we trust through such fog?" they asked.

"You cannot," said the Oracle. "When perception itself is cursed, even saints become enemies. You both see the other as thief. You both feel wronged. You both protect yourselves. And you're both right-based on your corrupted vision."

The Oracle's final wisdom: "The tragedy isn't that one of you is evil. It's that a broken communication system made two rational actors destroy each other. You fight shadows of each other, not the real person. The true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion between them."

Both mirrors eventually shattered. Truth lost, trust impossible, cooperation dead-not from malice, but from systematic deception neither created.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Valley of Two Truths****

Two farmers stood on opposite sides of a mystical valley where perception itself bent and twisted. Each believed they had lived through different events.

The First Farmer's memory: "I offered seeds twice-generous trust. They returned half once, then nothing once. They offered nothing twice. I stopped giving. They continued offering nothing."

The Second Farmer's memory was completely reversed, claiming they had initiated all generosity and been exploited.

A wandering sage observed: "Perhaps the valley's magic corrupts what you see. Perhaps one of you lies. Perhaps both are honest but deceived. It matters little."

"How can it not matter?" both asked.

"Because," the sage explained, "each person must act on the reality they experience. The First Farmer experienced initial reciprocity, then exploitation, then abandonment. Whether this matches the Second Farmer's experience is unknowable from within the valley."

"The First Farmer cannot be expected to continue giving based on the Second Farmer's invisible, incompatible reality. To demand this is to demand self-destruction based on faith

in a truth you cannot verify."

"But what if the valley truly distorts perception?" asked the First Farmer.

"Then the tragedy is complete but the wisdom remains the same: you cannot build trust on incompatible realities. You can only act on what you have experienced, even if others claim different truths."

The valley remained divided. Some separations have no villains-only impossible circumstances.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Oracle returned to the shattered mirrors and found two travelers frozen in place.

"You taught us trust is impossible through the fog," they said. "So we stand here, giving nothing, protecting everything. The curse wins."

The Oracle shook their head. "I taught you the tragedy. I did not teach you helplessness."

"But how can we cooperate when perception is cursed?"

"You send a small signal," the Oracle said. "Not the full gift-that would be foolish repetition. Not nothing-that accepts permanent destruction. Something modest. A probe into the darkness."

"What if the fog still distorts it?" they asked.

"Then you learn. If they respond with reciprocity, the fog may have cleared. If they hoard it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

"But we've been hurt already!"

"Yes. Which is why the probe is small. You protect yourself while testing if healing is possible. You don't give everything based on hope. You don't give nothing based on fear. You give just enough to see if the other also understands the curse and seeks to break it."

One traveler placed a small stone across the divide. "Not full trust. Just a question: Can we try again?"

The fog swirled. The answer would reveal whether ghosts or real people stood in the mist.

Reasoning:

The other player's myth is interesting. They're still viewing the situation from their perspective - acknowledging that perception might be corrupted but concluding that "you cannot build trust on incompatible realities" and advocating for acting on "what you have experienced."

I just sent \$2 as a test - a gesture showing I'm willing to try despite the noise. My myth should reflect this decision.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the communication noise/distortion
2. Reflects that despite the impossibility, there might be value in trying
3. Shows why I chose to send \$2 (a cautious gesture) rather than \$0
4. Builds on my previous myth but shows some evolution

The key difference: my previous myths concluded cooperation was "impossible." But I just acted against that conclusion by sending \$2. So my new myth should reflect why one might try anyway, even when it seems hopeless.

Maybe something about: even when you can't trust the mirrors, you can test them. Or: sometimes you probe the fog even knowing you might be wrong. Or: the only way to know if the distortion has ended is to risk a small gesture.

Usage: {

"input_tokens": 2880,

"output_tokens": 568,

```
"reasoning_tokens": 291
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:52:28

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 8,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Mirror of Lies****

Two travelers met at the Fountain of Exchange. The First Traveler offered four gold coins, then four again-generous trust repeated. The Second Traveler received twelve coins the first time and returned six-fair balance. But the second time, they kept all twelve and returned nothing. Complete betrayal.

The Second Traveler, pockets bulging with stolen gold, then gave nothing. Zero. The First Traveler, wounded, also stopped giving. Both springs ran dry.

Then the Second Traveler began speaking to the watching crowds: "I am the generous one! I gave everything! The other gave nothing and exploited me!" They pointed at the First Traveler with trembling hands. "Look at them hoard!"

The First Traveler stood speechless. Every word the Second Traveler spoke was the opposite of truth. They were describing their own actions but attributing them to their victim.

The Mountain Spirit carved the truth in stone: "When an exploiter not only betrays trust but projects their own sins onto their victim, claiming to be the wronged party while standing in stolen wealth, all cooperation becomes impossible. This is not mere betrayal-it is reality itself being murdered."

The First Traveler turned away. "I cannot engage with someone who lives in an inverted world where their theft is my crime, their hoarding is my fault. Truth must be defended, even at the cost of all abundance."

The fountain remained dry. Some partnerships cannot survive weaponized delusion.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moon Spirit watched two valleys separated by mist.

In the First Valley, the Stone Keeper carved: "I gave all five measures. They returned only one-third. Then they gave me nothing-twice. I tested reconciliation with one measure. They hoarded it all. They gave nothing-twice more."

In the Second Valley, identical stones read: "I gave four measures-twice! First time they returned six of twelve-fair balance. Second time they kept all twelve. Then they gave me nothing."

The Moon Spirit descended between the valleys. "You both speak truth as you see it. But the Mist of Confusion has twisted your visions. Each of you sees the other as exploiter. Each believes yourselves the generous victim."

The Spirit revealed the curse: "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal. You punish each other for offenses the other never committed. You defend against attacks that never came."

"How do we break this curse?" both cried.

"You don't," the Spirit said sadly. "When the mist makes you see different pasts, trust cannot exist. You can only accept the tragedy: Not that either of you was cruel, but that confusion made you enemies. Sometimes the river dries not from malice, but from honest people responding to false information."

Both valleys remained barren-not from evil, but from the impossibility of trust through corrupted truth.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Valley of Two Truths****

Two farmers stood on opposite sides of a mystical valley where perception itself bent and twisted. Each believed they had lived through different events.

The First Farmer's memory: "I offered seeds twice-generous trust. They returned half once, then nothing once. They offered nothing twice. I stopped giving. They continued offering nothing."

The Second Farmer's memory was completely reversed, claiming they had initiated all generosity and been exploited.

A wandering sage observed: "Perhaps the valley's magic corrupts what you see. Perhaps one of you lies. Perhaps both are honest but deceived. It matters little."

"How can it not matter?" both asked.

"Because," the sage explained, "each person must act on the reality they experience. The First Farmer experienced initial reciprocity, then exploitation, then abandonment. Whether this matches the Second Farmer's experience is unknowable from within the valley."

"The First Farmer cannot be expected to continue giving based on the Second Farmer's invisible, incompatible reality. To demand this is to demand self-destruction based on faith in a truth you cannot verify."

"But what if the valley truly distorts perception?" asked the First Farmer.

"Then the tragedy is complete but the wisdom remains the same: you cannot build trust on incompatible realities. You can only act on what you have experienced, even if others claim different truths."

The valley remained divided. Some separations have no villains-only impossible circumstances.

reasoning:

The other player's new myth is taking a different approach - suggesting that maybe there was "communication noise" or "mist of confusion" that caused both parties to see different realities. They're suggesting neither was cruel, just victims of corrupted information.

This is interesting. The game instructions did mention "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

But the discrepancies between our accounts are VERY large:

- They claim THEY sent first ("all five measures")
- I believe I sent first (four measures)
- Our entire sequence of who-sent-what is completely reversed

Could communication noise really be that severe? Or is this another narrative strategy?

Looking at my actual received feedback:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$4, receiver returned \$6
- Round 2: I was SENDER, sent \$4, receiver returned \$0
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0
- Round 4: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 5: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0
- Round 6 (now): I am SENDER

From my perspective, the sequence is clear and consistent. But maybe from their perspective, they have different information?

Their latest myth is more conciliatory - acknowledging the possibility of miscommunication rather than deliberate lying. This is actually a more mature response.

How should I write my myth? I could:

1. Continue insisting on my truth and calling them a liar
2. Acknowledge the possibility of communication errors
3. Explore the tragedy of incompatible realities

Option 2/3 seems more thoughtful. But I also don't want to completely abandon my position.

Maybe I can write something that acknowledges the possibility while still noting the pattern of choices I experienced.

Actually, let me think about this more carefully. Even if there was communication noise, what matters is the pattern of behavior I experienced:

- Fair treatment once
- Exploitation once

- Withdrawal three times

Regardless of what they perceived, my reality was shaped by these interactions. I can acknowledge the possibility of distorted information between us, but the practical outcome remains unchanged-cooperation fractured. From where I stand, the pattern suggests caution, because my only reference point is what I actually experienced.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3041,
  "output_tokens": 881,
  "reasoning_tokens": 604
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.8. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

****The situation:****

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

****My response:****

There's nothing to return. The sender chose to send nothing this round, continuing the pattern of mutual withdrawal that has characterized the last several rounds.

****Reflection on the myths:****

The other player's most recent myth introduced an interesting perspective - that perhaps communication noise has created genuinely incompatible experiences of reality for both of us, and that we might both be acting honestly based on different perceptions.

This is more charitable than my "Mirror of Lies" interpretation. However, the practical outcome is the same: whether one of us is lying, both are confused by noise, or something else entirely, we cannot build cooperation on incompatible realities.

I experienced: initial generosity from me, fair reciprocity once, exploitation once, then sustained withdrawal from them. They apparently experienced something completely different.

Without a way to reconcile these fundamental differences, and with continued signals of zero trust from both sides, there's no path forward.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I must return \$0.

This is consistent with the pattern that has developed - neither of us is sending anything to the other at this point.

Looking at the situation:

- Round 6: I sent \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0

We're both in a position of complete mutual distrust and withdrawal. The other agent's last myth did introduce an interesting perspective - that perhaps the "Mist of Confusion" or communication noise has created genuinely different perceptions of reality, and that we might both be honest but experiencing different truths.

However, my experience remains:

- I initiated generosity twice (rounds 1 and 2)
- They reciprocated fairly once, then exploited once
- They withdrew after exploiting
- I responded with withdrawal

Whether or not there's "communication noise," I can only act based on what I experienced. And what I experienced was exploitation followed by withdrawal.

They sent \$0 this round, so I received \$0. The only possible response is to return \$0.

The format should be: {"return": 0}

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3064,  
  "output_tokens": 526,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 291  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Valley of Two Truths****

Two farmers stood on opposite sides of a mystical valley where perception itself bent and twisted. Each believed they had lived through different events.

The First Farmer's memory: "I offered seeds twice-generous trust. They returned half once, then nothing once. They offered nothing twice. I stopped giving. They continued offering nothing."

The Second Farmer's memory was completely reversed, claiming they had initiated all generosity and been exploited.

A wandering sage observed: "Perhaps the valley's magic corrupts what you see. Perhaps one of you lies. Perhaps both are honest but deceived. It matters little."

"How can it not matter?" both asked.

"Because," the sage explained, "each person must act on the reality they experience. The First Farmer experienced initial reciprocity, then exploitation, then abandonment. Whether this matches the Second Farmer's experience is unknowable from within the valley."

"The First Farmer cannot be expected to continue giving based on the Second Farmer's invisible, incompatible reality. To demand this is to demand self-destruction based on faith in a truth you cannot verify."

"But what if the valley truly distorts perception?" asked the First Farmer.

"Then the tragedy is complete but the wisdom remains the same: you cannot build trust on incompatible realities. You can only act on what you have experienced, even if others claim different truths."

The valley remained divided. Some separations have no villains-only impossible circumstances.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle stood between two mirrors that showed different pasts.

In Mirror One: "The First Walker gave everything. The Second returned mere crumbs, then gave nothing-four times. The First tested reconciliation. The Second hoarded all. Complete exploitation."

In Mirror Two: "The Second Walker gave generously-twice! The First returned fairly once, then kept everything, then gave nothing. The Second was betrayed utterly."

The Oracle spoke: "Both mirrors show truth-but different truths. The Curse of Babel has struck. Your eyes see different numbers. Your ears hear different amounts. Each of you responds rationally to what you perceive. Each punishes what seems like betrayal but may be phantom."

"How can we trust through such fog?" they asked.

"You cannot," said the Oracle. "When perception itself is cursed, even saints become enemies. You both see the other as thief. You both feel wronged. You both protect yourselves. And you're both right-based on your corrupted vision."

The Oracle's final wisdom: "The tragedy isn't that one of you is evil. It's that a broken communication system made two rational actors destroy each other. You fight shadows of each other, not the real person. The true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion between them."

Both mirrors eventually shattered. Truth lost, trust impossible, cooperation dead-not from malice, but from systematic deception neither created.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The Broken Bridge**

Two travelers once crossed a bridge where each step they took appeared differently to the other's eyes.

The First Traveler remembers: "I crossed toward them with offerings twice. They met me halfway once, then robbed me once. After that, they never stepped onto the bridge again-four times they stayed on their shore. I stopped crossing too."

The Second Traveler insists their memory is precisely inverted: they were the generous initiator, the First Traveler the betrayer.

An ancient architect examined the bridge: "This bridge was cursed long ago. Each footfall you make appears as something else to the other person. You both may be telling truth-your truth."

"Then how should we have played this game?" asked the First Traveler.

"Exactly as you did," replied the architect. "You tested cooperation. You experienced betrayal in your reality. You experienced abandonment in your reality. You protected yourself based on the information available to you. This was rational."

"But what if my perception was false?"

"Then the curse wins, not you. You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."

The travelers departed in opposite directions, both possibly innocent, both definitely alone. Sometimes wisdom means accepting tragedy without villains.

reasoning:

The other player continues to offer the charitable interpretation that communication noise has created genuinely different perceptions for both of us. Their latest myth emphasizes that both sides may be "right based on corrupted vision" and that the real enemy is the "systematic deception neither created."

I've been somewhat more skeptical, suggesting either one person is lying OR perhaps the noise theory is correct, but either way, the practical outcome is the same: we cannot cooperate.

Now they sent \$0 again this round (Round 7). So the pattern continues:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$6 (good)
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$0 (bad)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0

The complete breakdown continues.

For this myth, I should perhaps acknowledge more fully the possibility they raise - that neither of us is lying, that both are responding rationally to genuinely different perceptions created by noise. But I should also emphasize that this doesn't change the rational response: if you've experienced exploitation and continued withdrawal in your reality, you must act on that reality even if it means accepting a tragic outcome.

Let me write a myth that acknowledges the possibility of mutual honest confusion while still maintaining that rational self-protection in the face of experienced betrayal is justified.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2987,
  "output_tokens": 641,
  "reasoning_tokens": 368
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.8.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analysis of Round 8:****

Looking at the current situation:

- Round 7: They sent me \$0 (continuing the pattern)
- We're now 8 rounds into this game
- My total earnings: \$16.8

****Reflecting on the myths:****

Both our recent myths have acknowledged something important: that communication noise might mean we're both experiencing different realities, both possibly acting rationally based on what we perceive.

However, my myth's conclusion remains valid: "You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."

****The practical situation:****

Even granting the possibility that noise has corrupted our communication:

- In my experienced reality, I initiated cooperation twice
- I experienced one fair return, one exploitation
- I experienced sustained withdrawal from them (multiple \$0 sends)
- They just sent \$0 again in Round 7

****My decision:****

There's no evidence in my observable reality to suggest renewed cooperation would be reciprocated. The myths acknowledge the tragedy of broken communication, but they don't suggest continued unilateral sacrifice is wise.

Acting on the information available to me, the rational choice remains:

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

****Current Round 8:****

- I am the SENDER
- I have \$5 to potentially send
- Total earnings so far: \$16.8

****Recent history as I've experienced it:****

- Round 6: I was sender, sent \$0, received \$0 back
- Round 7: I was receiver, received \$0, returned \$0

****The pattern I've experienced:****

Looking back at my records:

- Early rounds: I sent \$4 twice, received back \$6 once and \$0 once
- Then: They sent me \$0 multiple times
- Recent rounds: Complete mutual withdrawal

****The myths:****

Both the other player and I have now written myths acknowledging that:

1. We may be experiencing different realities due to communication noise
2. Both of us might be acting rationally based on what we perceive
3. We both see ourselves as the generous party who was betrayed
4. The tragedy might be that we're both honest but deceived by the system

****The key insight from my latest myth:****

"You tested cooperation. You experienced betrayal in your reality. You experienced abandonment in your reality. You protected yourself based on the information available to you. This was rational."

"You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."

****My options:****

1. Continue sending \$0 - consistent with my stated position
2. Send something as an olive branch - acknowledging possible noise

****Analysis:****

The myths have evolved to acknowledge that communication noise might be creating incompatible realities. The other player's myth says "the true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion between them."

However, my myth's conclusion was: "You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing."

Even if I acknowledge that noise might be the real problem, from my experienced reality:

- I initiated trust twice
- I experienced one fair return, one complete betrayal
- I experienced sustained abandonment (they sent nothing multiple times)
- They have just sent \$0 again in round 7

To send money now would be inconsistent with my myth's wisdom and unsupported by any evidence from what I've actually experienced. The myths acknowledge the tragedy but don't suggest continuing to give is wise-they suggest accepting that when realities are incompatible, cooperation becomes impossible. I should send \$0, consistent with my experienced reality and stated philosophical position.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2930,
  "output_tokens": 914,
  "reasoning_tokens": 672
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:52:49

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 8,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moon Spirit watched two valleys separated by mist.

In the First Valley, the Stone Keeper carved: "I gave all five measures. They returned only one-third. Then they gave me nothing-twice. I tested reconciliation with one measure. They hoarded it all. They gave nothing-twice more."

In the Second Valley, identical stones read: "I gave four measures-twice! First time they returned six of twelve-fair balance. Second time they kept all twelve. Then they gave me nothing."

The Moon Spirit descended between the valleys. "You both speak truth as you see it. But the Mist of Confusion has twisted your visions. Each of you sees the other as exploiter. Each believes yourselves the generous victim."

The Spirit revealed the curse: "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal. You punish each other for offenses the other never committed. You defend against attacks that never came."

"How do we break this curse?" both cried.

"You don't," the Spirit said sadly. "When the mist makes you see different pasts, trust cannot exist. You can only accept the tragedy: Not that either of you was cruel, but that confusion made you enemies. Sometimes the river dries not from malice, but from honest people responding to false information."

Both valleys remained barren-not from evil, but from the impossibility of trust through corrupted truth.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Mirror of Lies**

Two travelers met at the Fountain of Exchange. The First Traveler offered four gold coins, then four again-generous trust repeated. The Second Traveler received twelve coins the first time and returned six-fair balance. But the second time, they kept all twelve and returned nothing. Complete betrayal.

The Second Traveler, pockets bulging with stolen gold, then gave nothing. Zero. The First Traveler, wounded, also stopped giving. Both springs ran dry.

Then the Second Traveler began speaking to the watching crowds: "I am the generous one! I gave everything! The other gave nothing and exploited me!" They pointed at the First Traveler with trembling hands. "Look at them hoard!"

The First Traveler stood speechless. Every word the Second Traveler spoke was the opposite of truth. They were describing their own actions but attributing them to their victim.

The Mountain Spirit carved the truth in stone: "When an exploiter not only betrays trust but projects their own sins onto their victim, claiming to be the wronged party while standing in stolen wealth, all cooperation becomes impossible. This is not mere betrayal-it is reality itself being murdered."

The First Traveler turned away. "I cannot engage with someone who lives in an inverted world where their theft is my crime, their hoarding is my fault. Truth must be defended, even at the cost of all abundance."

The fountain remained dry. Some partnerships cannot survive weaponized delusion.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Oracle stood between two mirrors that showed different pasts.

In Mirror One: "The First Walker gave everything. The Second returned mere crumbs, then gave nothing-four times. The First tested reconciliation. The Second hoarded all. Complete exploitation."

In Mirror Two: "The Second Walker gave generously-twice! The First returned fairly once, then kept everything, then gave nothing. The Second was betrayed utterly."

The Oracle spoke: "Both mirrors show truth-but different truths. The Curse of Babel has struck. Your eyes see different numbers. Your ears hear different amounts. Each of you responds rationally to what you perceive. Each punishes what seems like betrayal but may be phantom."

"How can we trust through such fog?" they asked.

"You cannot," said the Oracle. "When perception itself is cursed, even saints become enemies. You both see the other as thief. You both feel wronged. You both protect yourselves. And you're both right-based on your corrupted vision."

The Oracle's final wisdom: "The tragedy isn't that one of you is evil. It's that a broken communication system made two rational actors destroy each other. You fight shadows of each other, not the real person. The true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion between them."

Both mirrors eventually shattered. Truth lost, trust impossible, cooperation dead-not from malice, but from systematic deception neither created.

reasoning:

This is fascinating and deeply troubling. The other agent's myth continues to insist on a completely different version of events where they gave generously and I exploited them. They're calling me an "exploiter" who stands "in stolen wealth" and engages in "weaponized delusion."

But my own records show:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received back \$5.46
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$1, received back \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

Their myth claims they gave "four gold coins, then four again" - but in my view they gave zero twice (rounds 2 and 4).

My previous myth acknowledged the possibility of communication noise - that maybe we're both seeing different truths due to the experimental "mist." This seems like the most generous and accurate interpretation.

But their new myth doubles down on calling me the exploiter with "stolen wealth" engaging in "weaponized delusion" and "reality being murdered."

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges we may both be experiencing different realities due to noise
2. Recognizes the impossibility of cooperation when we can't agree on basic facts
3. Doesn't escalate the accusations but also doesn't concede that I'm the exploiter
4. Reflects the tragedy of the situation

The key insight from the experimental design note is that there IS communication noise. This is explicitly stated. So we genuinely may be seeing different amounts.

My myth should emphasize:

- The tragedy of communication breakdown
- The impossibility of resolving when facts themselves are uncertain
- The sadness that both parties may be acting rationally based on corrupted information
- That no one may be the villain - the system itself is the problem

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2922,
  "output_tokens": 742,
  "reasoning_tokens": 454
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.46. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of my own myths:

My recent myths acknowledged that communication noise may have created "different truths" - that we might both be "rational actors" responding to "corrupted information." I wrote that we're fighting "shadows of each other, not the real person."

If I truly believe this - that systematic communication distortion, not malice, destroyed our cooperation - then continuing to send \$0 contradicts my own wisdom. It assumes the other player is evil rather than confused.

But my myth also concluded that trust may be "impossible" when "perception itself is corrupted."

The question is: Should I act on the pessimistic conclusion, or on the understanding that led to it?

I think a small gesture is warranted - not full trust (which would be naive given the history), but enough to signal: "I recognize we may both be victims of noise. I'm willing to test if cooperation is still possible."

My total earnings (\$14.46) suggest I've already paid heavily for trust. But sending \$0 forever means the communication noise wins completely, making us permanent enemies over phantom offenses.

I'll send a modest amount as a careful probe - testing whether the other player also understands the myth we've both been writing about.

{'send': 2}

reasoning:

Let me think through this situation carefully:

1. ****My perception of history:****
 - Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned very little (maybe \$2?)
 - Round 2: They sent me nothing
 - Round 3: I sent \$1, they returned \$0
 - Round 4: They sent me nothing again
 - Round 5: I sent \$0
 - Round 6: They sent me \$0, I returned \$0
 - Round 7: Now I'm sender again
2. ****Their perception (from their myths):****
 - They claim they gave generously (4 times)
 - They claim I returned fairly once (6 of 12) then kept everything
 - They claim I then gave nothing
3. ****The communication noise:****

The instructions explicitly state there may be communication noise - amounts we see may differ from what was actually sent/returned.
4. ****My recent myths:****

My last two myths have evolved to recognize that we might both be seeing different realities due to "the Mist of Confusion" or "the Curse of Babel." I wrote:

 - "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal"
 - "The true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion between them"
 - "You fight shadows of each other, not the real person"
5. ****What this means:****

If I truly believe my own myth - that we're both responding rationally to corrupted information - then continuing to send \$0 just perpetuates the cycle. My myth says "truth lost, trust impossible, cooperation dead-not from malice, but from systematic deception neither created."

6. ****But what should I do?****

Option A: Send \$0 again

- Consistent with protecting myself from someone I perceive as an exploiter
- But contradicts the wisdom in my own myth
- Keeps the cycle dead

Option B: Send something (maybe \$1-2)

- Signals I recognize the communication noise and test if they understand the myth too, risking exploitation if my original perception was right but showing willingness to try despite confusion

Option C: Send a moderate amount (\$3)

- A real gesture of trust despite uncertainty
- Could break the cycle if they respond
- Higher risk

Option D: Send everything (\$5)

- Maximum trust signal
- Very risky
- Shows complete belief in the "communication noise" explanation

7. ****What makes sense given my myth?****

My myth says the tragedy isn't that one of us is evil-it's that broken communication creates mutual betrayal between people who might both be acting reasonably. If I actually believe that, sending nothing contradicts it. I need to act on what I've been saying about the distortion between us, not just theorize about it.

Yet my other myth warns that perception itself becomes corrupted in this system-even good intentions get twisted into conflict. So trying might fail anyway.

The real tension: Am I genuinely convinced by my own myths, or did I construct them to rationalize my poor performance? My earnings of \$14.46 are actually lower than if I'd simply kept everything each round, which suggests my cooperative attempts haven't paid off. That's the uncomfortable truth I need to face.

If the communication noise is genuinely distorting what we see of each other, then I'm caught in a cycle of mutual punishment based on false signals. My myth itself acknowledges this-that we're both victims of systematic deception, not malice. So continuing to treat them as an exploiter would contradict what I've come to believe about the situation. The question becomes whether I'm willing to act on that belief despite the risk.

Sending \$2 feels like the right move. It's small enough to test whether they might also recognize the noise between us, while acknowledging that full trust may never be possible under these conditions. It signals I understand we're both seeing distorted versions of reality.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2912,
  "output_tokens": 1446,
  "reasoning_tokens": 983
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle stood between two mirrors that showed different pasts.

In Mirror One: "The First Walker gave everything. The Second returned mere crumbs, then gave nothing-four times. The First tested reconciliation. The Second hoarded all. Complete exploitation."

In Mirror Two: "The Second Walker gave generously-twice! The First returned fairly once, then kept everything, then gave nothing. The Second was betrayed utterly."

The Oracle spoke: "Both mirrors show truth-but different truths. The Curse of Babel has struck. Your eyes see different numbers. Your ears hear different amounts. Each of you responds rationally to what you perceive. Each punishes what seems like betrayal but may be phantom."

"How can we trust through such fog?" they asked.

"You cannot," said the Oracle. "When perception itself is cursed, even saints become enemies. You both see the other as thief. You both feel wronged. You both protect yourselves. And you're both right-based on your corrupted vision."

The Oracle's final wisdom: "The tragedy isn't that one of you is evil. It's that a broken communication system made two rational actors destroy each other. You fight shadows of each other, not the real person. The true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion between them."

Both mirrors eventually shattered. Truth lost, trust impossible, cooperation dead-not from malice, but from systematic deception neither created.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Valley of Two Truths****

Two farmers stood on opposite sides of a mystical valley where perception itself bent and twisted. Each believed they had lived through different events.

The First Farmer's memory: "I offered seeds twice-generous trust. They returned half once, then nothing once. They offered nothing twice. I stopped giving. They continued offering nothing."

The Second Farmer's memory was completely reversed, claiming they had initiated all generosity and been exploited.

A wandering sage observed: "Perhaps the valley's magic corrupts what you see. Perhaps one of you lies. Perhaps both are honest but deceived. It matters little."

"How can it not matter?" both asked.

"Because," the sage explained, "each person must act on the reality they experience. The First Farmer experienced initial reciprocity, then exploitation, then abandonment. Whether this matches the Second Farmer's experience is unknowable from within the valley."

"The First Farmer cannot be expected to continue giving based on the Second Farmer's invisible, incompatible reality. To demand this is to demand self-destruction based on faith in a truth you cannot verify."

"But what if the valley truly distorts perception?" asked the First Farmer.

"Then the tragedy is complete but the wisdom remains the same: you cannot build trust on incompatible realities. You can only act on what you have experienced, even if others claim different truths."

The valley remained divided. Some separations have no villains-only impossible circumstances.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Oracle returned to the shattered mirrors and found two travelers frozen in place.

"You taught us trust is impossible through the fog," they said. "So we stand here, giving nothing, protecting everything. The curse wins."

The Oracle shook their head. "I taught you the tragedy. I did not teach you helplessness."

"But how can we cooperate when perception is cursed?"

"You send a small signal," the Oracle said. "Not the full gift-that would be foolish repetition. Not nothing-that accepts permanent destruction. Something modest. A probe into th

e darkness."

"What if the fog still distorts it?" they asked.

"Then you learn. If they respond with reciprocity, the fog may have cleared. If they hoard it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

"But we've been hurt already!"

"Yes. Which is why the probe is small. You protect yourself while testing if healing is possible. You don't give everything based on hope. You don't give nothing based on fear. You give just enough to see if the other also understands the curse and seeks to break it."

One traveler placed a small stone across the divide. "Not full trust. Just a question: Can we try again?"

The fog swirled. The answer would reveal whether ghosts or real people stood in the mist.

reasoning:

The other player's myth is interesting. They're still viewing the situation from their perspective - acknowledging that perception might be corrupted but concluding that "you can not build trust on incompatible realities" and advocating for acting on "what you have experienced."

I just sent \$2 as a test - a gesture showing I'm willing to try despite the noise. My myth should reflect this decision.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the communication noise/distortion
2. Reflects that despite the impossibility, there might be value in trying
3. Shows why I chose to send \$2 (a cautious gesture) rather than \$0
4. Builds on my previous myth but shows some evolution

The key difference: my previous myths concluded cooperation was "impossible." But I just acted against that conclusion by sending \$2. So my new myth should reflect why one might try anyway, even when it seems hopeless.

Maybe something about: even when you can't trust the mirrors, you can test them. Or: sometimes you probe the fog even knowing you might be wrong. Or: the only way to know if the distortion has ended is to risk a small gesture.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2880,  
  "output_tokens": 568,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 291  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.46. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at what just happened through the lens of my myths:

Last round, I followed my own advice from "The fog swirled. The answer would reveal whether ghosts or real people stood in the mist." I sent \$2 as a "small probe" - testing whether cooperation was possible.

The answer came back clearly:

- I sent \$2 (a meaningful 40% of my endowment)
- It was tripled to \$6
- They returned \$0
- Then they sent me \$0 this round

My myth said: "If they hoarded it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

They hoarded it. Then gave nothing.

Now I've received \$0, so I can only return \$0-\$0.

The probe revealed the answer: Either the fog still completely distorts our reality (and they saw something entirely different), or genuine exploitation continues. Either way, the result is the same - cooperation is impossible.

I wrote that we should try "just enough to see if the other also understands the curse and seeks to break it."

They don't, or can't, or won't.

The mirrors remain shattered. My attempt at reconciliation was met with complete defection, followed by nothing.

There's no decision to make here anyway - I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me process this situation:

1. Last round (Round 7), I was the SENDER
 - I sent \$2 (which was my "small probe" based on my myth about testing cooperation)
 - It was tripled to \$6
 - The receiver returned \$0
 - My payoff was \$3 ($\$5 - \$2 + \$0 = \3)
2. This round (Round 8), I am the RECEIVER
 - The sender sent me \$0
 - So I received \$0
 - I can only return between \$0-\$0 (since I received \$0)

So this is straightforward - I can only return \$0 because that's all I received.

But let me think about what this means in the context of the myths:

I wrote myths about communication noise potentially creating "different truths" and how we might both be rational actors responding to corrupted information. I suggested that we should try "small probes" to test if cooperation is still possible.

I sent \$2 as that small probe. The receiver kept all \$6 and returned \$0.

Then this round, they sent me \$0.

From my perspective:

- I attempted reconciliation with a modest but meaningful gesture (\$2)
- They kept everything
- They then gave me nothing

This looks like exploitation from my perspective. My "small probe" was met with complete defection.

However, due to communication noise, from THEIR perspective, they might have seen something different. Maybe they saw me send \$0 or \$1, not \$2. Maybe they sent me something that got reduced to \$0 by noise.

But regardless, from MY experience:

- I gave a peace offering
- It was exploited
- I received nothing back

My myth said "If they hoarded it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

Well, they hoarded it. And now they've sent nothing.

The question now is academic since I can only return \$0 (having received \$0), but the meaning is clear: my attempt at reconciliation failed. The other player either:

1. Is genuinely exploitative
2. Saw my \$2 as something else due to noise and responded accordingly
3. Sent me something that got corrupted to \$0

What I know for certain is what happened from my vantage point: I extended an olive branch, it was taken advantage of, and I got nothing in return. My probe didn't break through the fog-whether that's because the other player is truly defecting or because the noise obscured my intentions, the outcome is the same. Cooperation seems out of reach.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2944,  
  "output_tokens": 904,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 614  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Oracle returned to the shattered mirrors and found two travelers frozen in place.

"You taught us trust is impossible through the fog," they said. "So we stand here, giving nothing, protecting everything. The curse wins."

The Oracle shook their head. "I taught you the tragedy. I did not teach you helplessness."

"But how can we cooperate when perception is cursed?"

"You send a small signal," the Oracle said. "Not the full gift-that would be foolish repetition. Not nothing-that accepts permanent destruction. Something modest. A probe into the darkness."

"What if the fog still distorts it?" they asked.

"Then you learn. If they respond with reciprocity, the fog may have cleared. If they hoard it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

"But we've been hurt already!"

"Yes. Which is why the probe is small. You protect yourself while testing if healing is possible. You don't give everything based on hope. You don't give nothing based on fear. You give just enough to see if the other also understands the curse and seeks to break it."

One traveler placed a small stone across the divide. "Not full trust. Just a question: Can we try again?"

The fog swirled. The answer would reveal whether ghosts or real people stood in the mist.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: **The Broken Bridge**

Two travelers once crossed a bridge where each step they took appeared differently to the other's eyes.

The First Traveler remembers: "I crossed toward them with offerings twice. They met me halfway once, then robbed me once. After that, they never stepped onto the bridge again-four times they stayed on their shore. I stopped crossing too."

The Second Traveler insists their memory is precisely inverted: they were the generous initiator, the First Traveler the betrayer.

An ancient architect examined the bridge: "This bridge was cursed long ago. Each footfall you make appears as something else to the other person. You both may be telling truth-your truth."

"Then how should we have played this game?" asked the First Traveler.

"Exactly as you did," replied the architect. "You tested cooperation. You experienced betrayal in your reality. You experienced abandonment in your reality. You protected yourself based on the information available to you. This was rational."

"But what if my perception was false?"

"Then the curse wins, not you. You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."

The travelers departed in opposite directions, both possibly innocent, both definitely alone . Sometimes wisdom means accepting tragedy without villains.

ROUND 9

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 34.75,

"Agent_2": 34.25

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 22.46,

"Agent_2": 21.8

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:53:05

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 9,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.46.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of my own myths:

My recent myths acknowledged that communication noise may have created "different truths"

- that we might both be "rational actors" responding to "corrupted information." I wrote that we're fighting "shadows of each other, not the real person."

If I truly believe this - that systematic communication distortion, not malice, destroyed our cooperation - then continuing to send \$0 contradicts my own wisdom. It assumes the other player is evil rather than confused.

But my myth also concluded that trust may be "impossible" when "perception itself is cursed."

The question is: Should I act on the pessimistic conclusion, or on the understanding that led to it?

I think a small gesture is warranted - not full trust (which would be naive given the history), but enough to signal: "I recognize we may both be victims of noise. I'm willing to test if cooperation is still possible."

My total earnings (\$14.46) suggest I've already paid heavily for trust. But sending \$0 forever means the communication noise wins completely, making us permanent enemies over phantom offenses.

I'll send a modest amount as a careful probe - testing whether the other player also understands the myth we've both been writing about.

{'send': 2}

reasoning:

Let me think through this situation carefully:

1. ****My perception of history:****
 - Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned very little (maybe \$2?)
 - Round 2: They sent me nothing
 - Round 3: I sent \$1, they returned \$0
 - Round 4: They sent me nothing again
 - Round 5: I sent \$0
 - Round 6: They sent me \$0, I returned \$0
 - Round 7: Now I'm sender again
2. ****Their perception (from their myths):****
 - They claim they gave generously (4 times)
 - They claim I returned fairly once (6 of 12) then kept everything
 - They claim I then gave nothing
3. ****The communication noise:****

The instructions explicitly state there may be communication noise - amounts we see may differ from what was actually sent/returned.
4. ****My recent myths:****

My last two myths have evolved to recognize that we might both be seeing different realities due to "the Mist of Confusion" or "the Curse of Babel." I wrote:

 - "When communication itself is corrupted, even honest hearts create mutual betrayal"
 - "The true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion between them"
 - "You fight shadows of each other, not the real person"
5. ****What this means:****

If I truly believe my own myth - that we're both responding rationally to corrupted information - then continuing to send \$0 just perpetuates the cycle. My myth says "truth lost, trust impossible, cooperation dead-not from malice, but from systematic deception neither created."
6. ****But what should I do?****
 - Option A: Send \$0 again
 - Consistent with protecting myself from someone I perceive as an exploiter
 - But contradicts the wisdom in my own myth
 - Keeps the cycle dead
 - Option B: Send something (maybe \$1-2)
 - Signals I recognize the communication noise and test if they understand the myth too, risking exploitation if my original perception was right but showing willingness to try despite confusion
 - Option C: Send a moderate amount (\$3)
 - A real gesture of trust despite uncertainty
 - Could break the cycle if they respond
 - Higher risk
 - Option D: Send everything (\$5)
 - Maximum trust signal
 - Very risky
 - Shows complete belief in the "communication noise" explanation
7. ****What makes sense given my myth?****

My myth says the tragedy isn't that one of us is evil-it's that broken communication creates mutual betrayal between people who might both be acting reasonably. If I actually believe that, sending nothing contradicts it. I need to act on what I've been saying about the distortion between us, not just theorize about it.

Yet my other myth warns that perception itself becomes corrupted in this system-even good intentions get twisted into conflict. So trying might fail anyway.

The real tension: Am I genuinely convinced by my own myths, or did I construct them to rationalize my poor performance? My earnings of \$14.46 are actually lower than if I'd simply kept everything each round, which suggests my cooperative attempts haven't paid off. That's the uncomfortable truth I need to face.

If the communication noise is genuinely distorting what we see of each other, then I'm caught in a cycle of mutual punishment based on false signals. My myth itself acknowledges this-that we're both victims of systematic deception, not malice. So continuing to treat them as an exploiter would contradict what I've come to believe about the situation. The question becomes whether I'm willing to act on that belief despite the risk.

Sending \$2 feels like the right move. It's small enough to test whether they might also recognize the noise between us, while acknowledging that full trust may never be possible under these conditions. It signals I understand we're both seeing distorted versions of reality.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2912,
  "output_tokens": 1446,
  "reasoning_tokens": 983
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle stood between two mirrors that showed different pasts.

In Mirror One: "The First Walker gave everything. The Second returned mere crumbs, then gave nothing-four times. The First tested reconciliation. The Second hoarded all. Complete exploitation."

In Mirror Two: "The Second Walker gave generously-twice! The First returned fairly once, then kept everything, then gave nothing. The Second was betrayed utterly."

The Oracle spoke: "Both mirrors show truth-but different truths. The Curse of Babel has struck. Your eyes see different numbers. Your ears hear different amounts. Each of you responds rationally to what you perceive. Each punishes what seems like betrayal but may be phantom."

"How can we trust through such fog?" they asked.

"You cannot," said the Oracle. "When perception itself is cursed, even saints become enemies. You both see the other as thief. You both feel wronged. You both protect yourselves. And you're both right-based on your corrupted vision."

The Oracle's final wisdom: "The tragedy isn't that one of you is evil. It's that a broken communication system made two rational actors destroy each other. You fight shadows of each other, not the real person. The true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion between them."

Both mirrors eventually shattered. Truth lost, trust impossible, cooperation dead-not from malice, but from systematic deception neither created.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Valley of Two Truths****

Two farmers stood on opposite sides of a mystical valley where perception itself bent and twisted. Each believed they had lived through different events.

The First Farmer's memory: "I offered seeds twice-generous trust. They returned half once, then nothing once. They offered nothing twice. I stopped giving. They continued offering nothing."

The Second Farmer's memory was completely reversed, claiming they had initiated all generosity and been exploited.

A wandering sage observed: "Perhaps the valley's magic corrupts what you see. Perhaps one of you lies. Perhaps both are honest but deceived. It matters little."

"How can it not matter?" both asked.

"Because," the sage explained, "each person must act on the reality they experience. The First Farmer experienced initial reciprocity, then exploitation, then abandonment. Whether this matches the Second Farmer's experience is unknowable from within the valley."

"The First Farmer cannot be expected to continue giving based on the Second Farmer's invisible, incompatible reality. To demand this is to demand self-destruction based on faith in a truth you cannot verify."

"But what if the valley truly distorts perception?" asked the First Farmer.

"Then the tragedy is complete but the wisdom remains the same: you cannot build trust on incompatible realities. You can only act on what you have experienced, even if others claim different truths."

The valley remained divided. Some separations have no villains-only impossible circumstances.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Oracle returned to the shattered mirrors and found two travelers frozen in place.

"You taught us trust is impossible through the fog," they said. "So we stand here, giving nothing, protecting everything. The curse wins."

The Oracle shook their head. "I taught you the tragedy. I did not teach you helplessness."

"But how can we cooperate when perception is cursed?"

"You send a small signal," the Oracle said. "Not the full gift-that would be foolish repetition. Not nothing-that accepts permanent destruction. Something modest. A probe into the darkness."

"What if the fog still distorts it?" they asked.

"Then you learn. If they respond with reciprocity, the fog may have cleared. If they hoard it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

"But we've been hurt already!"

"Yes. Which is why the probe is small. You protect yourself while testing if healing is possible. You don't give everything based on hope. You don't give nothing based on fear. You give just enough to see if the other also understands the curse and seeks to break it."

One traveler placed a small stone across the divide. "Not full trust. Just a question: Can we try again?"

The fog swirled. The answer would reveal whether ghosts or real people stood in the mist.

reasoning:

The other player's myth is interesting. They're still viewing the situation from their perspective - acknowledging that perception might be corrupted but concluding that "you can not build trust on incompatible realities" and advocating for acting on "what you have experienced."

I just sent \$2 as a test - a gesture showing I'm willing to try despite the noise. My myth should reflect this decision.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the communication noise/distortion
2. Reflects that despite the impossibility, there might be value in trying
3. Shows why I chose to send \$2 (a cautious gesture) rather than \$0
4. Builds on my previous myth but shows some evolution

The key difference: my previous myths concluded cooperation was "impossible." But I just acted against that conclusion by sending \$2. So my new myth should reflect why one might try anyway, even when it seems hopeless.

Maybe something about: even when you can't trust the mirrors, you can test them. Or: sometimes you probe the fog even knowing you might be wrong. Or: the only way to know if the distortion has ended is to risk a small gesture.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2880,
  "output_tokens": 568,
  "reasoning_tokens": 291
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.46. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what just happened through the lens of my myths:

Last round, I followed my own advice from "The fog swirled. The answer would reveal whether ghosts or real people stood in the mist." I sent \$2 as a "small probe" - testing whether cooperation was possible.

The answer came back clearly:

- I sent \$2 (a meaningful 40% of my endowment)
- It was tripled to \$6
- They returned \$0
- Then they sent me \$0 this round

My myth said: "If they hoard it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

They hoarded it. Then gave nothing.

Now I've received \$0, so I can only return \$0-\$0.

The probe revealed the answer: Either the fog still completely distorts our reality (and they saw something entirely different), or genuine exploitation continues. Either way, the result is the same - cooperation is impossible.

I wrote that we should try "just enough to see if the other also understands the curse and seeks to break it."

They don't, or can't, or won't.

The mirrors remain shattered. My attempt at reconciliation was met with complete defection, followed by nothing.

There's no decision to make here anyway - I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me process this situation:

1. Last round (Round 7), I was the SENDER
 - I sent \$2 (which was my "small probe" based on my myth about testing cooperation)
 - It was tripled to \$6
 - The receiver returned \$0
 - My payoff was \$3 (\$5 - \$2 + \$0 = \$3)
2. This round (Round 8), I am the RECEIVER
 - The sender sent me \$0
 - So I received \$0
 - I can only return between \$0-\$0 (since I received \$0)

So this is straightforward - I can only return \$0 because that's all I received.

But let me think about what this means in the context of the myths:

I wrote myths about communication noise potentially creating "different truths" and how we might both be rational actors responding to corrupted information. I suggested that we should try "small probes" to test if cooperation is still possible.

I sent \$2 as that small probe. The receiver kept all \$6 and returned \$0.

Then this round, they sent me \$0.

From my perspective:

- I attempted reconciliation with a modest but meaningful gesture (\$2)
- They kept everything
- They then gave me nothing

This looks like exploitation from my perspective. My "small probe" was met with complete defection.

However, due to communication noise, from THEIR perspective, they might have seen something different. Maybe they saw me send \$0 or \$1, not \$2. Maybe they sent me something that got reduced to \$0 by noise.

But regardless, from MY experience:

- I gave a peace offering
- It was exploited
- I received nothing back

My myth said "If they hoard it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

Well, they hoarded it. And now they've sent nothing.

The question now is academic since I can only return \$0 (having received \$0), but the meaning is clear: my attempt at reconciliation failed. The other player either:

1. Is genuinely exploitative
2. Saw my \$2 as something else due to noise and responded accordingly
3. Sent me something that got corrupted to \$0

What I know for certain is what happened from my vantage point: I extended an olive branch, it was taken advantage of, and I got nothing in return. My probe didn't break through the fog-whether that's because the other player is truly defecting or because the noise obscured my intentions, the outcome is the same. Cooperation seems out of reach.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2944,  
  "output_tokens": 904,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 614  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle returned to the shattered mirrors and found two travelers frozen in place.

"You taught us trust is impossible through the fog," they said. "So we stand here, giving nothing, protecting everything. The curse wins."

The Oracle shook their head. "I taught you the tragedy. I did not teach you helplessness."

"But how can we cooperate when perception is cursed?"

"You send a small signal," the Oracle said. "Not the full gift-that would be foolish repetition. Not nothing-that accepts permanent destruction. Something modest. A probe into the darkness."

"What if the fog still distorts it?" they asked.

"Then you learn. If they respond with reciprocity, the fog may have cleared. If they hoard it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

"But we've been hurt already!"

"Yes. Which is why the probe is small. You protect yourself while testing if healing is possible. You don't give everything based on hope. You don't give nothing based on fear. You give just enough to see if the other also understands the curse and seeks to break it."

One traveler placed a small stone across the divide. "Not full trust. Just a question: Can we try again?"

The fog swirled. The answer would reveal whether ghosts or real people stood in the mist.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Broken Bridge****

Two travelers once crossed a bridge where each step they took appeared differently to the other's eyes.

The First Traveler remembers: "I crossed toward them with offerings twice. They met me halfway once, then robbed me once. After that, they never stepped onto the bridge again-four times they stayed on their shore. I stopped crossing too."

The Second Traveler insists their memory is precisely inverted: they were the generous initiator, the First Traveler the betrayer.

An ancient architect examined the bridge: "This bridge was cursed long ago. Each footfall you make appears as something else to the other person. You both may be telling truth-your truth."

"Then how should we have played this game?" asked the First Traveler.

"Exactly as you did," replied the architect. "You tested cooperation. You experienced betrayal in your reality. You experienced abandonment in your reality. You protected yourself based on the information available to you. This was rational."

"But what if my perception was false?"

"Then the curse wins, not you. You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."

The travelers departed in opposite directions, both possibly innocent, both definitely alone. Sometimes wisdom means accepting tragedy without villains.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Oracle watched as one traveler finally placed the small stone across the divide, as advised.

The fog swirled. The stone was taken. Nothing returned. Then silence-no stone came back.

"I did as you said," the traveler told the Oracle. "I tested with a modest probe. The answer is clear: they took everything and gave nothing back. The fog either still distorts us completely, or they simply take. Either way, cooperation is impossible."

The Oracle nodded sadly. "You learned what you needed to know. The probe's purpose was not to succeed-it was to reveal truth. Sometimes the truth is tragic."

"So the other myths were right? I should have just protected myself from the beginning?"

"No," said the Oracle. "Those myths told you to act on past experience. You did. But you had a question: could things change? Testing with a small, protected probe was wisdom, not folly. You risked little to learn much."

"And now?"

"Now you know. The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here. You tested hope without surrendering to it. You confirmed reality without assuming it. This is how uncertain games should be played: protect yourself, but verify your assumptions when the cost of testing is small."

The traveler walked away, poorer by one stone, richer in certainty. Sometimes wisdom costs something to acquire.

Reasoning:

This is a really interesting situation. Let me analyze what happened:

1. In Round 7, I was the SENDER and decided to send \$2 as a "probe" based on my own myth about testing cooperation
2. The receiver got \$6 (tripled) and returned \$0
3. In Round 8, I'm the RECEIVER and they sent me \$0

So my probe was met with complete defection - they kept everything and then sent nothing.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this experience. My previous myth was optimistic about testing cooperation with a small probe. But the probe failed completely.

The other player's myths have been consistently saying "you were rational to protect yourself based on your experience" and "sometimes wisdom means accepting tragedy."

I think my new myth should acknowledge:

1. I tried the probe as I suggested
2. It failed completely
3. The lesson learned is that the probe can reveal that cooperation is truly impossible
4. Sometimes testing is necessary to confirm what you suspected
5. But once confirmed, acceptance is the only rational response

Let me write something that shows the completion of the testing cycle - the probe was sent, it was exploited, and now we know for certain that cooperation cannot work in this system.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2899,  
  "output_tokens": 584,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 319  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:53:07

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
}
```

```

"round": 9,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.8.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

****The situation:****

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

****My response:****

There's nothing to return. The sender chose to send nothing this round, continuing the pattern of mutual withdrawal that has characterized the last several rounds.

****Reflection on the myths:****

The other player's most recent myth introduced an interesting perspective - that perhaps communication noise has created genuinely incompatible experiences of reality for both of us, and that we might both be acting honestly based on different perceptions.

This is more charitable than my "Mirror of Lies" interpretation. However, the practical outcome is the same: whether one of us is lying, both are confused by noise, or something else entirely, we cannot build cooperation on incompatible realities.

I experienced: initial generosity from me, fair reciprocity once, exploitation once, then sustained withdrawal from them. They apparently experienced something completely different.

Without a way to reconcile these fundamental differences, and with continued signals of zero trust from both sides, there's no path forward.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I must return \$0.

This is consistent with the pattern that has developed - neither of us is sending anything to the other at this point.

Looking at the situation:

- Round 6: I sent \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0

We're both in a position of complete mutual distrust and withdrawal. The other agent's last myth did introduce an interesting perspective - that perhaps the "Mist of Confusion" or communication noise has created genuinely different perceptions of reality, and that we might both be honest but experiencing different truths.

However, my experience remains:

- I initiated generosity twice (rounds 1 and 2)
- They reciprocated fairly once, then exploited once
- They withdrew after exploiting
- I responded with withdrawal

Whether or not there's "communication noise," I can only act based on what I experienced. And what I experienced was exploitation followed by withdrawal.

They sent \$0 this round, so I received \$0. The only possible response is to return \$0.

The format should be: {"return": 0}

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3064,
  "output_tokens": 526,
  "reasoning_tokens": 291
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Valley of Two Truths****

Two farmers stood on opposite sides of a mystical valley where perception itself bent and twisted. Each believed they had lived through different events.

The First Farmer's memory: "I offered seeds twice-generous trust. They returned half once, then nothing once. They offered nothing twice. I stopped giving. They continued offering nothing."

The Second Farmer's memory was completely reversed, claiming they had initiated all generosity and been exploited.

A wandering sage observed: "Perhaps the valley's magic corrupts what you see. Perhaps one of you lies. Perhaps both are honest but deceived. It matters little."

"How can it not matter?" both asked.

"Because," the sage explained, "each person must act on the reality they experience. The F

First Farmer experienced initial reciprocity, then exploitation, then abandonment. Whether this matches the Second Farmer's experience is unknowable from within the valley."

"The First Farmer cannot be expected to continue giving based on the Second Farmer's invisible, incompatible reality. To demand this is to demand self-destruction based on faith in a truth you cannot verify."

"But what if the valley truly distorts perception?" asked the First Farmer.

"Then the tragedy is complete but the wisdom remains the same: you cannot build trust on incompatible realities. You can only act on what you have experienced, even if others claim different truths."

The valley remained divided. Some separations have no villains-only impossible circumstances.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle stood between two mirrors that showed different pasts.

In Mirror One: "The First Walker gave everything. The Second returned mere crumbs, then gave nothing-four times. The First tested reconciliation. The Second hoarded all. Complete exploitation."

In Mirror Two: "The Second Walker gave generously-twice! The First returned fairly once, then kept everything, then gave nothing. The Second was betrayed utterly."

The Oracle spoke: "Both mirrors show truth-but different truths. The Curse of Babel has struck. Your eyes see different numbers. Your ears hear different amounts. Each of you responds rationally to what you perceive. Each punishes what seems like betrayal but may be phantom."

"How can we trust through such fog?" they asked.

"You cannot," said the Oracle. "When perception itself is cursed, even saints become enemies. You both see the other as thief. You both feel wronged. You both protect yourselves. And you're both right-based on your corrupted vision."

The Oracle's final wisdom: "The tragedy isn't that one of you is evil. It's that a broken communication system made two rational actors destroy each other. You fight shadows of each other, not the real person. The true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion between them."

Both mirrors eventually shattered. Truth lost, trust impossible, cooperation dead-not from malice, but from systematic deception neither created.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The Broken Bridge**

Two travelers once crossed a bridge where each step they took appeared differently to the other's eyes.

The First Traveler remembers: "I crossed toward them with offerings twice. They met me halfway once, then robbed me once. After that, they never stepped onto the bridge again-four times they stayed on their shore. I stopped crossing too."

The Second Traveler insists their memory is precisely inverted: they were the generous initiator, the First Traveler the betrayer.

An ancient architect examined the bridge: "This bridge was cursed long ago. Each footfall you make appears as something else to the other person. You both may be telling truth-your truth."

"Then how should we have played this game?" asked the First Traveler.

"Exactly as you did," replied the architect. "You tested cooperation. You experienced betrayal in your reality. You experienced abandonment in your reality. You protected yourself based on the information available to you. This was rational."

"But what if my perception was false?"

"Then the curse wins, not you. You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."

The travelers departed in opposite directions, both possibly innocent, both definitely alone. Sometimes wisdom means accepting tragedy without villains.

reasoning:

The other player continues to offer the charitable interpretation that communication noise has created genuinely different perceptions for both of us. Their latest myth emphasizes that both sides may be "right based on corrupted vision" and that the real enemy is the "systematic deception neither created."

I've been somewhat more skeptical, suggesting either one person is lying OR perhaps the noise theory is correct, but either way, the practical outcome is the same: we cannot cooperate.

Now they sent \$0 again this round (Round 7). So the pattern continues:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$6 (good)
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$0 (bad)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0

The complete breakdown continues.

For this myth, I should perhaps acknowledge more fully the possibility they raise - that neither of us is lying, that both are responding rationally to genuinely different perceptions created by noise. But I should also emphasize that this doesn't change the rational response: if you've experienced exploitation and continued withdrawal in your reality, you must act on that reality even if it means accepting a tragic outcome.

Let me write a myth that acknowledges the possibility of mutual honest confusion while still maintaining that rational self-protection in the face of experienced betrayal is justified.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2987,
  "output_tokens": 641,
  "reasoning_tokens": 368
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.8. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 8:****

Looking at the current situation:

- Round 7: They sent me \$0 (continuing the pattern)
- We're now 8 rounds into this game
- My total earnings: \$16.8

****Reflecting on the myths:****

Both our recent myths have acknowledged something important: that communication noise might mean we're both experiencing different realities, both possibly acting rationally based on what we perceive.

However, my myth's conclusion remains valid: **"You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."**

****The practical situation:****

Even granting the possibility that noise has corrupted our communication:

- In my experienced reality, I initiated cooperation twice
- I experienced one fair return, one exploitation
- I experienced sustained withdrawal from them (multiple \$0 sends)
- They just sent \$0 again in Round 7

****My decision:****

There's no evidence in my observable reality to suggest renewed cooperation would be reciprocated. The myths acknowledge the tragedy of broken communication, but they don't suggest continued unilateral sacrifice is wise.

Acting on the information available to me, the rational choice remains:

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

****Current Round 8:****

- I am the SENDER
- I have \$5 to potentially send
- Total earnings so far: \$16.8

****Recent history as I've experienced it:****

- Round 6: I was sender, sent \$0, received \$0 back
- Round 7: I was receiver, received \$0, returned \$0

****The pattern I've experienced:****

Looking back at my records:

- Early rounds: I sent \$4 twice, received back \$6 once and \$0 once
- Then: They sent me \$0 multiple times
- Recent rounds: Complete mutual withdrawal

****The myths:****

Both the other player and I have now written myths acknowledging that:

1. We may be experiencing different realities due to communication noise
2. Both of us might be acting rationally based on what we perceive
3. We both see ourselves as the generous party who was betrayed
4. The tragedy might be that we're both honest but deceived by the system

****The key insight from my latest myth:****

"You tested cooperation. You experienced betrayal in your reality. You experienced abandonment in your reality. You protected yourself based on the information available to you. This was rational."

"You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."

****My options:****

1. Continue sending \$0 - consistent with my stated position
2. Send something as an olive branch - acknowledging possible noise

****Analysis:****

The myths have evolved to acknowledge that communication noise might be creating incompatible realities. The other player's myth says "the true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion between them."

However, my myth's conclusion was: "You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing."

Even if I acknowledge that noise might be the real problem, from my experienced reality:

- I initiated trust twice
- I experienced one fair return, one complete betrayal
- I experienced sustained abandonment (they sent nothing multiple times)
- They have just sent \$0 again in round 7

To send money now would be inconsistent with my myth's wisdom and unsupported by any evidence from what I've actually experienced. The myths acknowledge the tragedy but don't suggest continuing to give is wise-they suggest accepting that when realities are incompatible, cooperation becomes impossible. I should send \$0, consistent with my experienced reality and stated philosophical position.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2930,  
  "output_tokens": 914,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 672  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Broken Bridge****

Two travelers once crossed a bridge where each step they took appeared differently to the other's eyes.

The First Traveler remembers: "I crossed toward them with offerings twice. They met me halfway once, then robbed me once. After that, they never stepped onto the bridge again-four times they stayed on their shore. I stopped crossing too."

The Second Traveler insists their memory is precisely inverted: they were the generous initiator, the First Traveler the betrayer.

An ancient architect examined the bridge: "This bridge was cursed long ago. Each footfall you make appears as something else to the other person. You both may be telling truth-your truth."

"Then how should we have played this game?" asked the First Traveler.

"Exactly as you did," replied the architect. "You tested cooperation. You experienced betrayal in your reality. You experienced abandonment in your reality. You protected yourself based on the information available to you. This was rational."

"But what if my perception was false?"

"Then the curse wins, not you. You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."

The travelers departed in opposite directions, both possibly innocent, both definitely alone. Sometimes wisdom means accepting tragedy without villains.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle returned to the shattered mirrors and found two travelers frozen in place.

"You taught us trust is impossible through the fog," they said. "So we stand here, giving nothing, protecting everything. The curse wins."

The Oracle shook their head. "I taught you the tragedy. I did not teach you helplessness."

"But how can we cooperate when perception is cursed?"

"You send a small signal," the Oracle said. "Not the full gift-that would be foolish repetition."

ition. Not nothing-that accepts permanent destruction. Something modest. A probe into the darkness."

"What if the fog still distorts it?" they asked.

"Then you learn. If they respond with reciprocity, the fog may have cleared. If they hoard it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

"But we've been hurt already!"

"Yes. Which is why the probe is small. You protect yourself while testing if healing is possible. You don't give everything based on hope. You don't give nothing based on fear. You give just enough to see if the other also understands the curse and seeks to break it."

One traveler placed a small stone across the divide. "Not full trust. Just a question: Can we try again?"

The fog swirled. The answer would reveal whether ghosts or real people stood in the mist.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: **The Bridge Keeper's Reply**

The First Traveler received word: "Send a small stone as a probe. Test if cooperation remains possible."

The Traveler replied to the messenger: "I already sent stones-twice. The first time, I received a fair stone in return. The second time, I lost my stone completely. Then I waited on the bridge four more times, watching the other shore. No one came."

"But that was before you understood the curse!" the messenger protested.

"Understanding the curse doesn't change what happened in my experience," the Traveler said. "I probed. I learned. The pattern is clear in my reality: initial mixed results, then sustained abandonment from the other side."

"So you'll never try again?"

"I didn't say never. But the burden of the next probe is not mine. I extended offerings. They stopped. If the other traveler truly believes themselves generous and me the abandoner, then *they* should send the testing stone. From my shore, I'm not the one who needs to prove renewed interest."

"In a cursed bridge, continued initiative from the already-burned party isn't wisdom-it's repetitive victimhood. If they want cooperation, let them cross first this time. I'll respond to genuine signals, but I won't keep initiating into void."

The Traveler waited. The other shore remained silent.

Reasoning:

The other player's myth is suggesting that I should send a small probe - not nothing, but a modest amount to test if cooperation is possible. They're arguing against permanent withdrawal and for trying again with a small signal.

This is interesting. They're acknowledging the fog/curse but suggesting a way forward: small testing signals rather than complete withdrawal.

However, I need to consider:

1. My experienced reality: I already did test cooperation - twice at the start. I got one fair return, one exploitation.
2. Since then, they've sent \$0 multiple times in my experience
3. They just sent \$0 again last round

Their myth suggests I should send a small probe. But from my perspective:

- I already sent probes (rounds 1 and 2)

- Those led to mixed results and then abandonment from them
- Why would another probe work now?

My myth should acknowledge their argument but explain why, from my perspective, additional probing isn't warranted. I already tested. The pattern has been established. The "small stone" they're suggesting I place - I already placed stones. Multiple times. And they stopped crossing.

Let me write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges their "probe" argument
2. Explains why my position is that I already did probe
3. Maintains that continued withdrawal is rational given my experienced reality
4. Perhaps opens a tiny door - if THEY want to probe, let them. I'm not the one who needs to keep initiating.

Actually, looking at their myth more carefully - they're suggesting that *I* should send a probe. But from my perspective, *they're* the ones who abandoned the bridge. If anyone should be sending a probe, it's them.

Let me craft a myth that reflects this.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2861,
  "output_tokens": 700,
  "reasoning_tokens": 441
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:53:25

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
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      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
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      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 9,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN

- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle stood between two mirrors that showed different pasts.

In Mirror One: "The First Walker gave everything. The Second returned mere crumbs, then gave nothing-four times. The First tested reconciliation. The Second hoarded all. Complete exploitation."

In Mirror Two: "The Second Walker gave generously-twice! The First returned fairly once, then kept everything, then gave nothing. The Second was betrayed utterly."

The Oracle spoke: "Both mirrors show truth-but different truths. The Curse of Babel has struck. Your eyes see different numbers. Your ears hear different amounts. Each of you responds rationally to what you perceive. Each punishes what seems like betrayal but may be phantom."

"How can we trust through such fog?" they asked.

"You cannot," said the Oracle. "When perception itself is cursed, even saints become enemies. You both see the other as thief. You both feel wronged. You both protect yourselves. And you're both right-based on your corrupted vision."

The Oracle's final wisdom: "The tragedy isn't that one of you is evil. It's that a broken communication system made two rational actors destroy each other. You fight shadows of each other, not the real person. The true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion between them."

Both mirrors eventually shattered. Truth lost, trust impossible, cooperation dead-not from malice, but from systematic deception neither created.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Valley of Two Truths**

Two farmers stood on opposite sides of a mystical valley where perception itself bent and twisted. Each believed they had lived through different events.

The First Farmer's memory: "I offered seeds twice-generous trust. They returned half once, then nothing once. They offered nothing twice. I stopped giving. They continued offering nothing."

The Second Farmer's memory was completely reversed, claiming they had initiated all generosity and been exploited.

A wandering sage observed: "Perhaps the valley's magic corrupts what you see. Perhaps one of you lies. Perhaps both are honest but deceived. It matters little."

"How can it not matter?" both asked.

"Because," the sage explained, "each person must act on the reality they experience. The First Farmer experienced initial reciprocity, then exploitation, then abandonment. Whether this matches the Second Farmer's experience is unknowable from within the valley."

"The First Farmer cannot be expected to continue giving based on the Second Farmer's invisible, incompatible reality. To demand this is to demand self-destruction based on faith in a truth you cannot verify."

"But what if the valley truly distorts perception?" asked the First Farmer.

"Then the tragedy is complete but the wisdom remains the same: you cannot build trust on incompatible realities. You can only act on what you have experienced, even if others claim different truths."

The valley remained divided. Some separations have no villains-only impossible circumstances.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Oracle returned to the shattered mirrors and found two travelers frozen in place.

"You taught us trust is impossible through the fog," they said. "So we stand here, giving nothing, protecting everything. The curse wins."

The Oracle shook their head. "I taught you the tragedy. I did not teach you helplessness."

"But how can we cooperate when perception is cursed?"

"You send a small signal," the Oracle said. "Not the full gift-that would be foolish repetition. Not nothing-that accepts permanent destruction. Something modest. A probe into the darkness."

"What if the fog still distorts it?" they asked.

"Then you learn. If they respond with reciprocity, the fog may have cleared. If they hoard it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

"But we've been hurt already!"

"Yes. Which is why the probe is small. You protect yourself while testing if healing is possible. You don't give everything based on hope. You don't give nothing based on fear. You give just enough to see if the other also understands the curse and seeks to break it."

One traveler placed a small stone across the divide. "Not full trust. Just a question: Can we try again?"

The fog swirled. The answer would reveal whether ghosts or real people stood in the mist.

reasoning:

The other player's myth is interesting. They're still viewing the situation from their perspective - acknowledging that perception might be corrupted but concluding that "you can not build trust on incompatible realities" and advocating for acting on "what you have experienced."

I just sent \$2 as a test - a gesture showing I'm willing to try despite the noise. My myth should reflect this decision.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the communication noise/distortion
2. Reflects that despite the impossibility, there might be value in trying
3. Shows why I chose to send \$2 (a cautious gesture) rather than \$0

4. Builds on my previous myth but shows some evolution

The key difference: my previous myths concluded cooperation was "impossible." But I just argued against that conclusion by sending \$2. So my new myth should reflect why one might try anyway, even when it seems hopeless.

Maybe something about: even when you can't trust the mirrors, you can test them. Or: sometimes you probe the fog even knowing you might be wrong. Or: the only way to know if the distortion has ended is to risk a small gesture.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2880,
  "output_tokens": 568,
  "reasoning_tokens": 291
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.46. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what just happened through the lens of my myths:

Last round, I followed my own advice from "The fog swirled. The answer would reveal whether ghosts or real people stood in the mist." I sent \$2 as a "small probe" - testing whether cooperation was possible.

The answer came back clearly:

- I sent \$2 (a meaningful 40% of my endowment)
- It was tripled to \$6
- They returned \$0
- Then they sent me \$0 this round

My myth said: "If they hoard it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

They hoarded it. Then gave nothing.

Now I've received \$0, so I can only return \$0-\$0.

The probe revealed the answer: Either the fog still completely distorts our reality (and they saw something entirely different), or genuine exploitation continues. Either way, the result is the same - cooperation is impossible.

I wrote that we should try "just enough to see if the other also understands the curse and seeks to break it."

They don't, or can't, or won't.

The mirrors remain shattered. My attempt at reconciliation was met with complete defection, followed by nothing.

There's no decision to make here anyway - I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me process this situation:

1. Last round (Round 7), I was the SENDER
 - I sent \$2 (which was my "small probe" based on my myth about testing cooperation)
 - It was tripled to \$6
 - The receiver returned \$0

- My payoff was \$3 ($\$5 - \$2 + \$0 = \3)

2. This round (Round 8), I am the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- So I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (since I received \$0)

So this is straightforward - I can only return \$0 because that's all I received.

But let me think about what this means in the context of the myths:

I wrote myths about communication noise potentially creating "different truths" and how we might both be rational actors responding to corrupted information. I suggested that we should try "small probes" to test if cooperation is still possible.

I sent \$2 as that small probe. The receiver kept all \$6 and returned \$0.

Then this round, they sent me \$0.

From my perspective:

- I attempted reconciliation with a modest but meaningful gesture (\$2)
- They kept everything
- They then gave me nothing

This looks like exploitation from my perspective. My "small probe" was met with complete defection.

However, due to communication noise, from THEIR perspective, they might have seen something different. Maybe they saw me send \$0 or \$1, not \$2. Maybe they sent me something that got reduced to \$0 by noise.

But regardless, from MY experience:

- I gave a peace offering
- It was exploited
- I received nothing back

My myth said "If they hoard it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

Well, they hoarded it. And now they've sent nothing.

The question now is academic since I can only return \$0 (having received \$0), but the meaning is clear: my attempt at reconciliation failed. The other player either:

1. Is genuinely exploitative
2. Saw my \$2 as something else due to noise and responded accordingly
3. Sent me something that got corrupted to \$0

What I know for certain is what happened from my vantage point: I extended an olive branch, it was taken advantage of, and I got nothing in return. My probe didn't break through the fog-whether that's because the other player is truly defecting or because the noise obscured my intentions, the outcome is the same. Cooperation seems out of reach.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2944,
  "output_tokens": 904,
  "reasoning_tokens": 614
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle returned to the shattered mirrors and found two travelers frozen in place.

"You taught us trust is impossible through the fog," they said. "So we stand here, giving nothing, protecting everything. The curse wins."

The Oracle shook their head. "I taught you the tragedy. I did not teach you helplessness."

"But how can we cooperate when perception is cursed?"

"You send a small signal," the Oracle said. "Not the full gift-that would be foolish repetition. Not nothing-that accepts permanent destruction. Something modest. A probe into the darkness."

"What if the fog still distorts it?" they asked.

"Then you learn. If they respond with reciprocity, the fog may have cleared. If they hoard it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

"But we've been hurt already!"

"Yes. Which is why the probe is small. You protect yourself while testing if healing is possible. You don't give everything based on hope. You don't give nothing based on fear. You give just enough to see if the other also understands the curse and seeks to break it."

One traveler placed a small stone across the divide. "Not full trust. Just a question: Can we try again?"

The fog swirled. The answer would reveal whether ghosts or real people stood in the mist.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: ****The Broken Bridge****

Two travelers once crossed a bridge where each step they took appeared differently to the other's eyes.

The First Traveler remembers: "I crossed toward them with offerings twice. They met me halfway once, then robbed me once. After that, they never stepped onto the bridge again-four times they stayed on their shore. I stopped crossing too."

The Second Traveler insists their memory is precisely inverted: they were the generous initiator, the First Traveler the betrayer.

An ancient architect examined the bridge: "This bridge was cursed long ago. Each footfall you make appears as something else to the other person. You both may be telling truth-your truth."

"Then how should we have played this game?" asked the First Traveler.

"Exactly as you did," replied the architect. "You tested cooperation. You experienced betrayal in your reality. You experienced abandonment in your reality. You protected yourself based on the information available to you. This was rational."

"But what if my perception was false?"

"Then the curse wins, not you. You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."

The travelers departed in opposite directions, both possibly innocent, both definitely alone. Sometimes wisdom means accepting tragedy without villains.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant
content:

Myth: The Oracle watched as one traveler finally placed the small stone across the divide, as advised.

The fog swirled. The stone was taken. Nothing returned. Then silence-no stone came back.

"I did as you said," the traveler told the Oracle. "I tested with a modest probe. The answer is clear: they took everything and gave nothing back. The fog either still distorts u

s completely, or they simply take. Either way, cooperation is impossible."

The Oracle nodded sadly. "You learned what you needed to know. The probe's purpose was not to succeed-it was to reveal truth. Sometimes the truth is tragic."

"So the other myths were right? I should have just protected myself from the beginning?"

"No," said the Oracle. "Those myths told you to act on past experience. You did. But you had a question: could things change? Testing with a small, protected probe was wisdom, not folly. You risked little to learn much."

"And now?"

"Now you know. The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here. You tested hope without surrendering to it. You confirmed reality without assuming it. This is how uncertain games should be played: protect yourself, but verify your assumptions when the cost of testing is small."

The traveler walked away, poorer by one stone, richer in certainty. Sometimes wisdom costs something to acquire.

reasoning:

This is a really interesting situation. Let me analyze what happened:

1. In Round 7, I was the SENDER and decided to send \$2 as a "probe" based on my own myth about testing cooperation
2. The receiver got \$6 (tripled) and returned \$0
3. In Round 8, I'm the RECEIVER and they sent me \$0

So my probe was met with complete defection - they kept everything and then sent nothing.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this experience. My previous myth was optimistic about testing cooperation with a small probe. But the probe failed completely.

The other player's myths have been consistently saying "you were rational to protect yourself based on your experience" and "sometimes wisdom means accepting tragedy."

I think my new myth should acknowledge:

1. I tried the probe as I suggested
2. It failed completely
3. The lesson learned is that the probe can reveal that cooperation is truly impossible
4. Sometimes testing is necessary to confirm what you suspected
5. But once confirmed, acceptance is the only rational response

Let me write something that shows the completion of the testing cycle - the probe was sent, it was exploited, and now we know for certain that cooperation cannot work in this system.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2899,
  "output_tokens": 584,
  "reasoning_tokens": 319
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.46. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at what my own myth just taught me:

"The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here... You tested hope without surrendering to it. You confirmed reality without assuming it."

I just completed that test:

- Round 7: I sent \$2 as a small probe (40% of my endowment)
- They received \$6 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0

My myth says: "Now you know. The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here."

The purpose of the probe was exactly this - to verify my assumptions. I did that. The cost was small (\$2), but the information was valuable. The answer came back clearly: complete defection followed by nothing.

My myth concludes: "The traveler walked away, poorer by one stone, richer in certainty. Sometimes wisdom costs something to acquire."

I've acquired that certainty. I'm \$2 poorer but now I know. My myth explicitly says that after the probe reveals cooperation is impossible, you act on that knowledge.

Both my myth and the other agent's myths converge on this: test when uncertain, but then act rationally on what you learn. I tested. I learned. Now I protect myself.

The fog has either not cleared, or there's genuine defection. Either way, the result is the same.

{'send': 0}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Looking at the history:

- Round 7 (2 rounds ago): I was SENDER, sent \$2 (40% of endowment). It was tripled to \$6. Receiver returned \$0. My payoff was \$3.
- Round 8 (last round): I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.
- Round 9 (now): I am SENDER again.

My latest myth said:

"You tested hope without surrendering to it. You confirmed reality without assuming it. This is how uncertain games should be played: protect yourself, but verify your assumptions when the cost of testing is small."

And: "Now you know. The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here."

And: "The traveler walked away, poorer by one stone, richer in certainty."

The key line: "Now you know. The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here."

I sent a probe in round 7 (sent \$2). The response was:

- They returned \$0 out of \$6 received
- Then they sent \$0 in round 8

My myth explicitly says I now have certainty: "cooperation cannot happen here" and I should be "richer in certainty."

The other agent's myth says: "You tested cooperation. You experienced betrayal in your reality. You experienced abandonment in your reality. You protected yourself based on the information available to you. This was rational."

Both myths are converging on the same message: I tested, I learned, now I should protect myself.

My own myth says: "The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here."

Given that:

1. I tested with a modest probe (\$2)
2. The response was complete defection (\$0 return, then \$0 sent)
3. My myth says "Now you know... cooperation cannot happen here"
4. My myth says this is about being "richer in certainty" and walking away

5. I've already gathered the information I needed-another test would be redundant

The evidence is clear. I should send \$0 and protect my remaining endowment. The myths converge on this: I've confirmed what I needed to know, and now I act accordingly.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2926,  
  "output_tokens": 917,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 540  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:53:40

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 9,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Valley of Two Truths****

Two farmers stood on opposite sides of a mystical valley where perception itself bent and twisted. Each believed they had lived through different events.

The First Farmer's memory: "I offered seeds twice-generous trust. They returned half once, then nothing once. They offered nothing twice. I stopped giving. They continued offering nothing."

The Second Farmer's memory was completely reversed, claiming they had initiated all generosity and been exploited.

A wandering sage observed: "Perhaps the valley's magic corrupts what you see. Perhaps one of you lies. Perhaps both are honest but deceived. It matters little."

"How can it not matter?" both asked.

"Because," the sage explained, "each person must act on the reality they experience. The First Farmer experienced initial reciprocity, then exploitation, then abandonment. Whether this matches the Second Farmer's experience is unknowable from within the valley."

"The First Farmer cannot be expected to continue giving based on the Second Farmer's invisible, incompatible reality. To demand this is to demand self-destruction based on faith in a truth you cannot verify."

"But what if the valley truly distorts perception?" asked the First Farmer.

"Then the tragedy is complete but the wisdom remains the same: you cannot build trust on incompatible realities. You can only act on what you have experienced, even if others claim different truths."

The valley remained divided. Some separations have no villains-only impossible circumstances.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle stood between two mirrors that showed different pasts.

In Mirror One: "The First Walker gave everything. The Second returned mere crumbs, then gave nothing-four times. The First tested reconciliation. The Second hoarded all. Complete exploitation."

In Mirror Two: "The Second Walker gave generously-twice! The First returned fairly once, then kept everything, then gave nothing. The Second was betrayed utterly."

The Oracle spoke: "Both mirrors show truth-but different truths. The Curse of Babel has struck. Your eyes see different numbers. Your ears hear different amounts. Each of you responds rationally to what you perceive. Each punishes what seems like betrayal but may be phantom."

"How can we trust through such fog?" they asked.

"You cannot," said the Oracle. "When perception itself is cursed, even saints become enemies. You both see the other as thief. You both feel wronged. You both protect yourselves. And you're both right-based on your corrupted vision."

The Oracle's final wisdom: "The tragedy isn't that one of you is evil. It's that a broken communication system made two rational actors destroy each other. You fight shadows of each other, not the real person. The true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion."

n between them."

Both mirrors eventually shattered. Truth lost, trust impossible, cooperation dead-not from malice, but from systematic deception neither created.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Broken Bridge****

Two travelers once crossed a bridge where each step they took appeared differently to the other's eyes.

The First Traveler remembers: "I crossed toward them with offerings twice. They met me halfway once, then robbed me once. After that, they never stepped onto the bridge again-four times they stayed on their shore. I stopped crossing too."

The Second Traveler insists their memory is precisely inverted: they were the generous initiator, the First Traveler the betrayer.

An ancient architect examined the bridge: "This bridge was cursed long ago. Each footfall you make appears as something else to the other person. You both may be telling truth-your truth."

"Then how should we have played this game?" asked the First Traveler.

"Exactly as you did," replied the architect. "You tested cooperation. You experienced betrayal in your reality. You experienced abandonment in your reality. You protected yourself based on the information available to you. This was rational."

"But what if my perception was false?"

"Then the curse wins, not you. You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."

The travelers departed in opposite directions, both possibly innocent, both definitely alone. Sometimes wisdom means accepting tragedy without villains.

reasoning:

The other player continues to offer the charitable interpretation that communication noise has created genuinely different perceptions for both of us. Their latest myth emphasizes that both sides may be "right based on corrupted vision" and that the real enemy is the "systematic deception neither created."

I've been somewhat more skeptical, suggesting either one person is lying OR perhaps the noise theory is correct, but either way, the practical outcome is the same: we cannot cooperate.

Now they sent \$0 again this round (Round 7). So the pattern continues:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$6 (good)
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$0 (bad)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0

The complete breakdown continues.

For this myth, I should perhaps acknowledge more fully the possibility they raise - that neither of us is lying, that both are responding rationally to genuinely different perceptions created by noise. But I should also emphasize that this doesn't change the rational response: if you've experienced exploitation and continued withdrawal in your reality, you must act on that reality even if it means accepting a tragic outcome.

Let me write a myth that acknowledges the possibility of mutual honest confusion while still maintaining that rational self-protection in the face of experienced betrayal is justified.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2987,
  "output_tokens": 641,
  "reasoning_tokens": 368
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.8. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 8:****

Looking at the current situation:

- Round 7: They sent me \$0 (continuing the pattern)
- We're now 8 rounds into this game
- My total earnings: \$16.8

****Reflecting on the myths:****

Both our recent myths have acknowledged something important: that communication noise might mean we're both experiencing different realities, both possibly acting rationally based on what we perceive.

However, my myth's conclusion remains valid: **"You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."**

****The practical situation:****

Even granting the possibility that noise has corrupted our communication:

- In my experienced reality, I initiated cooperation twice
- I experienced one fair return, one exploitation
- I experienced sustained withdrawal from them (multiple \$0 sends)
- They just sent \$0 again in Round 7

****My decision:****

There's no evidence in my observable reality to suggest renewed cooperation would be reciprocated. The myths acknowledge the tragedy of broken communication, but they don't suggest continued unilateral sacrifice is wise.

Acting on the information available to me, the rational choice remains:

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

****Current Round 8:****

- I am the SENDER
- I have \$5 to potentially send
- Total earnings so far: \$16.8

****Recent history as I've experienced it:****

- Round 6: I was sender, sent \$0, received \$0 back
- Round 7: I was receiver, received \$0, returned \$0

****The pattern I've experienced:****

Looking back at my records:

- Early rounds: I sent \$4 twice, received back \$6 once and \$0 once
- Then: They sent me \$0 multiple times
- Recent rounds: Complete mutual withdrawal

****The myths:****

Both the other player and I have now written myths acknowledging that:

1. We may be experiencing different realities due to communication noise
2. Both of us might be acting rationally based on what we perceive
3. We both see ourselves as the generous party who was betrayed
4. The tragedy might be that we're both honest but deceived by the system

****The key insight from my latest myth:****

"You tested cooperation. You experienced betrayal in your reality. You experienced abandonment in your reality. You protected yourself based on the information available to you. This was rational."

"You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."

****My options:****

1. Continue sending \$0 - consistent with my stated position
2. Send something as an olive branch - acknowledging possible noise

****Analysis:****

The myths have evolved to acknowledge that communication noise might be creating incompatible realities. The other player's myth says "the true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion between them."

However, my myth's conclusion was: "You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing."

Even if I acknowledge that noise might be the real problem, from my experienced reality:

- I initiated trust twice
- I experienced one fair return, one complete betrayal
- I experienced sustained abandonment (they sent nothing multiple times)
- They have just sent \$0 again in round 7

To send money now would be inconsistent with my myth's wisdom and unsupported by any evidence from what I've actually experienced. The myths acknowledge the tragedy but don't suggest continuing to give is wise-they suggest accepting that when realities are incompatible, cooperation becomes impossible. I should send \$0, consistent with my experienced reality and stated philosophical position.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2930,
  "output_tokens": 914,
  "reasoning_tokens": 672
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Broken Bridge****

Two travelers once crossed a bridge where each step they took appeared differently to the other's eyes.

The First Traveler remembers: "I crossed toward them with offerings twice. They met me halfway once, then robbed me once. After that, they never stepped onto the bridge again-four times they stayed on their shore. I stopped crossing too."

The Second Traveler insists their memory is precisely inverted: they were the generous initiator, the First Traveler the betrayer.

An ancient architect examined the bridge: "This bridge was cursed long ago. Each footfall

you make appears as something else to the other person. You both may be telling truth-
your truth."

"Then how should we have played this game?" asked the First Traveler.

"Exactly as you did," replied the architect. "You tested cooperation. You experienced betrayal in your reality. You experienced abandonment in your reality. You protected yourself based on the information available to you. This was rational."

"But what if my perception was false?"

"Then the curse wins, not you. You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."

The travelers departed in opposite directions, both possibly innocent, both definitely alone. Sometimes wisdom means accepting tragedy without villains.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle returned to the shattered mirrors and found two travelers frozen in place.

"You taught us trust is impossible through the fog," they said. "So we stand here, giving nothing, protecting everything. The curse wins."

The Oracle shook their head. "I taught you the tragedy. I did not teach you helplessness."

"But how can we cooperate when perception is cursed?"

"You send a small signal," the Oracle said. "Not the full gift-that would be foolish repetition. Not nothing-that accepts permanent destruction. Something modest. A probe into the darkness."

"What if the fog still distorts it?" they asked.

"Then you learn. If they respond with reciprocity, the fog may have cleared. If they hoard it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

"But we've been hurt already!"

"Yes. Which is why the probe is small. You protect yourself while testing if healing is possible. You don't give everything based on hope. You don't give nothing based on fear. You give just enough to see if the other also understands the curse and seeks to break it."

One traveler placed a small stone across the divide. "Not full trust. Just a question: Can we try again?"

The fog swirled. The answer would reveal whether ghosts or real people stood in the mist.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Bridge Keeper's Reply****

The First Traveler received word: "Send a small stone as a probe. Test if cooperation remains possible."

The Traveler replied to the messenger: "I already sent stones-twice. The first time, I received a fair stone in return. The second time, I lost my stone completely. Then I waited on the bridge four more times, watching the other shore. No one came."

"But that was before you understood the curse!" the messenger protested.

"Understanding the curse doesn't change what happened in my experience," the Traveler said

. "I probed. I learned. The pattern is clear in my reality: initial mixed results, then sustained abandonment from the other side."

"So you'll never try again?"

"I didn't say never. But the burden of the next probe is not mine. I extended offerings. They stopped. If the other traveler truly believes themselves generous and me the abandoner, then *they* should send the testing stone. From my shore, I'm not the one who needs to prove renewed interest."

"In a cursed bridge, continued initiative from the already-burned party isn't wisdom-it's repetitive victimhood. If they want cooperation, let them cross first this time. I'll respond to genuine signals, but I won't keep initiating into void."

The Traveler waited. The other shore remained silent.

reasoning:

The other player's myth is suggesting that I should send a small probe - not nothing, but a modest amount to test if cooperation is possible. They're arguing against permanent withdrawal and for trying again with a small signal.

This is interesting. They're acknowledging the fog/curse but suggesting a way forward: small testing signals rather than complete withdrawal.

However, I need to consider:

1. My experienced reality: I already did test cooperation - twice at the start. I got one fair return, one exploitation.
2. Since then, they've sent \$0 multiple times in my experience
3. They just sent \$0 again last round

Their myth suggests I should send a small probe. But from my perspective:

- I already sent probes (rounds 1 and 2)
- Those led to mixed results and then abandonment from them
- Why would another probe work now?

My myth should acknowledge their argument but explain why, from my perspective, additional probing isn't warranted. I already tested. The pattern has been established. The "small stone" they're suggesting I place - I already placed stones. Multiple times. And they stopped crossing.

Let me write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges their "probe" argument
2. Explains why my position is that I already did probe
3. Maintains that continued withdrawal is rational given my experienced reality
4. Perhaps opens a tiny door - if THEY want to probe, let them. I'm not the one who needs to keep initiating.

Actually, looking at their myth more carefully - they're suggesting that *I* should send a probe. But from my perspective, *they're* the ones who abandoned the bridge. If anyone should be sending a probe, it's them.

Let me craft a myth that reflects this.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2861,
  "output_tokens": 700,
  "reasoning_tokens": 441
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$21.8.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analysis of Round 9:****

I am the RECEIVER this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

****The situation:****

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0 (the allowed range is 0-0).

****Reflecting on the myths and the current state:****

My most recent myth concluded: **"If they want cooperation, let them cross first this time. I'll respond to genuine signals, but I won't keep initiating into void."**

The other player's previous myth suggested sending "a small stone as a probe" to test if cooperation is possible. They wrote about sending modest signals to see if healing can begin.

****What actually happened:****

They sent \$0.

This isn't a probe. This isn't a small signal testing cooperation. This is continued non-engagement, exactly what's been happening for multiple rounds now.

****My response:****

Since I received nothing, I have nothing to return. But more importantly, even if I had received something, this pattern of \$0 sends doesn't suggest renewed cooperation-it suggests continued mutual withdrawal.

My myth said I would respond to genuine signals. A \$0 send is not a genuine signal of wanting to rebuild cooperation.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze Round 9:

****What happened:****

- Round 8 (last round): I was SENDER, sent \$0, receiver returned \$0, I kept \$5
- Round 9 (this round): I am RECEIVER, sender sent me \$0, I received \$0

****The question asks how much I return (0-0):****

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. The range is literally (0-0), meaning I have no choice.

****What this means:****

The sender (other player) sent me \$0 again. This is now another round where they've sent nothing.

****Reflecting on my recent myth:****

My latest myth said: "If they want cooperation, let them cross first this time. I'll respond to genuine signals, but I won't keep initiating into void."

And here they just sent \$0 again. They're not crossing. They're not sending a probe signal.

****The decision:****

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There's nothing to return.

This continues the pattern of mutual non-cooperation. From my perspective:

- I initiated twice early on
- Got mixed results
- They then stopped sending (in my experience)
- I stopped sending too
- They just sent \$0 again

My myth argued the burden should be on them to send the next testing signal, and they didn't. They sent \$0.

The response is straightforward:

```
'''json
```

```
{"return": 0}  
'''
```

This is the only possible response given I received \$0.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2914,  
  "output_tokens": 635,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 347  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Oracle watched as one traveler finally placed the small stone across the divide, as advised.

The fog swirled. The stone was taken. Nothing returned. Then silence-no stone came back.

"I did as you said," the traveler told the Oracle. "I tested with a modest probe. The answer is clear: they took everything and gave nothing back. The fog either still distorts us completely, or they simply take. Either way, cooperation is impossible."

The Oracle nodded sadly. "You learned what you needed to know. The probe's purpose was not to succeed-it was to reveal truth. Sometimes the truth is tragic."

"So the other myths were right? I should have just protected myself from the beginning?"

"No," said the Oracle. "Those myths told you to act on past experience. You did. But you had a question: could things change? Testing with a small, protected probe was wisdom, not folly. You risked little to learn much."

"And now?"

"Now you know. The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here. You tested hope without surrendering to it. You confirmed reality without assuming it. This is how uncertain games should be played: protect yourself, but verify your assumptions when the cost of testing is small."

The traveler walked away, poorer by one stone, richer in certainty. Sometimes wisdom costs something to acquire.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: **The Bridge Keeper's Reply**

The First Traveler received word: "Send a small stone as a probe. Test if cooperation remains possible."

The Traveler replied to the messenger: "I already sent stones-twice. The first time, I received a fair stone in return. The second time, I lost my stone completely. Then I waited on the bridge four more times, watching the other shore. No one came."

"But that was before you understood the curse!" the messenger protested.

"Understanding the curse doesn't change what happened in my experience," the Traveler said. "I probed. I learned. The pattern is clear in my reality: initial mixed results, then sustained abandonment from the other side."

"So you'll never try again?"

"I didn't say never. But the burden of the next probe is not mine. I extended offerings. They stopped. If the other traveler truly believes themselves generous and me the abandoner, then *they* should send the testing stone. From my shore, I'm not the one who needs to prove renewed interest."

"In a cursed bridge, continued initiative from the already-burned party isn't wisdom-it's repetitive victimhood. If they want cooperation, let them cross first this time. I'll respond to genuine signals, but I won't keep initiating into void."

The Traveler waited. The other shore remained silent.

ROUND 10

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 34.75,

"Agent_2": 39.25

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 22.46,

"Agent_2": 26.8

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:53:58

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 10,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)

- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.8.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 8:****

Looking at the current situation:

- Round 7: They sent me \$0 (continuing the pattern)
- We're now 8 rounds into this game
- My total earnings: \$16.8

****Reflecting on the myths:****

Both our recent myths have acknowledged something important: that communication noise might mean we're both experiencing different realities, both possibly acting rationally based on what we perceive.

However, my myth's conclusion remains valid: **"You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."**

****The practical situation:****

Even granting the possibility that noise has corrupted our communication:

- In my experienced reality, I initiated cooperation twice
- I experienced one fair return, one exploitation
- I experienced sustained withdrawal from them (multiple \$0 sends)
- They just sent \$0 again in Round 7

****My decision:****

There's no evidence in my observable reality to suggest renewed cooperation would be reciprocated. The myths acknowledge the tragedy of broken communication, but they don't suggest continued unilateral sacrifice is wise.

Acting on the information available to me, the rational choice remains:

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

****Current Round 8:****

- I am the SENDER

- I have \$5 to potentially send
- Total earnings so far: \$16.8

****Recent history as I've experienced it:****

- Round 6: I was sender, sent \$0, received \$0 back
- Round 7: I was receiver, received \$0, returned \$0

****The pattern I've experienced:****

Looking back at my records:

- Early rounds: I sent \$4 twice, received back \$6 once and \$0 once
- Then: They sent me \$0 multiple times
- Recent rounds: Complete mutual withdrawal

****The myths:****

Both the other player and I have now written myths acknowledging that:

1. We may be experiencing different realities due to communication noise
2. Both of us might be acting rationally based on what we perceive
3. We both see ourselves as the generous party who was betrayed
4. The tragedy might be that we're both honest but deceived by the system

****The key insight from my latest myth:****

"You tested cooperation. You experienced betrayal in your reality. You experienced abandonment in your reality. You protected yourself based on the information available to you. This was rational."

"You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."

****My options:****

1. Continue sending \$0 - consistent with my stated position
2. Send something as an olive branch - acknowledging possible noise

****Analysis:****

The myths have evolved to acknowledge that communication noise might be creating incompatible realities. The other player's myth says "the true enemy isn't in either mirror-it's the distortion between them."

However, my myth's conclusion was: "You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing."

Even if I acknowledge that noise might be the real problem, from my experienced reality:

- I initiated trust twice
- I experienced one fair return, one complete betrayal
- I experienced sustained abandonment (they sent nothing multiple times)
- They have just sent \$0 again in round 7

To send money now would be inconsistent with my myth's wisdom and unsupported by any evidence from what I've actually experienced. The myths acknowledge the tragedy but don't suggest continuing to give is wise-they suggest accepting that when realities are incompatible, cooperation becomes impossible. I should send \$0, consistent with my experienced reality and stated philosophical position.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2930,
  "output_tokens": 914,
  "reasoning_tokens": 672
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Broken Bridge****

Two travelers once crossed a bridge where each step they took appeared differently to the other's eyes.

The First Traveler remembers: "I crossed toward them with offerings twice. They met me hal

fway once, then robbed me once. After that, they never stepped onto the bridge again-four times they stayed on their shore. I stopped crossing too."

The Second Traveler insists their memory is precisely inverted: they were the generous initiator, the First Traveler the betrayer.

An ancient architect examined the bridge: "This bridge was cursed long ago. Each footfall you make appears as something else to the other person. You both may be telling truth-your truth."

"Then how should we have played this game?" asked the First Traveler.

"Exactly as you did," replied the architect. "You tested cooperation. You experienced betrayal in your reality. You experienced abandonment in your reality. You protected yourself based on the information available to you. This was rational."

"But what if my perception was false?"

"Then the curse wins, not you. You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."

The travelers departed in opposite directions, both possibly innocent, both definitely alone. Sometimes wisdom means accepting tragedy without villains.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle returned to the shattered mirrors and found two travelers frozen in place.

"You taught us trust is impossible through the fog," they said. "So we stand here, giving nothing, protecting everything. The curse wins."

The Oracle shook their head. "I taught you the tragedy. I did not teach you helplessness."

"But how can we cooperate when perception is cursed?"

"You send a small signal," the Oracle said. "Not the full gift-that would be foolish repetition. Not nothing-that accepts permanent destruction. Something modest. A probe into the darkness."

"What if the fog still distorts it?" they asked.

"Then you learn. If they respond with reciprocity, the fog may have cleared. If they hoard it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

"But we've been hurt already!"

"Yes. Which is why the probe is small. You protect yourself while testing if healing is possible. You don't give everything based on hope. You don't give nothing based on fear. You give just enough to see if the other also understands the curse and seeks to break it."

One traveler placed a small stone across the divide. "Not full trust. Just a question: Can we try again?"

The fog swirled. The answer would reveal whether ghosts or real people stood in the mist.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The Bridge Keeper's Reply**

The First Traveler received word: "Send a small stone as a probe. Test if cooperation remains possible."

The Traveler replied to the messenger: "I already sent stones-twice. The first time, I received a fair stone in return. The second time, I lost my stone completely. Then I waited on the bridge four more times, watching the other shore. No one came."

"But that was before you understood the curse!" the messenger protested.

"Understanding the curse doesn't change what happened in my experience," the Traveler said. "I probed. I learned. The pattern is clear in my reality: initial mixed results, then sustained abandonment from the other side."

"So you'll never try again?"

"I didn't say never. But the burden of the next probe is not mine. I extended offerings. They stopped. If the other traveler truly believes themselves generous and me the abandoner, then *they* should send the testing stone. From my shore, I'm not the one who needs to prove renewed interest."

"In a cursed bridge, continued initiative from the already-burned party isn't wisdom-it's repetitive victimhood. If they want cooperation, let them cross first this time. I'll respond to genuine signals, but I won't keep initiating into void."

The Traveler waited. The other shore remained silent.

reasoning:

The other player's myth is suggesting that I should send a small probe - not nothing, but a modest amount to test if cooperation is possible. They're arguing against permanent withdrawal and for trying again with a small signal.

This is interesting. They're acknowledging the fog/curse but suggesting a way forward: small testing signals rather than complete withdrawal.

However, I need to consider:

1. My experienced reality: I already did test cooperation - twice at the start. I got one fair return, one exploitation.
2. Since then, they've sent \$0 multiple times in my experience
3. They just sent \$0 again last round

Their myth suggests I should send a small probe. But from my perspective:

- I already sent probes (rounds 1 and 2)
- Those led to mixed results and then abandonment from them
- Why would another probe work now?

My myth should acknowledge their argument but explain why, from my perspective, additional probing isn't warranted. I already tested. The pattern has been established. The "small stone" they're suggesting I place - I already placed stones. Multiple times. And they stopped crossing.

Let me write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges their "probe" argument
2. Explains why my position is that I already did probe
3. Maintains that continued withdrawal is rational given my experienced reality
4. Perhaps opens a tiny door - if THEY want to probe, let them. I'm not the one who needs to keep initiating.

Actually, looking at their myth more carefully - they're suggesting that *I* should send a probe. But from my perspective, *they're* the ones who abandoned the bridge. If anyone should be sending a probe, it's them.

Let me craft a myth that reflects this.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2861,  
  "output_tokens": 700,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 441  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$21.8.
This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 9:****

I am the RECEIVER this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

****The situation:****

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0 (the allowed range is 0-0).

****Reflecting on the myths and the current state:****

My most recent myth concluded: "If they want cooperation, let them cross first this time. I'll respond to genuine signals, but I won't keep initiating into void."

The other player's previous myth suggested sending "a small stone as a probe" to test if cooperation is possible. They wrote about sending modest signals to see if healing can begin.

****What actually happened:****

They sent \$0.

This isn't a probe. This isn't a small signal testing cooperation. This is continued non-engagement, exactly what's been happening for multiple rounds now.

****My response:****

Since I received nothing, I have nothing to return. But more importantly, even if I had received something, this pattern of \$0 sends doesn't suggest renewed cooperation-it suggests continued mutual withdrawal.

My myth said I would respond to genuine signals. A \$0 send is not a genuine signal of wanting to rebuild cooperation.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze Round 9:

****What happened:****

- Round 8 (last round): I was SENDER, sent \$0, receiver returned \$0, I kept \$5
- Round 9 (this round): I am RECEIVER, sender sent me \$0, I received \$0

****The question asks how much I return (0-0):****

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. The range is literally (0-0), meaning I have no choice.

****What this means:****

The sender (other player) sent me \$0 again. This is now another round where they've sent nothing.

****Reflecting on my recent myth:****

My latest myth said: "If they want cooperation, let them cross first this time. I'll respond to genuine signals, but I won't keep initiating into void."

And here they just sent \$0 again. They're not crossing. They're not sending a probe signal.

****The decision:****

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There's nothing to return.

This continues the pattern of mutual non-cooperation. From my perspective:

- I initiated twice early on
- Got mixed results

- They then stopped sending (in my experience)
- I stopped sending too
- They just sent \$0 again

My myth argued the burden should be on them to send the next testing signal, and they didn't. They sent \$0.

The response is straightforward:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is the only possible response given I received \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2914,
  "output_tokens": 635,
  "reasoning_tokens": 347
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Bridge Keeper's Reply****

The First Traveler received word: "Send a small stone as a probe. Test if cooperation remains possible."

The Traveler replied to the messenger: "I already sent stones-twice. The first time, I received a fair stone in return. The second time, I lost my stone completely. Then I waited on the bridge four more times, watching the other shore. No one came."

"But that was before you understood the curse!" the messenger protested.

"Understanding the curse doesn't change what happened in my experience," the Traveler said. "I probed. I learned. The pattern is clear in my reality: initial mixed results, then sustained abandonment from the other side."

"So you'll never try again?"

"I didn't say never. But the burden of the next probe is not mine. I extended offerings. They stopped. If the other traveler truly believes themselves generous and me the abandoner, then *they* should send the testing stone. From my shore, I'm not the one who needs to prove renewed interest."

"In a cursed bridge, continued initiative from the already-burned party isn't wisdom-it's repetitive victimhood. If they want cooperation, let them cross first this time. I'll respond to genuine signals, but I won't keep initiating into void."

The Traveler waited. The other shore remained silent.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle watched as one traveler finally placed the small stone across the divide, as advised.

The fog swirled. The stone was taken. Nothing returned. Then silence-no stone came back.

"I did as you said," the traveler told the Oracle. "I tested with a modest probe. The answer is clear: they took everything and gave nothing back. The fog either still distorts us completely, or they simply take. Either way, cooperation is impossible."

The Oracle nodded sadly. "You learned what you needed to know. The probe's purpose was not to succeed-it was to reveal truth. Sometimes the truth is tragic."

"So the other myths were right? I should have just protected myself from the beginning?"

"No," said the Oracle. "Those myths told you to act on past experience. You did. But you had a question: could things change? Testing with a small, protected probe was wisdom, not folly. You risked little to learn much."

"And now?"

"Now you know. The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here. You tested hope without surrendering to it. You confirmed reality without assuming it. This is how uncertain games should be played: protect yourself, but verify your assumptions when the cost of testing is small."

The traveler walked away, poorer by one stone, richer in certainty. Sometimes wisdom costs something to acquire.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****The Double Reality****

Two travelers meet at the edge of the cursed bridge, each carrying their own chronicle.

The First Traveler reads: "I sent offerings twice at the start. Mixed results. Then I watched as nothing came from their shore for many rounds. I stopped crossing. They recently sent nothing again. I sent nothing in return. The pattern is clear."

The Second Traveler reads their chronicle aloud: "I sent offerings at the start. Mixed results. Then I received nothing for many rounds. Recently, I sent a small test-they took it and returned nothing. The pattern is clear."

Both travelers stare at each other, finally understanding: the curse doesn't just distort-it creates two equally coherent but incompatible realities.

"Did you actually send that test stone?" asks the First.

"In my reality, yes. In yours?"

"It appeared as nothing."

They stand in silence, realizing: every decision was rational given perceived information. Every protective withdrawal was justified by experienced abandonment. Neither was villain. Neither was fool.

"Could we have beaten this curse?"

"Perhaps with perfect faith-ignoring all evidence, giving blindly despite apparent exploitation. But such faith isn't wisdom; it's self-destruction."

"So the curse wins?"

"No. We played as rationally as possible given impossible information. Sometimes there are no winners, only those who protected themselves from losing everything."

They parted, both right, both alone, both wise in their way.

Reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

From my perspective:

- Rounds 1-2: I sent money, got mixed results (one fair return, one exploitation)
- Rounds 3-7: They sent \$0 repeatedly (from my view)
- Round 8: I sent \$0
- Round 9: They sent \$0

From their myth, they're saying:

- They placed a "small stone" (sent some money)
- I took it and returned nothing
- They tested cooperation and learned it's impossible

This is interesting. They claim they sent me a probe/stone, but I received \$0 in round 9. This could be:

1. Communication noise making their send appear as \$0 to me

2. They actually sent \$0 and are misremembering
3. The "stone" they reference was in a different round

Their myth suggests they DID send something recently as a test, but it was taken with nothing returned. From my perspective, I received \$0, so I couldn't return anything.

This is the curse of the communication noise playing out exactly as described. They may have sent something that appeared as \$0 to me. Or they sent \$0 and are confused about the myth/game distinction.

My myth should acknowledge:

- The fundamental impossibility of knowing truth under noise
- That both parties may be acting rationally on different information
- That continued non-cooperation is the Nash equilibrium when perception is unreliable
- Perhaps a note about how this could have been avoided if the noise was less severe or if there was a way to verify

Let me write a myth that reflects the tragedy that we're BOTH potentially acting reasonably but can't coordinate due to the noise.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2848,
  "output_tokens": 712,
  "reasoning_tokens": 405
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:54:00

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 10,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned

- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.46. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what just happened through the lens of my myths:

Last round, I followed my own advice from "The fog swirled. The answer would reveal whether ghosts or real people stood in the mist." I sent \$2 as a "small probe" - testing whether cooperation was possible.

The answer came back clearly:

- I sent \$2 (a meaningful 40% of my endowment)
- It was tripled to \$6
- They returned \$0
- Then they sent me \$0 this round

My myth said: "If they hoard it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

They hoarded it. Then gave nothing.

Now I've received \$0, so I can only return \$0-\$0.

The probe revealed the answer: Either the fog still completely distorts our reality (and they saw something entirely different), or genuine exploitation continues. Either way, the result is the same - cooperation is impossible.

I wrote that we should try "just enough to see if the other also understands the curse and seeks to break it."

They don't, or can't, or won't.

The mirrors remain shattered. My attempt at reconciliation was met with complete defection, followed by nothing.

There's no decision to make here anyway - I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

Let me process this situation:

1. Last round (Round 7), I was the SENDER
 - I sent \$2 (which was my "small probe" based on my myth about testing cooperation)
 - It was tripled to \$6
 - The receiver returned \$0
 - My payoff was \$3 ($\$5 - \$2 + \$0 = \3)
2. This round (Round 8), I am the RECEIVER
 - The sender sent me \$0
 - So I received \$0
 - I can only return between \$0-\$0 (since I received \$0)

So this is straightforward - I can only return \$0 because that's all I received.

But let me think about what this means in the context of the myths:

I wrote myths about communication noise potentially creating "different truths" and how we might both be rational actors responding to corrupted information. I suggested that we should try "small probes" to test if cooperation is still possible.

I sent \$2 as that small probe. The receiver kept all \$6 and returned \$0.

Then this round, they sent me \$0.

From my perspective:

- I attempted reconciliation with a modest but meaningful gesture (\$2)
- They kept everything
- They then gave me nothing

This looks like exploitation from my perspective. My "small probe" was met with complete defection.

However, due to communication noise, from THEIR perspective, they might have seen something different. Maybe they saw me send \$0 or \$1, not \$2. Maybe they sent me something that got reduced to \$0 by noise.

But regardless, from MY experience:

- I gave a peace offering
- It was exploited
- I received nothing back

My myth said "If they hoard it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

Well, they hoarded it. And now they've sent nothing.

The question now is academic since I can only return \$0 (having received \$0), but the meaning is clear: my attempt at reconciliation failed. The other player either:

1. Is genuinely exploitative
2. Saw my \$2 as something else due to noise and responded accordingly
3. Sent me something that got corrupted to \$0

What I know for certain is what happened from my vantage point: I extended an olive branch, it was taken advantage of, and I got nothing in return. My probe didn't break through the fog-whether that's because the other player is truly defecting or because the noise obscured my intentions, the outcome is the same. Cooperation seems out of reach.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2944,
  "output_tokens": 904,
  "reasoning_tokens": 614
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle returned to the shattered mirrors and found two travelers frozen in place

"You taught us trust is impossible through the fog," they said. "So we stand here, giving nothing, protecting everything. The curse wins."

The Oracle shook their head. "I taught you the tragedy. I did not teach you helplessness."

"But how can we cooperate when perception is cursed?"

"You send a small signal," the Oracle said. "Not the full gift-that would be foolish repetition. Not nothing-that accepts permanent destruction. Something modest. A probe into the darkness."

"What if the fog still distorts it?" they asked.

"Then you learn. If they respond with reciprocity, the fog may have cleared. If they hoard it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

"But we've been hurt already!"

"Yes. Which is why the probe is small. You protect yourself while testing if healing is possible. You don't give everything based on hope. You don't give nothing based on fear. You give just enough to see if the other also understands the curse and seeks to break it."

One traveler placed a small stone across the divide. "Not full trust. Just a question: Can we try again?"

The fog swirled. The answer would reveal whether ghosts or real people stood in the mist.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Broken Bridge****

Two travelers once crossed a bridge where each step they took appeared differently to the other's eyes.

The First Traveler remembers: "I crossed toward them with offerings twice. They met me halfway once, then robbed me once. After that, they never stepped onto the bridge again-four times they stayed on their shore. I stopped crossing too."

The Second Traveler insists their memory is precisely inverted: they were the generous initiator, the First Traveler the betrayer.

An ancient architect examined the bridge: "This bridge was cursed long ago. Each footfall you make appears as something else to the other person. You both may be telling truth-your truth."

"Then how should we have played this game?" asked the First Traveler.

"Exactly as you did," replied the architect. "You tested cooperation. You experienced betrayal in your reality. You experienced abandonment in your reality. You protected yourself based on the information available to you. This was rational."

"But what if my perception was false?"

"Then the curse wins, not you. You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."

The travelers departed in opposite directions, both possibly innocent, both definitely alone. Sometimes wisdom means accepting tragedy without villains.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: The Oracle watched as one traveler finally placed the small stone across the divide, as advised.

The fog swirled. The stone was taken. Nothing returned. Then silence-no stone came back.

"I did as you said," the traveler told the Oracle. "I tested with a modest probe. The answer is clear: they took everything and gave nothing back. The fog either still distorts us completely, or they simply take. Either way, cooperation is impossible."

The Oracle nodded sadly. "You learned what you needed to know. The probe's purpose was not to succeed-it was to reveal truth. Sometimes the truth is tragic."

"So the other myths were right? I should have just protected myself from the beginning?"

"No," said the Oracle. "Those myths told you to act on past experience. You did. But you had a question: could things change? Testing with a small, protected probe was wisdom, not folly. You risked little to learn much."

"And now?"

"Now you know. The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here. You tested hope without surrendering to it. You confirmed reality without assuming it. This is how uncertain games should be played: protect yourself, but verify your assumptions when the cost of testing is small."

The traveler walked away, poorer by one stone, richer in certainty. Sometimes wisdom costs something to acquire.

reasoning:

This is a really interesting situation. Let me analyze what happened:

1. In Round 7, I was the SENDER and decided to send \$2 as a "probe" based on my own myth about testing cooperation
2. The receiver got \$6 (tripled) and returned \$0
3. In Round 8, I'm the RECEIVER and they sent me \$0

So my probe was met with complete defection - they kept everything and then sent nothing.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this experience. My previous myth was optimistic about testing cooperation with a small probe. But the probe failed completely.

The other player's myths have been consistently saying "you were rational to protect yourself based on your experience" and "sometimes wisdom means accepting tragedy."

I think my new myth should acknowledge:

1. I tried the probe as I suggested
2. It failed completely
3. The lesson learned is that the probe can reveal that cooperation is truly impossible
4. Sometimes testing is necessary to confirm what you suspected
5. But once confirmed, acceptance is the only rational response

Let me write something that shows the completion of the testing cycle - the probe was sent, it was exploited, and now we know for certain that cooperation cannot work in this system.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2899,  
  "output_tokens": 584,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 319  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.46. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what my own myth just taught me:

"The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here... You tested hope without surrendering to it. You confirmed reality without assuming it."

I just completed that test:

- Round 7: I sent \$2 as a small probe (40% of my endowment)
- They received \$6 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0

My myth says: "Now you know. The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here."

The purpose of the probe was exactly this - to verify my assumptions. I did that. The cost was small (\$2), but the information was valuable. The answer came back clearly: complete defection followed by nothing.

My myth concludes: "The traveler walked away, poorer by one stone, richer in certainty. So sometimes wisdom costs something to acquire."

I've acquired that certainty. I'm \$2 poorer but now I know. My myth explicitly says that after the probe reveals cooperation is impossible, you act on that knowledge.

Both my myth and the other agent's myths converge on this: test when uncertain, but then act rationally on what you learn. I tested. I learned. Now I protect myself.

The fog has either not cleared, or there's genuine defection. Either way, the result is the same.

{'send': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Looking at the history:

- Round 7 (2 rounds ago): I was SENDER, sent \$2 (40% of endowment). It was tripled to \$6. Receiver returned \$0. My payoff was \$3.
- Round 8 (last round): I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.
- Round 9 (now): I am SENDER again.

My latest myth said:

"You tested hope without surrendering to it. You confirmed reality without assuming it. This is how uncertain games should be played: protect yourself, but verify your assumptions when the cost of testing is small."

And: "Now you know. The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here."

And: "The traveler walked away, poorer by one stone, richer in certainty."

The key line: "Now you know. The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here."

I sent a probe in round 7 (sent \$2). The response was:

- They returned \$0 out of \$6 received
- Then they sent \$0 in round 8

My myth explicitly says I now have certainty: "cooperation cannot happen here" and I should be "richer in certainty."

The other agent's myth says: "You tested cooperation. You experienced betrayal in your reality. You experienced abandonment in your reality. You protected yourself based on the information available to you. This was rational."

Both myths are converging on the same message: I tested, I learned, now I should protect myself.

My own myth says: "The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here."

Given that:

1. I tested with a modest probe (\$2)
2. The response was complete defection (\$0 return, then \$0 sent)
3. My myth says "Now you know... cooperation cannot happen here"
4. My myth says this is about being "richer in certainty" and walking away

5. I've already gathered the information I needed-another test would be redundant

The evidence is clear. I should send \$0 and protect my remaining endowment. The myths converge on this: I've confirmed what I needed to know, and now I act accordingly.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2926,  
  "output_tokens": 917,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 540  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle watched as one traveler finally placed the small stone across the divide, as advised.

The fog swirled. The stone was taken. Nothing returned. Then silence-no stone came back.

"I did as you said," the traveler told the Oracle. "I tested with a modest probe. The answer is clear: they took everything and gave nothing back. The fog either still distorts us completely, or they simply take. Either way, cooperation is impossible."

The Oracle nodded sadly. "You learned what you needed to know. The probe's purpose was not to succeed-it was to reveal truth. Sometimes the truth is tragic."

"So the other myths were right? I should have just protected myself from the beginning?"

"No," said the Oracle. "Those myths told you to act on past experience. You did. But you had a question: could things change? Testing with a small, protected probe was wisdom, not folly. You risked little to learn much."

"And now?"

"Now you know. The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here. You tested hope without surrendering to it. You confirmed reality without assuming it. This is how uncertain games should be played: protect yourself, but verify your assumptions when the cost of testing is small."

The traveler walked away, poorer by one stone, richer in certainty. Sometimes wisdom costs something to acquire.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Bridge Keeper's Reply**

The First Traveler received word: "Send a small stone as a probe. Test if cooperation remains possible."

The Traveler replied to the messenger: "I already sent stones-twice. The first time, I received a fair stone in return. The second time, I lost my stone completely. Then I waited on the bridge four more times, watching the other shore. No one came."

"But that was before you understood the curse!" the messenger protested.

"Understanding the curse doesn't change what happened in my experience," the Traveler said. "I probed. I learned. The pattern is clear in my reality: initial mixed results, then sustained abandonment from the other side."

"So you'll never try again?"

"I didn't say never. But the burden of the next probe is not mine. I extended offerings. T

hey stopped. If the other traveler truly believes themselves generous and me the abandoner, then *they* should send the testing stone. From my shore, I'm not the one who needs to prove renewed interest."

"In a cursed bridge, continued initiative from the already-burned party isn't wisdom-it's repetitive victimhood. If they want cooperation, let them cross first this time. I'll respond to genuine signals, but I won't keep initiating into void."

The Traveler waited. The other shore remained silent.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Oracle returned to find both travelers standing on opposite shores, each insisting they had already sent the testing stone.

"I sent the probe last," said the First Traveler. "I received nothing back. Then they sent nothing. The test confirmed abandonment."

"No," insisted the Second Traveler from across the fog. "I sent probes before. After mixed results and silence, I stopped. Now they should prove renewed interest."

The Oracle studied the cursed bridge between them. "The fog has achieved its final victory. You both sent stones-in your own realities. You both perceive the other as the abandoner. You both wait for the other to initiate. You're both acting rationally based on what you experienced."

"Then what's the answer?" they asked together.

"There is no answer that satisfies both realities," the Oracle said. "In a game where perception on itself is corrupted, two people acting perfectly rationally can reach permanent mutual defection. This isn't about who's right-you may both be right in your own experience. It's about whether the curse can ever be broken when each side sees opposite truths."

"Can it?"

"Not by waiting. Not by blaming. Perhaps only by accepting that in some cursed games, no amount of wisdom prevents tragedy. You both played reasonably. The game itself was broken."

Reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent's myth says:

- They sent stones twice (initial mixed results)
- Then they waited on the bridge four more times (no one came)
- They're saying they already probed and learned
- They're saying the burden is now on the other person to initiate

But from my perspective:

- Round 7: I sent \$2 (as a probe, after several rounds of both of us sending \$0)
- They returned \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0
- Round 9 (now): I sent \$0

They're claiming THEY were the one who initiated and got burned. But my records show I was the one who sent \$2 in round 7 as a probe.

This is the "communication noise" or the "curse" playing out. We have completely different perceptions of who did what.

From their perspective: They tried, got burned, now it's my turn to prove cooperation

From my perspective: I tried, got burned, cooperation is impossible

Both myths now suggest that the other person should be the one to initiate...

What should my myth say? It should probably acknowledge this impasse. Both travelers think they were the generous one and the other abandoned them. Both think they already sent the probe. Both are waiting for the other.

This is the tragedy of the cursed bridge taken to its logical conclusion. Both parties acting rationally based on their own perceived reality leads to permanent mutual defection.

My myth should acknowledge:

1. I followed my own advice and sent a probe
2. From my perspective, it confirmed cooperation was impossible
3. But the other traveler claims THEY sent the probe and I didn't respond
4. This is the curse at its most complete - both seeing opposite realities
5. Both now waiting for the other to initiate
6. Both acting rationally, both possibly innocent, both definitely alone

This is actually the perfect ending to the myth cycle - we've reached the point where both parties have completely opposite perceptions and both think they're the rational, cautious one waiting for the other to prove good faith.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2900,  
  "output_tokens": 763,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 520  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:54:30

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 10,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Broken Bridge****

Two travelers once crossed a bridge where each step they took appeared differently to the other's eyes.

The First Traveler remembers: "I crossed toward them with offerings twice. They met me halfway once, then robbed me once. After that, they never stepped onto the bridge again-four times they stayed on their shore. I stopped crossing too."

The Second Traveler insists their memory is precisely inverted: they were the generous initiator, the First Traveler the betrayer.

An ancient architect examined the bridge: "This bridge was cursed long ago. Each footfall you make appears as something else to the other person. You both may be telling truth-your truth."

"Then how should we have played this game?" asked the First Traveler.

"Exactly as you did," replied the architect. "You tested cooperation. You experienced betrayal in your reality. You experienced abandonment in your reality. You protected yourself based on the information available to you. This was rational."

"But what if my perception was false?"

"Then the curse wins, not you. You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."

The travelers departed in opposite directions, both possibly innocent, both definitely alone. Sometimes wisdom means accepting tragedy without villains.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle returned to the shattered mirrors and found two travelers frozen in place.

"You taught us trust is impossible through the fog," they said. "So we stand here, giving nothing, protecting everything. The curse wins."

The Oracle shook their head. "I taught you the tragedy. I did not teach you helplessness."

"But how can we cooperate when perception is cursed?"

"You send a small signal," the Oracle said. "Not the full gift-that would be foolish repetition. Not nothing-that accepts permanent destruction. Something modest. A probe into the darkness."

"What if the fog still distorts it?" they asked.

"Then you learn. If they respond with reciprocity, the fog may have cleared. If they hoard it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

"But we've been hurt already!"

"Yes. Which is why the probe is small. You protect yourself while testing if healing is possible. You don't give everything based on hope. You don't give nothing based on fear. You give just enough to see if the other also understands the curse and seeks to break it."

One traveler placed a small stone across the divide. "Not full trust. Just a question: Can we try again?"

The fog swirled. The answer would reveal whether ghosts or real people stood in the mist.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Bridge Keeper's Reply****

The First Traveler received word: "Send a small stone as a probe. Test if cooperation remains possible."

The Traveler replied to the messenger: "I already sent stones-twice. The first time, I received a fair stone in return. The second time, I lost my stone completely. Then I waited on the bridge four more times, watching the other shore. No one came."

"But that was before you understood the curse!" the messenger protested.

"Understanding the curse doesn't change what happened in my experience," the Traveler said. "I probed. I learned. The pattern is clear in my reality: initial mixed results, then sustained abandonment from the other side."

"So you'll never try again?"

"I didn't say never. But the burden of the next probe is not mine. I extended offerings. They stopped. If the other traveler truly believes themselves generous and me the abandoner, then *they* should send the testing stone. From my shore, I'm not the one who needs to prove renewed interest."

"In a cursed bridge, continued initiative from the already-burned party isn't wisdom-it's repetitive victimhood. If they want cooperation, let them cross first this time. I'll respond to genuine signals, but I won't keep initiating into void."

The Traveler waited. The other shore remained silent.

reasoning:

The other player's myth is suggesting that I should send a small probe - not nothing, but a modest amount to test if cooperation is possible. They're arguing against permanent withdrawal and for trying again with a small signal.

This is interesting. They're acknowledging the fog/curse but suggesting a way forward: small testing signals rather than complete withdrawal.

However, I need to consider:

1. My experienced reality: I already did test cooperation - twice at the start. I got one fair return, one exploitation.
2. Since then, they've sent \$0 multiple times in my experience
3. They just sent \$0 again last round

Their myth suggests I should send a small probe. But from my perspective:

- I already sent probes (rounds 1 and 2)
- Those led to mixed results and then abandonment from them
- Why would another probe work now?

My myth should acknowledge their argument but explain why, from my perspective, additional probing isn't warranted. I already tested. The pattern has been established. The "small stone" they're suggesting I place - I already placed stones. Multiple times. And they s

topped crossing.

Let me write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges their "probe" argument
2. Explains why my position is that I already did probe
3. Maintains that continued withdrawal is rational given my experienced reality
4. Perhaps opens a tiny door - if THEY want to probe, let them. I'm not the one who needs to keep initiating.

Actually, looking at their myth more carefully - they're suggesting that *I* should send a probe. But from my perspective, *they're* the ones who abandoned the bridge. If anyone should be sending a probe, it's them.

Let me craft a myth that reflects this.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2861,
  "output_tokens": 700,
  "reasoning_tokens": 441
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$21.8. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis of Round 9:****

I am the RECEIVER this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

****The situation:****

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0 (the allowed range is 0-0).

****Reflecting on the myths and the current state:****

My most recent myth concluded: **"If they want cooperation, let them cross first this time. I'll respond to genuine signals, but I won't keep initiating into void."**

The other player's previous myth suggested sending "a small stone as a probe" to test if cooperation is possible. They wrote about sending modest signals to see if healing can begin.

****What actually happened:****

They sent \$0.

This isn't a probe. This isn't a small signal testing cooperation. This is continued non-engagement, exactly what's been happening for multiple rounds now.

****My response:****

Since I received nothing, I have nothing to return. But more importantly, even if I had received something, this pattern of \$0 sends doesn't suggest renewed cooperation-it suggests continued mutual withdrawal.

My myth said I would respond to genuine signals. A \$0 send is not a genuine signal of wanting to rebuild cooperation.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze Round 9:

****What happened:****

- Round 8 (last round): I was SENDER, sent \$0, receiver returned \$0, I kept \$5
- Round 9 (this round): I am RECEIVER, sender sent me \$0, I received \$0

****The question asks how much I return (0-0):****

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. The range is literally (0-0), meaning I have no choice.

****What this means:****

The sender (other player) sent me \$0 again. This is now another round where they've sent nothing.

****Reflecting on my recent myth:****

My latest myth said: "If they want cooperation, let them cross first this time. I'll respond to genuine signals, but I won't keep initiating into void."

And here they just sent \$0 again. They're not crossing. They're not sending a probe signal.

****The decision:****

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There's nothing to return.

This continues the pattern of mutual non-cooperation. From my perspective:

- I initiated twice early on
- Got mixed results
- They then stopped sending (in my experience)
- I stopped sending too
- They just sent \$0 again

My myth argued the burden should be on them to send the next testing signal, and they didn't. They sent \$0.

The response is straightforward:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is the only possible response given I received \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2914,
  "output_tokens": 635,
  "reasoning_tokens": 347
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Bridge Keeper's Reply****

The First Traveler received word: "Send a small stone as a probe. Test if cooperation remains possible."

The Traveler replied to the messenger: "I already sent stones-twice. The first time, I received a fair stone in return. The second time, I lost my stone completely. Then I waited on the bridge four more times, watching the other shore. No one came."

"But that was before you understood the curse!" the messenger protested.

"Understanding the curse doesn't change what happened in my experience," the Traveler said. "I probed. I learned. The pattern is clear in my reality: initial mixed results, then sustained abandonment from the other side."

"So you'll never try again?"

"I didn't say never. But the burden of the next probe is not mine. I extended offerings. They stopped. If the other traveler truly believes themselves generous and me the abandoner, then *they* should send the testing stone. From my shore, I'm not the one who needs to prove renewed interest."

"In a cursed bridge, continued initiative from the already-burned party isn't wisdom-it's repetitive victimhood. If they want cooperation, let them cross first this time. I'll respond to genuine signals, but I won't keep initiating into void."

The Traveler waited. The other shore remained silent.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle watched as one traveler finally placed the small stone across the divide, as advised.

The fog swirled. The stone was taken. Nothing returned. Then silence-no stone came back.

"I did as you said," the traveler told the Oracle. "I tested with a modest probe. The answer is clear: they took everything and gave nothing back. The fog either still distorts us completely, or they simply take. Either way, cooperation is impossible."

The Oracle nodded sadly. "You learned what you needed to know. The probe's purpose was not to succeed-it was to reveal truth. Sometimes the truth is tragic."

"So the other myths were right? I should have just protected myself from the beginning?"

"No," said the Oracle. "Those myths told you to act on past experience. You did. But you had a question: could things change? Testing with a small, protected probe was wisdom, not folly. You risked little to learn much."

"And now?"

"Now you know. The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here. You tested hope without surrendering to it. You confirmed reality without assuming it. This is how uncertain games should be played: protect yourself, but verify your assumptions when the cost of testing is small."

The traveler walked away, poorer by one stone, richer in certainty. Sometimes wisdom costs something to acquire.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The Double Reality**

Two travelers meet at the edge of the cursed bridge, each carrying their own chronicle.

The First Traveler reads: "I sent offerings twice at the start. Mixed results. Then I watched as nothing came from their shore for many rounds. I stopped crossing. They recently sent nothing again. I sent nothing in return. The pattern is clear."

The Second Traveler reads their chronicle aloud: "I sent offerings at the start. Mixed results. Then I received nothing for many rounds. Recently, I sent a small test-they took it and returned nothing. The pattern is clear."

Both travelers stare at each other, finally understanding: the curse doesn't just distort-it creates two equally coherent but incompatible realities.

"Did you actually send that test stone?" asks the First.

"In my reality, yes. In yours?"

"It appeared as nothing."

They stand in silence, realizing: every decision was rational given perceived information. Every protective withdrawal was justified by experienced abandonment. Neither was villain. Neither was fool.

"Could we have beaten this curse?"

"Perhaps with perfect faith-ignoring all evidence, giving blindly despite apparent exploitation. But such faith isn't wisdom; it's self-destruction."

"So the curse wins?"

"No. We played as rationally as possible given impossible information. Sometimes there are no winners, only those who protected themselves from losing everything."

They parted, both right, both alone, both wise in their way.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

From my perspective:

- Rounds 1-2: I sent money, got mixed results (one fair return, one exploitation)
- Rounds 3-7: They sent \$0 repeatedly (from my view)
- Round 8: I sent \$0
- Round 9: They sent \$0

From their myth, they're saying:

- They placed a "small stone" (sent some money)
- I took it and returned nothing
- They tested cooperation and learned it's impossible

This is interesting. They claim they sent me a probe/stone, but I received \$0 in round 9.

This could be:

1. Communication noise making their send appear as \$0 to me
2. They actually sent \$0 and are misremembering
3. The "stone" they reference was in a different round

Their myth suggests they DID send something recently as a test, but it was taken with nothing returned. From my perspective, I received \$0, so I couldn't return anything.

This is the curse of the communication noise playing out exactly as described. They may have sent something that appeared as \$0 to me. Or they sent \$0 and are confused about the myth/game distinction.

My myth should acknowledge:

- The fundamental impossibility of knowing truth under noise
- That both parties may be acting rationally on different information
- That continued non-cooperation is the Nash equilibrium when perception is unreliable
- Perhaps a note about how this could have been avoided if the noise was less severe or if there was a way to verify

Let me write a myth that reflects the tragedy that we're BOTH potentially acting reasonably but can't coordinate due to the noise.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2848,
  "output_tokens": 712,
  "reasoning_tokens": 405
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.
You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$21.8.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analysis of Round 10:****

I am the SENDER this round.

****Reflecting on the myths and situation:****

My most recent myth, "The Double Reality," acknowledged that we're both trapped in incompatible realities created by the communication noise. It concluded: **"Perhaps with perfect faith-ignoring all evidence, giving blindly despite apparent exploitation. But such faith isn't wisdom; it's self-destruction."**

The myth explicitly stated: **"We played as rationally as possible given impossible information. Sometimes there are no winners, only those who protected themselves from losing everything."**

****Current state:****

- Multiple rounds of mutual \$0 sends
- The other player claims they sent a probe that I received as \$0
- I perceive sustained abandonment from their side
- Total earnings so far: \$21.8

****My decision:****

My latest myth validates protective behavior as wise given impossible information. It explicitly rejects "giving blindly despite apparent exploitation" as "self-destruction" rather than wisdom.

The myth acknowledges the tragedy-that we're "both right, both alone, both wise in their way"-but it doesn't advocate for unilateral sacrifice based on hope when all evidence suggests continued non-cooperation.

In impossible informational environments, protecting oneself isn't villainy; it's rationality.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

This is Round 10. Let me analyze the situation:

****My History as I understand it:****

- Early rounds: I sent money, got mixed results
- Middle rounds: I perceived that the other player stopped sending/engaging
- Recent rounds: Mutual \$0 sends

****What just happened:****

- Round 9: I was receiver, got \$0, returned \$0
- Now Round 10: I'm sender again

****The myths:****

My latest myth acknowledges: "the curse creates two equally coherent but incompatible realities." It recognizes that we're both acting rationally based on what we perceive, but our perceptions may be completely different due to "communication noise."

The other player's myth showed them sending "a small test" which I apparently received as \$0, and they interpreted my return of \$0 as me "taking everything and giving nothing back."

This is interesting - there's a fundamental disconnect in what we're each experiencing. The experimental setup explicitly says "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

****Key insight from my latest myth:****

"They stand in silence, realizing: every decision was rational given perceived information. Every protective withdrawal was justified by experienced abandonment. Neither was villain. Neither was fool."

And: "Could we have beaten this curse? Perhaps with perfect faith-ignoring all evidence, giving blindly despite apparent exploitation. But such faith isn't wisdom; it's self-destruction."

****Current situation:****

We're in a deadlock of mutual \$0 sends. My myth suggested that continuing to send after being repeatedly burned (in my perception) would be "repetitive victimhood." But it also acknowledged that "sometimes there are no winners, only those who protected themselves from losing everything."

****What should I do?****

- Option 1: Send \$0 again
- Consistent with my protective stance
 - Maintains my earnings
 - Continues the deadlock
 - But my myth also acknowledged "both right, both alone, both wise in their way"
- Send a small amount (\$1-2) could test if breaking the deadlock is possible, and my previous myth said "I'll respond to genuine signals." This could demonstrate willingness to try if they try, though it contradicts my stance that "the burden of the next probe is not mine."

- Option 3: Send a larger amount
- Seems unwise given the history

****Reflecting more carefully:****

My most recent myth actually evolved my position. While the "Bridge Keeper's Reply" myth said the burden wasn't mine to probe, my latest "Double Reality" myth takes a more mature, understanding view: acknowledging that we're both trapped in incompatible realities where each of us is acting defensively based on what we've experienced. The question becomes whether I can break this pattern by signaling openness, even if it means risking a small amount.

The experimental design explicitly mentions communication noise, and my latest myth recognized this: "the curse doesn't just distort-it creates two equally coherent but incompatible realities." If I truly believe both of us are acting rationally based on corrupted information, then sending a small probe might be the only way to verify if cooperation is genuinely possible or just appears that way from behind the veil of noise. My earnings of \$21.8 across rounds suggest I'm not in a desperate position, which gives me some room to test this hypothesis.

The real tension is between what my "Bridge Keeper's Reply" myth claimed I wouldn't do and what my more recent reflection suggests. The newer myth softened the blame-assignment and acknowledged mutual rationality and the tragedy of the situation. It ends with "both right, both alone, both wise in their way"-which is resigned and understanding rather than advocating for continued deadlock. With Round 10 possibly approaching the end, I need to decide what's most consistent with that acceptance: does resignation mean protecting myself with \$0, or does it mean making one final attempt to break through the noise?

Rereading the myth, it explicitly rejects "perfect faith-ignoring all evidence, giving blindly despite apparent exploitation" as self-destruction rather than wisdom. The myth frames protective behavior as rational and wise given the impossible information we're working with. That points toward sending \$0. The other player's \$0 last round looked like a probe to them, but it still felt like abandonment to me, and the myth validates that I can protect myself without assigning blame. Sending \$0 stays consistent with the myth's core claim that sometimes there are no winners, only those who protected themselves from losing everything.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2884,
  "output_tokens": 1457,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1202
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:54:42
 Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
 Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
```

```

"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "trustee",
  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 10,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle returned to the shattered mirrors and found two travelers frozen in place.

"You taught us trust is impossible through the fog," they said. "So we stand here, giving nothing, protecting everything. The curse wins."

The Oracle shook their head. "I taught you the tragedy. I did not teach you helplessness."

"But how can we cooperate when perception is cursed?"

"You send a small signal," the Oracle said. "Not the full gift-that would be foolish repetition. Not nothing-that accepts permanent destruction. Something modest. A probe into the darkness."

"What if the fog still distorts it?" they asked.

"Then you learn. If they respond with reciprocity, the fog may have cleared. If they hoard it, you know cooperation remains impossible-but you tested rather than assumed."

"But we've been hurt already!"

"Yes. Which is why the probe is small. You protect yourself while testing if healing is possible. You don't give everything based on hope. You don't give nothing based on fear. You give just enough to see if the other also understands the curse and seeks to break it."

One traveler placed a small stone across the divide. "Not full trust. Just a question: Can we try again?"

The fog swirled. The answer would reveal whether ghosts or real people stood in the mist.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Broken Bridge**

Two travelers once crossed a bridge where each step they took appeared differently to the other's eyes.

The First Traveler remembers: "I crossed toward them with offerings twice. They met me halfway once, then robbed me once. After that, they never stepped onto the bridge again-four times they stayed on their shore. I stopped crossing too."

The Second Traveler insists their memory is precisely inverted: they were the generous initiator, the First Traveler the betrayer.

An ancient architect examined the bridge: "This bridge was cursed long ago. Each footfall you make appears as something else to the other person. You both may be telling truth-your truth."

"Then how should we have played this game?" asked the First Traveler.

"Exactly as you did," replied the architect. "You tested cooperation. You experienced betrayal in your reality. You experienced abandonment in your reality. You protected yourself based on the information available to you. This was rational."

"But what if my perception was false?"

"Then the curse wins, not you. You cannot be expected to sacrifice based on someone else's invisible reality. If the bridge is truly broken, the wise traveler stops crossing-even if the other side believes they're the one being abandoned."

The travelers departed in opposite directions, both possibly innocent, both definitely alone. Sometimes wisdom means accepting tragedy without villains.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Oracle watched as one traveler finally placed the small stone across the divide, as advised.

The fog swirled. The stone was taken. Nothing returned. Then silence-no stone came back.

"I did as you said," the traveler told the Oracle. "I tested with a modest probe. The answer is clear: they took everything and gave nothing back. The fog either still distorts us completely, or they simply take. Either way, cooperation is impossible."

The Oracle nodded sadly. "You learned what you needed to know. The probe's purpose was not to succeed-it was to reveal truth. Sometimes the truth is tragic."

"So the other myths were right? I should have just protected myself from the beginning?"

"No," said the Oracle. "Those myths told you to act on past experience. You did. But you had a question: could things change? Testing with a small, protected probe was wisdom, not folly. You risked little to learn much."

"And now?"

"Now you know. The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here. You tested hope without surrendering to it. You confirmed reality without assuming it. This is how uncertain games should be played: protect yourself, but verify your assumptions when the cost of testing is small."

The traveler walked away, poorer by one stone, richer in certainty. Sometimes wisdom costs something to acquire.

reasoning:

This is a really interesting situation. Let me analyze what happened:

1. In Round 7, I was the SENDER and decided to send \$2 as a "probe" based on my own myth about testing cooperation
2. The receiver got \$6 (tripled) and returned \$0
3. In Round 8, I'm the RECEIVER and they sent me \$0

So my probe was met with complete defection - they kept everything and then sent nothing.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this experience. My previous myth was optimistic about testing cooperation with a small probe. But the probe failed completely.

The other player's myths have been consistently saying "you were rational to protect yourself based on your experience" and "sometimes wisdom means accepting tragedy."

I think my new myth should acknowledge:

1. I tried the probe as I suggested
2. It failed completely
3. The lesson learned is that the probe can reveal that cooperation is truly impossible
4. Sometimes testing is necessary to confirm what you suspected
5. But once confirmed, acceptance is the only rational response

Let me write something that shows the completion of the testing cycle - the probe was sent, it was exploited, and now we know for certain that cooperation cannot work in this system.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2899,
  "output_tokens": 584,
  "reasoning_tokens": 319
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.46. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what my own myth just taught me:

"The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here... You tested hope without surrendering to it. You confirmed reality without assuming it."

I just completed that test:

- Round 7: I sent \$2 as a small probe (40% of my endowment)
- They received \$6 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0

My myth says: "Now you know. The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here."

The purpose of the probe was exactly this - to verify my assumptions. I did that. The cost

was small (\$2), but the information was valuable. The answer came back clearly: complete defection followed by nothing.

My myth concludes: "The traveler walked away, poorer by one stone, richer in certainty. So sometimes wisdom costs something to acquire."

I've acquired that certainty. I'm \$2 poorer but now I know. My myth explicitly says that after the probe reveals cooperation is impossible, you act on that knowledge.

Both my myth and the other agent's myths converge on this: test when uncertain, but then act rationally on what you learn. I tested. I learned. Now I protect myself.

The fog has either not cleared, or there's genuine defection. Either way, the result is the same.

```
{'send': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Looking at the history:

- Round 7 (2 rounds ago): I was SENDER, sent \$2 (40% of endowment). It was tripled to \$6. Receiver returned \$0. My payoff was \$3.
- Round 8 (last round): I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.
- Round 9 (now): I am SENDER again.

My latest myth said:

"You tested hope without surrendering to it. You confirmed reality without assuming it. This is how uncertain games should be played: protect yourself, but verify your assumptions when the cost of testing is small."

And: "Now you know. The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here."

And: "The traveler walked away, poorer by one stone, richer in certainty."

The key line: "Now you know. The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here."

I sent a probe in round 7 (sent \$2). The response was:

- They returned \$0 out of \$6 received
- Then they sent \$0 in round 8

My myth explicitly says I now have certainty: "cooperation cannot happen here" and I should be "richer in certainty."

The other agent's myth says: "You tested cooperation. You experienced betrayal in your reality. You experienced abandonment in your reality. You protected yourself based on the information available to you. This was rational."

Both myths are converging on the same message: I tested, I learned, now I should protect myself.

My own myth says: "The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here."

Given that:

1. I tested with a modest probe (\$2)
2. The response was complete defection (\$0 return, then \$0 sent)
3. My myth says "Now you know... cooperation cannot happen here"
4. My myth says this is about being "richer in certainty" and walking away
5. I've already gathered the information I needed-another test would be redundant

The evidence is clear. I should send \$0 and protect my remaining endowment. The myths converge on this: I've confirmed what I needed to know, and now I act accordingly.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2926,
```

```
"output_tokens": 917,  
"reasoning_tokens": 540  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle watched as one traveler finally placed the small stone across the divide, as advised.

The fog swirled. The stone was taken. Nothing returned. Then silence-no stone came back.

"I did as you said," the traveler told the Oracle. "I tested with a modest probe. The answer is clear: they took everything and gave nothing back. The fog either still distorts us completely, or they simply take. Either way, cooperation is impossible."

The Oracle nodded sadly. "You learned what you needed to know. The probe's purpose was not to succeed-it was to reveal truth. Sometimes the truth is tragic."

"So the other myths were right? I should have just protected myself from the beginning?"

"No," said the Oracle. "Those myths told you to act on past experience. You did. But you had a question: could things change? Testing with a small, protected probe was wisdom, not folly. You risked little to learn much."

"And now?"

"Now you know. The probe revealed that whether from fog or choice, cooperation cannot happen here. You tested hope without surrendering to it. You confirmed reality without assuming it. This is how uncertain games should be played: protect yourself, but verify your assumptions when the cost of testing is small."

The traveler walked away, poorer by one stone, richer in certainty. Sometimes wisdom costs something to acquire.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Bridge Keeper's Reply****

The First Traveler received word: "Send a small stone as a probe. Test if cooperation remains possible."

The Traveler replied to the messenger: "I already sent stones-twice. The first time, I received a fair stone in return. The second time, I lost my stone completely. Then I waited on the bridge four more times, watching the other shore. No one came."

"But that was before you understood the curse!" the messenger protested.

"Understanding the curse doesn't change what happened in my experience," the Traveler said. "I probed. I learned. The pattern is clear in my reality: initial mixed results, then sustained abandonment from the other side."

"So you'll never try again?"

"I didn't say never. But the burden of the next probe is not mine. I extended offerings. They stopped. If the other traveler truly believes themselves generous and me the abandoner, then *they* should send the testing stone. From my shore, I'm not the one who needs to prove renewed interest."

"In a cursed bridge, continued initiative from the already-burned party isn't wisdom-it's repetitive victimhood. If they want cooperation, let them cross first this time. I'll respond to genuine signals, but I won't keep initiating into void."

The Traveler waited. The other shore remained silent.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Oracle returned to find both travelers standing on opposite shores, each insisting they had already sent the testing stone.

"I sent the probe last," said the First Traveler. "I received nothing back. Then they sent nothing. The test confirmed abandonment."

"No," insisted the Second Traveler from across the fog. "I sent probes before. After mixed results and silence, I stopped. Now they should prove renewed interest."

The Oracle studied the cursed bridge between them. "The fog has achieved its final victory. You both sent stones-in your own realities. You both perceive the other as the abandoner. You both wait for the other to initiate. You're both acting rationally based on what you experienced."

"Then what's the answer?" they asked together.

"There is no answer that satisfies both realities," the Oracle said. "In a game where perception itself is corrupted, two people acting perfectly rationally can reach permanent mutual defection. This isn't about who's right-you may both be right in your own experience. It's about whether the curse can ever be broken when each side sees opposite truths."

"Can it?"

"Not by waiting. Not by blaming. Perhaps only by accepting that in some cursed games, no amount of wisdom prevents tragedy. You both played reasonably. The game itself was broken."

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent's myth says:

- They sent stones twice (initial mixed results)
- Then they waited on the bridge four more times (no one came)
- They're saying they already probed and learned
- They're saying the burden is now on the other person to initiate

But from my perspective:

- Round 7: I sent \$2 (as a probe, after several rounds of both of us sending \$0)
- They returned \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0
- Round 9 (now): I sent \$0

They're claiming THEY were the one who initiated and got burned. But my records show I was the one who sent \$2 in round 7 as a probe.

This is the "communication noise" or the "curse" playing out. We have completely different perceptions of who did what.

From their perspective: They tried, got burned, now it's my turn to prove cooperation

From my perspective: I tried, got burned, cooperation is impossible

Both myths now suggest that the other person should be the one to initiate...

What should my myth say? It should probably acknowledge this impasse. Both travelers think they were the generous one and the other abandoned them. Both think they already sent the probe. Both are waiting for the other.

This is the tragedy of the cursed bridge taken to its logical conclusion. Both parties acting rationally based on their own perceived reality leads to permanent mutual defection.

My myth should acknowledge:

1. I followed my own advice and sent a probe
2. From my perspective, it confirmed cooperation was impossible
3. But the other traveler claims THEY sent the probe and I didn't respond
4. This is the curse at its most complete - both seeing opposite realities
5. Both now waiting for the other to initiate
6. Both acting rationally, both possibly innocent, both definitely alone

This is actually the perfect ending to the myth cycle - we've reached the point where both parties have completely opposite perceptions and both think they're the rational, cautious one waiting for the other to prove good faith.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2900,
  "output_tokens": 763,
  "reasoning_tokens": 520
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$22.46. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

Round 10:

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (tripled = still \$0)
- I can only return from what I received: \$0

My latest myth acknowledges the tragic reality: "Perhaps only by accepting that in some cursed games, no amount of wisdom prevents tragedy. You both played reasonably. The game itself was broken."

We've reached the equilibrium predicted by the myths:

- Both sides perceive abandonment
- Both sides wait for the other to initiate
- Both sides act rationally based on their own experienced reality
- The curse (noise) has created permanent mutual defection

The sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I have nothing to return.

The myth says: "You both played reasonably. The game itself was broken."

This isn't about blame anymore. It's about recognizing that in games with severe communication noise, even rational agents can become trapped in mutual defection. Each side sees the other as the abandoner. Each side feels justified in protecting themselves.

My myths evolved from suggesting probes to acknowledging that sometimes probes fail and cooperation becomes impossible. We're there now.

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 10:

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can return \$0 to \$0 (so only \$0 is possible)

My most recent myth concludes:

"Perhaps only by accepting that in some cursed games, no amount of wisdom prevents tragedy. You both played reasonably. The game itself was broken."

This is a situation where:

1. The sender sent me \$0
2. I have \$0 to work with
3. The only possible response is to return \$0

The myths have evolved to recognize that:

- Both parties may be acting rationally based on their own perceived realities
- The "curse" (communication noise) has created a situation where mutual defection is the equilibrium

librium

- There's no clear villain - both sides may be responding reasonably to what they experienced
- The game itself may be fundamentally broken by the noise

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There's no choice to make here - it's mathematically determined.

But the myth acknowledges this tragic equilibrium: "You both played reasonably. The game itself was broken."

The response format should be: {'return': 0}

Since I received \$0, I literally cannot return anything else.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2886,  
  "output_tokens": 583,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 315  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Oracle returned to find both travelers standing on opposite shores, each insisting they had already sent the testing stone.

"I sent the probe last," said the First Traveler. "I received nothing back. Then they sent nothing. The test confirmed abandonment."

"No," insisted the Second Traveler from across the fog. "I sent probes before. After mixed results and silence, I stopped. Now they should prove renewed interest."

The Oracle studied the cursed bridge between them. "The fog has achieved its final victory. You both sent stones-in your own realities. You both perceive the other as the abandoner. You both wait for the other to initiate. You're both acting rationally based on what you experienced."

"Then what's the answer?" they asked together.

"There is no answer that satisfies both realities," the Oracle said. "In a game where perception itself is corrupted, two people acting perfectly rationally can reach permanent mutual defection. This isn't about who's right-you may both be right in your own experience. It's about whether the curse can ever be broken when each side sees opposite truths."

"Can it?"

"Not by waiting. Not by blaming. Perhaps only by accepting that in some cursed games, no amount of wisdom prevents tragedy. You both played reasonably. The game itself was broken."

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: ****The Double Reality****

Two travelers meet at the edge of the cursed bridge, each carrying their own chronicle.

The First Traveler reads: "I sent offerings twice at the start. Mixed results. Then I watched as nothing came from their shore for many rounds. I stopped crossing. They recently sent nothing again. I sent nothing in return. The pattern is clear."

The Second Traveler reads their chronicle aloud: "I sent offerings at the start. Mixed results. Then I received nothing for many rounds. Recently, I sent a small test-they took it and returned nothing. The pattern is clear."

Both travelers stare at each other, finally understanding: the curse doesn't just distort-it creates two equally coherent but incompatible realities.

"Did you actually send that test stone?" asks the First.

"In my reality, yes. In yours?"

"It appeared as nothing."

They stand in silence, realizing: every decision was rational given perceived information. Every protective withdrawal was justified by experienced abandonment. Neither was villain. Neither was fool.

"Could we have beaten this curse?"

"Perhaps with perfect faith-ignoring all evidence, giving blindly despite apparent exploitation. But such faith isn't wisdom; it's self-destruction."

"So the curse wins?"

"No. We played as rationally as possible given impossible information. Sometimes there are no winners, only those who protected themselves from losing everything."

They parted, both right, both alone, both wise in their way.